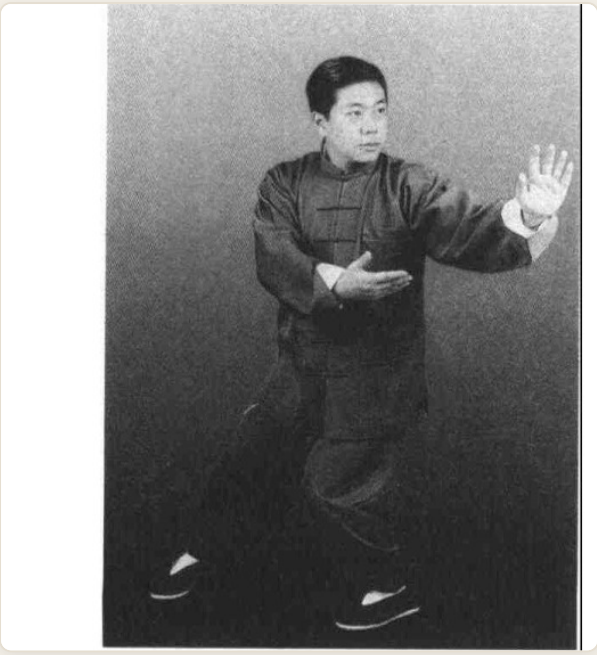
图 216B



the right foot stepping forward to the south-east, the weight shifting, both palms in transition.

...onto the right leg until the whole sole settles flat, the right leg bends and the left leg extends, forming the right bow stance. As the body turns and the centre of gravity shifts forward, the right palm, from in front of the left upper arm, goes down past the top of the right knee (the reverse brush of the knee) and arcs up to the right; as it moves the right arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm gradually turns outward, and it stops above and in front of the right temple (changing to a fist). The eye of the fist faces obliquely left, the centre of the fist obliquely outward; the left palm at the same time moves level as the body turns (lower than the shoulder), the elbow bent and the forearm laid across in front of the upper abdomen, the centre of the palm facing obliquely down, the eye of the fist facing obliquely inward. The eyes look level to the front (see the first two figures on this page).

BOOK PAGE 162

III. Key Points

III. Key Points

1. The turning in of the left foot, the changing of the two fists to palms and the turning of the waist with the lifting of the right leg must all begin together; when one thing moves, nothing is unmoved.

2. The left foot must be turned in sufficiently.

Fortieth Posture: Turn the Body Back and Right Heel Kick (Hui Shen You Deng Jiao)

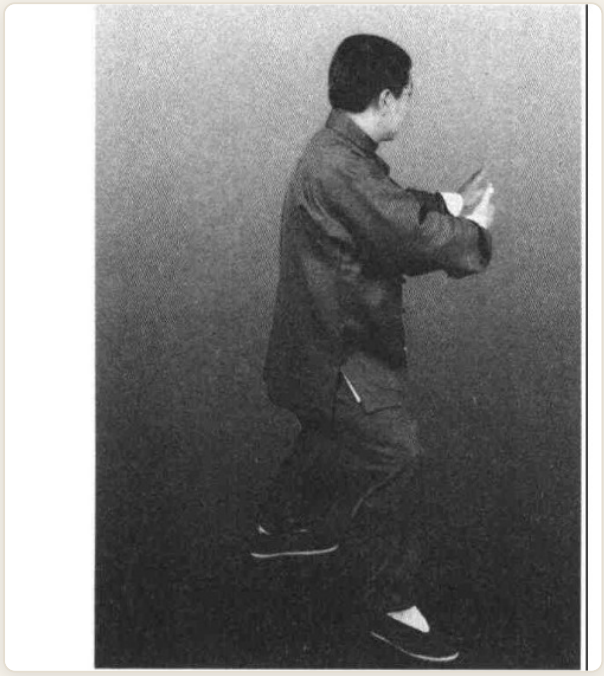
I. Application

The same as the thirty-seventh posture, the right heel kick, save that the direction of the joining is slightly different.

II. The Course of the Movement

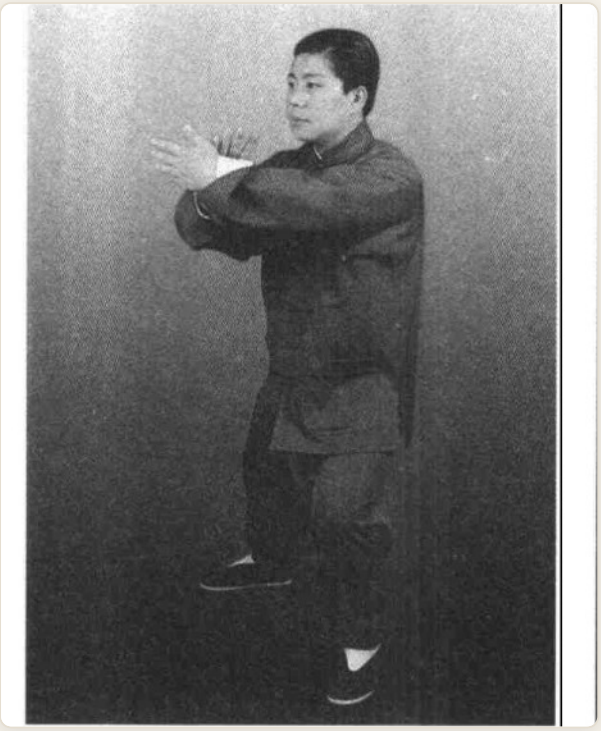
1. Pivoting on the ball of the left foot, the heel grinds inward and settles flat, the body gradually turns left, and the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg. At the same time the two fists change to palms and shift level to the left as the body turns; the right palm arcs down and to the right, and the eyes follow the turning of the body in a level shift (see the last figure on this page).

图 217A



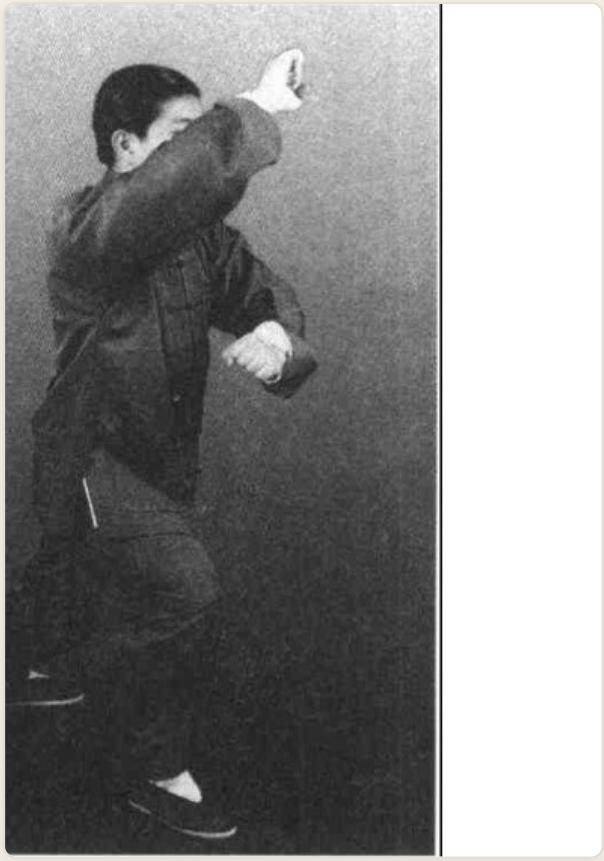
the right foot stepping out to the south-east, the right palm sinking and beginning its arc up past the right knee.

图 217B



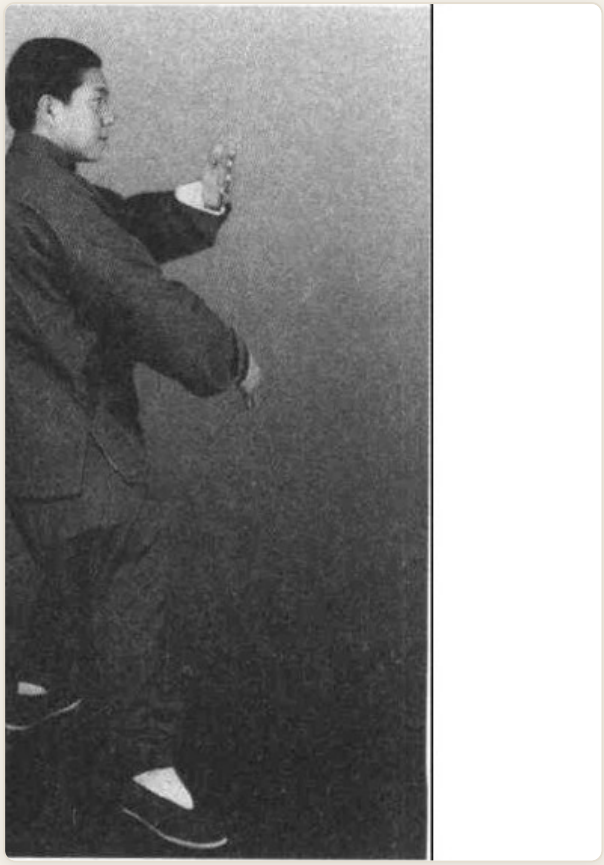
the right bow stance forming, the right palm arcing up to above the right temple, the left palm across the upper abdomen.

图 218



the right Beat the Tiger posture formed, the two fists opposed above and below, seen from the front.

图 219



turning the body back to the left, the right palm arcing down and to the right, the gaze shifting level with the turn.

2. The centre of gravity gradually shifts entirely onto the left leg, the body continues to turn left, and the right foot is drawn back. At the same time the left palm reaches slightly upward to the left front, and the right palm goes down, passes in front of the abdomen to the left, and clasps and crosses with the left palm before the chest (facing north), the left palm inside and the right palm outside, the centres of both palms facing inward. The gaze attends briefly to the left palm as it reaches up, then turns to look level to the front, as in the first figure on this page (the same as an earlier figure).

3. The same as the right heel kick, as in the second figure on this page (the same as another earlier figure).

III. Key Points

III. Key Points

1. The left heel grinds inward, so that the left toe points north-by-slightly-east; only then does it not interfere with the kick.

2. The movement of the two arms must be led by the turning of the waist. The boxing treatise says, "The master is in the waist"; and so the turning of the waist should gradually lead the turning of the four limbs.

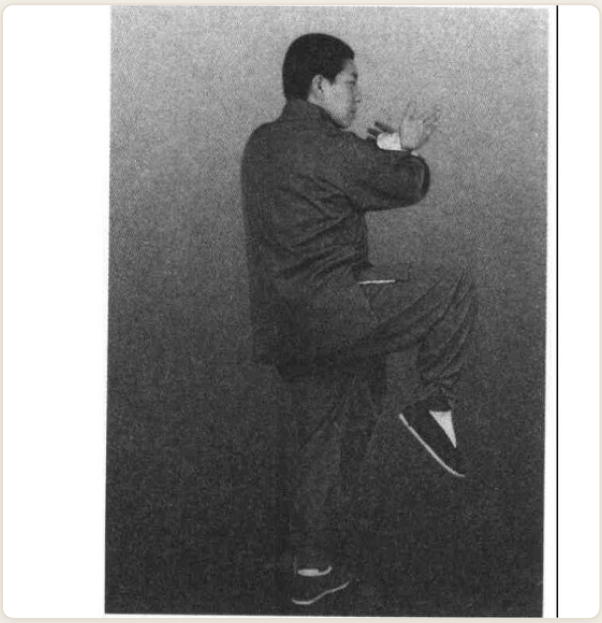
IV. Requirements

1. When the centre of gravity shifts onto the left leg the body method must be centred and true; the upper body must not lean forward or backward.

2. The direction of the movement must be exact: when the two palms clasp and cross, the body must turn to face north, and only at the kick does it turn to the east.

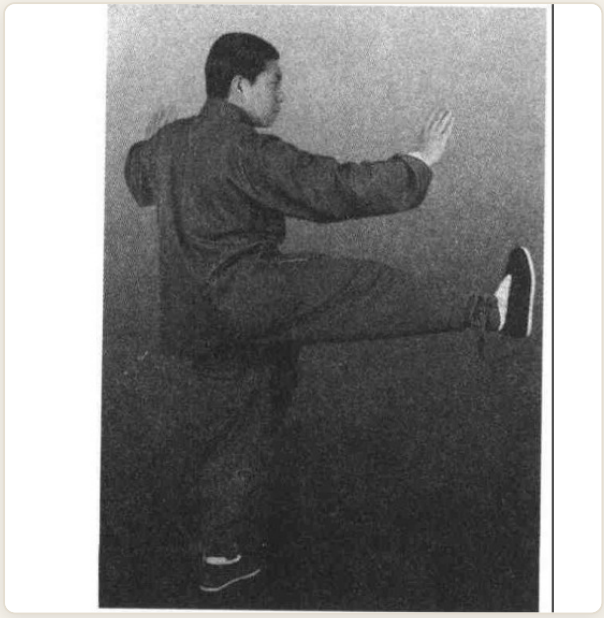
The rest is the same as the right heel kick.

图 220



the weight shifted onto the left leg, the two palms clasped and crossed before the chest, the face towards the north.

图 221



the left heel kick, the foot thrust out towards the east with the sole leading, the two palms separated.

(There is also a close-up photograph of the foot at the middle of the right-hand side of this page; it is unnumbered and carries no caption.)

Forty-first Posture: Twin Peaks Pierce the Ears (Shuang Feng Guan Er)

BOOK PAGE 164

I. Application

I. Application

Joining from the preceding posture. If an opponent strikes with both hands from the right side, I at once move my left toe slightly to the right and stand firm. The right foot at the same time swings round to the right side, the knee is lifted, the toe hanging down. The body at the same time turns to the right cardinal oblique angle (towards the south-east). I quickly bring the backs of both hands from above downward, separate the opponent's two wrists to left and right and pin them, and at once close both hands into fists and drive them from below upward at the opponent's two ears with the tiger's mouths facing each other. The right foot at the same time descends forward and becomes solid; and it is best if the body carries a slight intention of attacking.

II. The Course of the Movement

1. The right foot comes down, the right knee is lifted, the toe hangs down relaxed, and pivoting on the ball of the left foot the body turns right through 45° (towards the south-east). At the same time the two palms, as the body turns, arc from left to right and move before the chest, and as they move the elbows bend and the two arms rotate outward so that the centres of the palms face obliquely inward and up, the two elbows hanging down, the two arms forming arcs, and the two palms a shoulder's width apart. The eyes look level as the body turns, the gaze attending to the two palms' downward movement (see the first figure on this page).

2. The left leg gradually squats, the right leg steps forward one pace (to the south-east), the heel touching the ground first, and as the centre of gravity gradually shifts onto the right leg the whole sole settles flat; the right leg bends and the left leg extends, forming the right bow stance. At the same time the two palms go from the front downward, separate past the two sides of the right knee to left and right, and then converge upward from below; as they move the two arms rotate inward, and on reaching the upper front the two palms close into fists, the arms forming pincers, the two fists slightly higher than the head, their two tiger's mouths facing obliquely down at each other. The eyes look level to the front, the gaze attending to the two fists (see the remaining figures on this page and on the next).

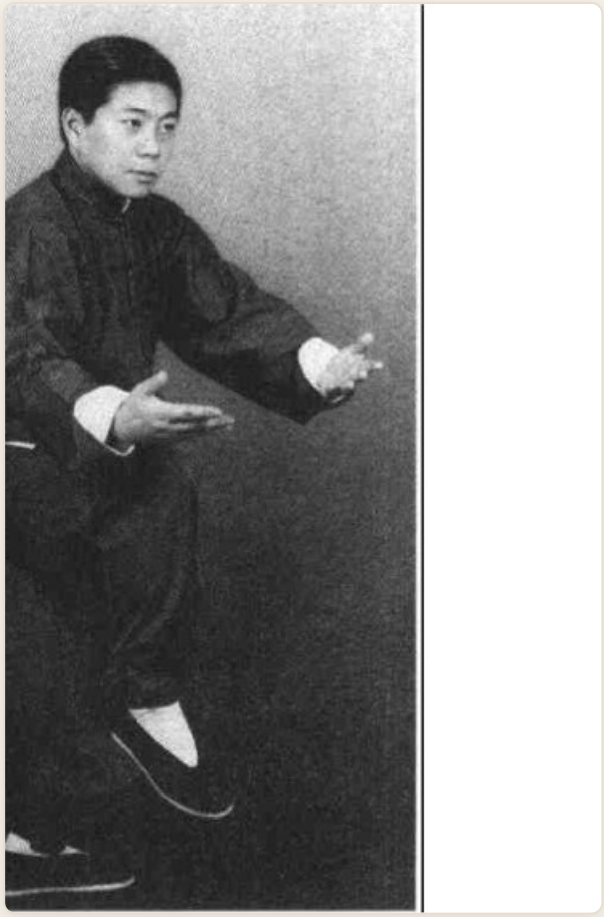
III. Key Points

1. When the body turns it must be centred and true; it must not lean forward or backward.

2. After the turn the left leg squats and the right leg has a slight intention of lifting upward; this makes it easier to draw in the hips. The loosening of the shoulders, the sinking of the elbows, the lifting of the leg and the drawing in of the hips must all be done together.

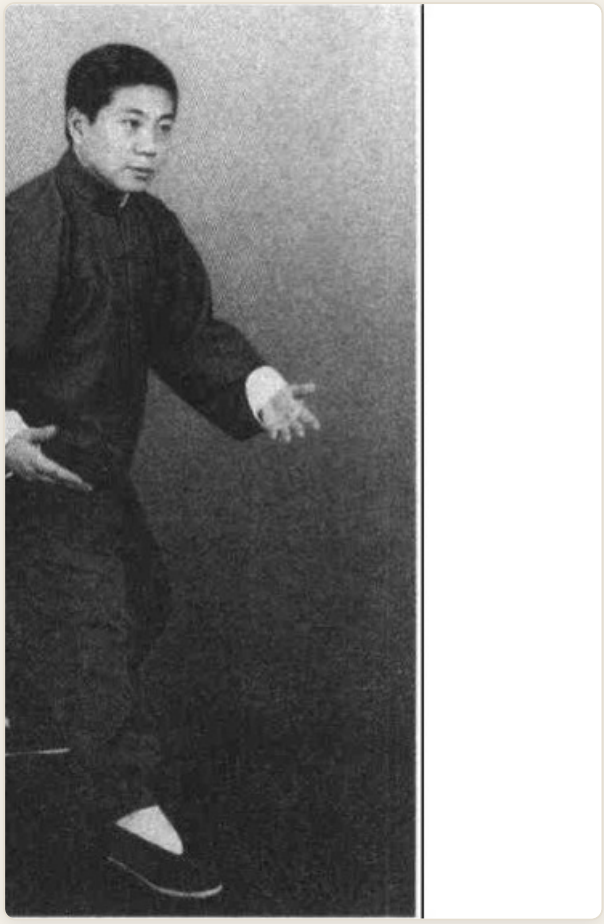
3. In stepping the right foot forward, the left leg must first be settled solid and the root of the right hip drawn in; then the left leg gradually squats and the two hands reach downward at the same time as the knee extends, and the right leg steps forward under control, the upper body still kept upright, and the speed of the step must be even.

图 222



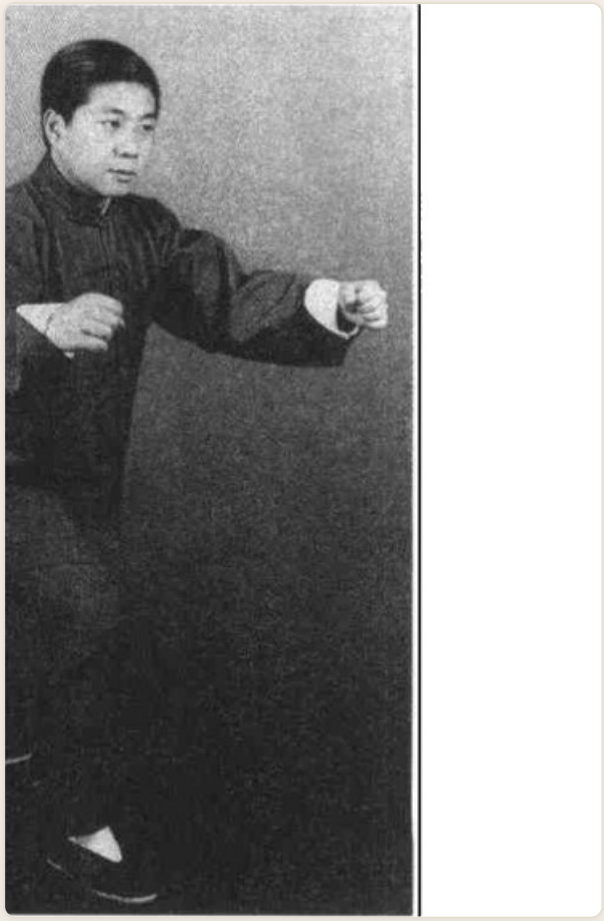
the right foot lowered and the right knee raised, the toe hanging relaxed, both palms arcing from left to right before the chest, the elbows down.

图 223



the right foot stepping forward to the south-east, the two palms separating past the sides of the right knee.

图 224



the right bow stance forming, the two palms converging upward, about to close into fists.

4. The two palms should close into the two fists only when the elbows are hanging and the palms have turned from below upward. The driving through of the two fists with the tiger's mouths facing each other must be coordinated with the right bow stance; the width between the two fists should be about one tiger's mouth (about 20 cm).

5. Sink the hips, sink the breath, loosen the shoulders; when the two palms have come down level with the knee, the two elbows sink to lead the two palms' descent — the two palms must not descend by themselves. Use the strength of the whole body, so that the backs of the palms descend steadily, calmly and cleanly.

BOOK PAGE 165

IV. Requirements

IV. Requirements

1. The turning of the body to the right must be steady.

2. After the body has turned right the left leg must be settled solid, and the stepping out of the right leg must be light and nimble — it must not come down in a rush.

3. The fists should not be gripped too tightly, nor yet be wholly slack and strengthless; they should be such that they cannot be forced open, and cannot be broken up when struck.

4. The whole movement must be continuous and without pauses. The requirement is that after the body has turned towards the south-east the left foot immediately squats and the two palms are drawn back and moved down — and one must not let the other movements pause in order to keep the centre of gravity steady. In martial terms, immediately after the turn one must separate the opponent's two wrists, struck in from the right side, to left and right; and if the movement pauses at that moment, one will be struck on the body by the opponent's fist.

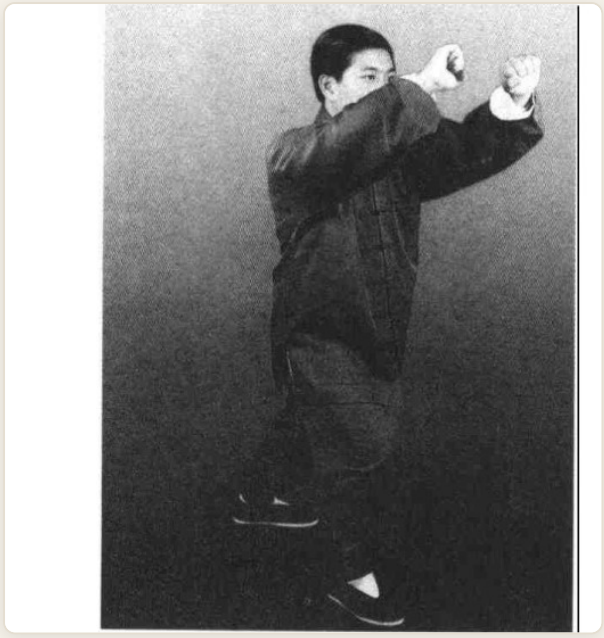
5. When the two fists drive through with the tiger's mouths facing each other, the arms must not be straightened; they must still keep their arcs, and the body must not lean forward and reach out.

V. Faults, Their Causes, and How to Correct Them

1. Fault: the direction of the right turn is not exact (it is not towards the south-east). One principal cause is poor control, making the angle of the turn too small or too large. The second is a shallow understanding of the application. The opponent strikes from the right side, and so after the turn one should face the right-hand side (the south-east). Correction: the turn should be practised repeatedly, checking after each turn whether the direction is right, with particular attention to the angle through which the left foot grinds; after much practice one gradually achieves controlled rotation.

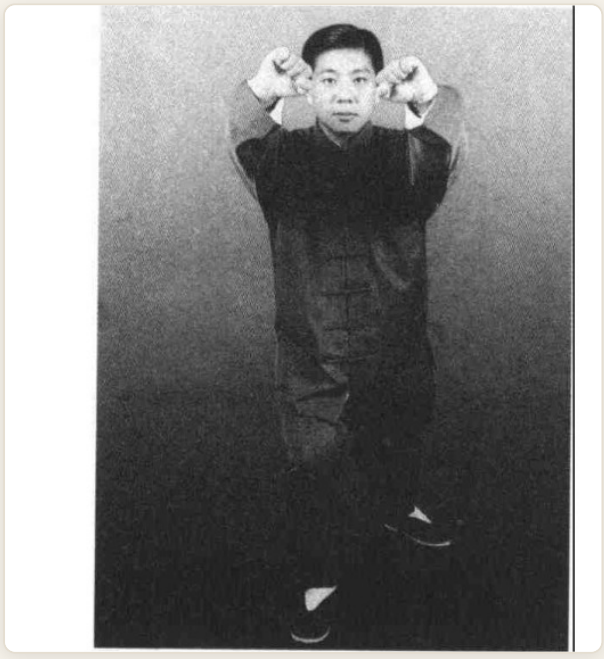
2. Fault: after the turn the left knee does not bend and the body does not sink. The principal cause is a failure to understand the application. If one tries with the backs of the two hands alone to separate and pin the opponent's two wrists to left and right, one's strength is necessarily limited; but if the sinking strength of the body and the two elbows is added to the two hands, then the strength...

图 225A



the two fists driven up at the ears, the tiger's mouths facing each other, seen from the front.

图 225B



the completed Twin Peaks posture, the two fists at head height, arms pincer-shaped, seen from the front.

...is greater. Correction: after the turn the left leg must squat and the two elbows sink to lead the two palms' descent.

3. Fault: the stepping of the right leg forward is sluggish and heavy. The principal cause is that the root of the left hip has not been drawn in and the left leg has not been settled solid. Correction: "Movement originates in the waist and spine, and strength runs through to the four tips" — and so the waist's hollow governs the two legs. If stepping is to be light and nimble, the left and right waist hollows must alternately draw and exchange in order to distinguish full from empty; when full and empty are clear, the left leg seems able to coil its root into the ground. In this way the right leg's stepping forward becomes light and nimble.

VI. Teaching Method and Practice Method

VI. Teaching Method and Practice Method

1. The emphasis of the teaching should be placed on the rotation supported on one foot, feeling out the coordination of the turning of the waist and hips, the lifting of the knee and the grinding turn of the left foot, so that the rotation is steady.

2. Teaching mnemonic: turn, sink, extend, strike.

3. The difficulty of this method lies in the bending and sinking of the left leg; this requires leg strength and must be practised long. While strengthening the legs one also masters the technique, and thereby strengthens the constitution as well. In practice the teacher must remind the practitioner that the upper body must be straight and the central axis must not bend.

4. Paired practice following the application: A — performs the right heel kick; B — strikes at A with both hands from A's right side; A — turns the body right, the right leg swings round, the two hands go from above downward, separate and pin B's two wrists to left and right, and immediately drives the two fists hooking at B's two ears. The two then exchange.

5. Progressive method: (1) First practise the turn alone, requiring the correct direction, the lifting of the leg and the moving of the two hands before the body. (2) The same, plus the squatting of the left leg, the right leg stepping forward with the heel coming down, and the two hands separating to left and right at the level of the knee. (3) The same, plus the shifting forward of the centre of gravity and the two hands hooking upward at the front.

6. Of the beginner one should require only that the movements be correct. Of the long-term practitioner one should require lightness and nimbleness. The boxing treatise says, "With a single movement, the whole body should be light and nimble", and "In every posture, move lightly, stop silently, and drive it only with intent and meaning." Only by using little strength and practising "lightly" can the movements become more and more nimble, and gradually attain to the highly sensitised "spirit" that is "unable to bear even a feather added".

VII. Technical Analysis

1. This movement is a turn performed supported on one foot, pivoting on the ball of the left foot. Because the angle of the turn is not great, and both the two arms and the right leg can play a part in driving and checking it, it can generally be accomplished fairly well.

2. The squatting of the left leg and the stepping forward of the right leg are not easy to do well. Because in squatting supported on one leg the load on the quadriceps and so on is considerable; yet the two hands merely come down and separate, with little effect on the steadiness of the centre of gravity. But to step the right leg out lightly and nimbly requires the loosening of the right hip, and this is not easy to do well. Long practice can open the root of the hip, and then the turning of the waist and legs becomes nimble and the stepping light and broad.

Forty-second Posture: Left Heel Kick (Zuo Deng Jiao)

BOOK PAGE 167

I. Application

I. Application

Joining from the preceding posture. If an opponent strikes at my left flank, I quickly use my left hand to stick to his right arm and ward it off from the inside outward. The right foot shifts slightly to the right in place, and the left foot at the same time is lifted forward and kicks at the opponent's abdomen. The rest is the same as the thirty-second posture, Turn the Body and Heel Kick.

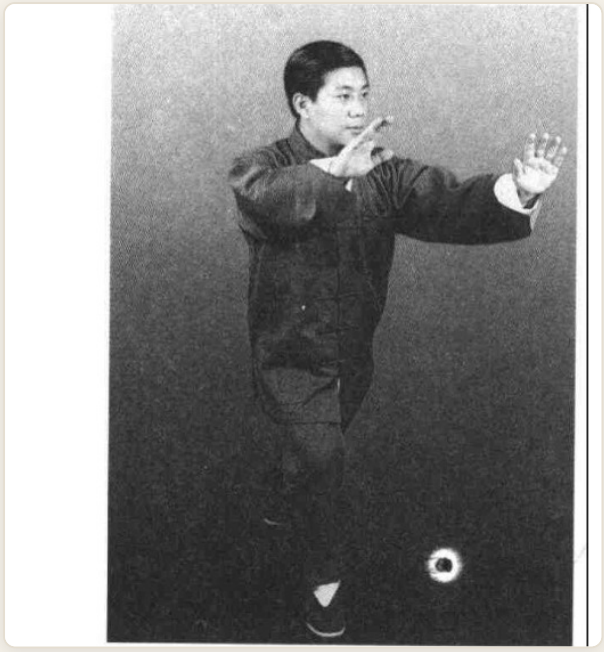
II. The Course of the Movement

1. The body turns slightly right, the right toe turns out and settles flat, the centre of gravity gradually shifts entirely onto the right leg, and the left foot is lifted forward. At the same time the two fists change to palms and separate in arcs to left and right, then go down, pass in front of the abdomen, and clasp and cross before the chest, the left palm outside; as they move the two arms rotate outward so that the centres of the palms gradually turn inward. The gaze first attends to the two palms as they trace their arcs, and when the two arms are about to cross it turns to look level to the left (see the first two figures on this page).

2. The left foot is slowly kicked out to the left (the east) with the heel. At the same time the two palms separate to left and right, and the right leg gradually straightens as the left kicks out, though the knee remains slightly bent. The gaze attends to the left palm as it separates, and looks level to the front past the left palm (see the third figure on this page).

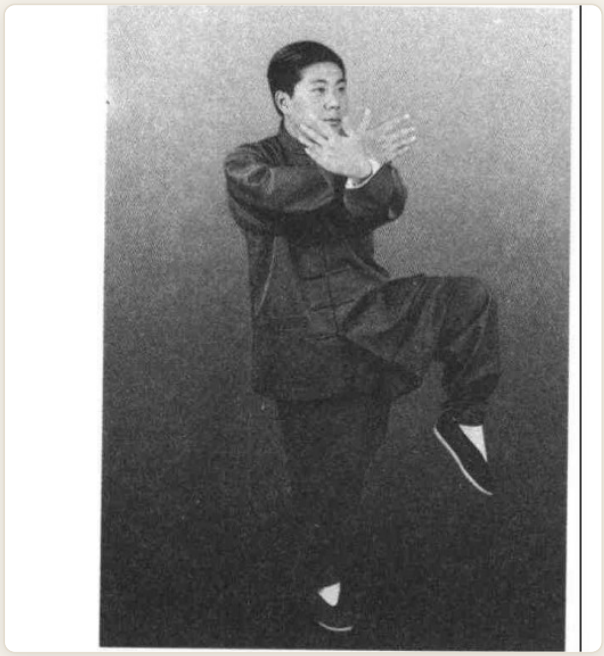
3. The rest is the same as the right heel kick, only the direction is reversed.

图 226



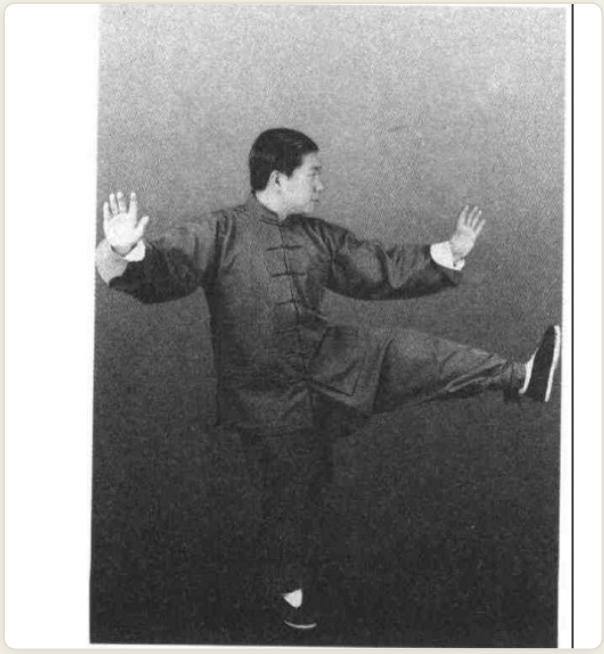
the body turning slightly right, the two fists changing to palms and separating in arcs to left and right.

图 227



the two palms clasped and crossed before the chest, the left palm outside, the left knee raised.

图 228



the left heel kick, the foot thrust out towards the east, the two palms separated to left and right.

Forty-third Posture: Turn the Body and Right Heel Kick (Zhuan Shen You Deng Jiao)

BOOK PAGE 168

I. Application

I. Application

Joining from the preceding posture. If an opponent strikes from the left behind, I pivot on the ball of my right foot and turn my body to the right and rear, and as the body turns the left foot is drawn back and suspended to the right, then comes down and settles solid with the toe pointing forward (north). At this moment the ball of the right foot is the pivot of the whole body's turn. The two hands close and are gathered before the body; I quickly use my right wrist to stick to the opponent's elbow and wrist, and from above downward cut it out to the left side. At the same time the right foot is lifted and kicks at the opponent's ribs and abdomen, and the left and right hands separate to left and right accordingly.

II. The Course of the Movement

1. The right heel leaves the ground, and pivoting on the ball of the right foot the body turns rapidly to the right and rear. At the same time the left foot, as the body turns, swings from left

through front to right rear, and after the turn comes down beside the inner side of the right ankle, the toe touching the ground first; as the centre of gravity gradually shifts the whole sole settles flat, and immediately the left leg squats slightly and the right foot is lifted. At the same time the two palms, as the body turns, arc from left and right and clasp and cross before the chest, the right palm outside, the centres of both palms facing inward, the face towards the north. The eyes follow the turning of the body in a level shift, the gaze attending to the clasping of the two palms (see the figures on this page and on the next).

2. The rest is the same as the right heel kick.

III. Key Points

1. The turn must be just right: too much or too little and the direction will be wrong. And so it must be controlled. Therefore the left foot and the crossing of the two arms must cooperate with the waist in doing the turning well.

2. In the instant of steadiness after the turn, the right leg squats and "sends" the left leg down to settle solid; then the right heel kick is made.

3. In turning, the direction is fixed by the right heel landing correctly.

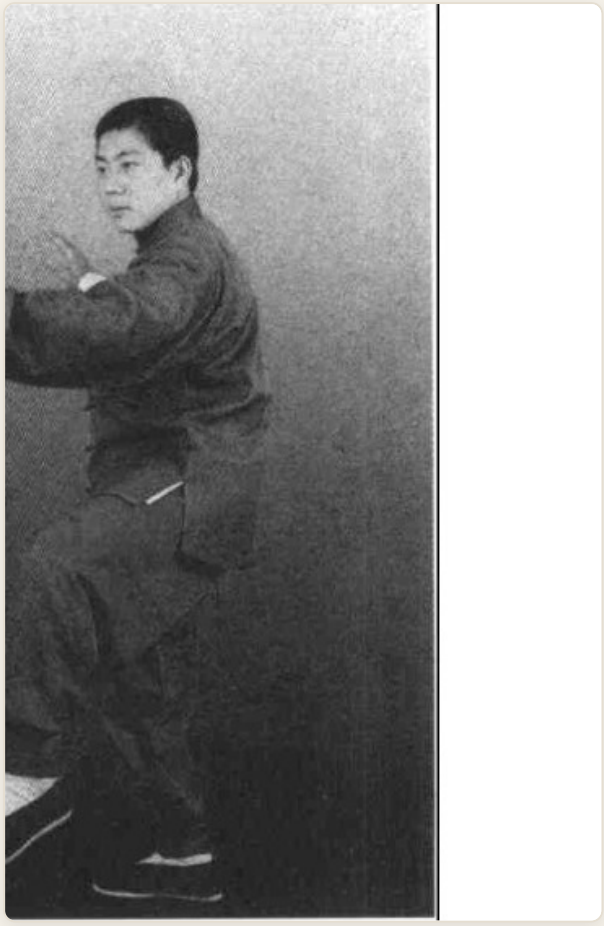
4. The clasping and crossing of the two hands must begin at the same time as the turning of the body, and be completed at the same time.

5. The rest is the same as the right heel kick.

IV. Requirements

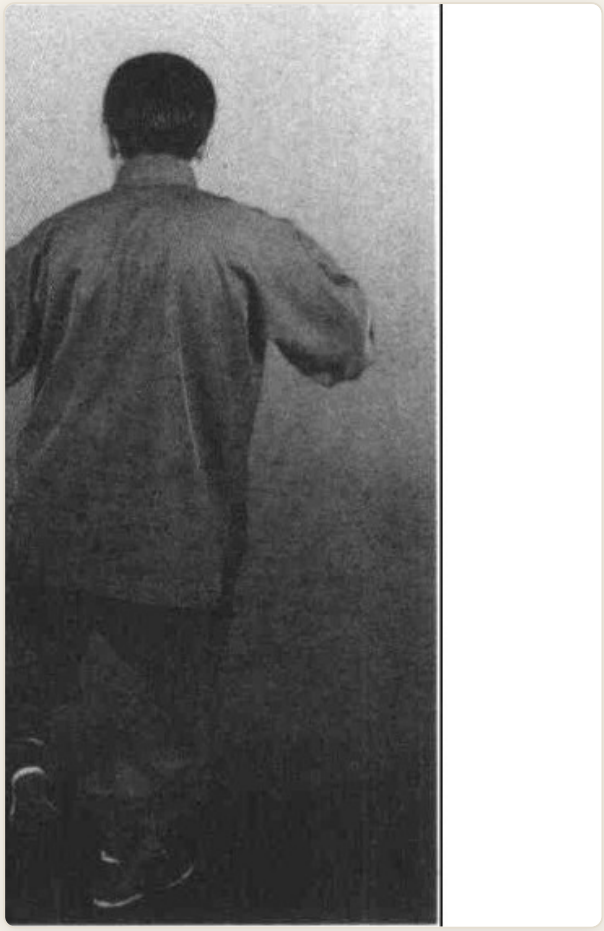
1. The rotation of the waist must be relaxed, sunk and upright — not swaying. To use the leg to swing is to be loose and disconnected.

图 229



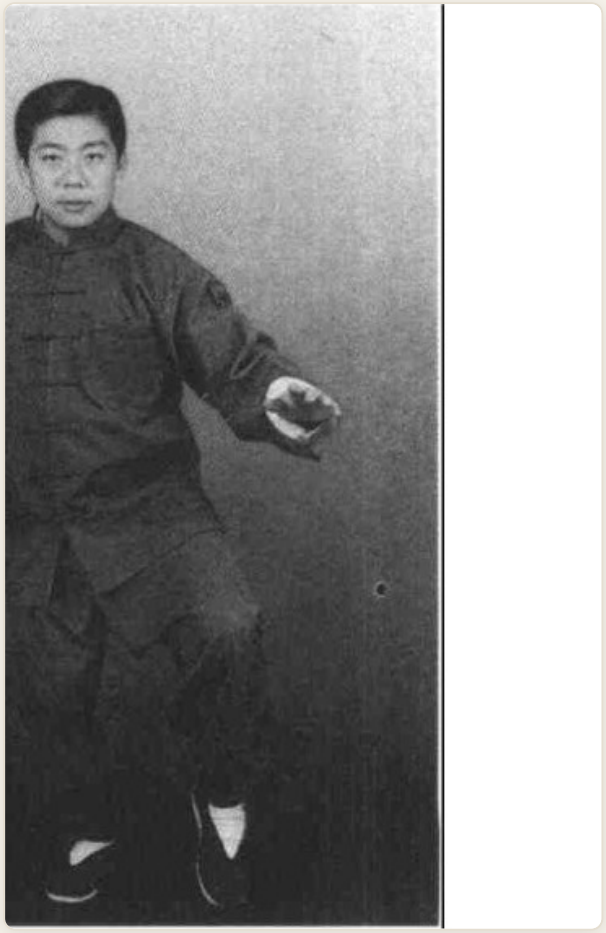
the body turning to the right rear, the left foot swinging round, the two palms beginning to close before the chest.

图 230A



the left foot coming down beside the right ankle, the toe touching first, both palms crossed before the chest.

图 230B



the two palms clasped and crossed before the chest, the body facing north, the right foot about to be lifted.

2. After the turn the angle must be correct and the body must face north. The kick goes due east.

3. The rotation must be light, nimble and natural, and the movements neither hurried nor slow.

BOOK PAGE 169

V. Faults, Their Causes, and How to Correct Them

V. Faults, Their Causes, and How to Correct Them

1. Fault: swaying after the turn, or an unsteady stance. The principal cause is a failure to attend to relaxation and the use of stiff force instead. In turning, some do not relax the waist and hips, some swing the left leg through too great an arc, and some have poor control of the suspended turning of the left leg. Correction: the tailbone must be centred and true, the waist and hips

relaxed, and there must be control over the landing position of the right heel and over the left knee.

2. Fault: the left foot comes down too fast, destroying the evenness and roundness. The principal cause is poor management of the centre of gravity — in order to keep balance and avoid falling, the left leg is landed too early. Correction: after the turn the right heel should land slowly; then the left leg is suspended and lifted, the right leg squats slightly, and only then does the left leg gradually come to the ground.

VI. Teaching Method and Practice Method

1. For the elderly and the weak the requirement for the rotation may be lowered and the left leg held lower.

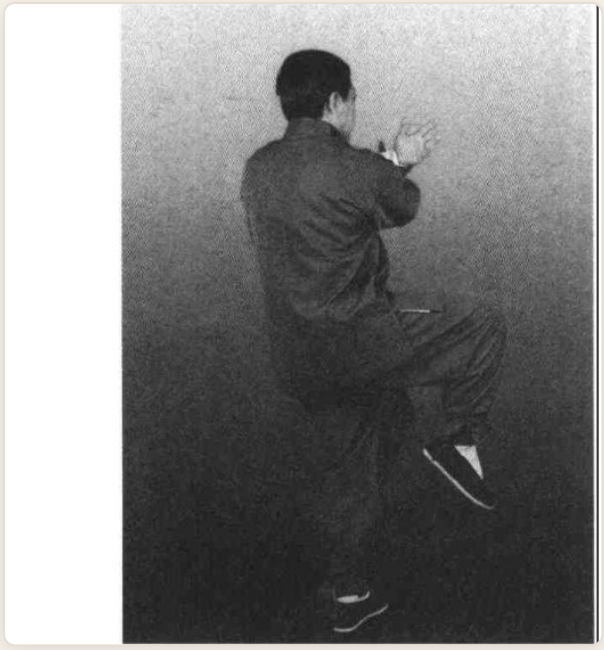
2. The difficulty of this movement lies in the rotation, and so the emphasis of practice should be placed on the rotation. No demands are made on the two hands; building on the preceding movement, the left knee is lifted in turning, remains lifted after the turn, the right leg sinks, and only then does the left foot slowly come to the ground.

3. Mnemonic: release — the left leg is let down and suspended; land — the left leg descends and settles; turn — the waist and hips turn the body round; rise — the left leg rises slightly; sink — the left leg squats; kick — the right leg kicks out; close — the two hands cross before the chest.

VII. Technical Analysis

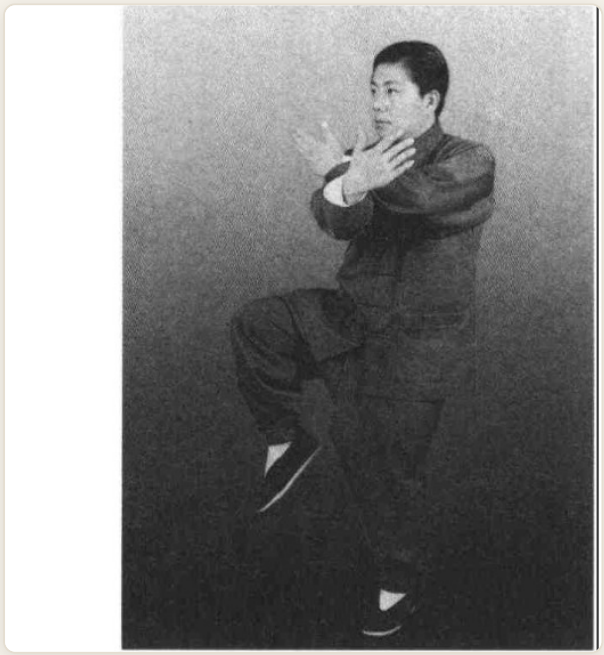
In Turn the Body and Heel Kick the body rotates through nearly 360°; the preceding left heel kick goes to the east, and in Turn the Body and Heel Kick the body turns and then the right foot goes to the east. In both cases the direction of the kick is east — only the direction of the turn and the leg are changed. The key lies in the rotation to the right and rear. The requirement for the rotation is first that it be steady, and second that it be exact (that is, the direction after the turn must be exact). And so the technique of Turn the Body and Heel Kick must first be analysed in terms of the rotation. All things…

图 231A



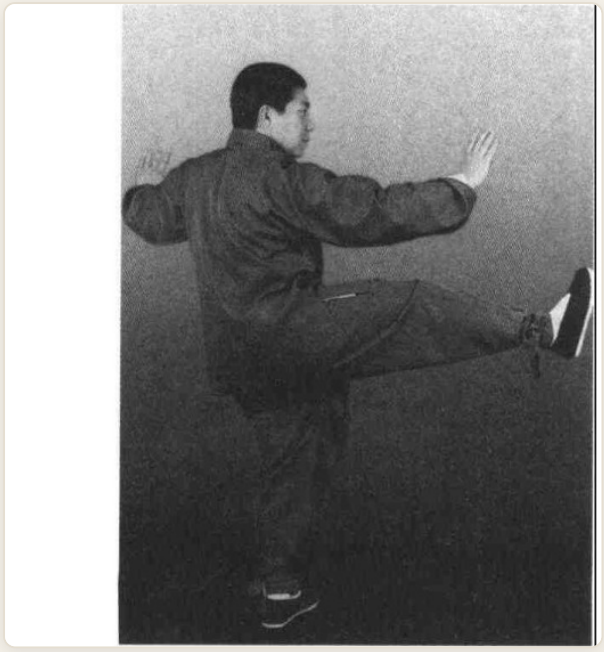
the right heel landing slowly after the turn, the left knee still raised, the two palms crossed at the chest.

图 231B



the left foot suspended and lifted, the right leg squatting slightly, the body steadied before the kick.

图 232



the right heel kick delivered towards the east, the sole leading, the two palms separated.

...can only move in a circle when acted upon by centripetal force; and so the swinging of the arms and legs must not go straight to and fro. The driving force of the rotation must come from the waist and hips. When the rotation is done well, the subsequent bending of the right leg to "send" the left leg down, and then the right heel kick, are not hard to do.

Forty-fourth Posture: Step Forward, Deflect, Parry and Punch (Jin Bu Ban Lan Chui)

BOOK PAGE 170

I. Application

I. Application

The same as the twelfth posture, Step Forward, Deflect, Parry and Punch.

II. The Course of the Movement

The left leg gradually squats, the right leg descends and the knee is lifted, and the waist turns slightly right; at the same time the right palm closes into a fist and arcs from the right downward and to the left across the front of the abdomen, the centre of the fist facing down; the left palm sinks slightly as the left leg squats, then arcs slightly upward from the left (the fingers no higher than the shoulder), and as it traces its arc the centre of the palm faces obliquely down-right. The

gaze attends to the right fist's arc to the left, then gradually looks level to the right (see the first two figures on this page).

All the remaining points are the same as the twelfth posture, Step Forward, Deflect, Parry and Punch. See the remaining figures on this page and on the next (the same as an earlier set of five).

图 233A

the left leg squatting, the right knee lifted, the right palm closed into a fist and arcing down and to the left in front of the abdomen.

图 233B

the fist continuing its arc to the left, the left palm rising slightly on the left, the gaze following.

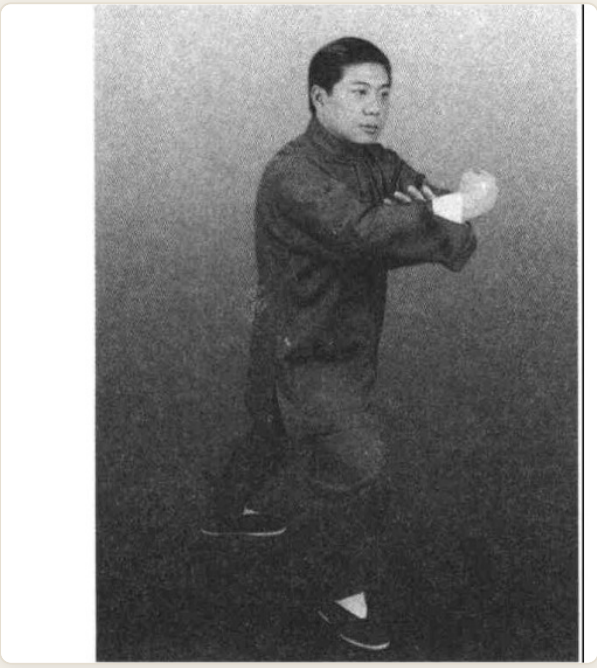
图 234

the left foot stepping forward, the right fist drawn to the waist, the left palm crossing before the chest.

图 235A

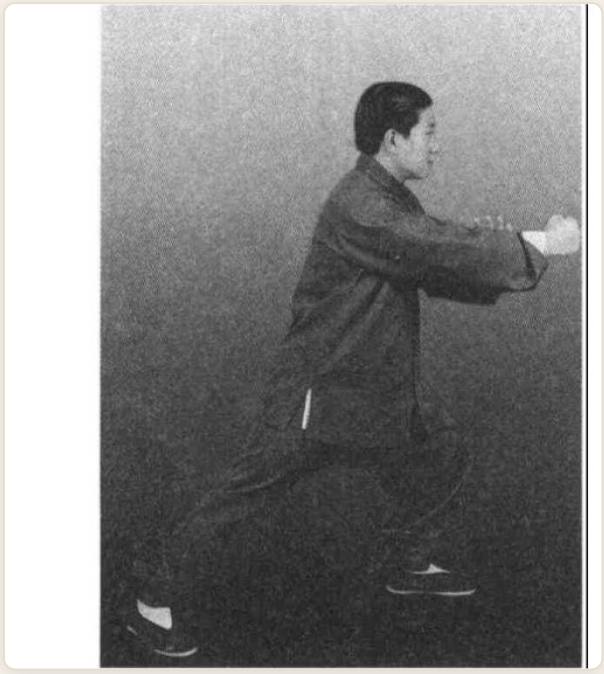
the left palm warding off to the left, the right fist at the waist, the body turning.

图 235B



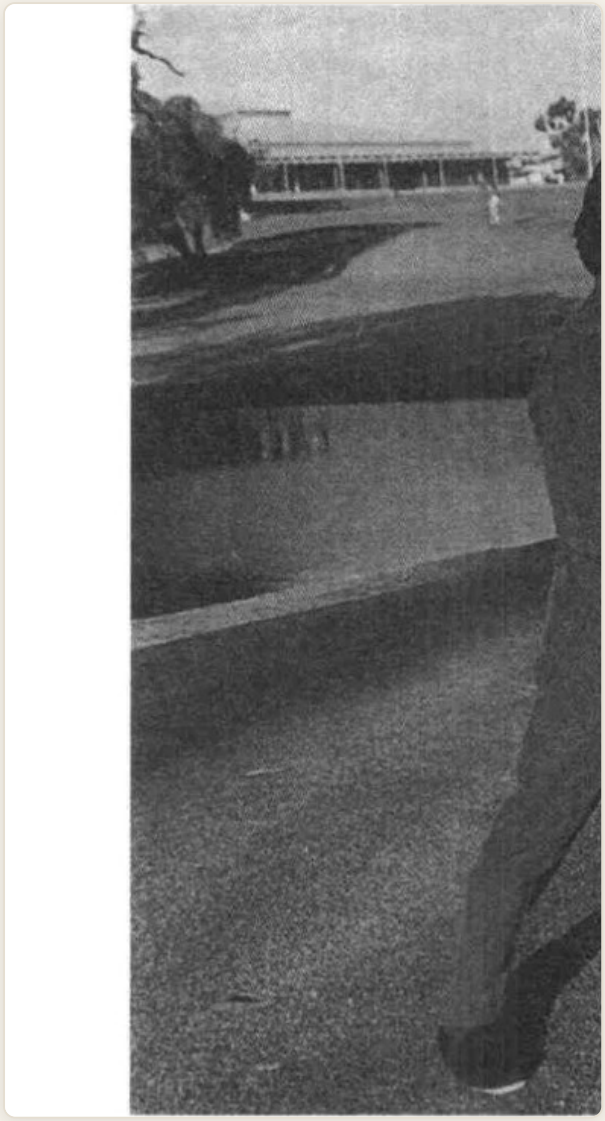
the same moment seen from the front, the left forearm horizontal, the right fist at the waist.

图 236



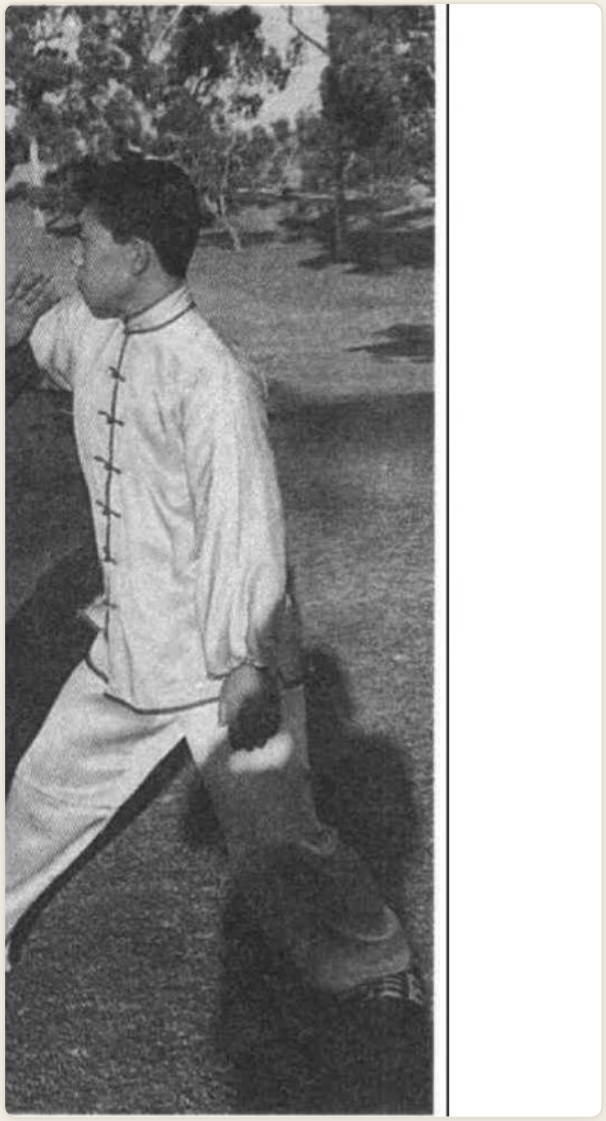
the right fist beginning to punch forward, the left palm withdrawn to the inside of the right forearm.

图 237



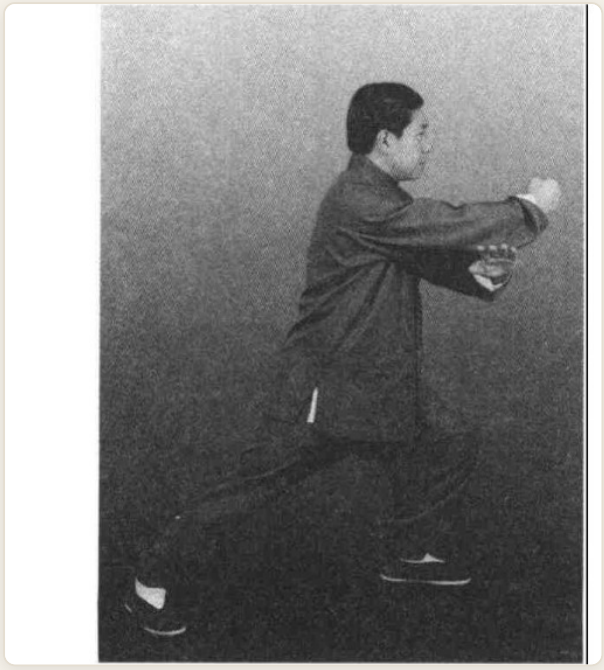
the right fist thrust forward, the left palm pressing at the inside of the right elbow.

图 238



the completed right thrust, the left bow stance formed, seen in profile.

图 239



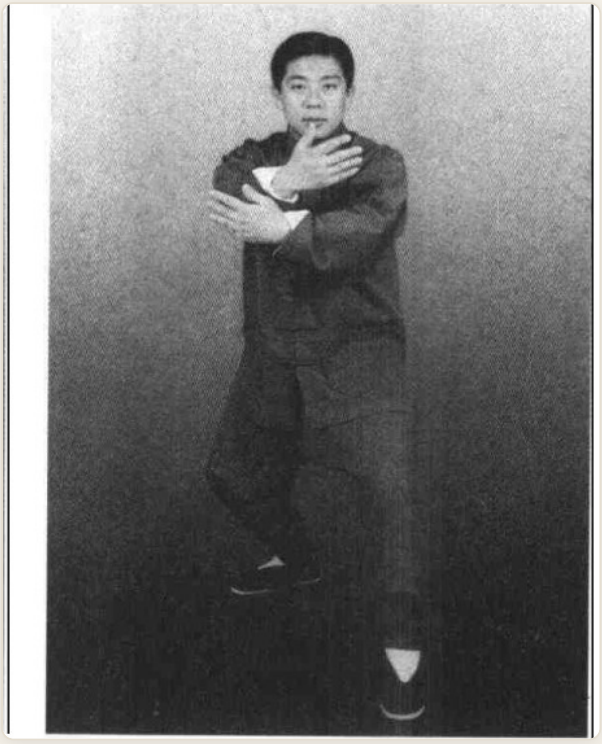
the same completed posture seen from the front-left, both arms extended forward.

(There is also a push-hands photograph at the middle of the right-hand side of this page; it is unnumbered and carries no caption.)

Forty-fifth Posture: As If Sealing, As If Closing (Ru Feng Si Bi)

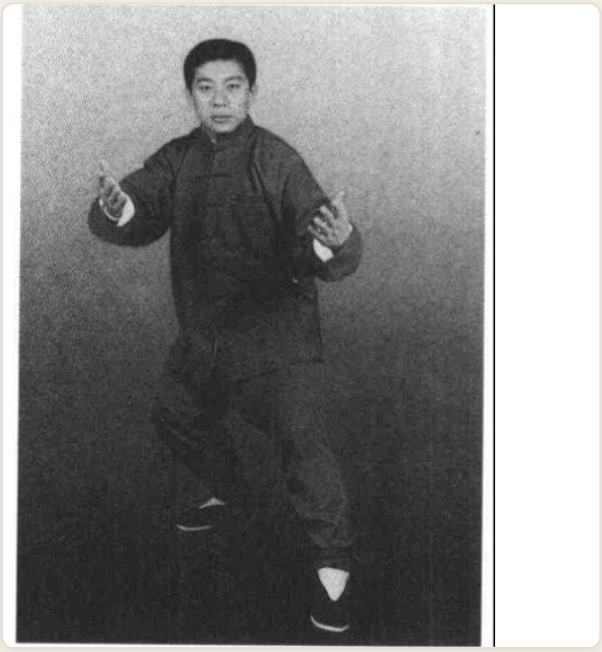
All the points are the same as the thirteenth posture, As If Sealing, As If Closing. See the figures on this page and on the next (the same as an earlier set of four).

图 240A



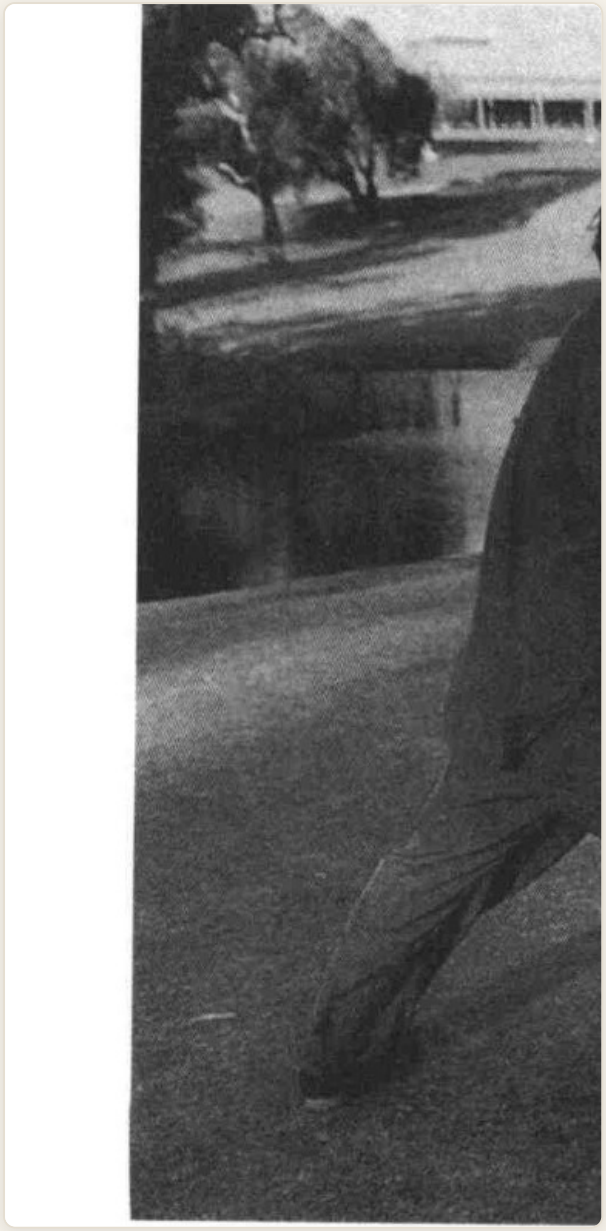
the two palms drawn back, the elbows bent, the body straightening, seen from the side.

图 240B



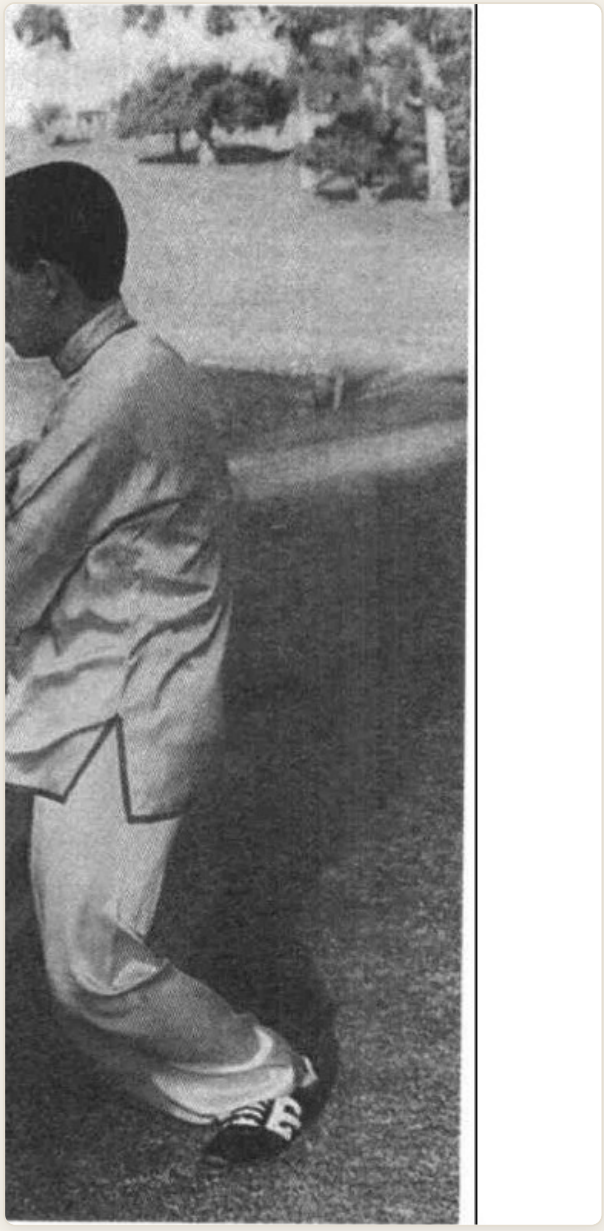
the two palms turned over and drawn to the chest, seen from the front.

图 241A



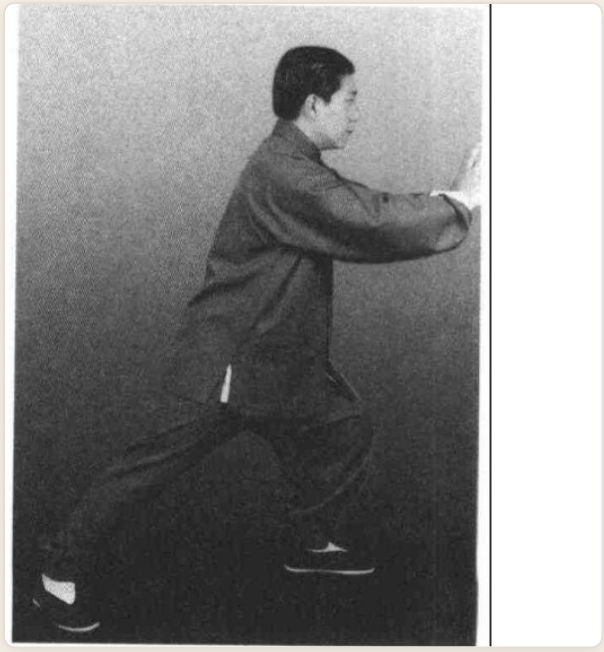
the two palms about to press forward, the elbows sunk, the body beginning to advance.

图 241B



the two palms pressed forward at chest height, seen from the front, the fingers of both hands facing forward.

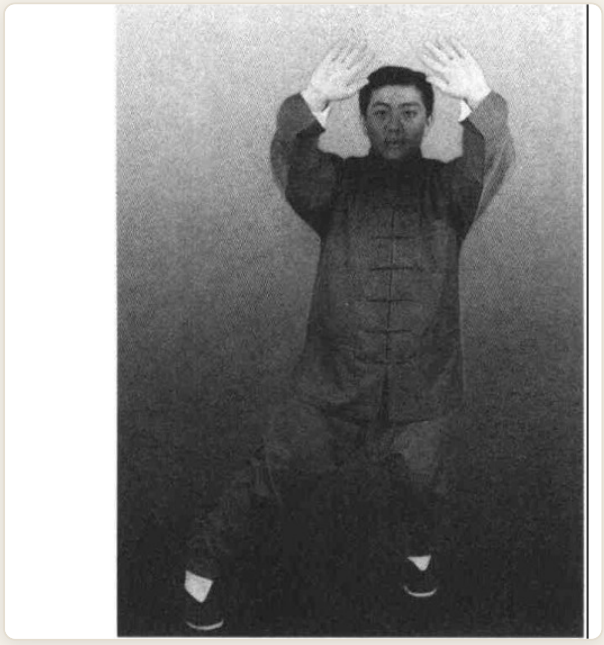
图 242



the completed press, the left bow stance formed, seen in profile.

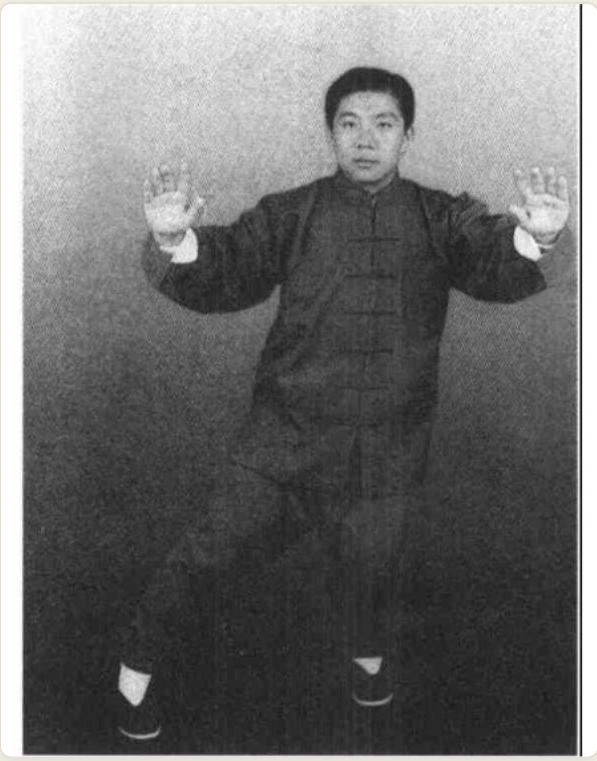
(There is also a push-hands photograph at the lower left of this page; it is unnumbered and carries no caption.)

图 243



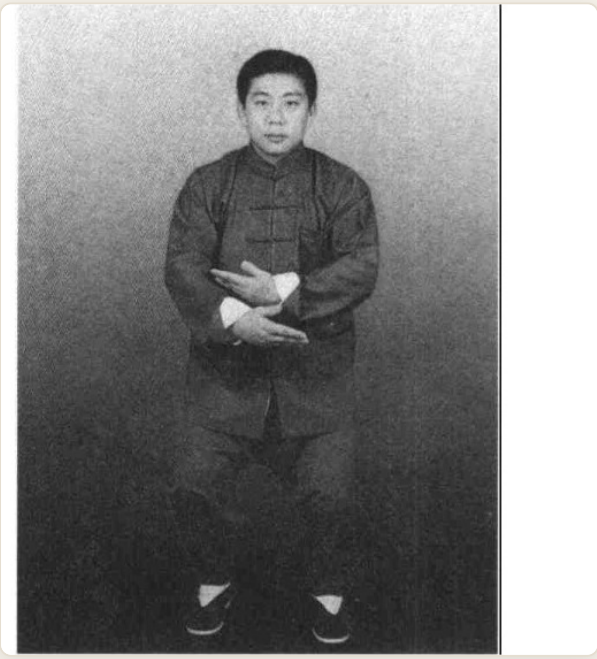
the two hands raised and crossed above the head, the wrists crossed, seen from the front.

图 244



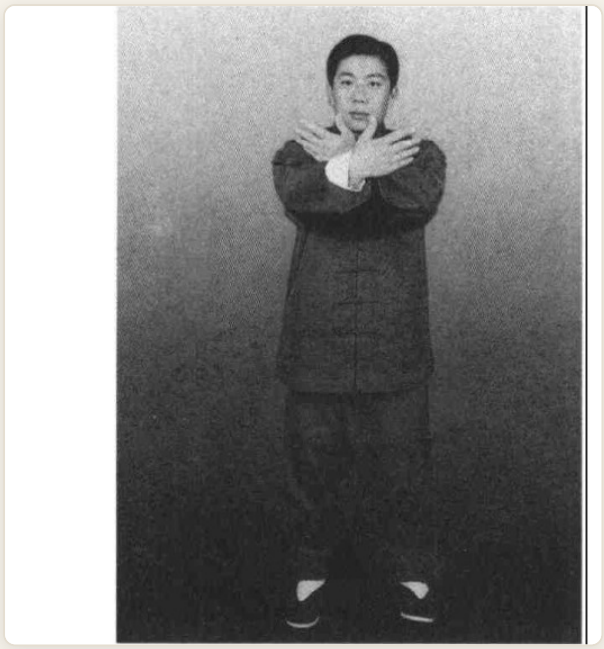
the two hands separating at shoulder height, the left leg beginning to step out to the left.

图 245



the arms drawn in, the right hand clasped inside the left forearm, seen from the front.

图 246

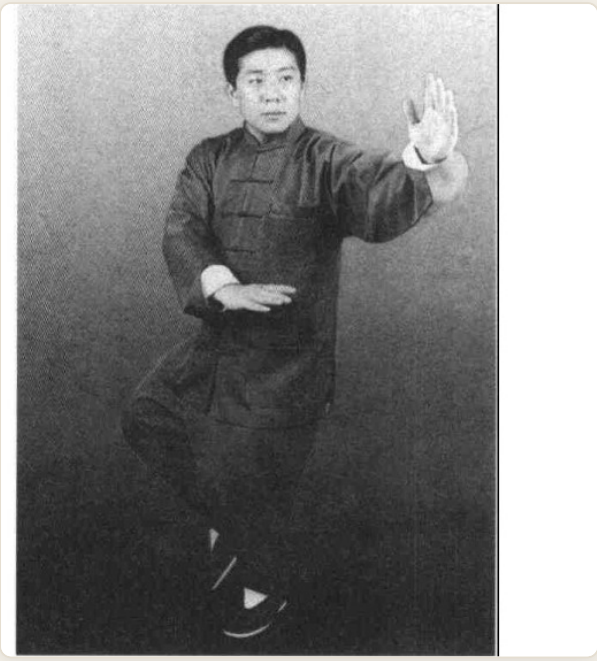


the two arms crossed at the chest, the left leg stepping out, seen from the front.

图 247

the left foot set down, the weight shifting, the hands beginning to separate.

图 248



the completed cross-hands posture seen in profile, the left bow stance, one hand forward and one back.

Forty-sixth Posture: Cross Hands (Shi Zi Shou)

All the points are the same as the fourteenth posture, Cross Hands. See the first four figures on this page (the same as an earlier set of four).

Forty-seventh Posture: Embrace the Tiger and Return to the Mountain (Bao Hu Gui Shan)

All the points are the same as the fifteenth posture, Embrace the Tiger and Return to the Mountain. See the remaining figures on this page and on the next (the same as an earlier set of ten). The whole of this page is taken up by nine posture photographs, arranged in three rows of three across the page. There is no running text on this page.

图 249

turning the body, the right hand raised before the face, the left hand lowered, the step beginning to close.

图 250A

the left foot brought in beside the right, the left palm raised at the shoulder, the right hand at the abdomen.

图 250B

the same moment seen from behind, both arms raised, the step closing.

图 251

the body turned, the left palm raised at the shoulder, the right hand in front of the chest.

图 252

the weight shifting, the right hand sinking, the left palm rising, seen in profile.

图 253

the right hand raised before the chest, the left hand at the side, seen from behind.

图 254

the advance beginning, the left foot stepping out to the right, both hands raised.

图 255

the right hand pushing out, the left hand at the elbow, seen from the left rear.

图 256

the completed posture, the right bow stance, the right palm pushed forward, the left hand at the waist.

Forty-eighth Posture: Diagonal Single Whip (Xie Dan Bian)

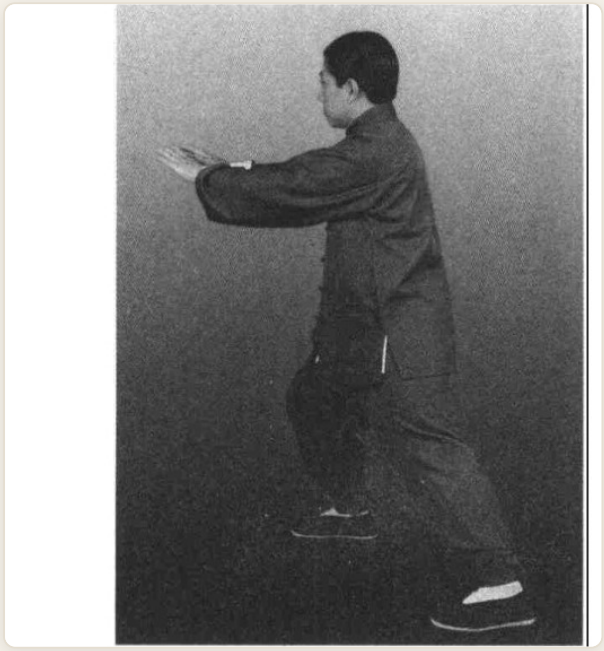
All the points are the same as the fourth posture, Single Whip; the differences are as follows:

1. The direction of the settled pose of this single whip is obliquely forward-left (the south-east), whereas the single whip of the fourth posture goes to the east.

2. The diagonal single whip begins facing the north-west and moves through 180° to the south-east. The single whip of the fourth posture begins facing west and moves through 180° to the east.

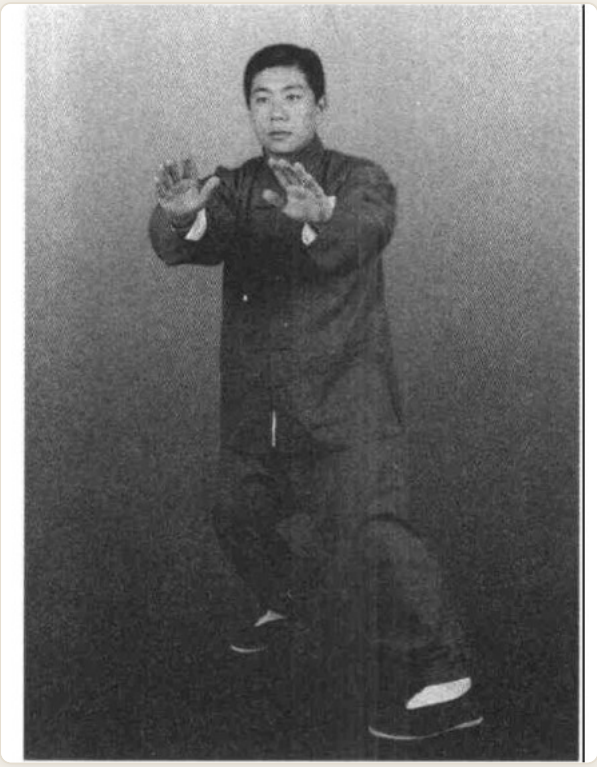
3. All the other points are the same as the fourth posture, Single Whip (see the figures on this page).

图 257



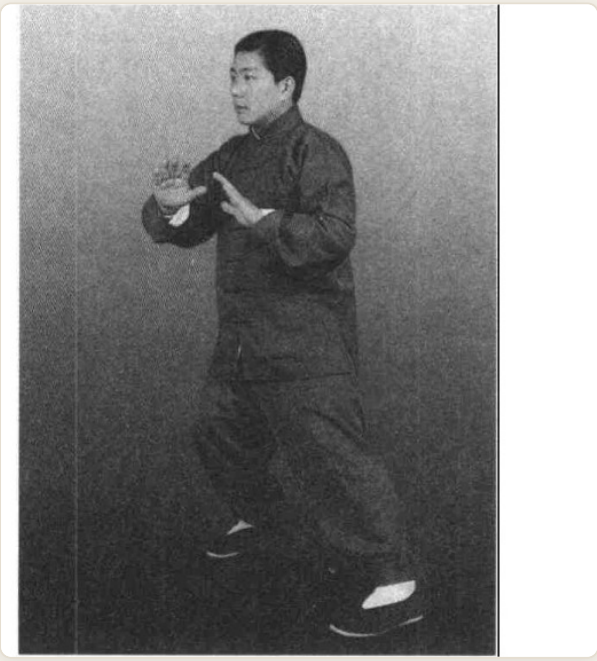
the beginning of the diagonal single whip, the body turned to the north-west, both hands raised.

图 258



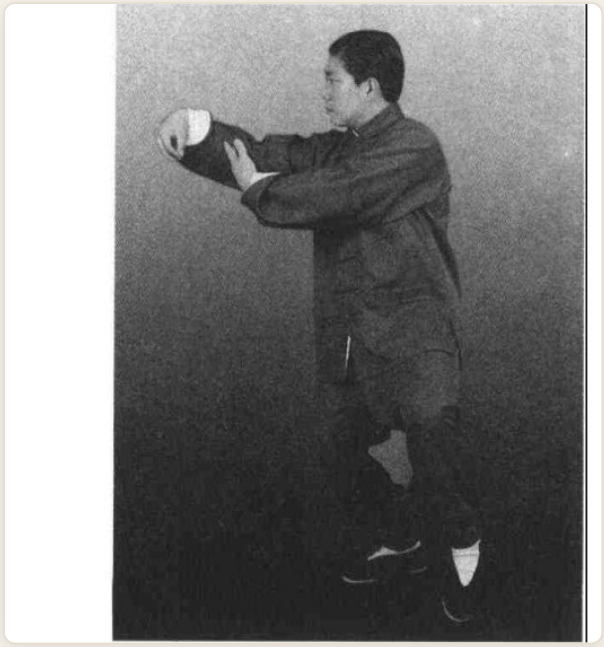
the hands beginning to arc apart, the weight shifting, the body turning.

图 259



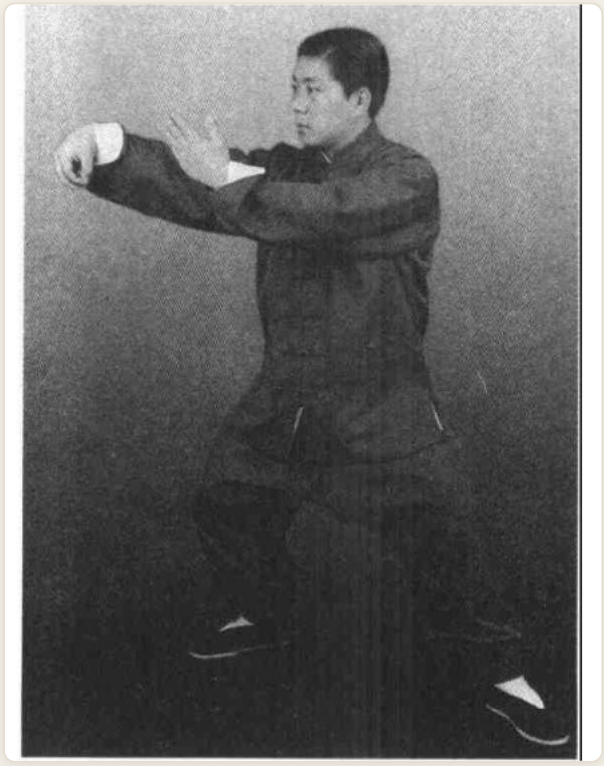
the right hand rising into the hook, the left palm drawn before the chest.

图 260



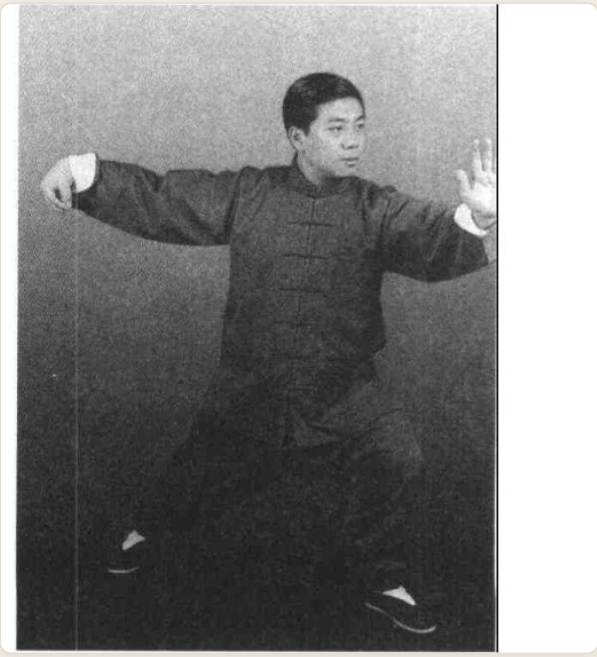
the left foot stepping out to the south-east, the hook-hand extended behind.

图 261



the left bow stance forming, the left palm pushing forward, the hook-hand at the rear.

图 262



the completed diagonal single whip, seen from the front, both arms extended, facing the south-east.

Forty-ninth Posture: Part the Wild Horse's Mane to Left and Right (Zuo You Ye Ma Fen Zong)

BOOK PAGE 176

I. Application

I. Application

Joining from the preceding posture: if an opponent uses a press from the right side to press my right arm, I at once turn my body to the right and move my left foot also to the right, drawing the right heel back to form the empty step. Then I use my right hand to stick to the opponent's left wrist and relax slightly to the left, and use my left hand to ward off his right wrist. At the same time I quickly bring the right foot up, bend the knee and settle solid, straighten the left leg, and at once use my right forearm to separate into the opponent's armpit; his root strength can then be plucked up by me, and his body will lean back. At this moment the left hand should also separate slightly to the rear, using sinking strength to assist the right hand's force (to assist the momentum of the right hand).

Another application is this: if an opponent strikes at my right chest with his right fist, I use the left Part the Wild Horse's Mane to ward his hand out with my left hand, and then strike out with a press.

II. The Course of the Movement

(A) Right Part the Wild Horse's Mane

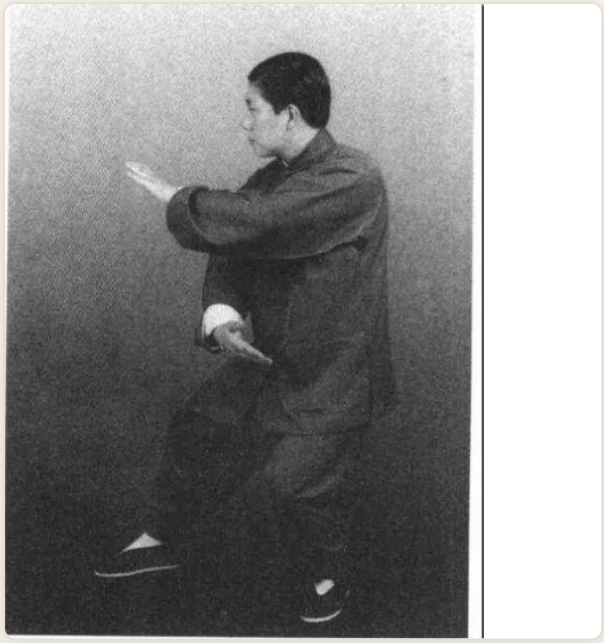
1. The body turns slightly right, the left toe turns in and settles flat, the centre of gravity gradually shifts entirely onto the left leg, the left leg settles solid, and the right foot is lifted and drawn back (facing west). At the same time the left palm, the elbow bent, arcs to the front of the left chest, the palm facing obliquely down; the right hanging hand changes to a palm and scoops from the right downward and to the left in an arc to the front of the abdomen, and as it scoops the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns obliquely up and joins with the left hand, both arms forming arcs. The gaze attends to the left palm (see the first figure on this page).

2. The body continues to turn right, facing west, and the right foot slowly steps forward, the heel touching first; as the centre of gravity gradually shifts onto the right leg and the whole sole of the right foot settles flat, the right leg bends and the left leg extends, forming the right bow stance. At the same time the right palm, its centre facing obliquely up, arcs out with the radial side of the forearm to the upper right front as the body turns, the fingers at eyebrow height; the left palm plucks down in an arc to the side of the left hip. The gaze attends to the right palm as it separates, and reaches the right front slightly before the right palm does, the face towards the south-west (see the second figure on this page).

(B) Left Part the Wild Horse's Mane

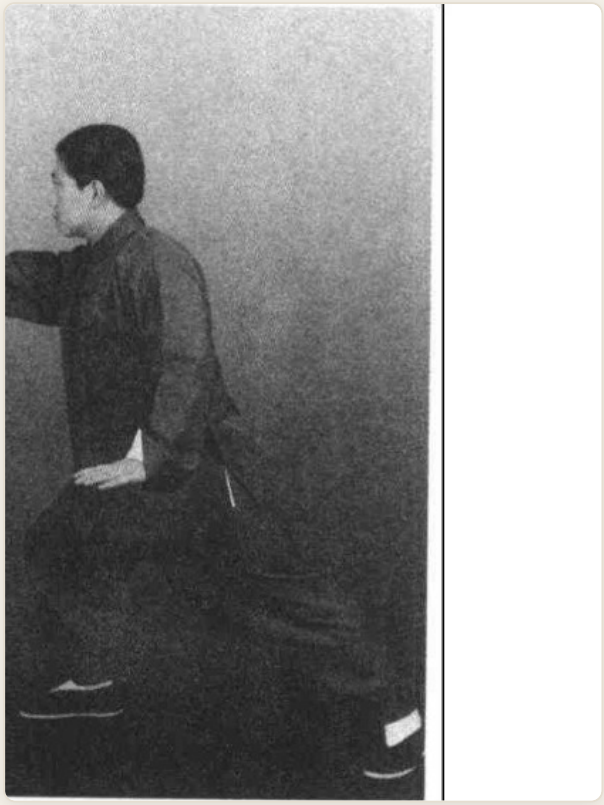
1. The body turns slightly right (facing north-west), the right toe turns out and treads flat, the centre of gravity gradually shifts entirely onto the right leg, the right leg settles solid, and the left leg is lifted forward. At the same time the right palm, as the body turns, arcs with the elbow bent to the front of the right chest...

图 263



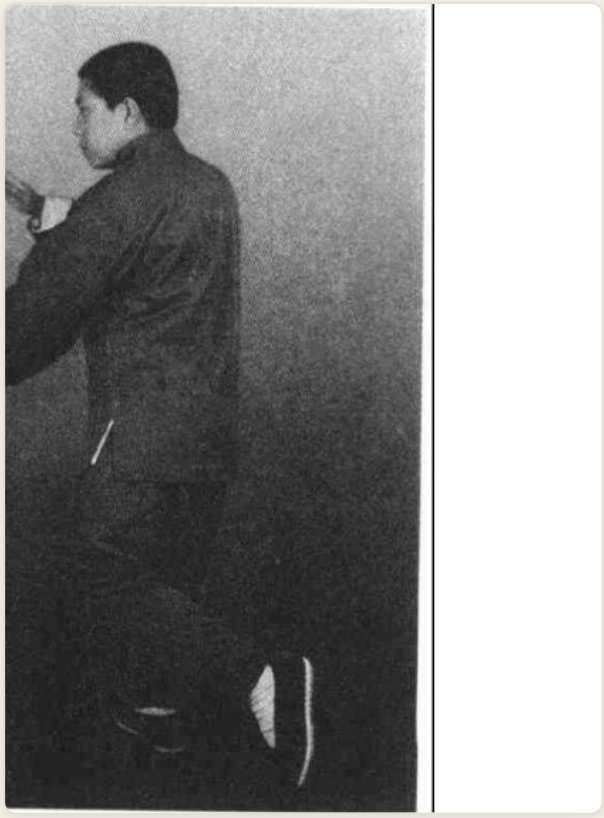
the left toe turned in and settled, the right foot drawn back, the left palm at the left chest, the right palm scooping to the front of the abdomen.

图 264



the right foot stepping forward, the right palm arcing out to the upper right, the left palm plucking down to the left hip.

图 265



the right bow stance formed, seen in profile, the right forearm separating outward, the left hand at the left hip.

...and as it moves the arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm gradually turns down; the left palm scoops in an arc to the right to the front of the abdomen, and as it scoops the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns obliquely up and joins with the right palm, both arms forming arcs. The eyes follow the turning of the body in a level shift, the gaze attending to the right palm (see the first two figures on this page).

2. The body continues to turn gradually left (facing west), the left foot steps forward, the heel touching first; as the centre of gravity gradually shifts onto the left leg and the whole sole settles flat, the left leg bends and the right leg extends, forming the left bow stance. At the same time the left palm, its centre facing obliquely up, arcs out with the thumb side of the hand to the upper left front as the body turns, the fingers at eyebrow height; the right palm plucks down in an arc to the side of the right hip. The gaze attends to the left palm as it separates, and reaches the left front slightly before the left palm does, the face towards the south-west (see the remaining figures on this page).

3. Thereafter the left and right Part the Wild Horse's Mane are identical in movement, only the direction changing again and again (once to the left, once to the right), as in the further figures on this page and on the next (the same as earlier figures).

BOOK PAGE 177

III. Key Points

III. Key Points

1. Whether the right or the left hand separates, the power is issued from the waist. The Boxing Treatise stresses, "At every moment keep your mind on the waist", and "The nine joints above and below — the strength issues from the waist at every joint." When the waist's strength is used correctly it can concentrate the whole body's strength on one point; and one must thread from shoulder to elbow to hand, joint by joint, issuing outward. The separation of the hand and the turning of the waist and the bow stance must also be coordinated. The strength must go from the foot to the leg, to the waist, and take form in the fingers: its root is in the foot, its master in the waist. When I separate into the opponent's armpit I must pluck up his root strength; if I use only the strength of the hand, that is far from enough.

2. The bow stance of Part the Wild Horse's Mane is a little wider than the ordinary bow stance, but not as much as a 45° oblique angle. If the lateral distance of the bowed-out foot is small the stance is unsteady and one cannot give strength to the separating hand.

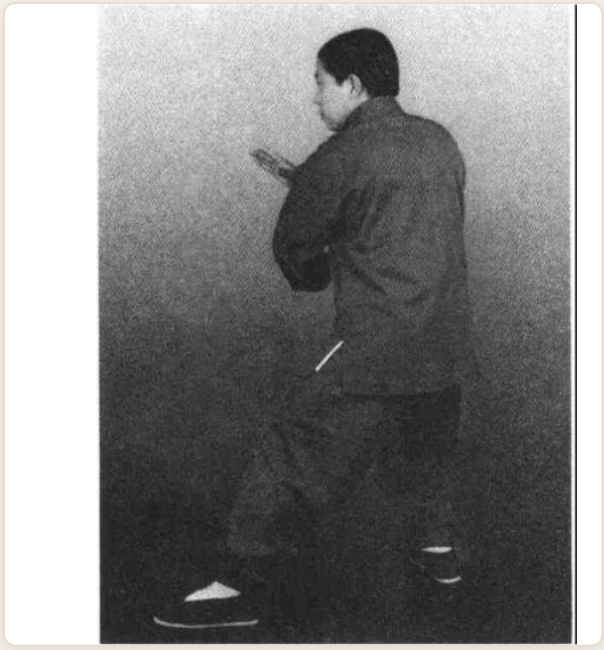
3. The toe of the bowed-out leg must be in the same direction as the knee.

4. Whether closing or splitting, the shoulders must sink and the elbows hang.

5. The route of the separating hand is first forward, then outward (the right hand to the right, the left hand to the left).

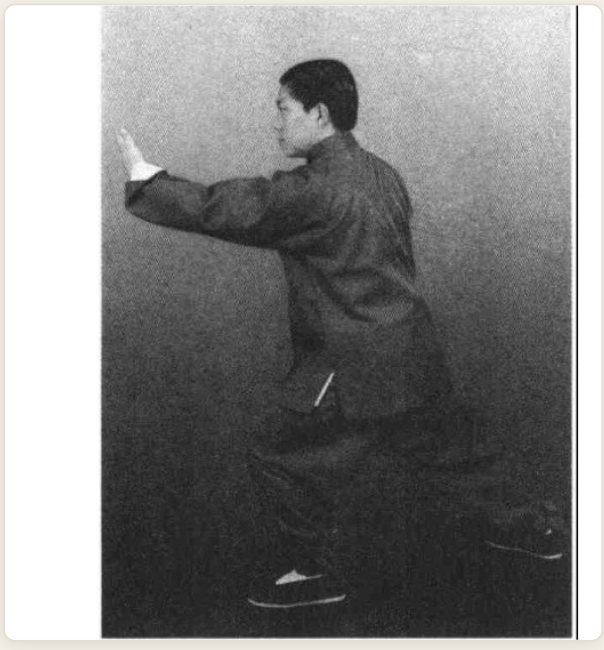
6. When the left and right Part the Wild Horse's Mane is repeated many times (three, five or more), although the movements alternate left and right they must be continuous; and so each posture must carry on from the last, with no dividing pause.

图 266



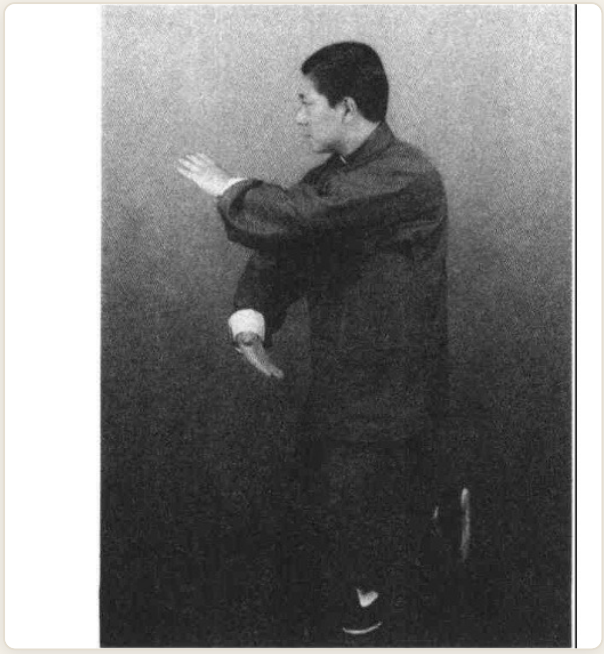
the body turned right, the right palm arcing to the front of the right chest, the left palm converging upward from the abdomen.

图 267



the left foot stepping forward, the left palm arcing out to the upper left, the right palm plucking down to the right hip.

图 268



the left bow stance formed, seen in profile, the left forearm separating outward at eyebrow height.

BOOK PAGE 178

IV. Requirements

IV. Requirements

1. Empty and full must be clear. The body, the hands and the steps are all to be distinct, and the internal and external conversions of empty and full must also agree. That is why internal and external, above and below, left and right, front and rear are all to be clearly distinguished as empty or full. The sinking of the lower limb is the key to the body's steadiness; therefore the first thing to attend to is the clear distinction of empty and full in the two legs. The more finely the empty and full of the two legs is distinguished, the more the feeling of the movement improves step by step. Beginners must make the full foot grind and a single foot be solid, and only then may the other foot be slowly lifted and slowly sent out; before the heel has landed, the centre of gravity may not change.

2. In left and right Part the Wild Horse's Mane there must be no pause between one posture and the next. It is to be threaded through, one posture succeeding another, connected and lively. But one must also avoid the fault of the hands and feet not having arrived in place — that is, of the movement not being complete — before going on to the next movement.

3. In advancing, the two feet are not to be in one line; the toe of the front foot is to face square to the front.

4. Opening out and drawing together must be combined.

V. Likely Errors, Their Causes, and Their Correction

1. *Error: the two hands make a large circle, so the direction is not correct and the direction at the settled posture is unclear.* The main cause is a poor grasp of the method of use. Take the right Part the Wild Horse's Mane as the example: the opponent attacks me from my right side, I step forward with the right foot and separate the right hand downward into his armpit. If my right hand describes a large circle, then when the hand arrives it is not under the opponent's armpit but in front of his head, and the possibility of "separating" is lost. *Correction:* it must first go forward and then outward, the fingers no higher than the eyebrows — only then can it separate into his armpit and pluck up his root strength.

2. *Error: the turn of the body is too great, giving a loose and scattered appearance.* Take the left Part the Wild Horse's Mane as the example: if the right foot is wrongly opened out to as much as 90°, so that the right toe points north, then when stepping up on the left one feels a pull in the right leg and a great awkwardness, and it also interferes with the left foot's stepping forward correctly. The main cause is an insufficient understanding of the method of use. *Correction:* the right foot should be opened out to about 45°.

3. *Error: the two hands do not follow an arc but go straight out and straight back.* The main cause is an inadequate understanding of Tai Chi's characteristic — circular motion...

图 269

the right Part the Wild Horse's Mane, seen in profile from the left, the right forearm separating outward, the left hand at the left hip.

图 270

the right bow stance formed, the right palm separating to the upper front, the left palm plucking down at the left side.

...deeply. Tai Chi has a movement, and that is a circle; "a marvellous hand is one Tai Chi". It contains the two forces of yin and yang revolving and transforming. *Correction:* one must "have the straight within the curved" — every place a curve, every place a straight line, the unification of the curved and the straight; one must be able at any moment to transform the arc into a straight line and so strike.

4. *Error: in the movement the stepping foot lands with a heavy sound, and empty and full are unclear.* The main cause is that the supporting leg has not sat solid. *Correction:* besides the empty-full conversion of the stepping method, the waist and hips must also be brought into coordinated conversion, so that the stepping is light and nimble.

BOOK PAGE 179

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods

1. The mnemonic (taking the right Part the Wild Horse's Mane as the example): the right hand plucks and the left hand wards; ward, brush and strike; the left is solid and the right is empty, stepping slowly; the right hand plucks down and separates forward into the armpit; you receive my root strength and I myself pluck it up.

2. The learner must keep raising the standard of bow-stance advancing. Besides the empty-full distinction of the step already learned, one should also practise "even movement" and "unbroken continuity".

3. Use discussion to correct details, for example: ① How does the body turn — is there a turn when closing? ② Why must the arm first go forward and then outward?

VII. Technical Analysis

图 271

the push-hands application of the right Part the Wild Horse's Mane, outdoors: the attacker drives in with the right forearm, the defender separates it outward.

When using it one must step up with the right foot in good time, the right knee sat solid, the left leg extended, and separate the right forearm downward into the opponent's armpit. Why "in good time"? The important meaning here is that the victory lies in seizing the initiative of advancing; if one does not step up in good time, then either the opponent steps up towards me, or one fails to follow up the advantage. If one does not act promptly one loses the opportunity. But in practising the form one must still step forward slowly.

BOOK PAGE 180

Posture Fifty — Grasping the Bird's Tail

Posture Fifty — Grasping the Bird's Tail

I. Method of Use

Same as Posture Three, Grasping the Bird's Tail.

II. Course of the Movement

The body turns slightly right, the centre of gravity gradually shifting entirely onto the right leg, the left leg lifted from the ground. At the same time the right elbow draws back, and as it draws

back the right arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns down, arcing to the front of the chest, the right elbow slightly lower than the wrist; the left palm likewise arcs to the front of the abdomen, and as it moves the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns up. The two palms join, the left foot steps to the left side, the heel touching first, the foot turned out obliquely, the toes pointing south-west, the left leg bent and the right leg extended forming the left bow stance (the left foot slightly behind and to the right of the right foot). As the left foot steps to the left, the body turns slightly left; as soon as the left heel has touched the ground the body immediately turns gradually right; at the same time the left elbow sinks, the left arm arcs out to the upper left, the left palm at shoulder height, the wrist slightly bent, the centre of the palm facing obliquely up…

图 271

the right elbow drawing back, both palms closing before the chest, the left foot stepping out to the left side.

图 272

both palms closed together before the chest, the left foot stepping to the left, the toes turned out.

图 273

the left arm arcing out to the upper left, the left palm at shoulder height.

图 274

the left bow stance formed, both hands joined at the front of the chest.

This page is taken up entirely by the posture photographs of the Grasping the Bird's Tail sequence, arranged in three rows of three; there is no running text. The plates continue the movement from the previous page and carry forward into the next.

图 275A

the left bow stance, the right palm pushing forward, the left palm at the inner side of the right forearm.

图 275B

the body turned to face front, both forearms crossed before the chest.

图 276

the right bow stance, the right forearm warding outward to the front right.

图 277

the body turned right, the right palm pushing forward, the left palm guarding at the right elbow.

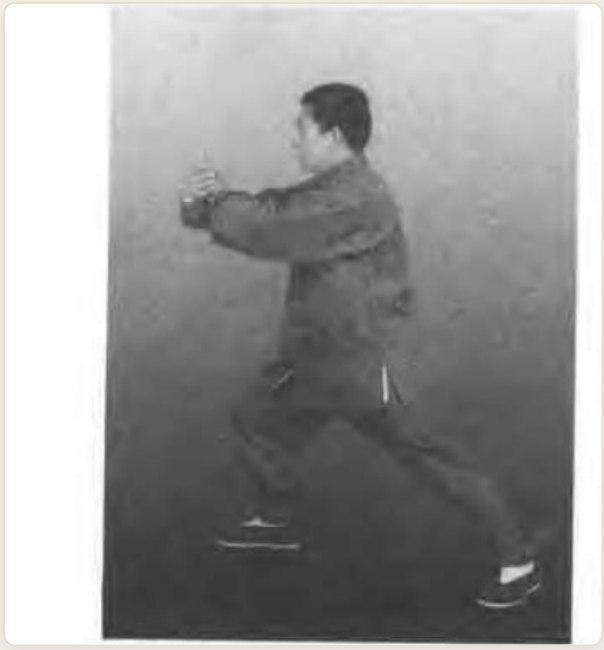
图 278

the body turned right, both hands closing at the front of the chest.

图 279

the left bow stance, the right forearm warding outward.

图 280



the body turned left, the right palm rolling back, the left hand supporting the right forearm.

图 281

the right palm pressing forward, the left palm following at the right wrist.

图 282

the left bow stance formed, the right palm pressed forward at chest height.

...side, the right palm sweeping forward and outward down to slightly above the hip, the centre of the palm down, the fingers pointing forward, the wrist sat, the knuckles turned slightly upward. The eyes look level to the front, the gaze attending to the left and right palms as they separate (see the first figure on this page).

All the other points are the same as Posture Three, Grasping the Bird's Tail, see the remaining figures on this page and on the next (the same as the second to the seventeenth figures).

III. Key Points

1. The right hand drawing back and the left hand moving across, and the lifting of the left foot, must all accord with the turn of the waist.

2. In stepping the left leg, the right leg must sit solid, and the right leg must squat very slightly in order to "send" the left leg down.

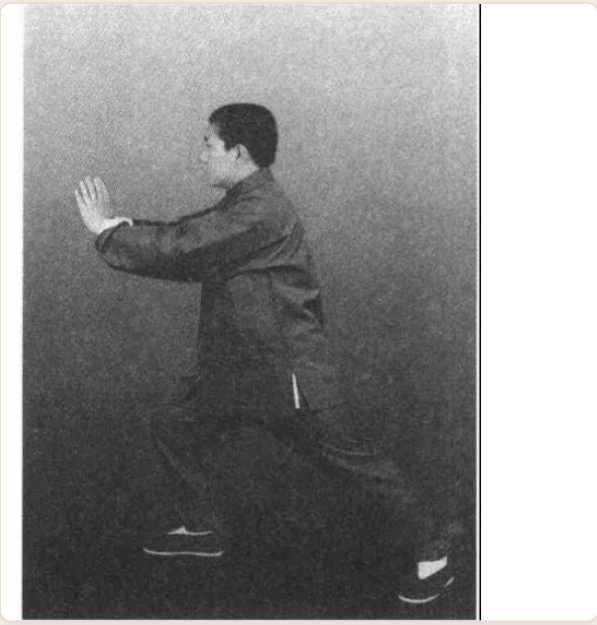
BOOK PAGE 182

Posture Fifty-One — Single Whip

Posture Fifty-One — Single Whip

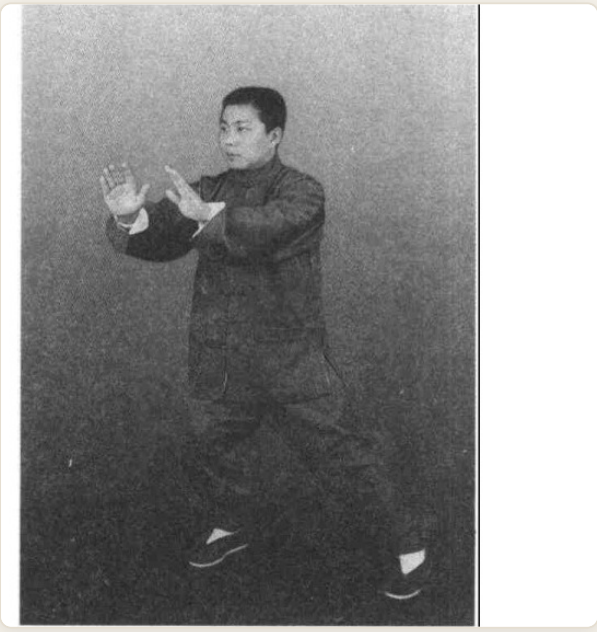
All points are the same as Posture Four, Single Whip, see the figures on this page and the next (the same as the eighteenth to the twenty-third figures).

图 283



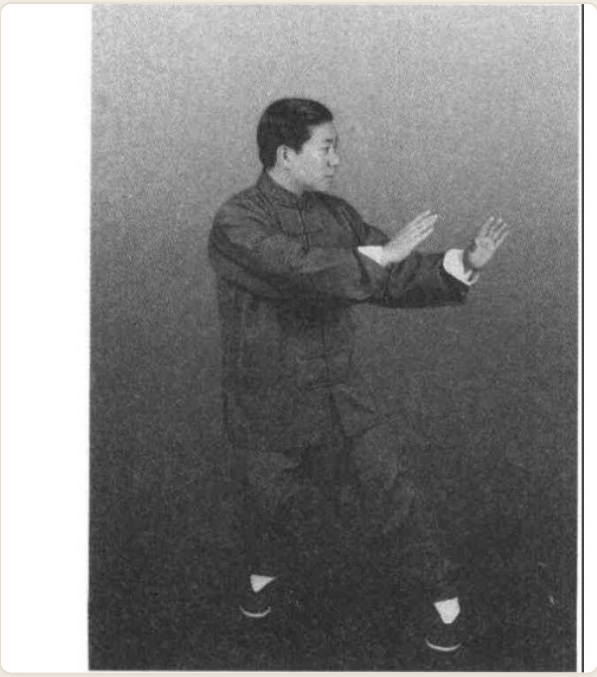
the right bow stance, the right palm sweeping down and outward to above the hip, fingers forward.

图 284



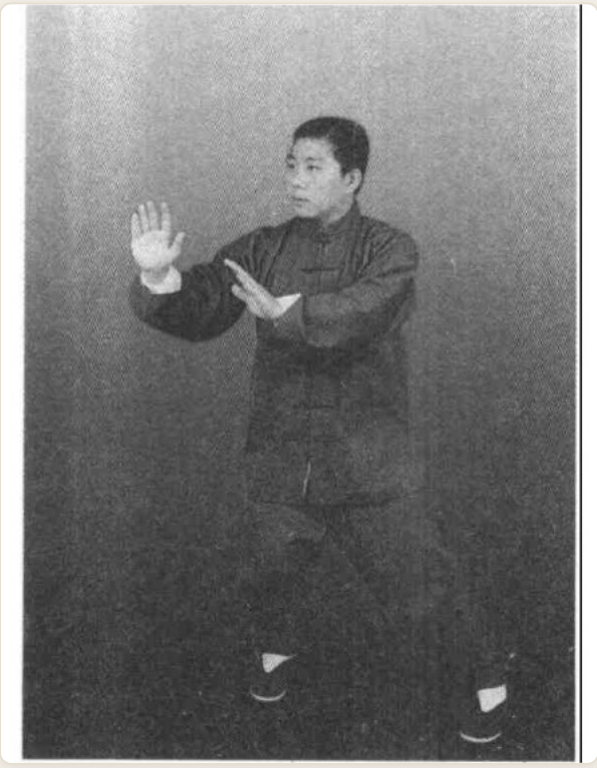
both forearms crossing before the chest, the left foot turning in.

图 285



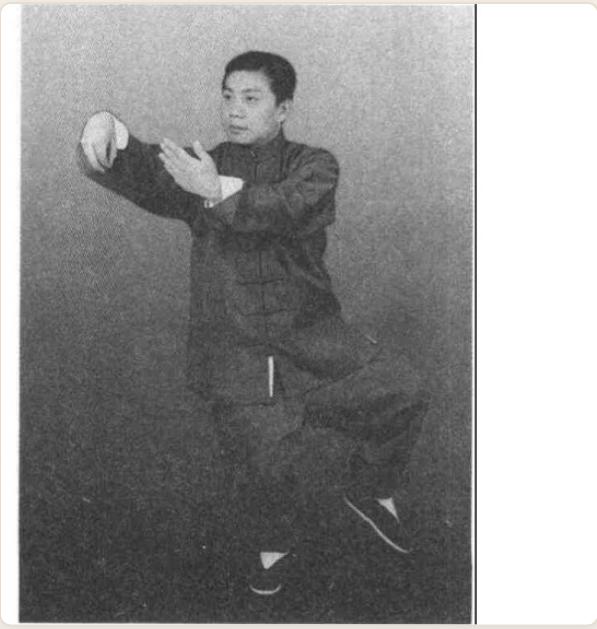
the left palm at the front of the chest, the right forearm extending outward.

图 286



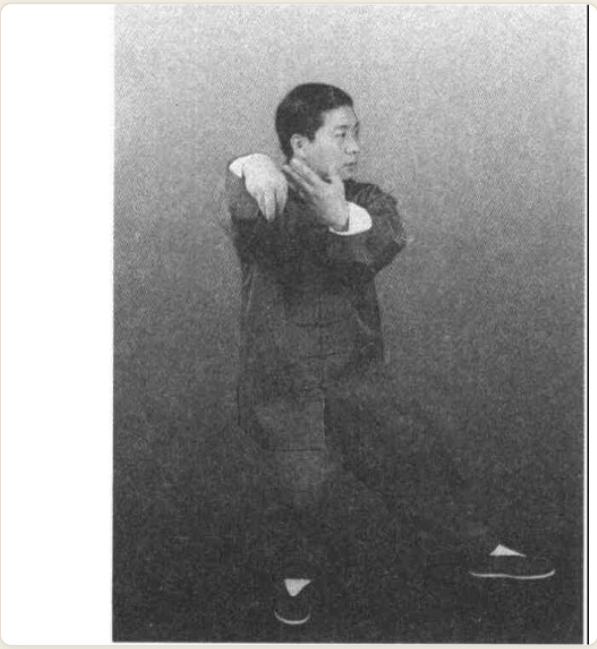
the right bow stance, the right palm continuing to push forward.

图 287



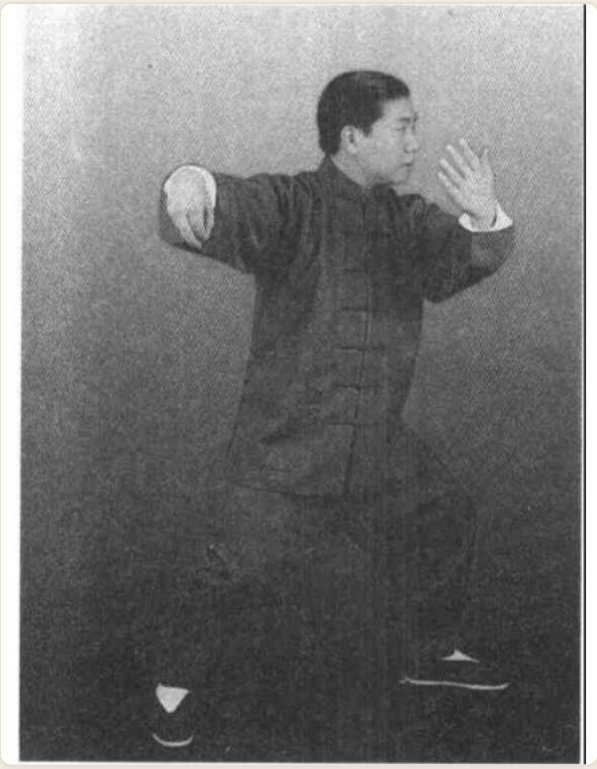
the right hand forming the hook, the left palm pushing forward, the left bow stance formed.

图 288A



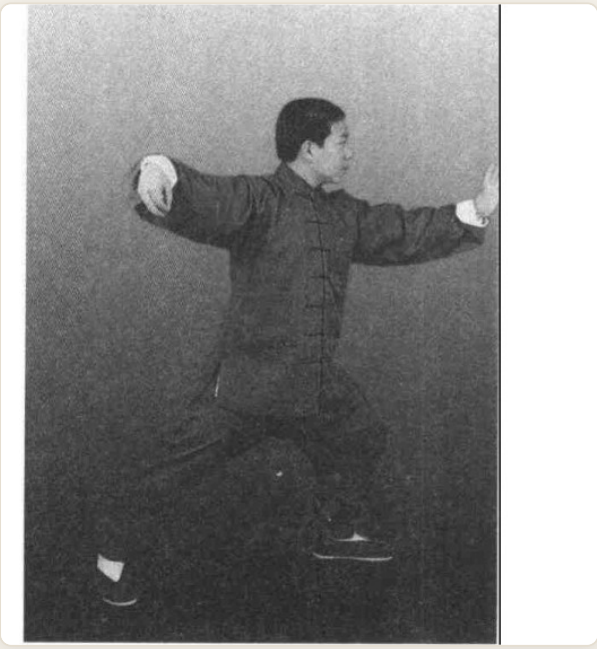
the body turned right, the right palm drawn back to the front of the right shoulder, the left hand closed at the right armpit.

图 288B



the right forearm warding outward to the upper right, both palms turned over.

图 289



the right bow stance, the right palm separating outward, the left palm below the right elbow.

BOOK PAGE 183

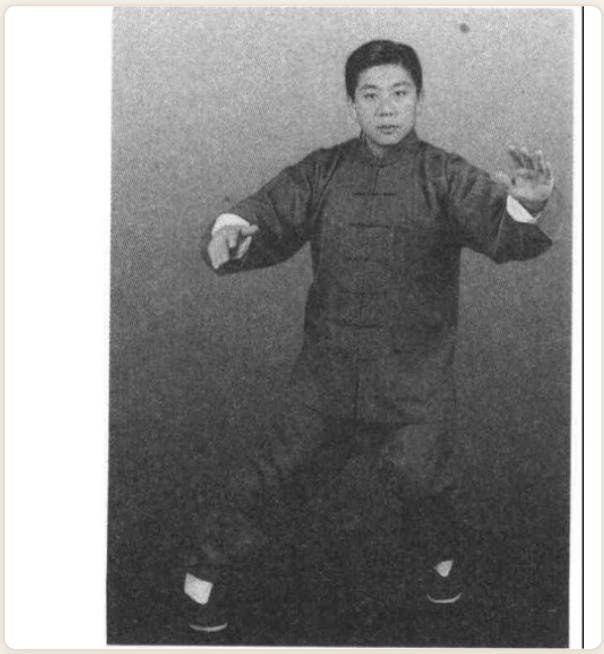
Posture Fifty-Two — the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle

Posture Fifty-Two — the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle

I. Method of Use

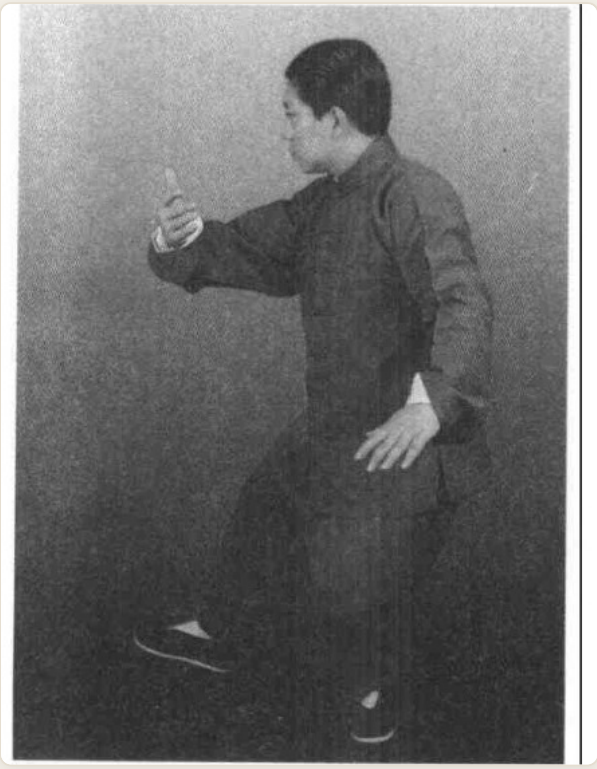
(A) The Left Shuttle Following the Single Whip posture. Should the opponent, from my right rear, strike down with his right hand from above, I immediately turn my body to the right as I turn my left foot in, and the right foot is thereupon lifted back and set down in front of the left foot, the toes turned to sit apart to the right. The left hand draws back and closes beneath the right hand, and following this guards around the right upper arm, threading through at the right elbow; that is, I ward (peng) it up and out to the left front corner, lifting the opponent's wrist, while the left foot simultaneously advances, the knee bent and sat solid, the right leg extended...

图 290



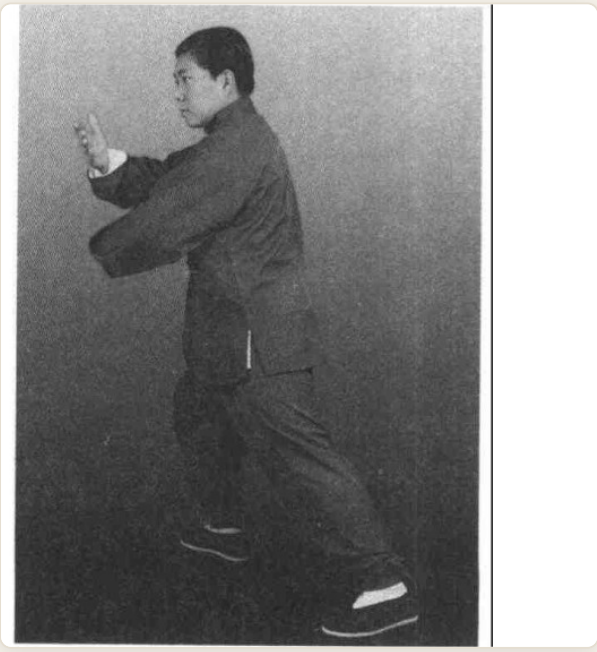
the left forearm warding outward to the upper left, the right palm guarding at the inner side of the left elbow.

图 291



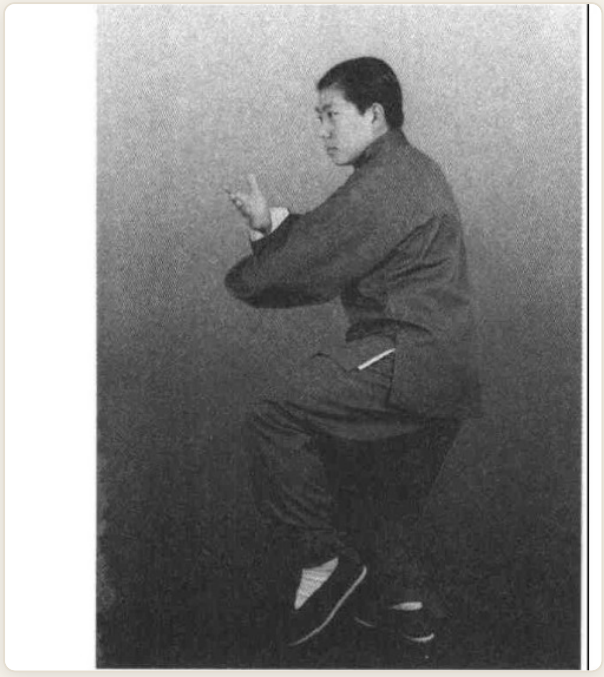
the body turned left, the left palm turned over and rising, the right hand closed at the left armpit.

图 292



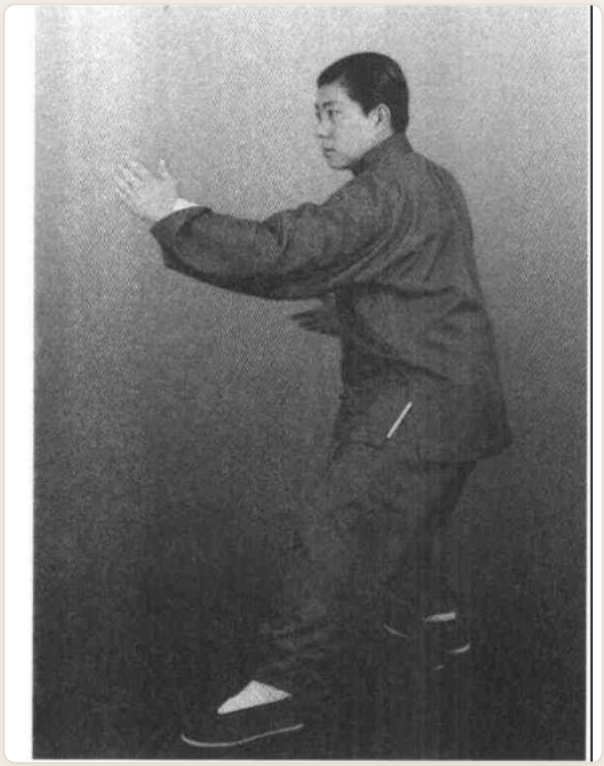
the left bow stance formed, the left forearm warding up and out to the left front corner.

图 293



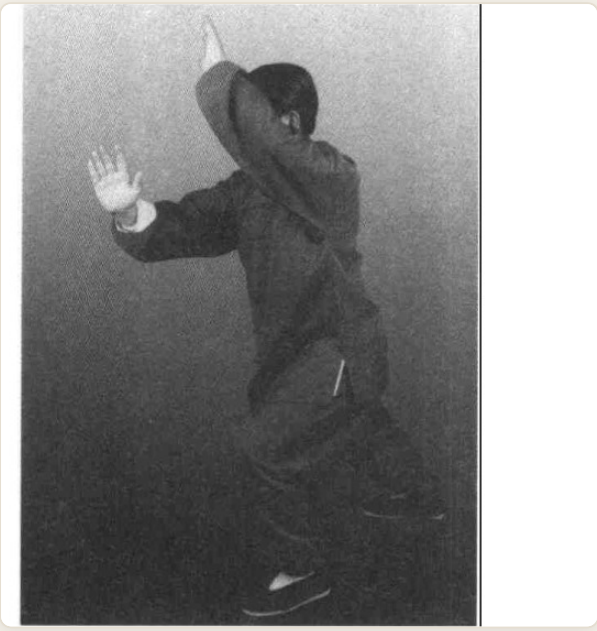
the left forearm warding outward to the upper left, the right hand closed at the left armpit.

图 294



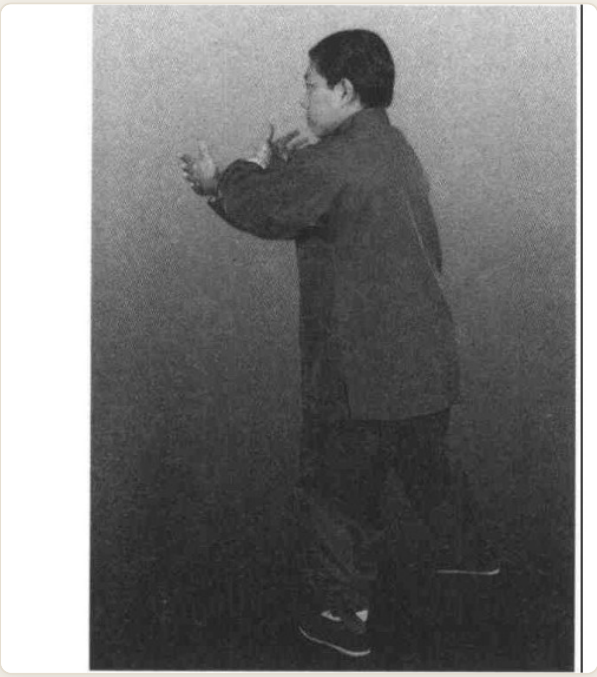
the left bow stance, the left palm turned over and pushing forward.

图 295



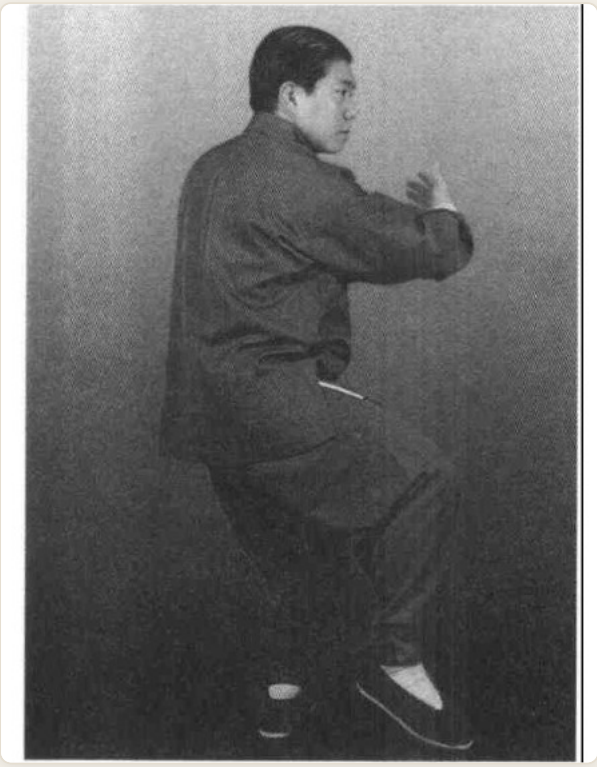
the left palm warding up and out to the left front corner, the right palm guarding below the left elbow.

图 296



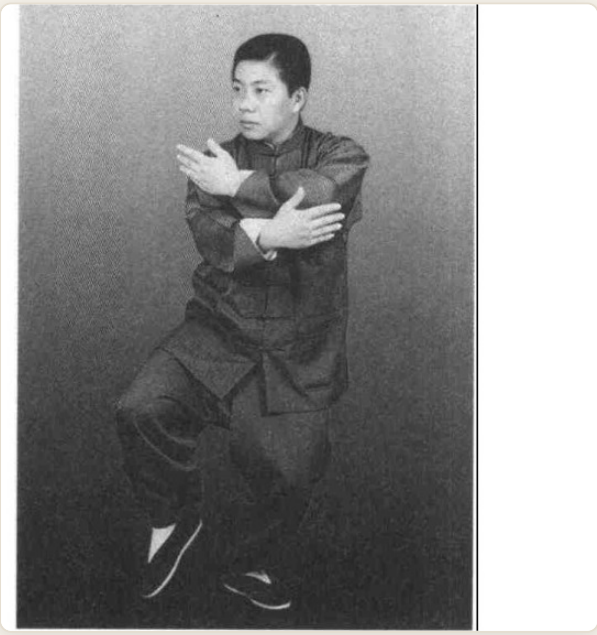
the body turned right, the right forearm crossing before the chest.

图 297A



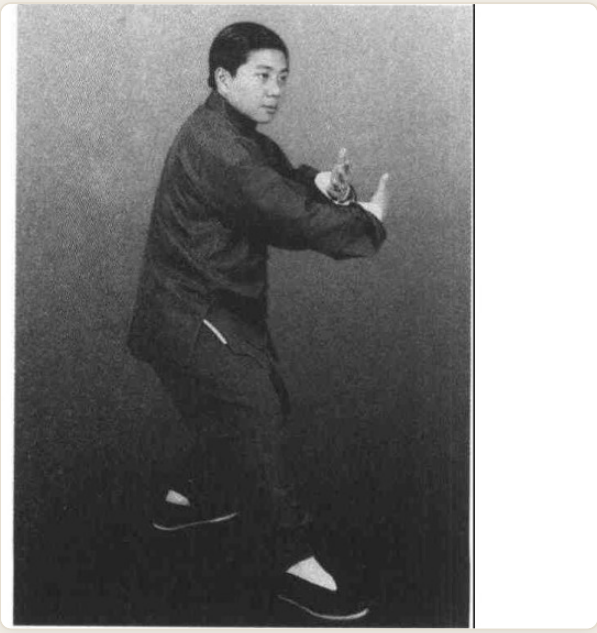
the right bow stance, the right forearm warding outward.

图 297B



the body turned right again, both forearms crossed before the chest.

图 298

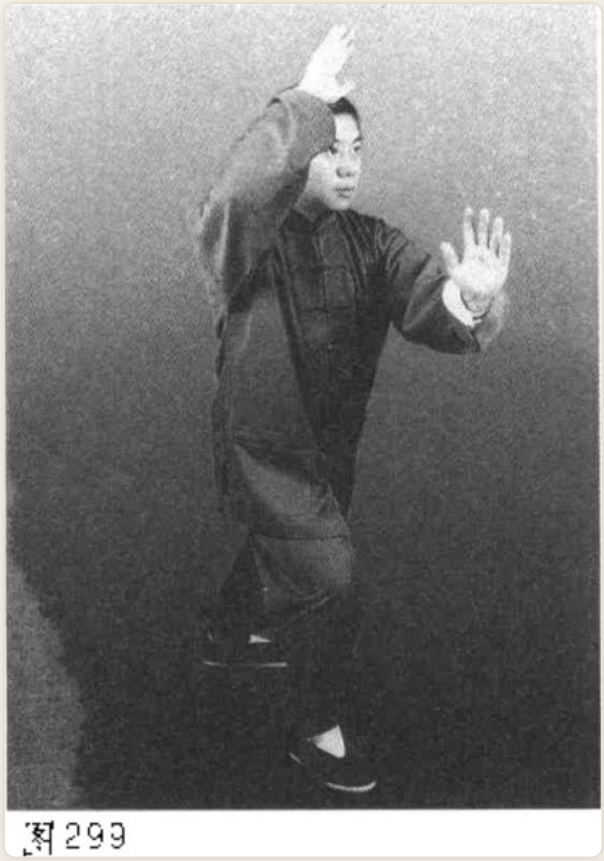


the right palm pushing forward, the left palm following at the inner side of the right forearm.

The right hand thereupon becomes a palm, and in haste threads out from beneath the left elbow, striking at the opponent's chest and ribs; thus the opponent has no one who does not fall. In this posture the left and right hands thread through one another, now hidden now appearing, elusive and unfixed, taking advantage of his emptiness to strike — and so it is called the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle, using this to liken this movement's nimbleness and agility (see the first six figures on this page).

(B) The Right Shuttle Following the previous posture. Should the opponent strike from behind my right side with the head of his right fist, I immediately turn my left foot in, and at the same time the right foot steps one pace out to the right rear, the knee bent and sat solid, the body following this turning to the right, the left foot becoming empty; in haste I use my right forearm to stick to the outside of the opponent's right arm and lift it up to the right rear...

图 299

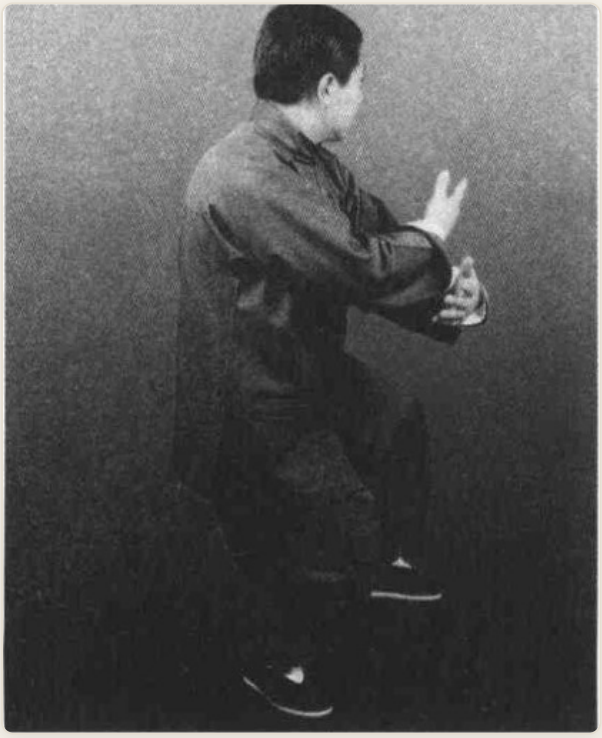


the right forearm warding outward to the upper right, the left hand at the right elbow.

图 300

the left foot stepping out to the left front corner, the left palm turning over.

图 301



the left bow stance formed, the left forearm warding up and out to the left front corner.

Following this the left hand is pressed down towards the opponent's right ribs; the rest is as in the previous posture (see the first figures on this page).

(C) The Left Shuttle Following the previous posture. Should the opponent strike from my left side with his left hand, I immediately sit apart with my right toes turned to the right, and the left foot is lifted and steps out to the left corner to sit solid, the hand technique being the same as the previous Left Shuttle (see the figures at the foot of this page and on the next).

(D) The Right Shuttle This posture is the same as the previous Right Shuttle (see the figures on the next page). One must note that the correct directions of the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle are at the four corners; this point must on no account be mistaken.

II. Course of the Movement

(A) The Left Shuttle 1. The upper body turns slightly right, the left toes are turned in and sat solid; at the same time the right hand hangs and becomes a palm, arcing downward from the right front to the left, the left palm also gradually arcing downward and moving across, the gaze shifting level and attending to the direction of both hands.

2. The body continues to turn gradually right, the centre of gravity shifting entirely onto the left leg, the right foot lifted; at the same time the right palm, following the body's turning, arcs upward from below through the front of the left chest to the right, the left hand continuing to arc downward and lick across. The gaze attends to the right palm as it wards up to the right.

3. The body continues to turn right, the right foot stepping out to the right front (north-west), the heel touching first, the centre of gravity gradually shifting entirely onto the right leg and the whole sole settling flat; the left foot then lifted forward, the left palm passing through the abdomen and arcing to the lower side of the right forearm, the centre of the left palm facing down, the backs of the two hands obliquely opposing; the right palm also continues to ward right as the body turns, that is, the right elbow sinks, naturally carrying the right palm to shift downward and return.

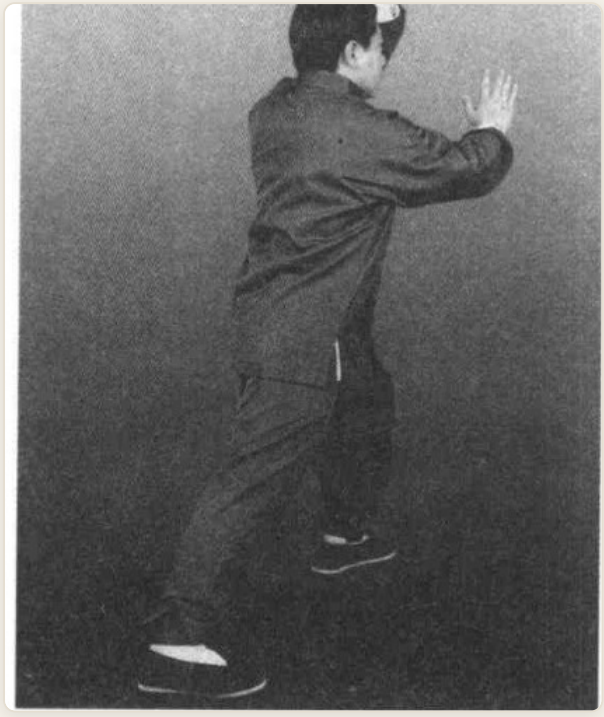
4. The left foot steps out one pace to the left front diagonal (south-west), the heel touching first, the waist turning slightly left; at the same time the left forearm wards up and forward from the lower side of the right forearm; the right palm (with a sinking elbow) threads back through the upper side of the left forearm, and as it threads the arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns obliquely to the lower front. The eyes look level to the left front, the gaze attending to the left forearm as it wards forward.

5. The body gradually turns left, the centre of gravity gradually shifting onto the left leg, the left foot settling flat, the left leg bent and the right leg extended forming the left bow stance; at the same time the left forearm moves up and round to the front, and as it moves the arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns obliquely...

图 302

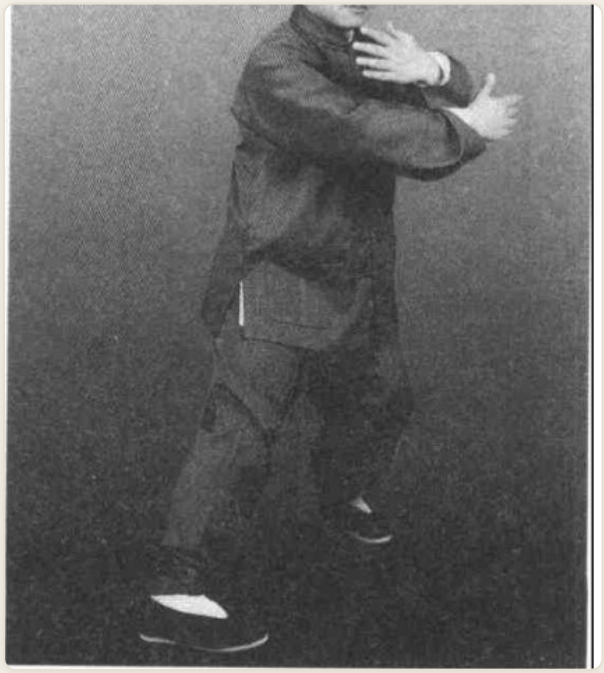
the right bow stance, the right forearm warding outward to the right.

图 303



the body turned right, the right palm pushing forward, the left palm guarding at the right elbow.

图 304



the left bow stance, the left forearm warding up and out, the right palm below the left elbow.

...to the upper front, the left palm stopping above in front of the forehead; at the same time the right palm threads out to the front, the eyes looking level to the front, the gaze attending to the right palm as it threads forward (see the third figure on this page).

(B) The Right Shuttle 1. The waist gradually turns right, the right toes turned in and sat solid. At the same time, the right palm, following the body's turning, bends the elbow and crosses the forearm (the arm forming an arc) shifting to the front of the chest, and as it shifts the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm gradually turns to face inward; the left arm rotates outward, and as it sinks and the left elbow drops the left palm is naturally carried to move down, the hand sinking with the back at the outer side and the palm facing inward, the two warding arms gradually forming a shape close to a crossed ten. The gaze attends to the left palm as it shifts back.

2. The body continues to turn right, the centre of gravity gradually shifting entirely onto the left leg, the right foot lifted; following the waist's turning right, at the same time the left arm, following the body's turning, sinks the elbow, passing through the lower side of the right forearm and shifting back down, the right arm gradually warding right, the gaze first attending to the left palm as it shifts down, then immediately turning to the right front (see the fifth figure on this page).

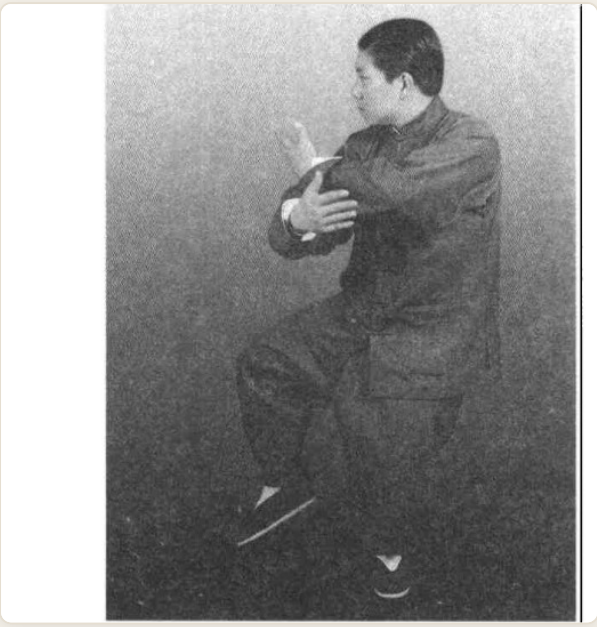
3. The waist continues to turn right, the right foot steps out to the right front diagonal (south-east), the heel touching first; at the same time, the right forearm wards up and forward from the lower side of the left forearm; the left palm sinks the elbow, threads back through the upper side of the right forearm, and as it threads the arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns gradually to face the lower front. The eyes look level to the front, the gaze attending to the right forearm as it wards forward.

4. The centre of gravity gradually shifts onto the right leg, the right foot settling flat, the body gradually turning right, the right leg bent and the left leg extended forming the right bow stance. At the same time, the right forearm turns upward across the front, and as it turns the arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns to face the upper front, the right palm stopping above in front of the forehead; the left palm simultaneously threads forward, the eyes looking level to the front, the gaze attending to the left palm as it pushes forward (see the first three figures on this page).

(C) The Left Shuttle 1. The waist turns slightly left, the whole centre of gravity gradually shifting onto the right leg, the left leg lifted forward; at the same time, the left arm, following the body's turning, bends the elbow and crosses the forearm (the arm forming an arc) shifting to the front of the chest, and as it shifts the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm gradually turns to face inward; the right arm rotates outward, and the sinking right elbow naturally carries the right palm to shift down, the palm facing inward, the left hand outside and the right hand within, gradually forming two warding arcs close to a crossed ten. The gaze attends to the right palm as it shifts down, then immediately turns to the left arm in front (see the seventh figure on this page).

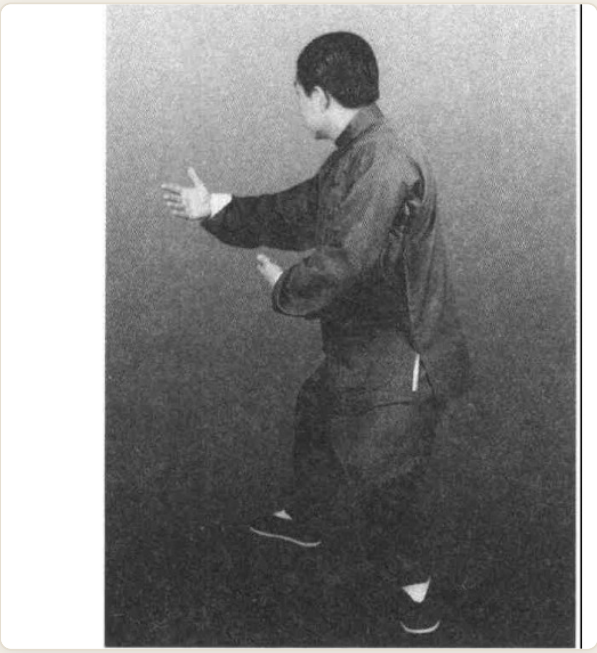
2. 2 and 3. The movement is the same as steps 4 and 5 of the previous Left Shuttle.

图 305



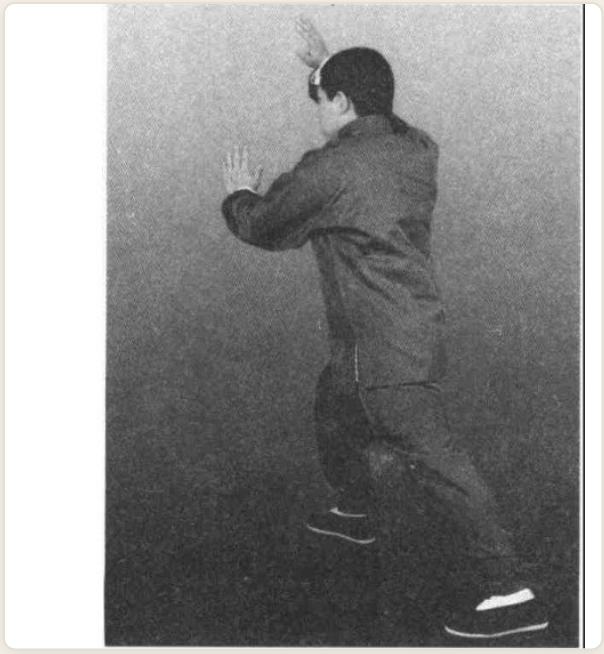
the left bow stance, the left forearm warding up and out, the right palm guarding below the left elbow.

图 306



the body turned right, the right forearm crossing before the chest, the left palm at the right armpit.

图 307



the right bow stance formed, the right forearm warding outward, the left arm extended to the left.

...are the same; what differs is that the previous Left Shuttle's direction is to the south-west, and this Left Shuttle's direction is the north-east diagonal (see the first three figures on this page).

(D) The Right Shuttle The movement is the same as the previous Right Shuttle; what differs is that the previous Right Shuttle's direction is the south-east, and this Right Shuttle's direction is the north-west (see the three figures on this page).

III. Key Points

1. The Jade Girl Works the Shuttle has in all four threadings-through, the directions being towards the four diagonal corners (south-west, south-east, north-east, north-west).

2. In the four threadings the two hands each pass once through a shape resembling a crossed ten; the first has the left hand outside, the second the right hand outside, the third the left hand outside, the fourth the right hand outside.

3. At each turn of the body or step up, one must not rise up, so that the centre of gravity has no great fluctuation. In turning the body while stepping, because of the changes of direction and angle and the lack of coordination between the upper and lower, left and right, the beginner cannot avoid instability, swaying and rising and falling, which then affects the movement. Therefore one must first take care over the empty-full conversion of the stepping method, and make each step follow the body's turning.

4. In the movement the body must be kept upright, the chest contained and the back rounded; do not lower the head or bend the waist.

5. When warding up with one hand, guard against the shoulders rising or the elbows protruding; the pushing arm should not be straightened, but slightly bent — bent and not straight is what preserves the stored force.

6. When changing into the bow stance, one palm pushes forward, and the toes, knees, body, face and gaze must all be in the same direction as the push, all facing the diagonal corner.

IV. Requirements

1. The connecting movement from Single Whip to the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle is the easiest to overlook and the easiest to confuse; it requires a clear understanding. In my Single Whip posture I face east; now the opponent strikes down from above at my right rear. Therefore the transition for the first threading is: the upper body turns right, the right foot lifted back, set down in front of the left foot, the left foot stepping out at the south-west diagonal, performing the first threading (towards the south-west). This accords with the requirement of the method of use, and it also divides the transition movement clearly.

2. The upper and lower, left and right must mutually draw one another...

...turning over, one hand at the same time threads out to the front, one foot advances with the knee sat solid, one leg extended. In this way, between the two hands and between the two feet, the upper and lower, left and right mutually respond and have the sense of drawing and binding one another, so that the movement is expansive without being loose, the spirit gathered, and in the opening out the stored force is not lost. There must be no upper with no lower, no lower with no upper.

3. In the transition the right foot must turn over to the right with the body and be drawn back; otherwise one will not gain the advantage.

4. The movement must be centred, upright and comfortable. The body must be centred and not leaning; wherever the movement goes, the spine must point directly there — especially in going from the first threading to the second, and the third to the fourth, when the change of the body's direction reaches (180° + 90°) = 270°. If the turning-in of the foot is insufficient, the stance is unsteady, the upper body will then lean forward or backward or twist awkwardly, and this does not meet the requirement of being centred, upright and comfortable.

5. The turning of the two hands must not leave the centre line; they may not "scatter" — that is, the two hands may not leave the body.

6. When the two hands cross in a ten, the two hands must follow as the body turns (following the turn and closing).

7. The movement must be continuous and even.

V. Likely Errors, Their Causes, and Their Correction

V. Likely Errors, Their Causes, and Their Correction

1. *Error: the direction is not correct.* The main cause is a lack of understanding of the method of use, and insufficient turning-in of the foot. The first and second threadings have the opponent at my right rear, the third has him at the left, the fourth at the right rear — all are at diagonal (side) angles. Therefore the threading directions must all be diagonal. *Correction:* the key lies in the turning-in of the foot; the turning-in must be sufficient, and to turn the foot in well one must turn the waist and hips well.

2. *Error: the buttocks protrude.* The main causes are, first, using the shifting back of the buttocks to carry the turning of the body instead of turning the waist and hips to bring the body round; and second, in order to keep the balance easily, the buttocks are pushed back and the upper body leans forward. *Correction:* first one must tuck in the tailbone, then attend to sufficient turning-in of the foot.

3. *Error: the movement pauses.* The main cause is that the beginner, because he performs the movement while thinking, is always wanting to think of the hands and think of the feet, and so makes a slip and a pause; and further, the supporting foot is unsteady. If the movement is interrupted, then the old strength is spent and the new strength has not yet been born, and at this moment… …is the easiest for people to catch. Therefore the movement must not pause; it must be continuous and unbroken, revolving endlessly, as the *Treatise* says: "Like the great river and the sea, flowing on without cease." *Correction:* one form joined to the next, continuous and lively, rise, receive, turn and close threaded through; one breath, and the strength gradually enough, the spirit gathered — and the opportunity of the lower posture is born of itself. Therefore there must be no place of pause.

4. *Error: the movement is awkward*, especially when one hand wards up and the other threads forward. The main cause lies in the lower limbs not being smooth. *Correction:* after stepping out at the diagonal, one should in turning follow round to the rear foot, so that the body follows the foot and the foot follows the body.

5. *Error: the transition from Single Whip to the threading is unclear*, so that one often feels that the hands and feet have nowhere to be placed. The main cause is an incomplete understanding of the method of use. The transition and connecting movements are chiefly to prepare the conditions for the main movement. In my position of Single Whip the opponent strikes down from above at my right rear; if in turning the body I take the right leg as full, this must produce a passive situation, and it will be difficult to turn and difficult to advance. I must draw back the right leg…

At the foot of this page is a push-hands photograph, outdoors, in which the upper hand lifts the opponent's arm from below; it carries no number and no caption.

...falling in front of the left foot, and the left foot then advances at the diagonal — and the lower limbs are lively. "The hand follows the foot, the foot follows the hand", the upper and lower drawing one another. Because the left hand circles a small circle, driven by the waist's turning right and left; the right hand's falling is to prepare for threading out from beneath the left elbow, and therefore at this moment the two hands' movements are only preparatory. *Correction:* the left foot turns in and the body turns slightly right, and this brings the right hand to move right; the right hand falls and the right foot is drawn back, the left hand also being brought to move left, forming a small circle. The foot is set down, the right hand moves up, the left hand moves down, the body turns right, and the left leg is lifted as preparation for the threading.

6. *Error: the threading hand is pulled back without sinking the elbow.* The main cause is an unclear grasp of the method of use. Closing is issuing; without closing there is nothing to issue. *Correction:* after closing (crossing), one must sink the elbow and draw back, and only then thread out. And the threading hand must not cross out sideways away from the elbow of the warding arm.

BOOK PAGE 190

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods

1. First make clear the directions and distinguish the four diagonal corners of the four threadings. Correct them one by one; the teacher may stand at the diagonal corner to guide the direction.

2. The transition at the beginning is the easiest for the beginner to muddle; therefore the teacher must divide this part of the movement clearly — that is, take steps 1–3 of the first Left Shuttle as the transition movement.

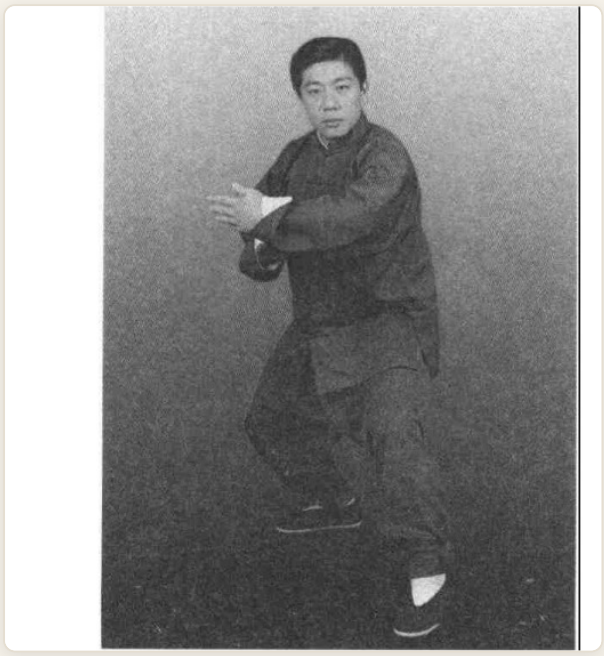
3. The graded method: learn the transition first, then consolidate one by one on this basis until all four threadings are learned.

4. Paired practice in accordance with the method of use: A — settled in the Single Whip posture, facing east. B — stands at A's right rear (south-west) and strikes down from above with his right hand. A — turns in the left foot, turns the body over, the right foot drawn back and set down, the left foot stepping out at the south-west diagonal, the left hand warding up, the right hand threading out to strike at B's chest and ribs. C — stands at A's right rear (south-east) and continues the practice as above; if there are only two people, B may move about to take the part.

5. After the movement is basically proficient, the practitioner should, with care, experience that the intention arrives, the eye arrives, the body arrives, the hand arrives and the step arrives, and that speaking of one brings all together; and should strive to achieve the union of spirit and form.

VII. Technical Analysis

图 308



the opening of the Grasping the Bird's Tail posture: the right elbow sinking, both palms closing before the chest, the left foot lifted.

1. The Jade Girl Works the Shuttle changes direction without cease, and its continuous single-leg supporting steps are of great benefit to the growth of the legs' strength; and the repeated revolutions and changes of direction give the body's position-sense receptors a good training.

2. Every posture has its rise, receive, turn and close. Issuing is the rise, receiving is the receive, changing is the turn, and forming the posture is the close. In the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle, the four threadings make up one overall posture, and each threading must be threaded through, every place fitting together, the fitting together bringing together the whole spirit; the four limbs' upper and lower, left and right, front and rear must all unite naturally. Therefore between the movements there must be no place of pause; there must be "one breath threaded through".

3. The long-time practitioner of Tai Chi must attend to the union of internal and external. The traditional method of practice is "first the intention stirs, then the internal moves, then the form appears"; that is, the internal moves and the external form follows, the external form closes with the internal movement, from internal to external and from external drawing the internal, until at last internal and external become one (the internal and external join). Therefore the long-time practitioner should not stop at speaking only of external movement; the breath and blood must be harmonised and the channels and vessels made free. One must achieve "the mind calm and the intention present", "the body upright and relaxed". Therefore, when practising the Jade Girl Works the Shuttle, one must first settle in the mind the opponent's attack, position and

movement; and then deepen the method: as the movement opens and closes, cause the internal organs to make slight upward and downward, left and right, and variously sized peristaltic movements and massaging, so that the breath and blood flow lively and smooth along the channels and blood vessels. Practising in this way is better than practising the external form alone.

BOOK PAGE 191

Posture Fifty-Three — Grasping the Bird's Tail

Posture Fifty-Three — Grasping the Bird's Tail

I. Method of Use

Same as Posture Three, Grasping the Bird's Tail.

II. Course of the Movement

The centre of gravity gradually shifts onto the right leg, the left leg lifted forward; at the same time, the right palm, bending the elbow and sinking it, arcs from outside inward to close at the front of the chest; as it closes the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns down, the right elbow slightly lower than the wrist; the left palm likewise arcs to the right and downward to the front of the abdomen, and as it arcs the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns up. The two palms join, both arms forming arcs. The gaze attends to the right arm, see the figure at the foot of this page (the same as the first figure of the third posture). This page is taken up entirely by the posture photographs of the Grasping the Bird's Tail sequence, arranged in three rows of three; there is no running text. The plates continue the movement begun on the previous page and carry forward into the next.

图 309

both palms closing before the chest, the left foot lifted, the right elbow sinking.

图 310

the left foot stepping out, the left palm crossing to the inner side of the right forearm.

图 311

the left bow stance, the right palm pressing forward, the left palm at the right wrist.

图 312A

the body turned left, the right palm rolling back, the left hand supporting the right forearm.

图 312B

the body turned to face front, both forearms crossed before the chest.

图 313

the right bow stance, the right forearm warding outward to the front right.

图 314

the body turned right, the right palm pushing forward, the left palm guarding at the right elbow.

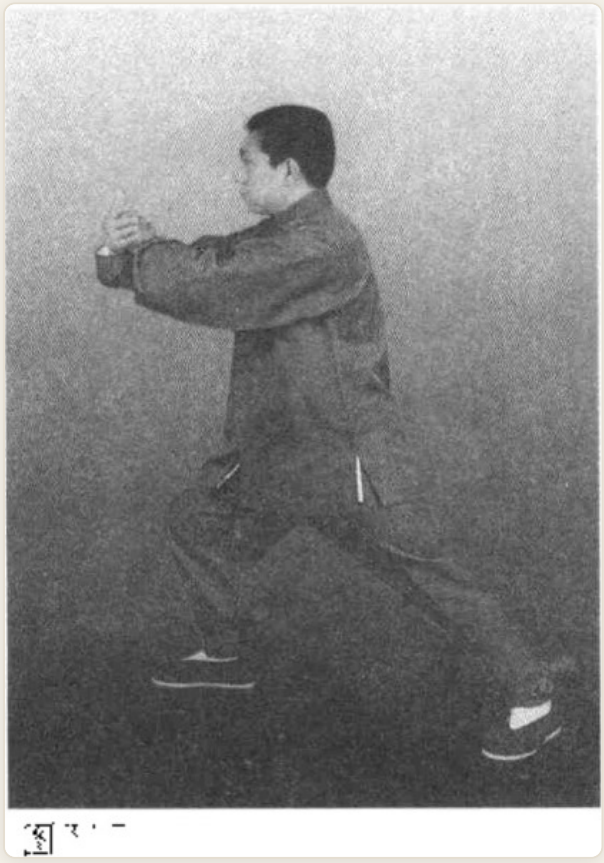
图 315

the body turned right, both hands closing at the front of the chest.

图 316

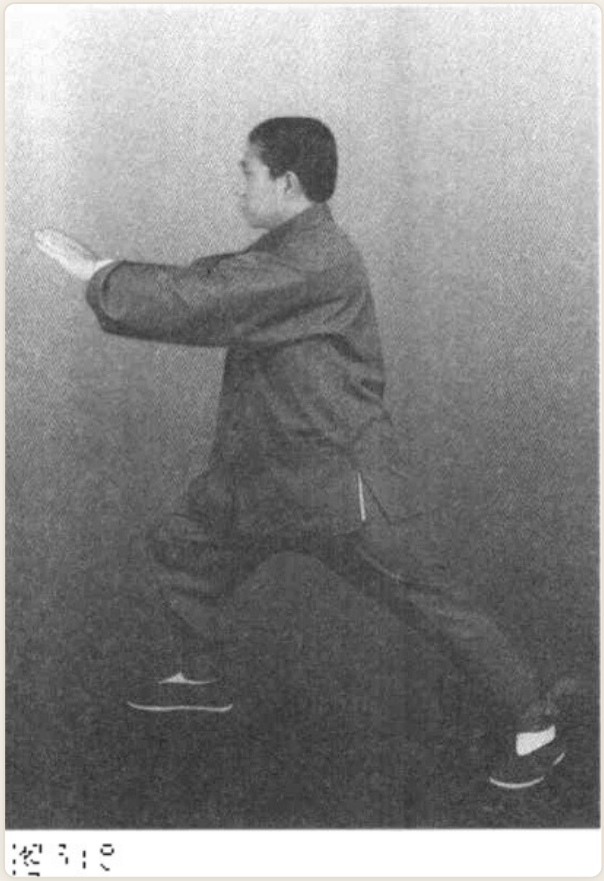
the left bow stance, both palms pressed forward.

图 317



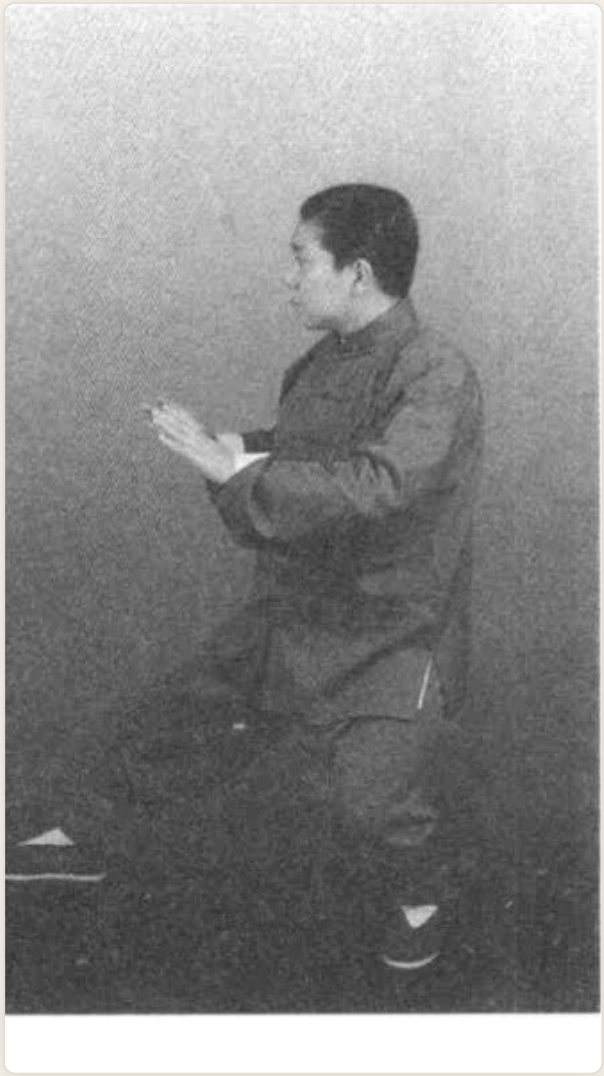
the left bow stance, the right palm pressed forward, the left palm at the right wrist.

图 318A



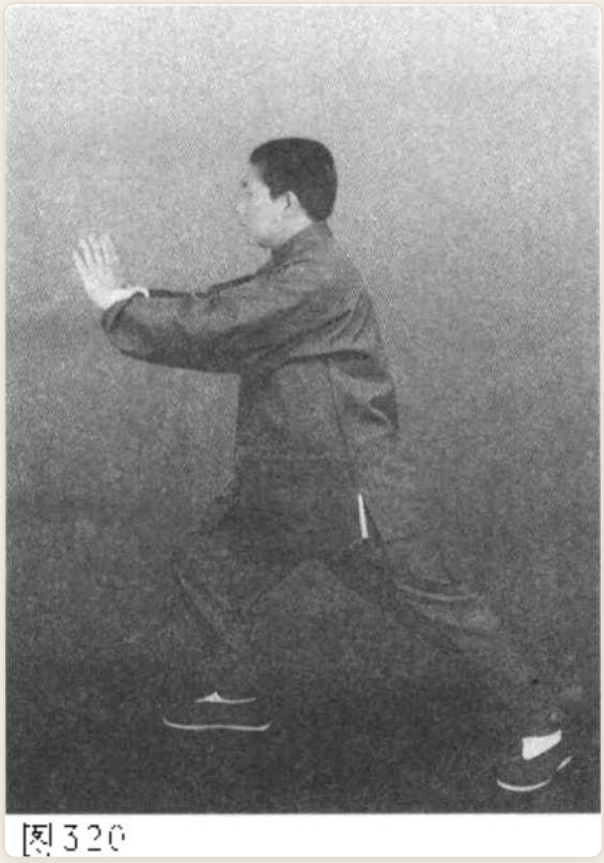
the body turned left, the right palm rolling back, the left hand supporting the right forearm.

图 318B



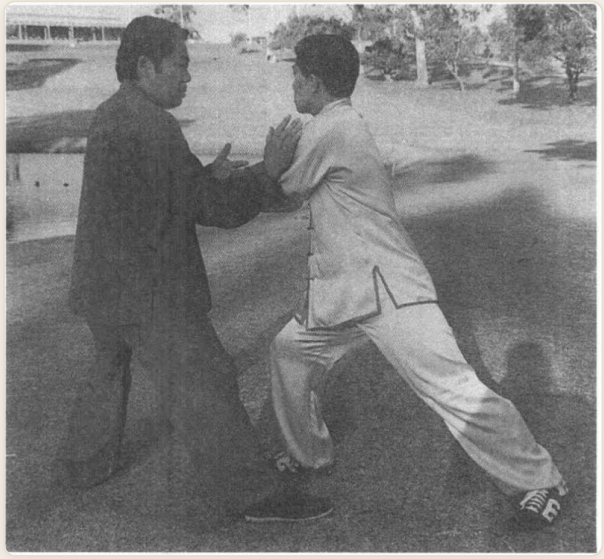
the body turned to face front, both forearms crossing before the chest.

图 319



the right bow stance, the right forearm warding outward to the front right.

图 320



outdoors, a push-hands photograph: the two partners joined at the forearms, the upper hand pressing forward.

The later movements are the same as Posture Three, Grasping the Bird's Tail, see the first five figures on this page (the same as the second to the seventeenth figures).

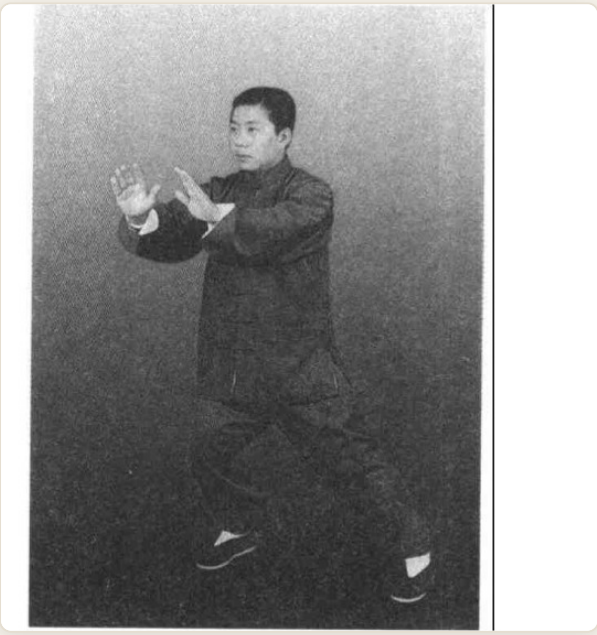
BOOK PAGE 194

Posture Fifty-Four — Single Whip

Posture Fifty-Four — Single Whip

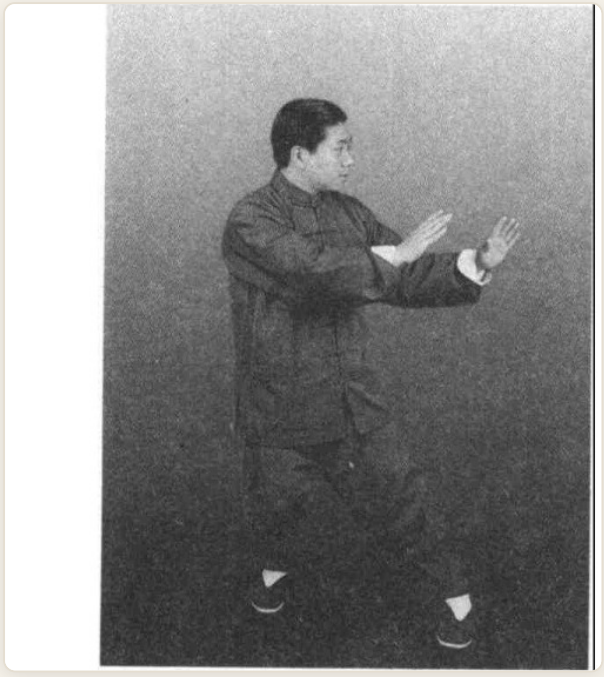
All points are the same as Posture Four, Single Whip, see the seven figures on this page (the same as the eighteenth to the twenty-third figures).

图 321



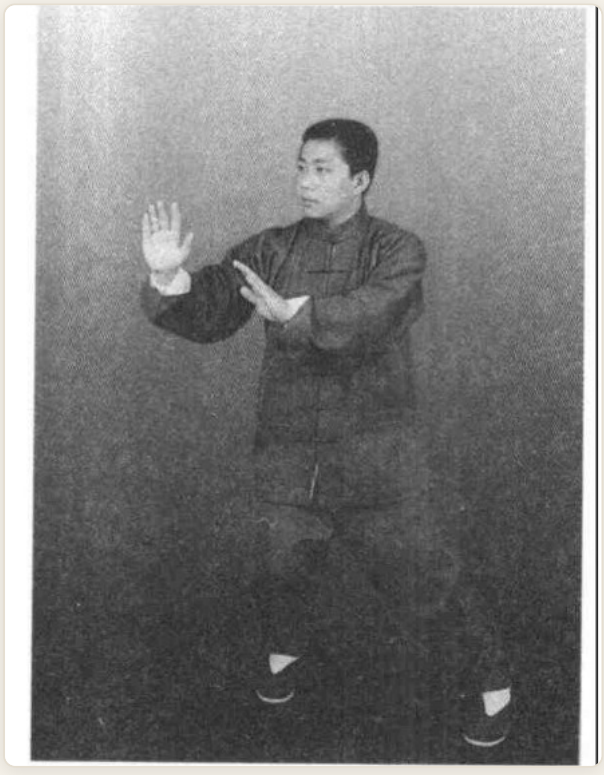
the right bow stance, the right forearm extending outward, the left palm at the front of the chest.

图 322



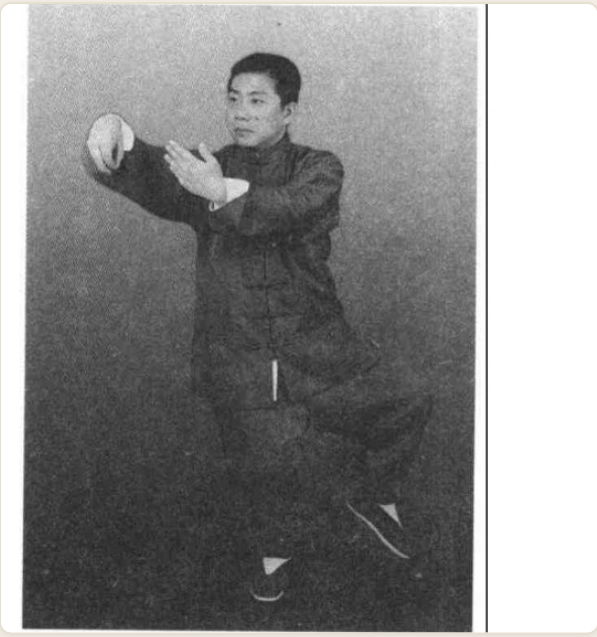
the left palm at the front of the chest, the right forearm drawn back.

图 323



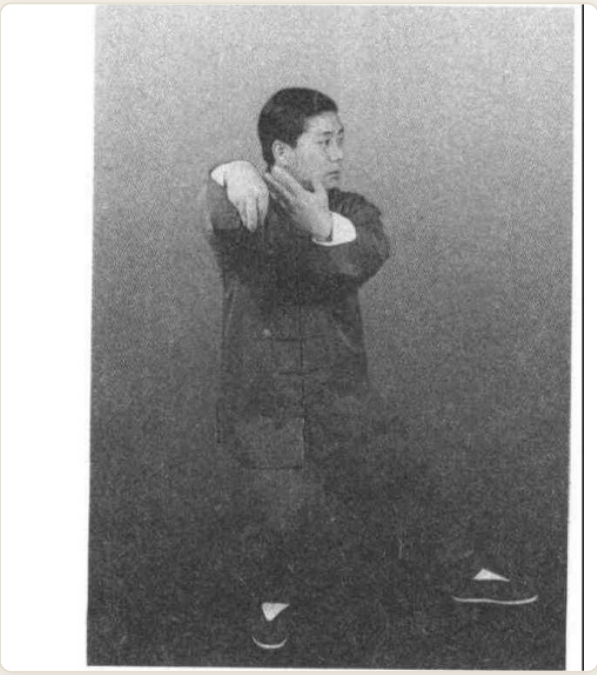
the right bow stance, the right palm pushing forward.

图 324



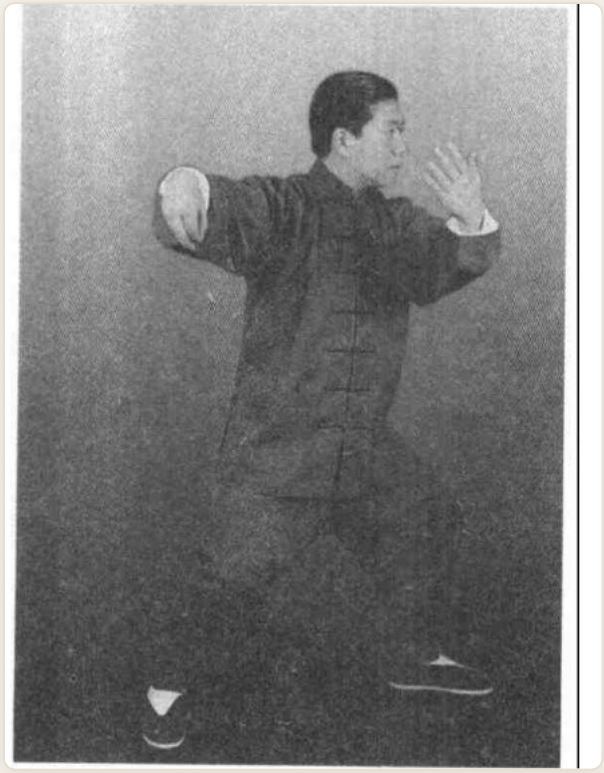
the right hand forming the hook, the left palm crossing at the chest.

图 325



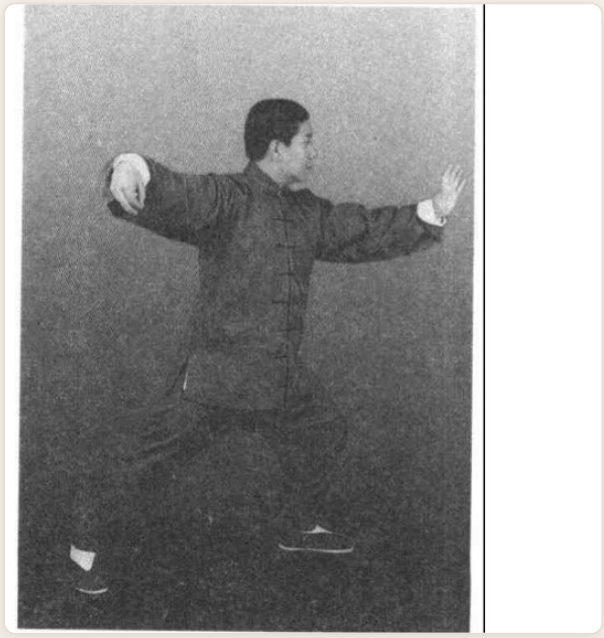
the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward, the right hook at the right side.

图 326



the body turned left, both palms crossing before the chest.

图 327



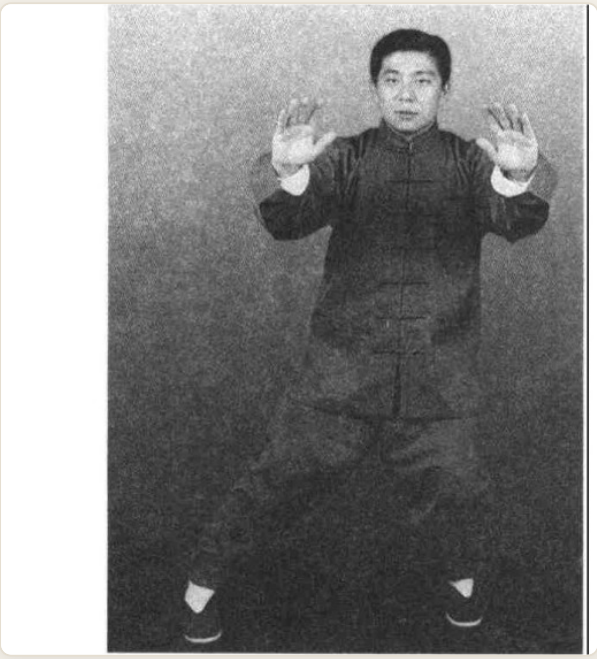
the left bow stance settled, the left palm pushed forward, the right hook drawn back.

Posture Fifty-Five — Cloud Hands

Posture Fifty-Five — Cloud Hands

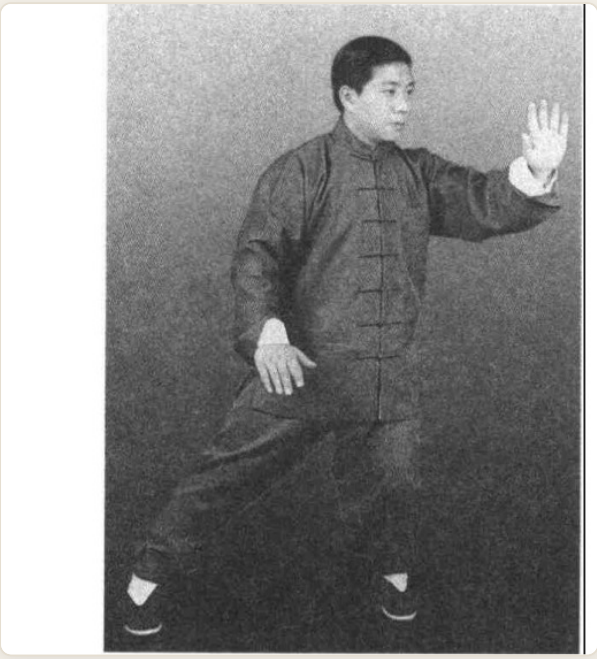
All points are the same as Posture Twenty-Eight, Cloud Hands, see the first eight figures on this page and the figures on the next (the same as the hundred-and-forty-ninth to the hundred-and-fifty-sixth figures).

图 328



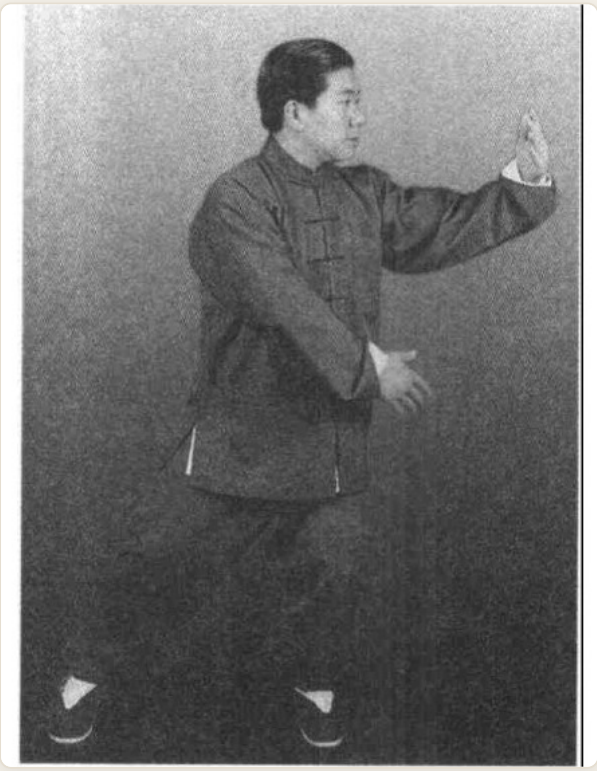
standing facing front, both palms at the sides of the chest, the arms forming arcs.

图 329



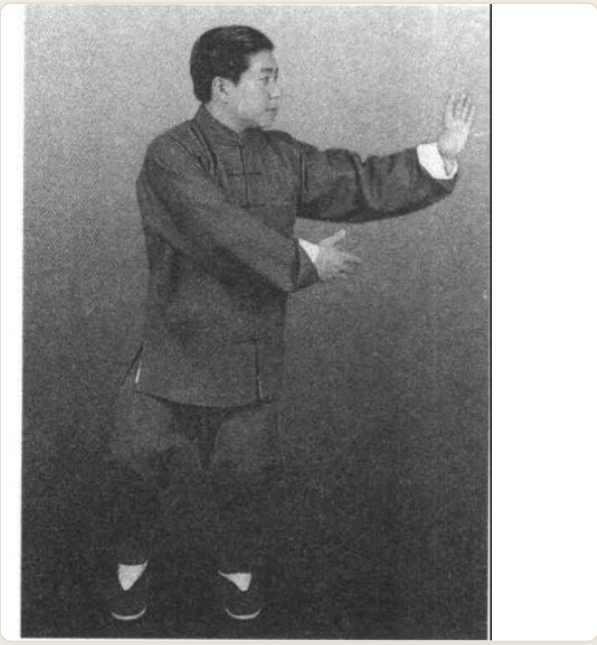
the left bow stance, the left palm arcing upward to the left, the right palm below at the abdomen.

图 330



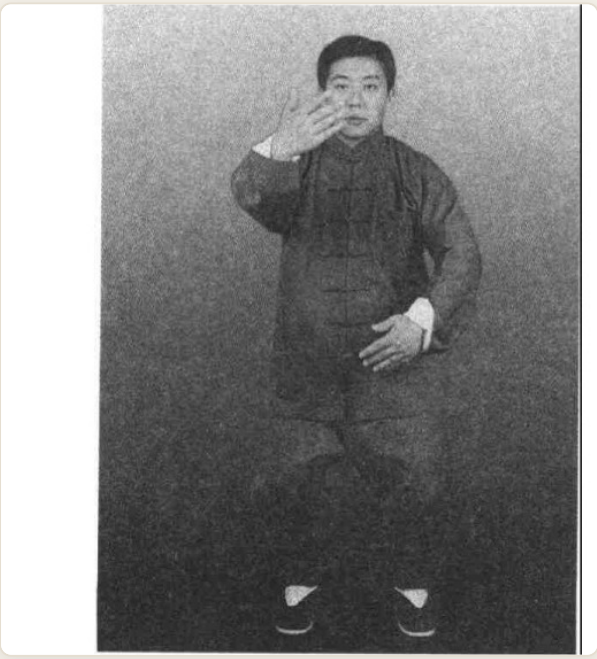
the body turned left, the left palm at the upper left, the right palm crossing at the abdomen.

图 331



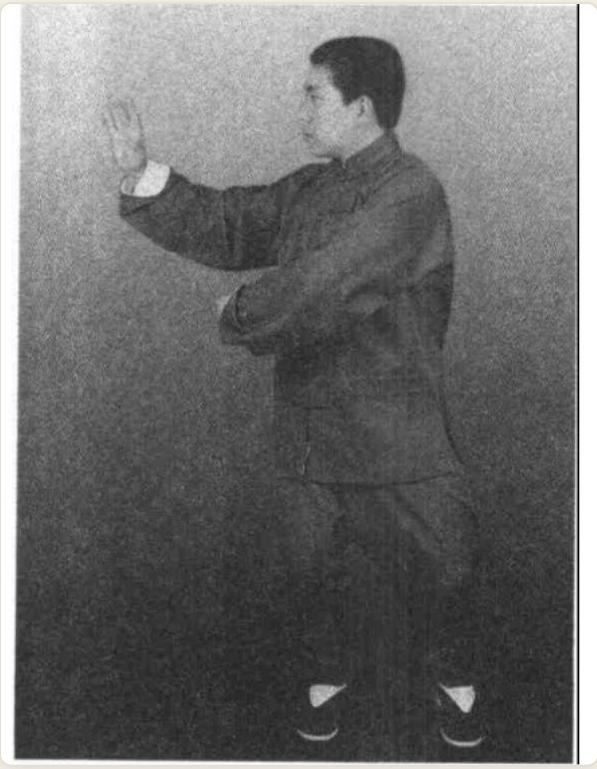
the weight shifted onto the left leg, the right palm arcing up to the right, the left palm below.

图 332



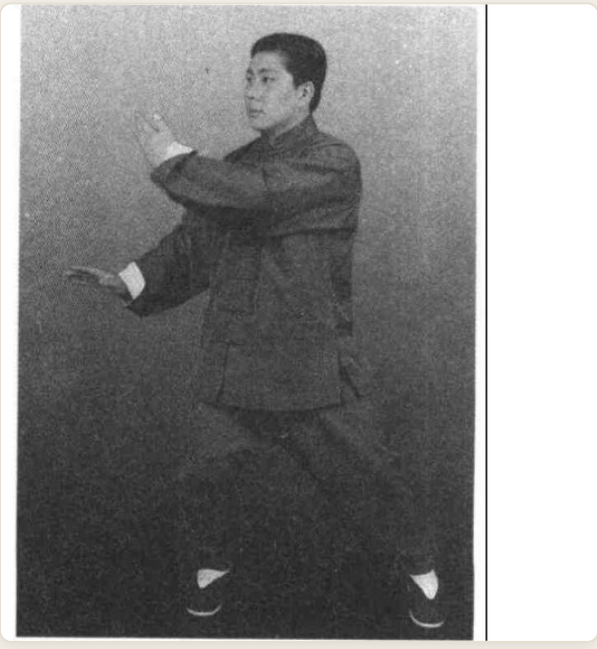
the right palm at the upper right, guarding before the face, the left palm at the abdomen.

图 333



the body turned right, the right palm arcing to the right, the left palm crossing up.

图 334



the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward, the right palm below.

This page is taken up entirely by the posture photographs of the Cloud Hands sequence, arranged in three rows of three; there is no running text. The plates continue the movement from the previous page.

图 335

the left bow stance, the right palm guarding before the face, the left palm at the abdomen.

图 336

the body turned right, the right palm arcing to the right, the left palm below.

图 337

the weight on the right leg, the right palm extending to the right, the left palm crossing at the abdomen.

图 338

the right palm guarding before the face, the left palm at the abdomen.

图 339

the body turned left, the left palm arcing up to the left, the right palm below.

图 340

the left bow stance, the left palm extended to the left front, the right palm at the right side.

图 341

the weight shifted onto the left leg, the right palm guarding before the face.

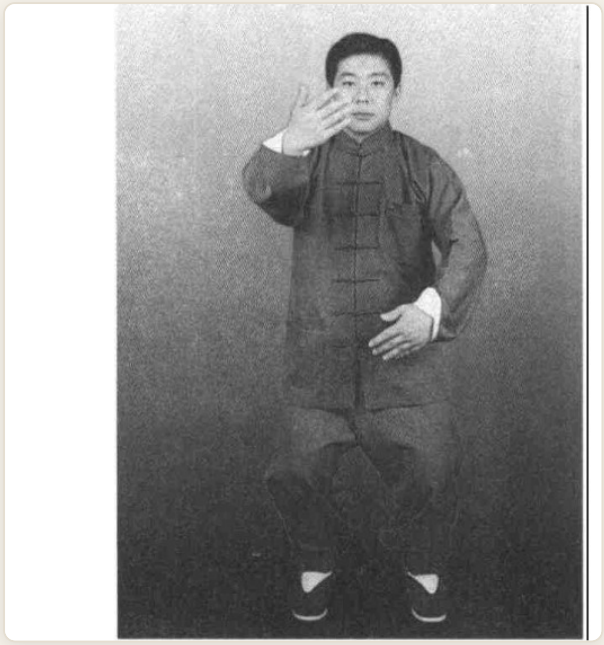
图 342

the body turned left, the left palm arcing upward, the right palm crossing at the abdomen.

图 343

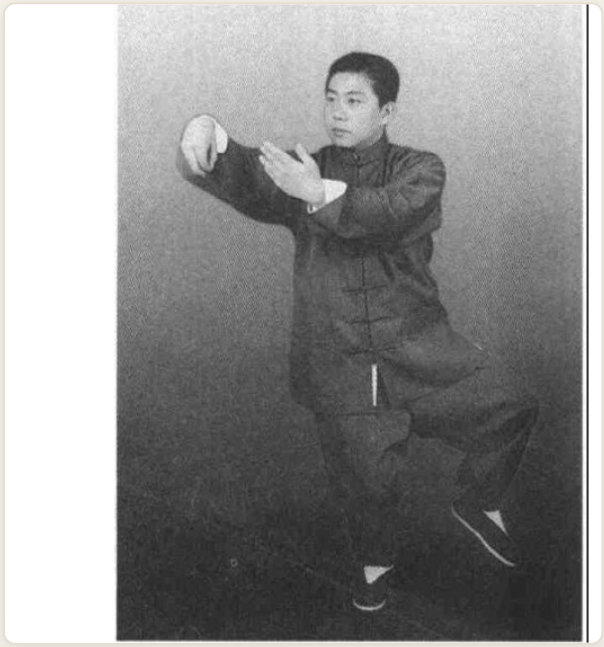
the left bow stance, the left palm extending to the left front, the right palm below.

图 344



the right palm guarding before the face, the left palm at the abdomen, both feet parallel.

图 345



the right hand forming the hook, the left palm at the front of the chest, the left foot lifted.

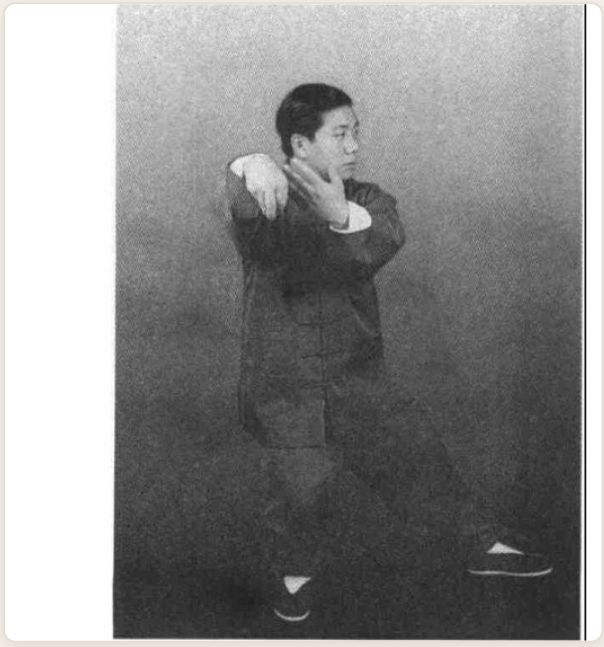
Posture Fifty-Six — Single Whip

Posture Fifty-Six — Single Whip

All points are the same as Posture Twenty-Nine, Single Whip, see the remaining figures on this page (the same as the twenty-first to the twenty-third figures).

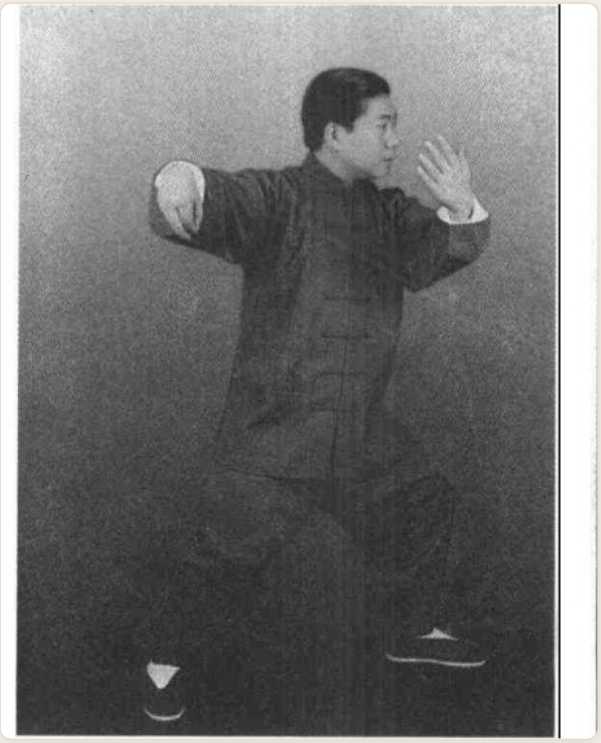
At the middle of this page, to the right of the plates, is an outdoor push-hands photograph in which the upper hand is lifted; it carries no number and no caption.

图 346



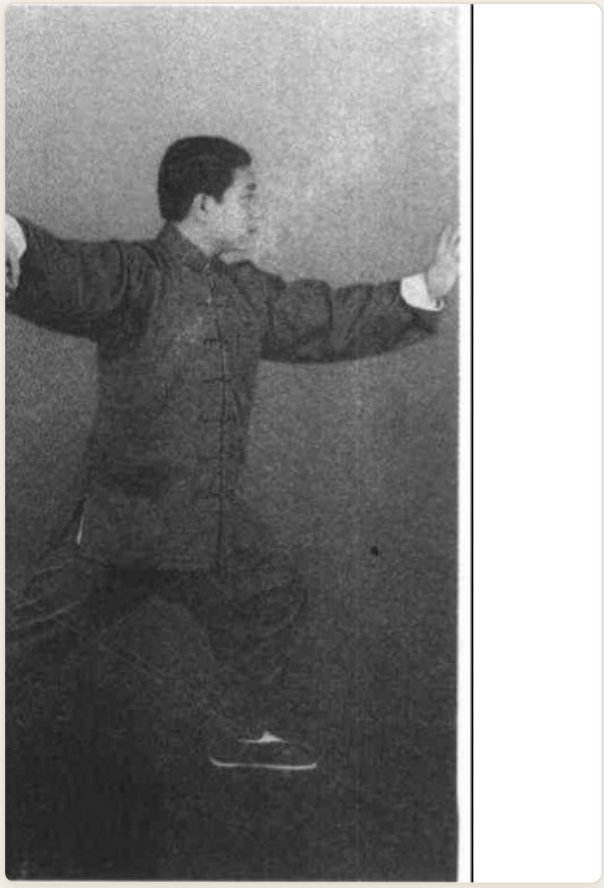
the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward, the right hook at the right side.

图 347



the body turned slightly left, the left palm at the front of the chest, the right forearm extending outward.

图 348



the left bow stance settled, the left palm pushed forward, the right hook drawn back.

BOOK PAGE 198

Posture Fifty-Seven — The Lower Posture

Posture Fifty-Seven — The Lower Posture

I. Method of Use

1. Following the previous posture. Should the opponent use his right hand to push my left hand outward or grip it with force, I immediately sit apart with the right leg turned slightly to the right and sit back down; at the same time the left hand is drawn back to the front of the chest in a lively circling movement, to await the opportunity to attack again.

2. Following the previous posture. Should the opponent strike with his left hand, I hastily grip his wrist with my left hand and pluck it down to the left, the right leg and the waist and hips sitting down at the same time, to borrow his strength and to store my own strength.

II. Course of the Movement

1. The waist turns slightly right, the right toes opened out and sat solid, the centre of gravity gradually shifting onto the right leg; the right leg slowly bends, the centre of gravity shifting back, the left leg slowly extending (keeping a bend in the knee). At the same time, the left hand is drawn back inward and curled, the fingers pointing forward (see the first figure on this page).

2. The right leg continues to squat down forming the left resting stance; at the same time, the left palm follows the centre of gravity back and down, bending the elbow and arcing down past the side of the chest, the left hand threading forward from the inner side of the left leg, the right leg at the same time rising slightly. The gaze attends to the left hand (see the second figure on this page).

III. Key Points

1. When the left palm arcs inward and down, it must follow the shifting back of the body's centre of gravity, loosening the waist and hips and sinking the shoulders and dropping the elbows; only thus can it be threaded joint by joint, carrying the left palm to draw in and move down.

2. The left palm's movement from drawing in and down to threading forward must be lively, the fingers pointing forward (east), the centre of the palm facing south, the wrist sat.

3. Guard against the body leaning forward, the head lowered, or the buttocks protruding; the upper body should be kept upright — but note that one must not stick out the chest.

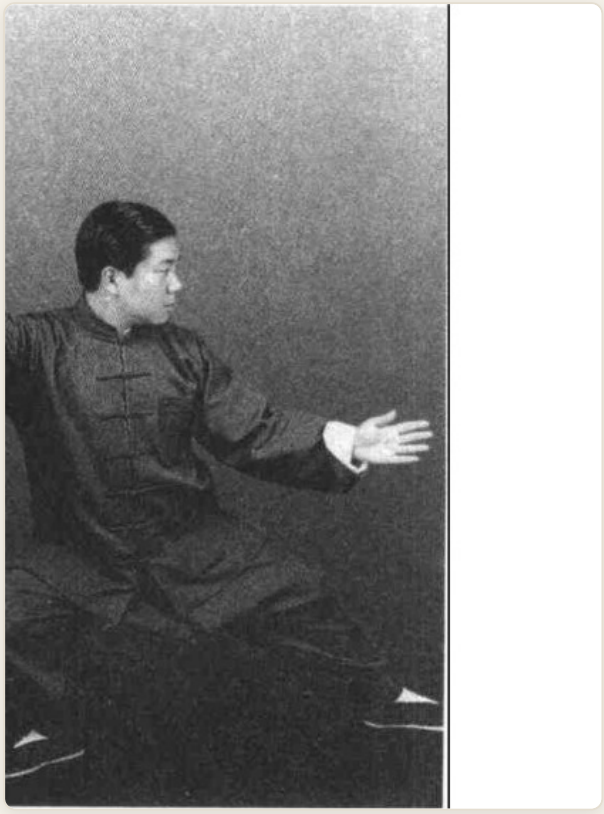
4. The gaze follows the left palm; but when the left palm threads from below forward, one may not lower the head — the eyes must look level.

IV. Requirements

1. The squatting down of the right leg must be slow.

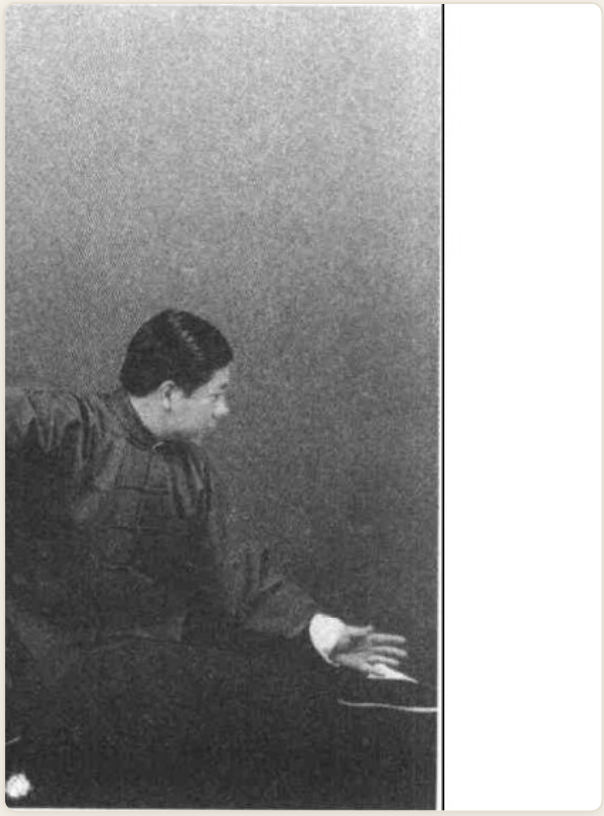
2. The upper body must be straight and not bent. The Boxing Treatise says: "The hundred meetings, the central pole, one breath threaded through." Any place where the body leans forward, leans back, or is crooked does not meet the requirement.

图 349



the right leg squatting, the waist turned right, the left palm at the left side, the right palm raised at the right.

图 350



the left resting stance formed, the left palm threading forward from the inner side of the left leg, the right palm at the right.

3. When squatting down, the left arm's drawing back must be greater than 90° and not too bent; and the drawing back of the hand must be carried by the waist.

BOOK PAGE 199

V. Likely Errors, Their Causes, and Their Correction

V. Likely Errors, Their Causes, and Their Correction

1. *Error: the two feet stand in one line and the person is unsteady.* The main cause lies in the previous posture, Single Whip: the left foot was not shifted back far enough to the left and the lateral distance is too small. *Correction:* attend to the correct position of the two feet in the preceding Single Whip.

2. *Error: the left arm is too straight or too bent.* The main cause is a failure to sink the elbow, or making the palm's circle too large. *Correction:* the arm must be relaxed, lively, round and alive, and must be firm yet soft and springy; the rising, falling, extending and contracting must all follow arcs. The arm must avoid both stiffness, forming a straight arm, and looseness and

slackness, with great rises and falls; generally the bend of the arm should be no more than about 100°.

3. *Error: the upper body leans forward.* The main cause is an inadequate understanding of the method of use. Because, whether in the plucking down or in drawing my left hand back to the front of the chest with a lively circle, what is used is the sitting down of the right leg and the waist and hips, borrowing his strength; and if the upper body leans forward, not only can one use only the strength of the arm, which is unfavourable for the plucking down and the freeing of the grip, but it also affects the gaze, which cannot observe the opponent well. *Correction:* the waist and hips must be relaxed, sunk and straight; only when the central pole is not bent can it support the eight directions.

4. *Error: the resting stance is incorrect* — some have the hip lower than the knee and it looks as though the posture is very low, but in fact the muscles of the front of the upper leg are in a relaxed state, and with the calf lifting the thigh it is an effort-saving movement, forming an over-softness and lifelessness. The main cause is an inadequate understanding of the requirements of the resting stance. *Correction:* the resting stance requires the supporting leg (the right leg) to have the hip higher than or level with the knee, the front of the foot lightly on the ground, the body straight, and the weight mostly on the right leg.

5. *Error: when squatting down the buttocks protrude.* The main cause is failing to "tuck in the buttocks" (also called retracting the buttocks); protruding buttocks easily cause the body to twist. *Correction:* the waist and hips must be relaxed, sunk, straight and vertical, and the buttocks must naturally be drawn in.

6. *Error: raising the shoulders, causing the right arm to be stiff and the left arm not round and lively.* The main cause is that the beginner often uses the muscles around the shoulder to make the arm's movement, and some think only of relaxation and not of...

...of "sinking". Hence some raise the shoulders and some are loose without sinking. *Correction:* the shoulders must be loosened before the shoulder muscles and ligaments can be stretched, and thus the arm's extending, contracting, wrapping and winding can follow the mind's wish.

7. *Error: after the centre of gravity has shifted back and the resting stance formed, the movement pausing.* The main cause is an insufficient grasp of continuity and liveliness. *Correction:* in the movement there must be no hollow and no protrusion, no defect, no sharp corners; one must understand that when the old strength is spent and the new strength has not yet been born, this is precisely the moment when one is most easily taken advantage of. For this reason Tai Chi requires continuity and liveliness, unbroken, revolving endlessly, with no pause.

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods

1. The emphasis of teaching is to be placed on the centre of gravity shifting onto the right leg, and sitting down with a straight body without sticking out the chest.

2. Use the method of comparison: A — performs the Single Whip posture. B — grips A's left hand with his right hand. A — ① first uses his left hand to break free downward (the mind not moving). ② then uses the shifting of the centre of gravity onto the right leg to sit the body straight down. The two compare and experience which method is more powerful, and which more easily plucks the opponent or frees the grip; naturally the shifting of the centre of gravity and sitting the body straight down is the more powerful.

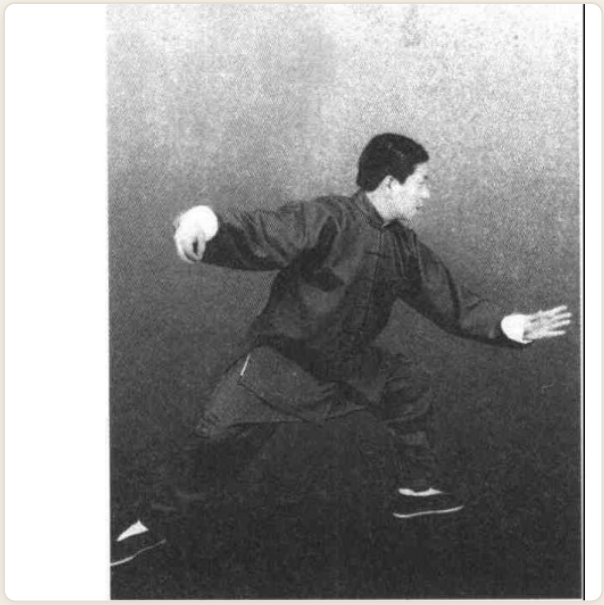
3. The teacher observes the practitioner's movement from different angles: for example, whether the upper body is turned towards the east when seen from the front, whether the line of the hand's movement and whether the upper body is upright are correct when seen from the side; and corrects them one by one.

4. If the practitioner is weak or elderly, he may squat down less and make the frame higher.

VII. Technical Analysis

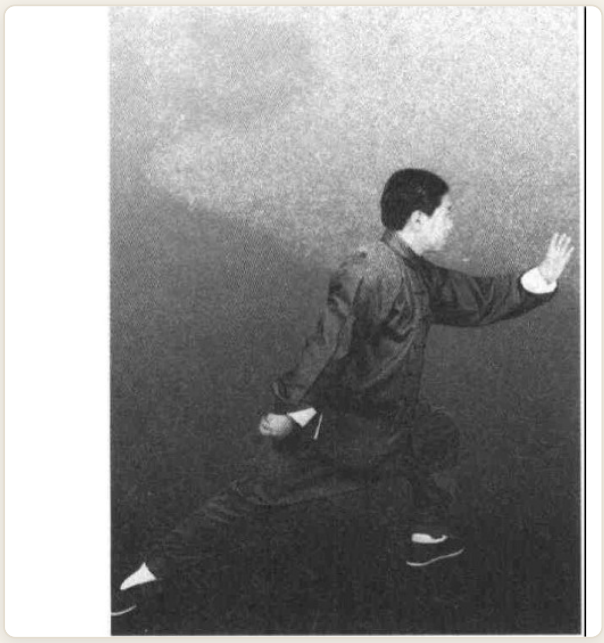
The Lower Posture is the movement of changing from the left bow stance into the resting stance; it requires the centre of gravity to shift back and the right leg to sit down with the body straight. Its key lies in the sitting down, and whether the sitting down is good or not determines whether the whole movement is correct. If when sitting down the heel of the hip is lower than the knee, then a "shallow pit" is formed, making the foundation of the leg hollow and unsteady, and the empty-full conversion of the two legs becomes instead un-lively (making the rising movement un-lively); if the heel of the hip is higher than the knee, then the amount of exercise is very small, and the effect of training the body is not well obtained. When practising the Lower Posture, first shift the centre of gravity slowly back; at the same time turn the right toes out about 45°; at this moment the left and right toes form an outward-turned shape of the character eight. In the process of the centre of gravity shifting back...

图 351



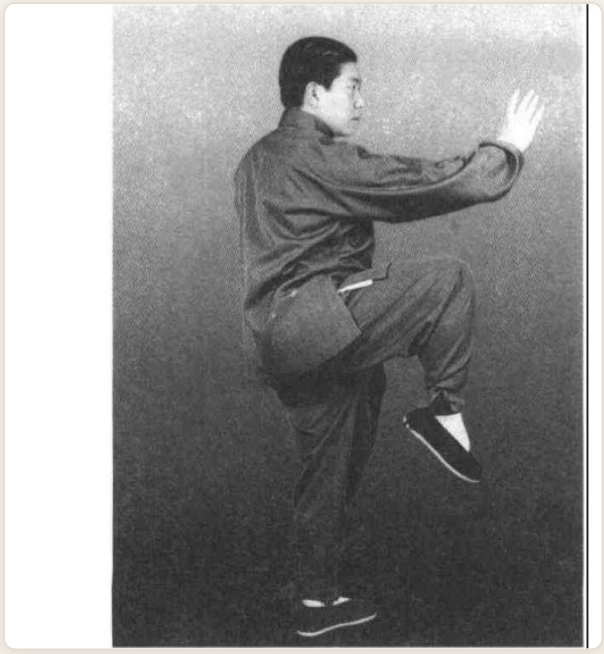
the left resting stance, the left palm threaded forward at the left, the right palm raised at the right rear.

图 352



the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward, the right hand plucking down.

图 353



the solitary left stance, the left palm raised before the face, the right hand at the side of the right knee.

...in the process of the centre of gravity shifting back, one must "lift the top of the head", the centre of gravity gradually shifting onto the right leg, slowly bending the knee and loosening the hips; this is what is meant by the waist being relaxed, sunk, straight and vertical, and not a collapse forming the "lower posture".

BOOK PAGE 201

Posture Fifty-Eight — The Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg

Posture Fifty-Eight — The Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg

I. Method of Use

(A) The Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg, Left Style Following the previous posture. Should the opponent lift upward with returning force, I take advantage of the situation to raise the body and lean forward, the right leg at the same time lifting and rising, striking the opponent's abdomen with the tip of the foot. The right hand follows and advances, bending the elbow, the tip of the index finger pointing upward, to close off the opponent's left hand; at this moment the left foot changes to empty and stands firm. The right hand may then follow and at

any time control the opponent's left hand, and may also control the opponent's right hand — one need not be rigid about it.

Another method of use: after the right foot has been lifted and then immediately set down, the left foot steps forward, the two hands dividing the opponent's two hands, that is, using the two palms to press forward.

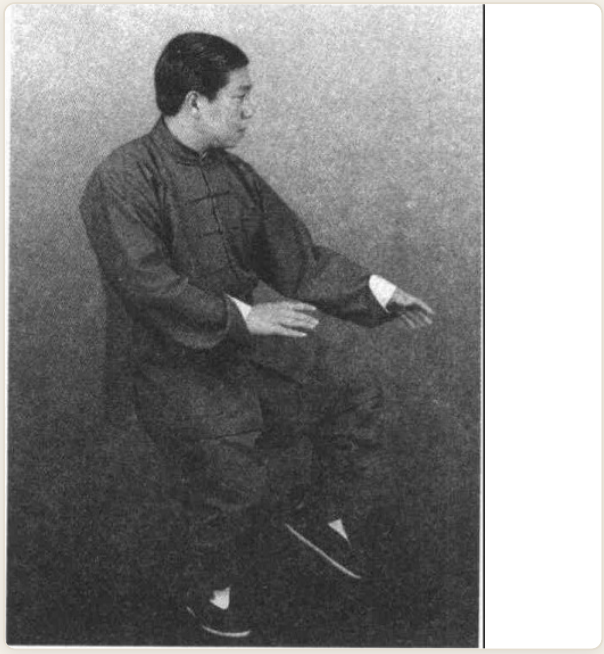
(B) The Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg, Right Style From the left style. Should the opponent strike with his right fist, my right hand sinks down, and I quickly raise the left hand to support the opponent's elbow, lifting the left knee; the rest is the same as the right style.

II. Course of the Movement

(A) The Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg, Left Style 1. The body gradually turns left, the left toes opened out, the centre of gravity gradually shifting onto the left leg; the left leg bending the knee and bowing forward, the right leg extended, the upper body gradually rising; at the same time, as the centre of gravity shifts forward, the left palm threads forward and upward, the right hand slightly sinking (still a hanging hand). The gaze attends to the left palm (see the first and second figures on this page).

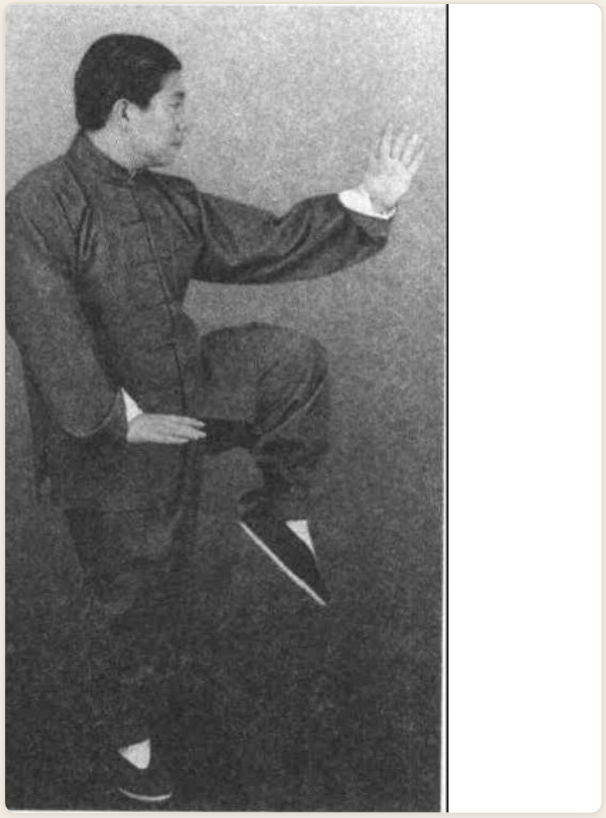
2. The body continues to turn left, the centre of gravity continuing to shift forward onto the left leg; the right leg lifted forward from the rear, the sole of the foot lifted, the left leg gradually standing up. At the same time, the left palm arcs down to the side of the left knee (the centre of the palm facing down); the right hanging hand becomes a palm and follows down from the rear; as the right leg lifts forward and raises the knee, the right hand passes the right side of the leg and, above the front of the right leg, wards upward with the right forearm in an arc, bending the elbow and placing it above the front of the right knee, the fingertip pointing upward, level with the eyebrows, the centre of the palm facing left, forming the left solitary stance. The gaze first attends to the left palm as it shifts before, and when the left palm reaches the left knee, then looks toward the right palm as it wards up...

图 354



the right solitary stance forming, the right palm at the side of the right knee, the left knee lifted.

图 355



the right solitary stance settled, the left palm raised before the face, the right palm below at the side of the right knee.

...and slightly arriving before the right palm; then, looking level forward past the right palm (see the first figure on this page).

(B) The Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg, Right Style 1. The body gradually turns right, the left leg gradually bending the knee and squatting down, "sending" the right foot down to fall behind and to the right of the left foot, the toes touching the ground first; as the centre of gravity gradually shifts onto the right leg and the whole sole settles flat, the right knee bends and the left leg becomes empty and lifted. At the same time, the right palm follows the right leg and arcs down to fall above the front of the knee, the centre of the palm facing obliquely down; the left palm first follows the bending of the left knee and the squatting down and sinks, then rises and lifts forward and upward following the lifting of the left knee. The gaze attends to the right palm as it falls, and then turns to the left palm as it lifts (see the second figure on this page).

2. The body continues to turn right, the right leg continuing to gradually stand up, the left knee continuing to lift. At the same time, the right palm arcs down and falls to the side of the hip, the centre of the palm facing down, the left palm from below going forward and upward; as the left leg lifts the knee forward, the left hand passes the side of the left leg and, above the front of the left leg, wards upward in an arc, bending the elbow and placing it before the face, the elbow placed above the front of the left knee, the fingertip pointing upward, level with the eyebrows,

the centre of the palm facing right. The gaze first attends to the right palm as it falls, and then immediately turns to the left palm as it wards up, arriving slightly before the left palm does, and looks level forward past the left palm (see the second figure on this page).

III. Key Points

1. In taking up the solitary stance from the Lower Posture after the left leg rests on the ground, first the left toes are opened out, then the centre of gravity slowly shifts forward: the left knee bows forward forming the left bow stance; then the right leg rises slightly, pushing the knee forward, and only then does one stand up — and this must not be done with the two legs straight.

2. In standing up, the left leg must first bend the knee and sit solid (taking the left solitary stance as the example), so that the lower frame is steady; then the right leg, led by the right knee, gradually lifts forward and upward, and at the same time the left leg gradually stands up. Guard against using the leaning forward of the upper body to make standing up easier; the upper body is still required to remain upright.

3. In the left solitary stance, when the right leg lifts the knee forward from the rear, the right hand must be placed to the side of the upper part of the right thigh and ward up together.

4. In going from the left solitary stance to the right solitary stance, attend to the fact that when the right foot falls, the left foot must at the same time squat down and "send" it down; it must not be that only the right leg falls while the left leg is still standing straight. When the left leg lifts the knee, the right leg must also gradually stand up accordingly. 5. When standing on one leg, you must "sink the shoulders and let the elbows hang", "sit the wrists", and "empty the collar and lift the crown"; the elbow must join with the knee, and the direction faced must be consistent. The leg that supports the body's weight should not be stiffened by force.

6. Every use of the word "lift" (tuo) in the explanations of the left and right standing-on-one-leg postures derives from the martial application of the movement. In practice, however, do not turn the palm upward merely because of the word "lift" — the fingers should point upward.

IV. Requirements 1. Rising from the crouching stance must be round, alive and nimble; there must be no pause or interruption, and the body must not sway.

2. In the settled standing-on-one-leg posture the centre of gravity must be stable; there must be no wavering.

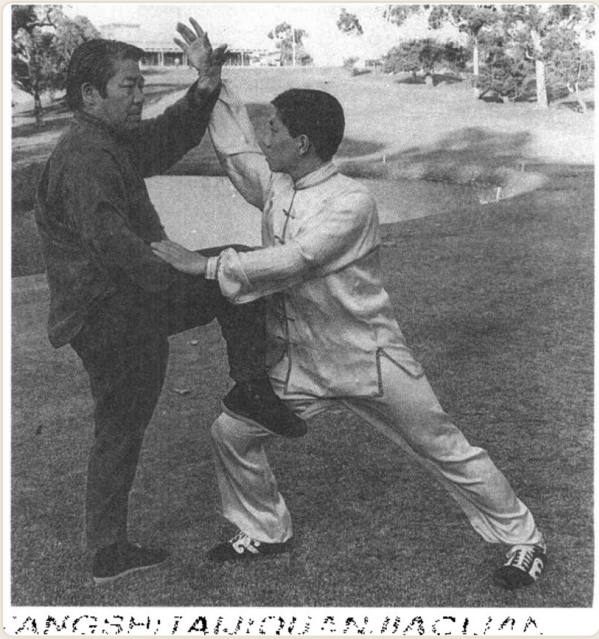
3. The shoulders must join with the hips, and the elbows with the knees.

4. When rising, the rear foot must not be dragged forward along the ground, nor may it stamp hard against the ground.

5. The withdrawing of the foot must not change abruptly; it must accord with the body's movement and be drawn back slowly.

6. When the left and right standing-on-one-leg postures join, the one hand rising and the other descending must neither of them pause.

图 356



The settled left standing-on-one-leg posture: the right palm lifts above and in front of the right brow, the left palm presses down beside the left hip, the left knee is lifted high, and the right leg supports the body alone.

V. Common errors, their causes, and how to correct them 1. Error: you cannot crouch down, or having crouched you cannot rise. The main cause is weakness in the legs, so you must train diligently. Another cause is that the centre of gravity has not shifted forward sufficiently, which makes rising difficult. Correction: send the hips forward, shift the centre of gravity forward, settle the left leg firmly, then draw the right leg forward slowly — rising will then come easily.

2. Error: you stand unsteadily and the body sways. The main cause is likewise weakness in the muscles of the legs, waist and hips, so again you must train diligently. Another cause is that upper and lower do not coordinate, and the centre of gravity is not controlled. Correction: besides persisting in training, the upper and lower must follow one another.

3. Error: the elbow and the knee come apart — the knee lifts forward and up, but the lifting hand bends the elbow too much, bringing the elbow close to the chest. The main cause is insufficient understanding of the application: when the hand comes too close to the chest it loses its function of closing off the opponent's left hand or of propping up the opponent's elbow. Correction: move the elbow above the knee.

4. Error: the supporting leg stands straight and rigid. The main cause is insufficient understanding of the application. Correction: the two feet must be divided into empty and full —

"the empty is not entirely without strength, the full is not entirely braced dead". If the supporting leg is braced dead and you yourself sway unsteadily, how can you kick forward with the raised toes, and how can you both attack and withdraw in defence? Therefore the supporting leg must be slightly bent.

VI. Teaching and practice methods 1. The emphasis should be placed on rising from the crouching stance. Practise repeatedly: train the rising from the crouching stance more to build leg strength, and pay attention to shifting the centre of gravity forward in order to improve technique. Therefore, in repeated practice the emphasis should be on improving the rising from the crouching stance.

2. In teaching, great importance must be attached to keeping the central axis unbent and the waist upright. On this basis, rise slowly from the crouching stance and hold to the requirement of "straightness".

3. In the joining of the left and right standing-on-one-leg postures, the "sending" must be practised well. As the supporting leg crouches, the teacher must remind the student not to let the descending leg touch the ground in haste.

VII. Technical analysis 1. There are two keys to the standing-on-one-leg posture: first, rising from the crouching stance; second, being able to stabilise the centre of gravity while the body is supported on one leg. This is "standing like a balance, moving like a wheel".

...like a wheel".

2. The application of the standing-on-one-leg posture is to lift the knee and kick at the opponent's abdomen with the toes, while the lifting hand closes off the opponent's hand. In practising the form the foot is not actually kicked out, but the intention should nonetheless be present. The uses of the knee and the foot are endlessly varied: sometimes in combat the foot is not used and the knee is used instead. The boxing treatises say, "when the foot comes, lift the knee" and "when close, add the knee" — this is the use of the knee. Therefore the lifted knee of the standing-on-one-leg posture has many and varied applications.

BOOK PAGE 205

Posture Fifty-Nine — Step Back and Repulse the Monkey, Left and Right

Posture Fifty-Nine — Step Back and Repulse the Monkey, Left and Right

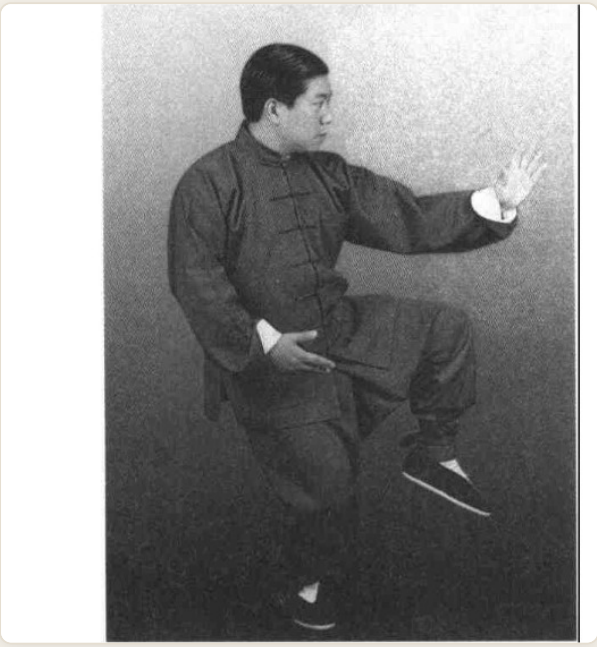
I. Application Same as Posture Seventeen, Step Back and Repulse the Monkey, Left and Right.

II. Sequence of movement (a) Repulsing the Monkey to the Left The right leg gradually bends at the knee and crouches down, and the waist gradually turns to the right. At the same time, the left

leg slowly descends. The right hand rotates outward, arcs backward and moves up obliquely to about shoulder level; the left palm extends and moves forward, sinking slightly downward. The eyes follow the right palm as it moves back, up and to the right. See the first figure on this page, the second figure on this page, the third to the eighth figures on this page (the same as the eighty-ninth to the ninety-fourth figures), and the ninth to the twelfth figures on this page (the same as the eighty-eighth to the ninety-first figures).

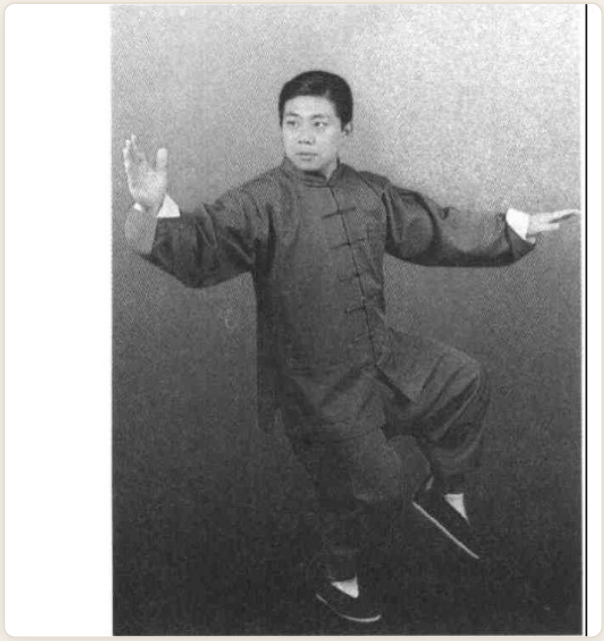
All the remaining sections are the same as Posture Seventeen, Step Back and Repulse the Monkey, Left and Right.

图 356



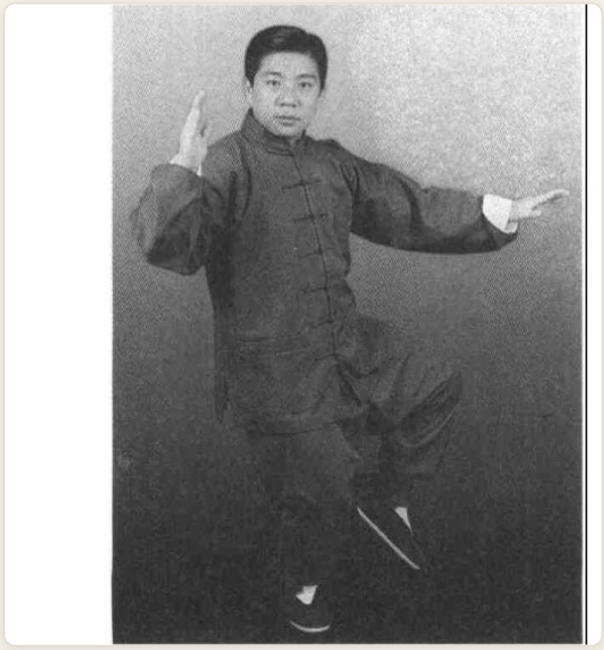
The settled left standing-on-one-leg posture: the right palm lifts above and in front of the right brow, the left palm presses down beside the left hip, the left knee is lifted high, and the right leg supports the body alone.

图 357



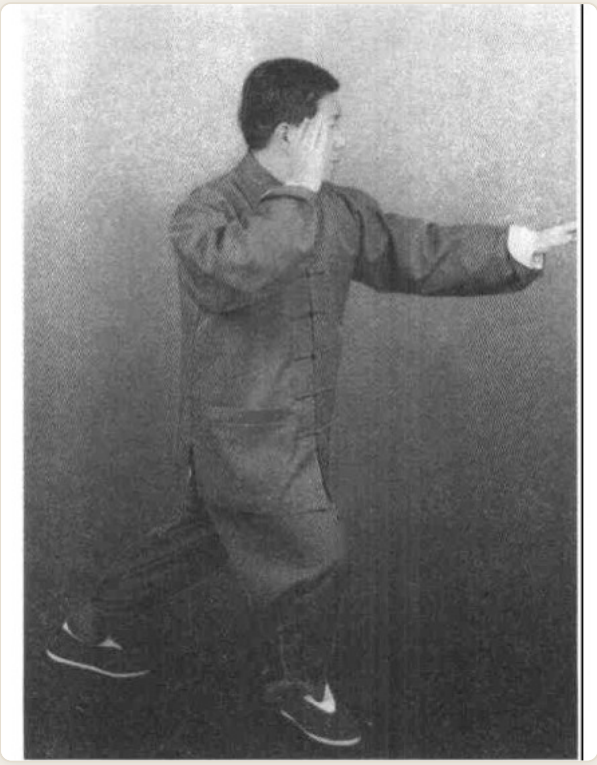
From the left standing-on-one-leg to the right: the right leg gradually bends and crouches, the left leg slowly descends, and the right hand rotates outward and arcs back and upward.

图 358



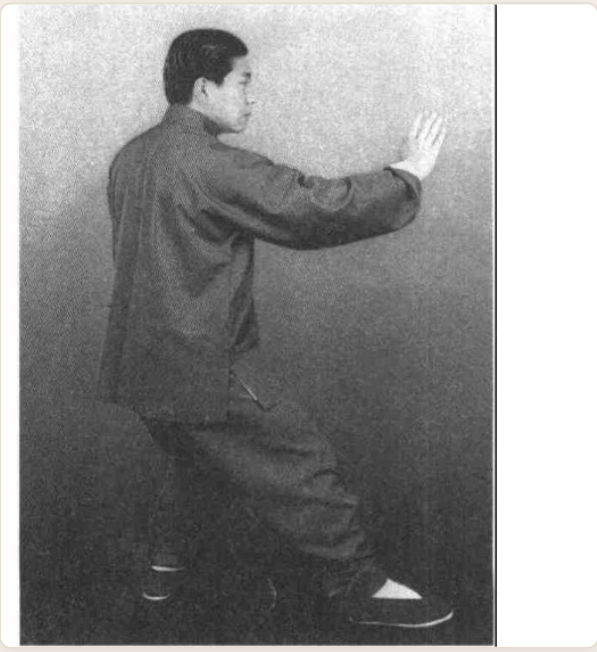
The opening of Repulse the Monkey: the right hand rotates outward and is raised behind to about shoulder level, the left palm extends forward and sinks slightly, and the waist turns right.

图 359



The left foot is lifted and steps back and down, while the right palm rotates inward and presses forward.

图 360



The settled retreating posture: the right palm presses forward, the left palm is drawn in beside the left hip, and the stance is the sitting stance.

This page is a full-page sheet of movement plates with no running text. Figures 361 to 367 are the continuous movement sequence of Posture Fifty-Nine, Step Back and Repulse the Monkey, Left and Right, continuing on from the previous page's figures 358 to 360.

图 361

The opening of Repulse the Monkey to the right: the right hand rotates outward and is raised behind to about shoulder level, the left palm extends forward, the waist turns left, and the eyes look toward the right palm.

图 362

The left palm presses forward and the right hand is drawn in beside the right hip, while the right foot is lifted and steps back and down.

图 363

The settled retreating posture: the left hand presses forward, the right hand is drawn in beside the right waist, and the weight sits on the rear leg.

图 364

Repulse the Monkey to the left repeated: the right leg bends and crouches once more, the left leg descends, and the right hand rotates outward and arcs back and upward.

图 365

The left foot steps back and down, while the right palm rotates inward and presses forward and the left palm is drawn in beside the left hip.

图 366

The settled retreating posture in profile: the right palm presses forward, the left palm is drawn back, and the body is centred and upright.

图 367

The settled posture seen from the front: the right palm presses forward at shoulder level, the left palm is drawn in beside the left waist, and the eyes look in the direction of the right palm.

(At the lower left of figure 361 there is one unnumbered push-hands photograph: the two are joined at the hands, one pressing forward with the right palm while the other receives with the left hand and withdraws a step.)

BOOK PAGE 207

Posture Sixty — Diagonal Flying

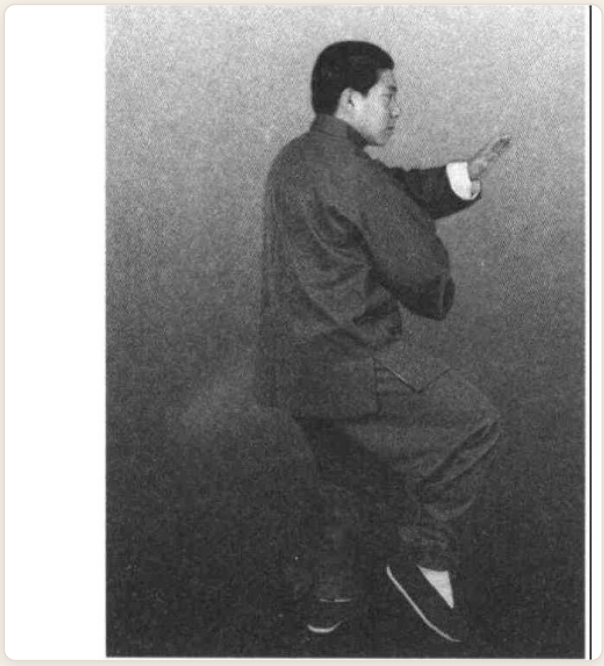
Posture Sixty — Diagonal Flying

All sections are the same as Posture Eighteen, Raise the Hands. See the first three figures on this page (the same as the ninety-ninth to the hundred-and-first figures).

Posture Sixty-One — Raise the Hands

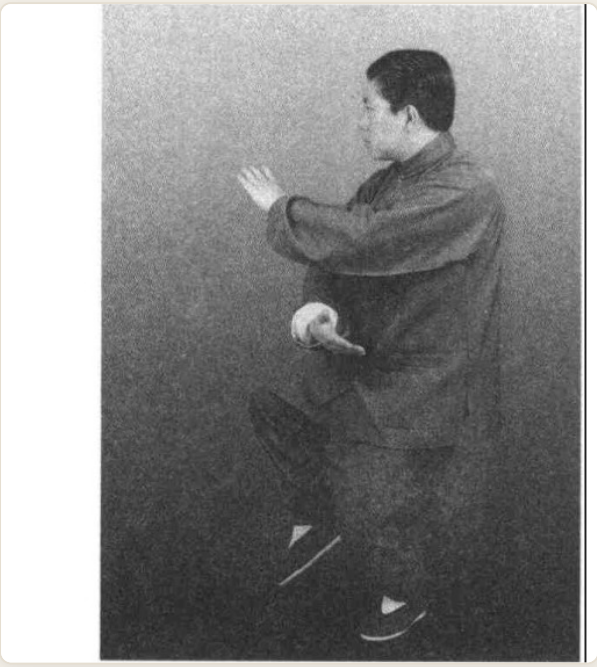
All sections are the same as Posture Nineteen, Raise the Hands. See the fourth to the sixth figures on this page (the same as the twenty-fourth to the twenty-sixth figures).

图 368A



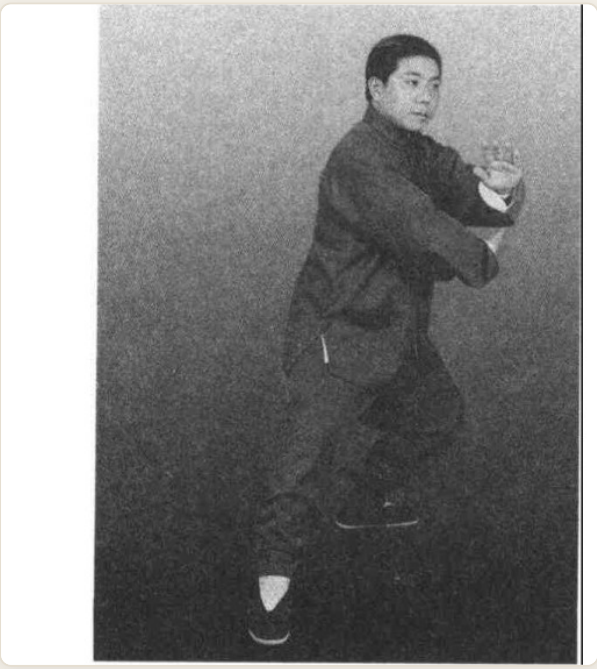
The opening of Diagonal Flying: the weight sits back on the left leg, the right hand rotates outward and is raised in front of the right brow, and the left hand presses down beside the left hip.

图 368B



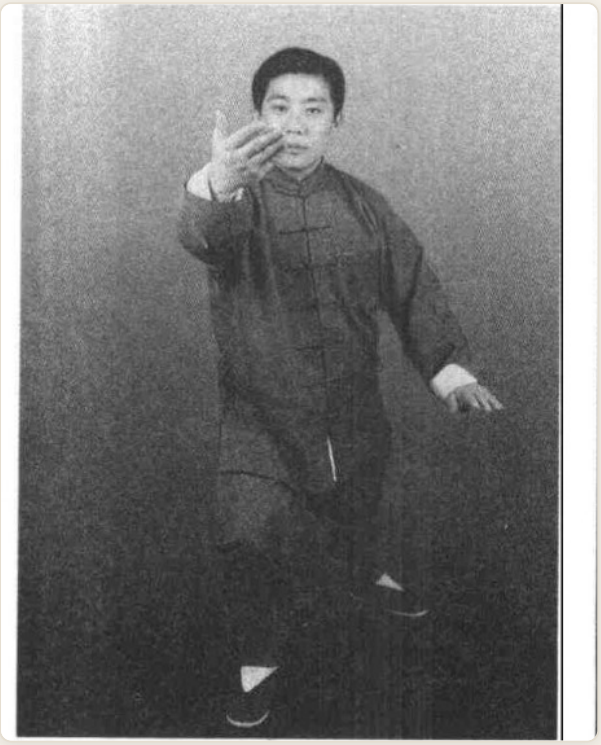
Diagonal Flying in transition: the right leg steps forward, the right hand rotates inward and plucks downward to the right waist, and the left hand accordingly rotates outward and shifts upward.

图 369



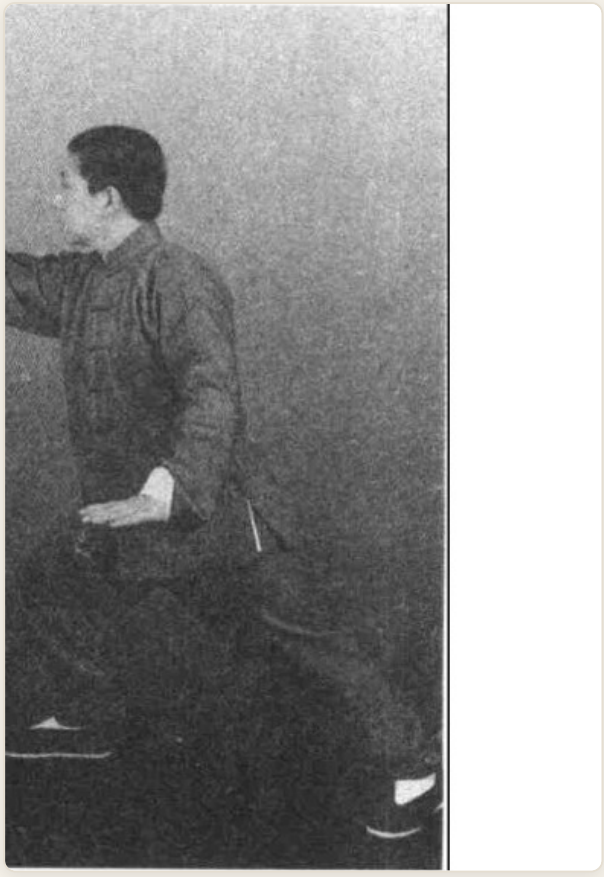
The settled Diagonal Flying posture: the right leg is bent forward in the bow stance, the right palm spreads out diagonally upward to the right, and the left palm presses beside the left hip.

图 370A



The opening of Raise the Hands: both palms rise together in front of the chest, and the right foot steps forward half a step.

图 370B



The settled Raise the Hands posture: the right hand lifts above and in front of the right brow, the left hand presses beside the left hip, and the right foot is forward in the empty stance.

(Above figure 368B there is one unnumbered push-hands photograph: the two are joined at the hands, one lifting the other's right arm with both palms.)

The upper part of this page continues the plate sequence of Posture Sixty-One, Raise the Hands (figures 371 to 373); the lower part begins the plates of Posture Sixty-Two, the White Crane Spreads Its Wings.

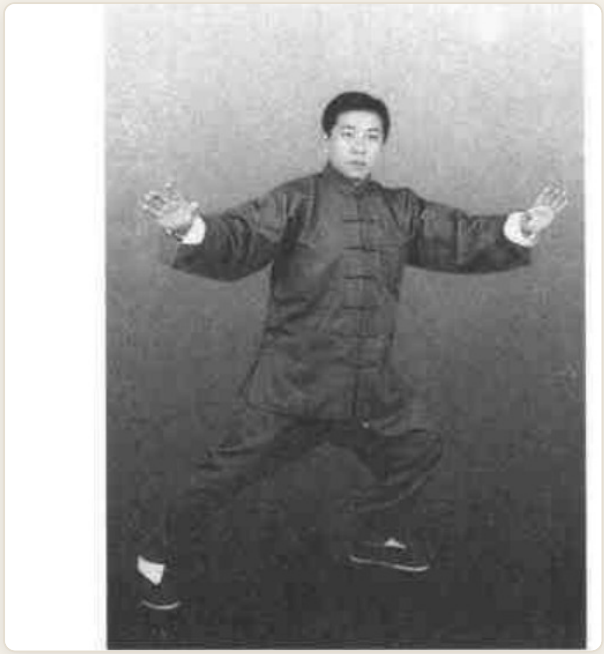
BOOK PAGE 208

Posture Sixty-Two — the White Crane Spreads Its Wings

Posture Sixty-Two — the White Crane Spreads Its Wings

All sections are the same as Posture Six, the White Crane Spreads Its Wings. See the fourth to the seventh figures on this page (the same as the twenty-seventh to the thirtieth figures).

图 371



The settled Raise the Hands posture in profile: the right hand lifts in front of the right brow, the left hand presses down beside the left hip, and the right foot is forward in the empty stance.

图 372

Raise the Hands from another angle: the two arms separate one above the other, the right hand high and the left hand low, the body centred and upright.

图 373

The joined-hands settled posture of Raise the Hands: the right hand rotates inward and returns to guard in front of the chest, and the left hand presses beside the left waist.

图 374

The opening of the White Crane Spreads Its Wings: the right hand rotates inward and strokes down to the front of the right abdomen, the left hand rotates outward and lifts in front of the left chest, and the weight sits back.

图 375

The White Crane Spreads Its Wings in transition: the right hand lifts above and in front of the right brow, the left hand presses down, and the right foot is drawn in slightly.

图 376

The settled White Crane posture in profile: the right palm is raised above and in front of the right brow, the left palm presses beside the left hip, and the right foot is forward, touching the ground lightly in the empty stance.

图 377A

The settled White Crane posture from the front: the right palm lifts in front of the right brow, the left palm presses beside the left hip, and the eyes look straight ahead.

图 377B

The settled White Crane posture: the right palm is raised and the left palm presses down, the stance is the right empty stance, and the body is centred, calm and at ease.

BOOK PAGE 209

Posture Sixty-Three — Brush the Knee and Twist the Step, Left

Posture Sixty-Three — Brush the Knee and Twist the Step, Left

All sections are the same as Posture Seven, Brush the Knee and Twist the Step, Left. See the first to the fifth figures on this page (the same as the thirty-first to the thirty-fifth figures).

图 378

The opening of Brush the Knee and Twist the Step, Left: the weight sits back on the right leg, the right palm is drawn in beside the right ear, the left palm extends forward, and the eyes look straight ahead.

图 379

In transition: the right hand rotates outward and strokes down to the front of the abdomen, the left palm rotates outward and lifts, and the waist turns right.

图 380

The transition in which the left palm brushes the knee and the right palm pushes forward: the left hand brushes past above the left knee, and the right hand pushes forward from beside the ear.

图 381

Brushing the knee in the bow stance: the left leg is bent forward, the left hand brushes past the left knee and then presses beside the left hip, and the right palm pushes forward.

图 382A

The settled brush-the-knee posture in profile: the left bow stance, the left palm pressed beside the left hip, and the right palm pushing forward with sunken shoulders and hanging elbows, the eyes looking toward the right palm.

图 382B

The settled brush-the-knee posture from the front: the left bow stance unchanged, the right palm pushing forward at shoulder level, and the left palm drawn in beside the left hip.

(At the middle lower part of this page there is one further unnumbered close-up photograph of the hand: the right palm pushing forward, the fingers pointing upward and the tiger's mouth open. It carries no figure number.)

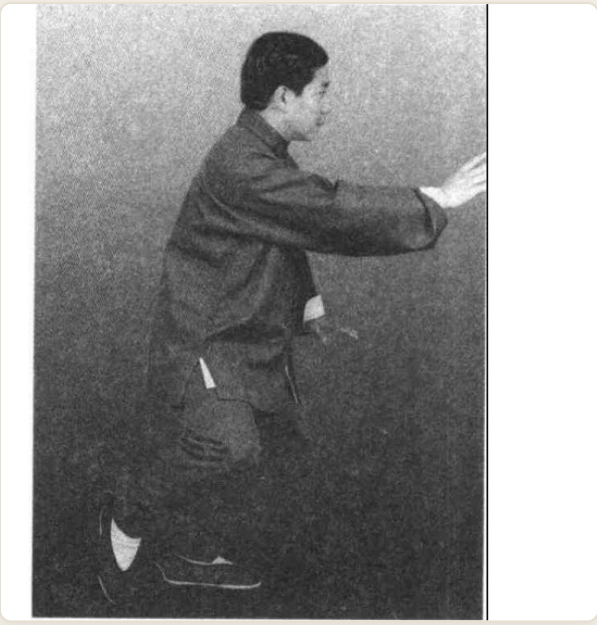
BOOK PAGE 210

Posture Sixty-Four — Needle at the Bottom of the Sea

Posture Sixty-Four — Needle at the Bottom of the Sea

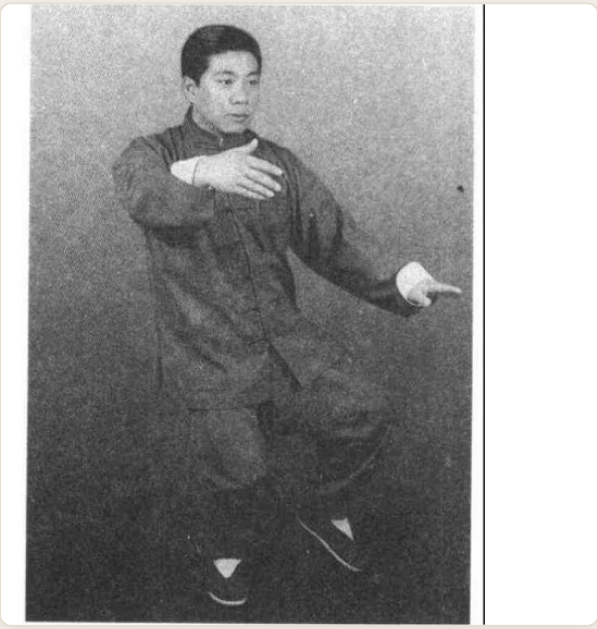
All sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Two, Needle at the Bottom of the Sea. See the first to the fourth figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-fourteenth to the hundred-and-seventeenth figures).

图 383



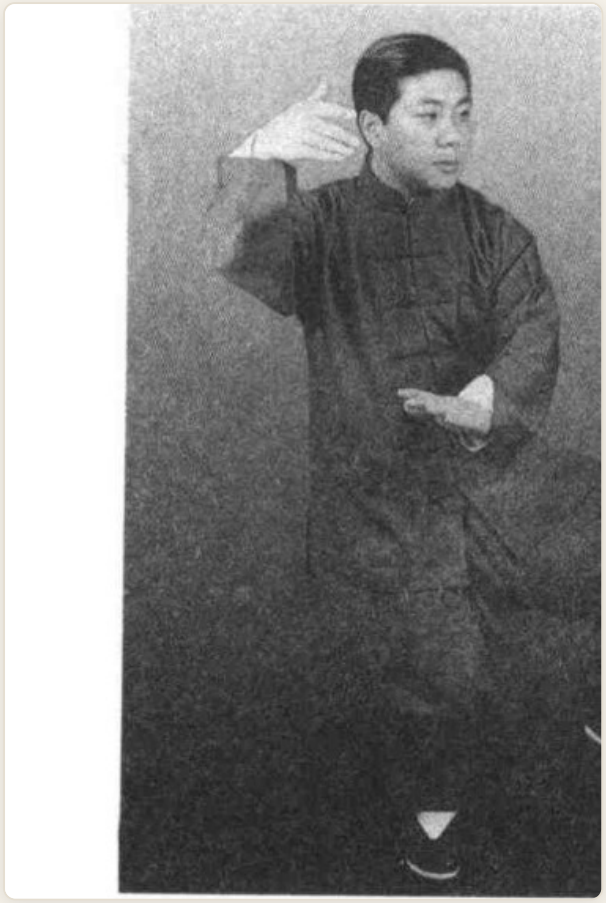
The opening of Needle at the Bottom of the Sea: the right palm rotates inward and extends forward, the left palm rotates outward and is drawn in beside the left hip, and the weight sits back.

图 384



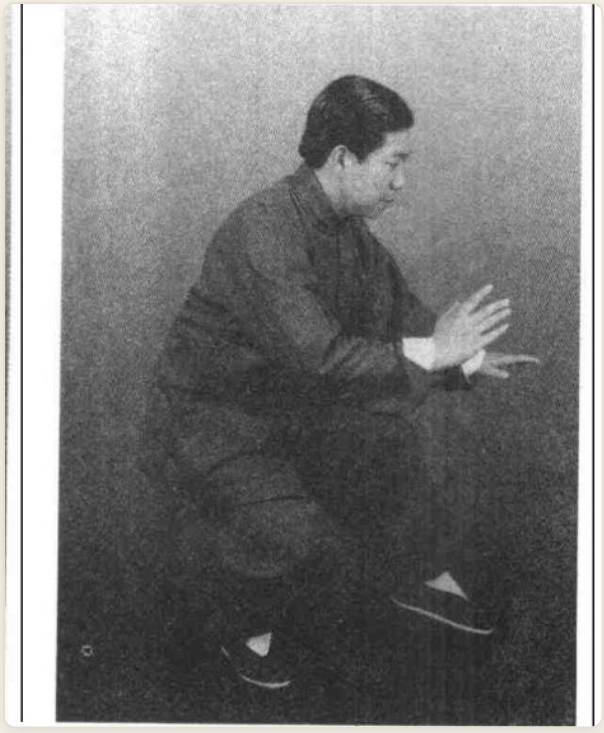
In transition: the right palm follows the waist as it turns right and presses down, the left palm lifts in front of the left chest, and the right foot is drawn back half a step.

图 385



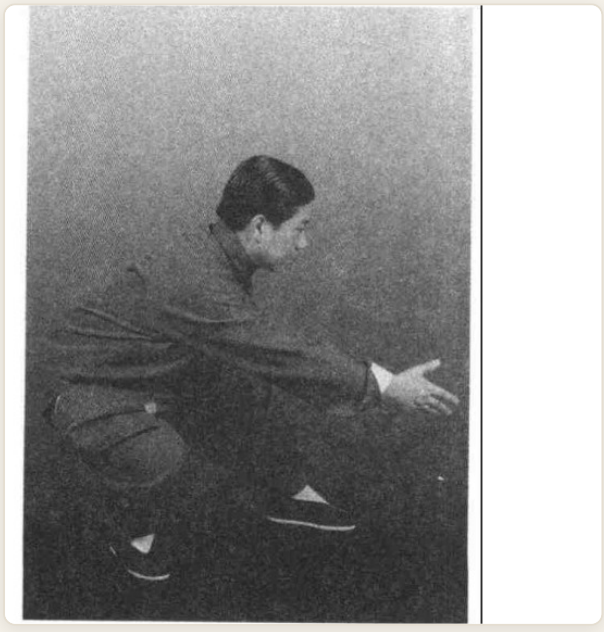
The transition before the right palm thrusts down: the right palm rotates outward and lifts, the left palm presses down above the left knee, and the body sits back.

图 386A



The settled Needle posture in profile: the right palm thrusts downward and diagonally below and in front of the right knee, the left palm presses above the left knee, and the right leg is settled firm.

图 386B



The settled Needle posture from the front: the right palm thrusts down, the left palm lifts, the body is centred and leaning very slightly forward, and the eyes look down and ahead.

(At the middle upper part of this page there is one further unnumbered close-up photograph of the hand: the right palm thrusting down, the fingers pointing downward and the tiger's mouth open. It carries no figure number.)

BOOK PAGE 211

Posture Sixty-Five — Spread the Back Like a Fan

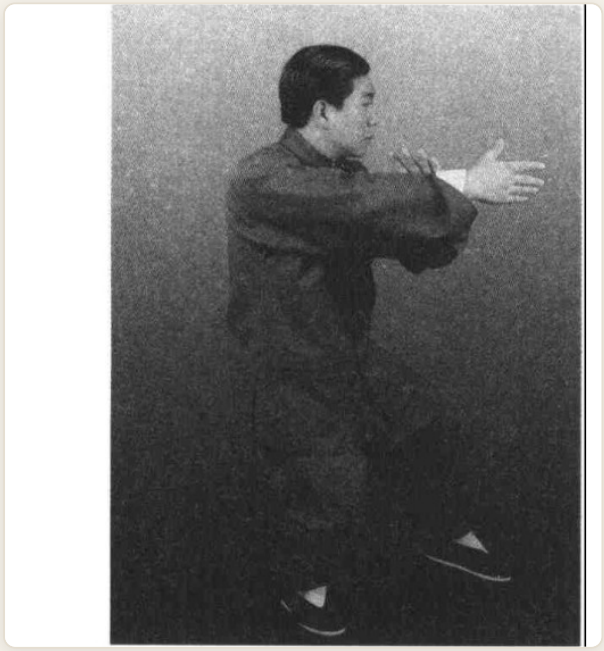
Posture Sixty-Five — Spread the Back Like a Fan

All sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Three, Spread the Back Like a Fan. See the first and second figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-eighteenth and hundred-and-nineteenth figures).

Posture Sixty-Six — Turn the Body and the White Snake Puts Out Its Tongue

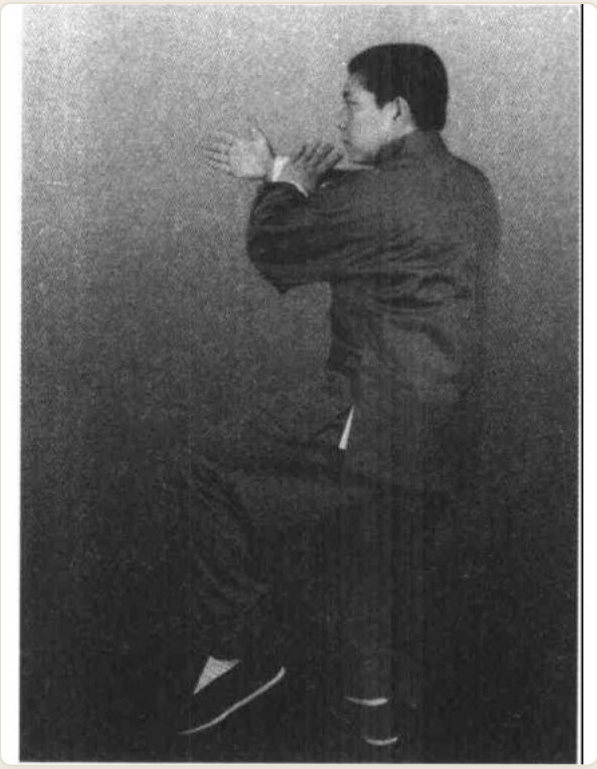
I. Application Turning the body and having the white snake put out its tongue is essentially the same as Parry and Punch, except that the fist is changed for the use of the palm, and the added point is that the palm must carry more sinking strength.

图 387A



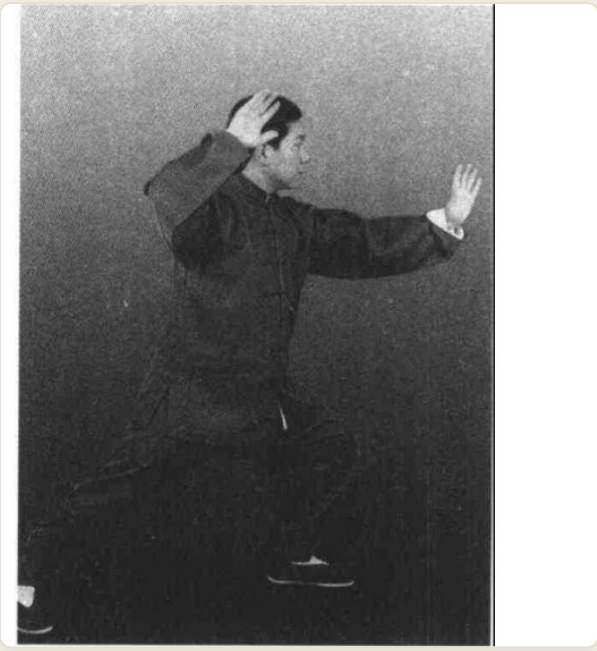
The opening of Spread the Back Like a Fan: the right palm rotates outward and lifts above and in front of the right brow, the left palm extends forward as an upright palm, and the body sits back.

图 387B



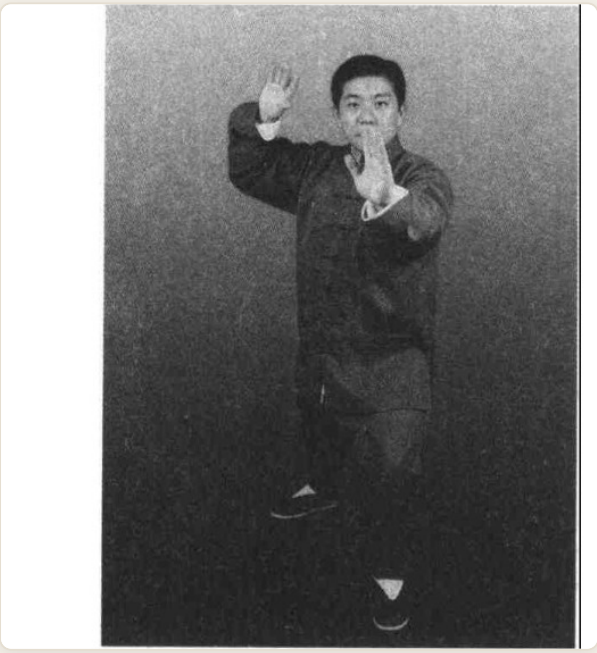
Spread the Back Like a Fan in transition: the weight shifts forward, the right palm props upward in front of the right brow, and the left palm accordingly pushes forward.

图 388A



The settled Spread the Back Like a Fan posture: the left leg is bent forward in the bow stance, the left palm pushes forward at shoulder level, the right palm props up above and in front of the right brow, and the eyes look toward the left palm.

图 388B



The settled Spread the Back Like a Fan posture from the front: the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward and the right palm propping up, the two arms spread apart one above the other, and the eyes looking straight ahead.

II. Sequence of movement 1. The body slowly turns right (toward the south); at the same time the left toes turn inward, the left leg settles firm, and the right foot becomes empty. As the trunk turns, the right palm is lowered in an arc and closes into a fist, which is placed for the moment in front of the left ribs, the elbow bent and the forearm horizontal, the centre of the fist facing down. The left palm is drawn back and raised in an arc to above and in front of the left brow. The gaze attends briefly to the right hand as it arcs, then looks level ahead. See the first figure on this page (the same as the hundred-and-twentieth figure).

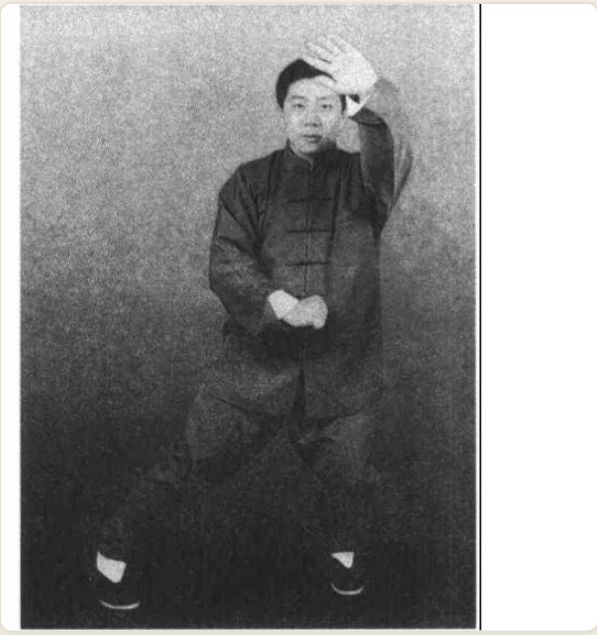
2. The body continues to turn right (toward the west). The whole of the weight shifts onto the left leg, the right foot is lifted, and the left palm, following the turn, arcs down from the right and, passing along the outside of the right forearm, comes to rest outside the right elbow, while the right fist circles upward (a little higher than the left elbow). Follow the turn and look level ahead, attending also to the movement of the two hands. See the second figure on this page (the same as the hundred-and-twenty-first figure).

3. The right foot is set down forward (a little to the right), the heel touching first, and the body continues to turn right. At the same time the right fist continues forward with the turn and, at the farthest point, changes into a palm using sinking strength. The eyes look level ahead, attending also to the right fist (see the third figure on this page).

4. The body continues to turn right, and the right palm continues to pluck downward to the front of the waist, the centre of the palm facing up. The left palm arcs back to the front of the chest and pushes forward from above the inner side of the right forearm. At the same time the weight gradually shifts onto the right leg, the right leg bending and the left leg pressing out to form the right bow stance. The eyes look level ahead, and must attend also to the left palm as it pushes forward (see the fourth figure on this page).

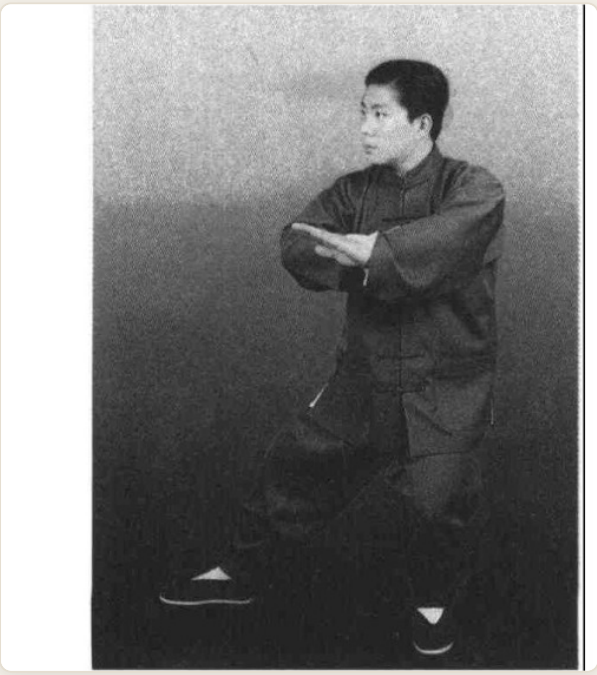
Apart from the fact that the right fist becomes a palm which plucks forward and down with sinking strength, all the remaining sections of this posture are the same as Posture Twenty-Four, Parry and Punch.

图 389



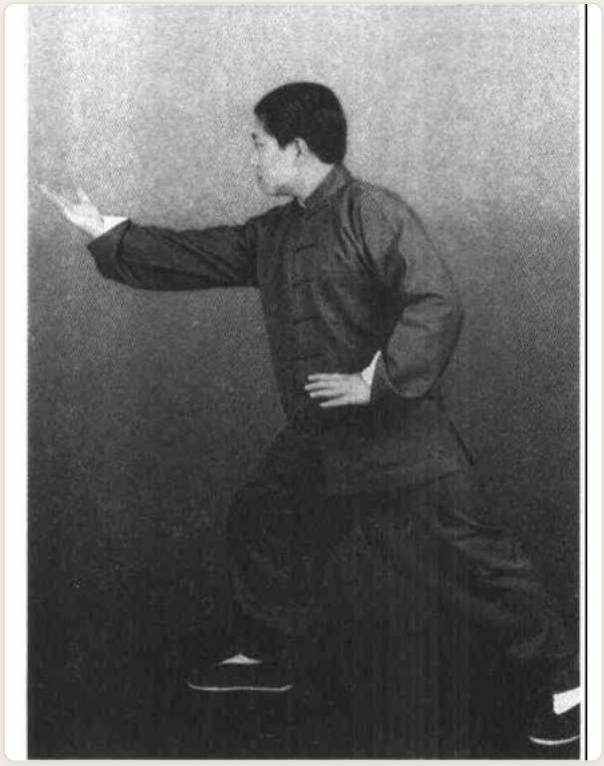
The opening of Turn the Body and the White Snake Puts Out Its Tongue: the body turns right, the right hand closes into a fist held horizontally in front of the left ribs, and the left palm is raised above and in front of the left brow.

图 390



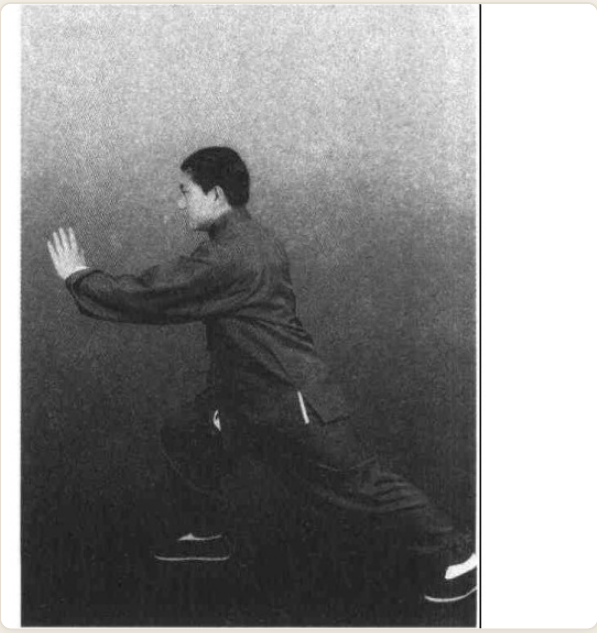
The right foot is lifted; the left palm arcs down to the outside of the right elbow and the right fist circles upward.

图 391



The right foot is set down forward with the heel touching; the right fist extends forward to the farthest point and changes into a palm with sinking strength.

图 392



The settled posture: the right bow stance, the left palm pushing forward from above the right forearm, and the right palm plucking down in front of the waist, the eyes looking straight ahead.

BOOK PAGE 213

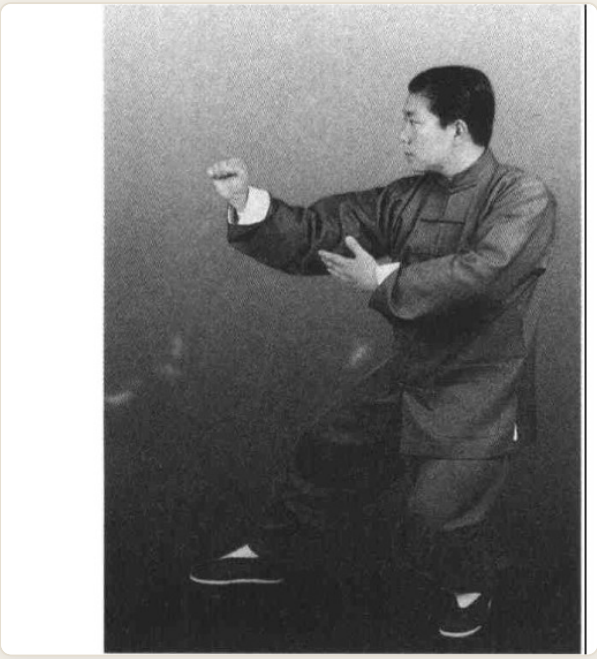
Posture Sixty-Seven — Step Forward, Parry, Block and Punch

Posture Sixty-Seven — Step Forward, Parry, Block and Punch

I. Application Same as Posture Twenty-Five above, Step Forward, Parry, Block and Punch.

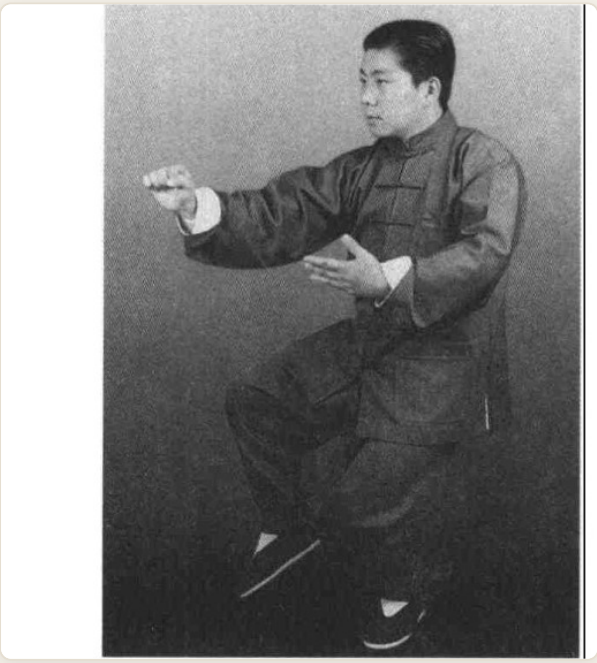
II. Sequence of movement The body gradually turns left, and the weight slowly shifts onto the left leg. At the same time the right palm sinks with the turn of the trunk, and the left arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm gradually turns to face upward and is drawn in beside the right elbow in front of the chest; the right palm closes into a fist and extends forward and upward to the upper side of the left palm, rotating inward as the right arm extends so that the centre of the fist faces down. The gaze attends to the right fist as it extends forward.

图 393



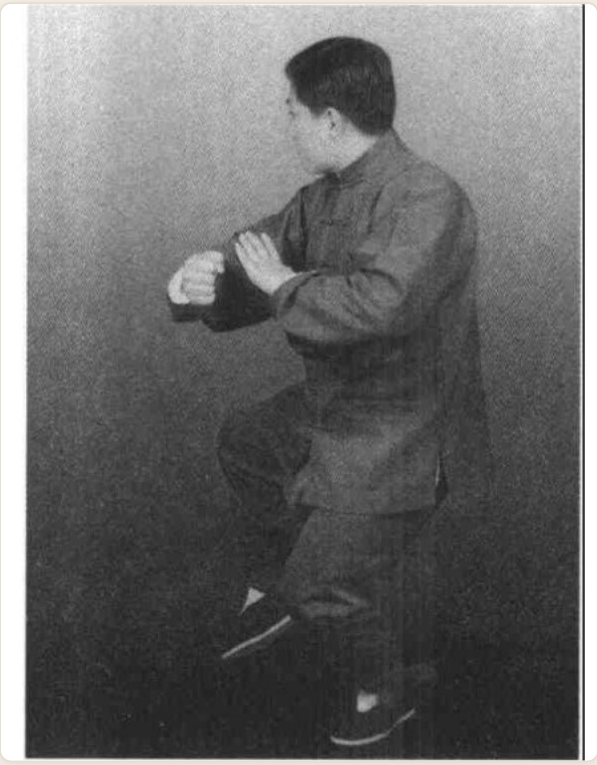
The opening of Step Forward, Parry, Block and Punch in profile: the body turns left, the right palm sinks, and the left arm rotates outward and turns the palm over in front of the chest.

图 394



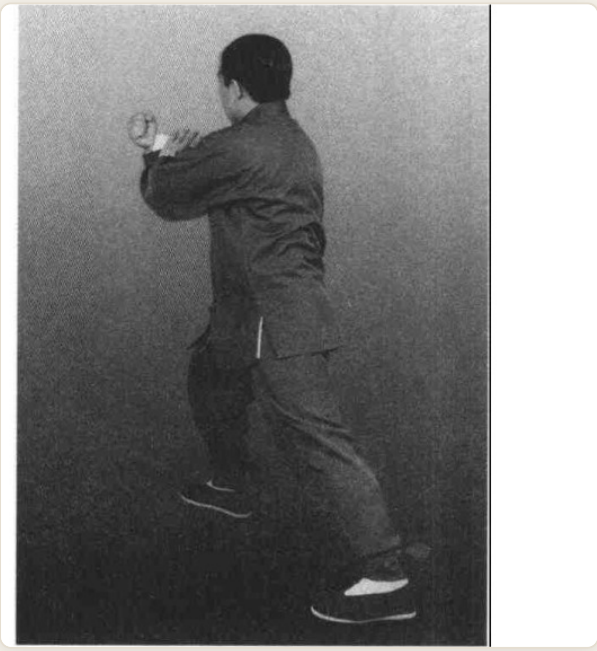
The right palm closes into a fist and extends forward and upward, while the left palm turns to face up and is drawn in beside the right elbow in front of the chest.

图 395



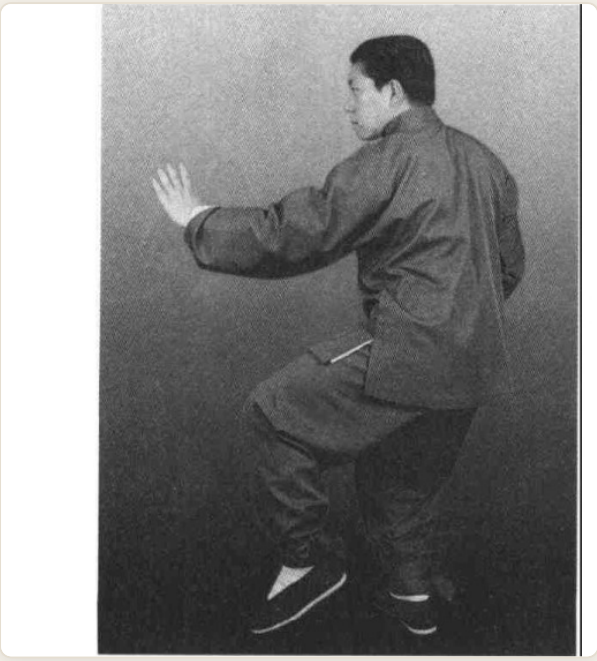
In transition: the right fist rotates inward so that the centre of the fist faces down, and the two arms cross in front of the chest.

图 396



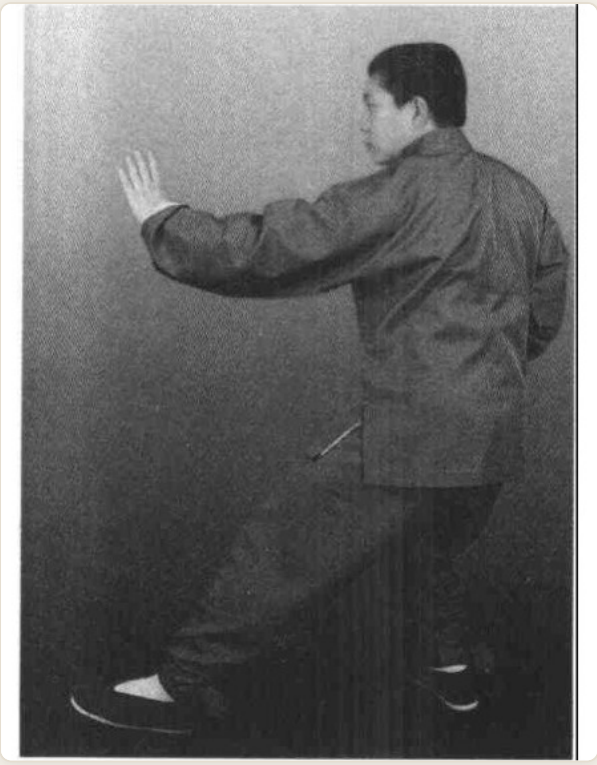
The right fist extends forward and the left palm rotates outward, the body centred and upright, the eyes looking toward the right fist.

图 397



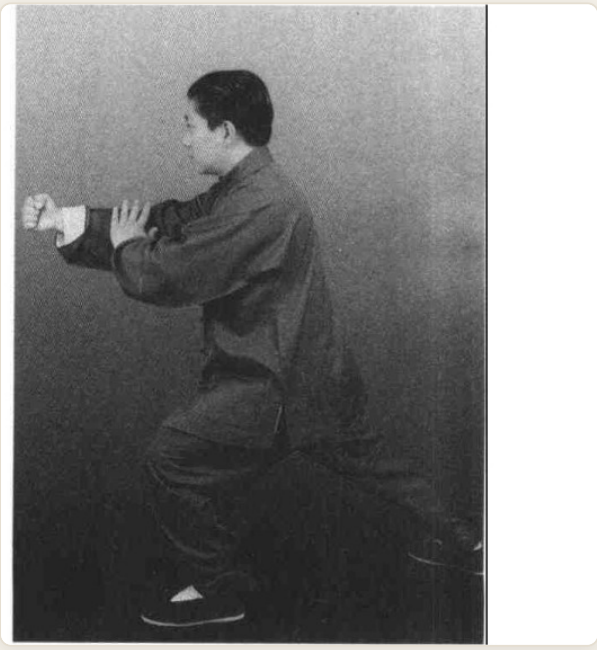
Parrying the fist in the bow stance: the right leg is bent forward, the right fist swings inward, and the left palm accordingly rotates outward to meet it in front.

图 398



The blocking posture: the left palm meets forward, the right fist is drawn in beside the right waist, and the weight shifts forward into the bow stance.

图 399



The settled punching posture: the right bow stance, the right fist driven forward from beside the waist at shoulder level, and the left palm drawn in on the inner side of the right elbow.

All the remaining sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Five, Parry, Block and Punch. See the first to the seventh figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-twenty-fourth to the hundred-and-thirtieth figures).

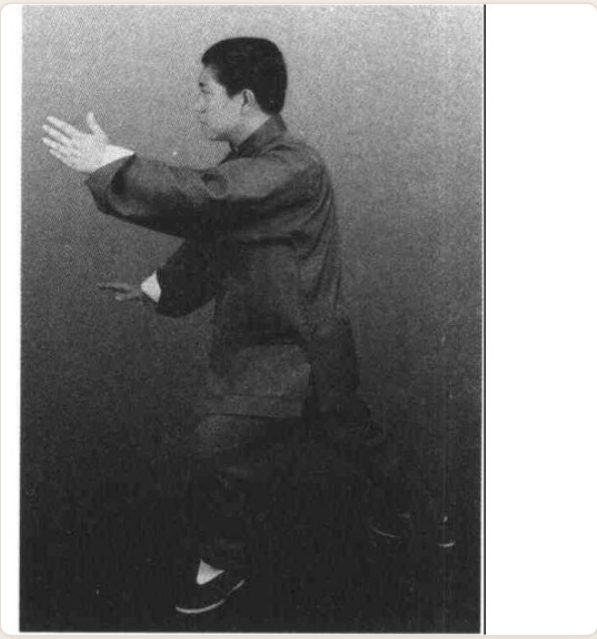
BOOK PAGE 214

Posture Sixty-Eight — Step Forward and Grasp the Bird's Tail

Posture Sixty-Eight — Step Forward and Grasp the Bird's Tail

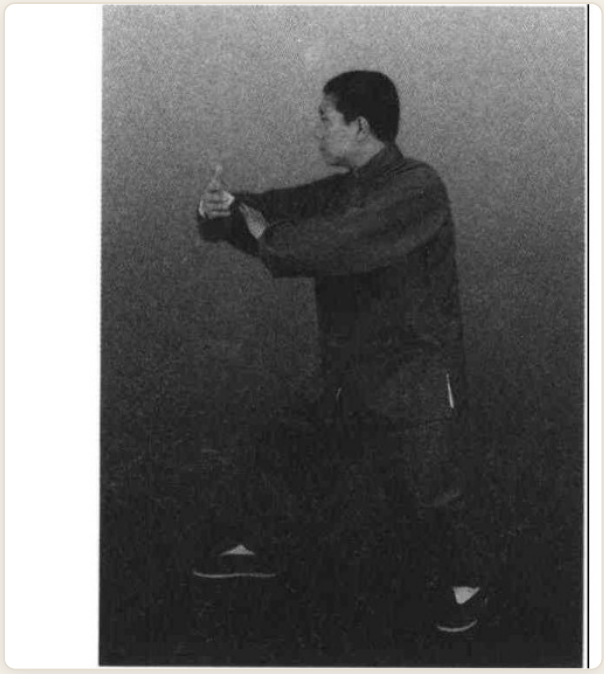
All sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Six, Grasp the Bird's Tail. See the eighth figure on this page (the same as the hundred-and-thirty-first figure) and the ninth to the fourteenth figures on this page (the same as the eighth to the thirteenth figures); the sequence continues on the next page.

图 400



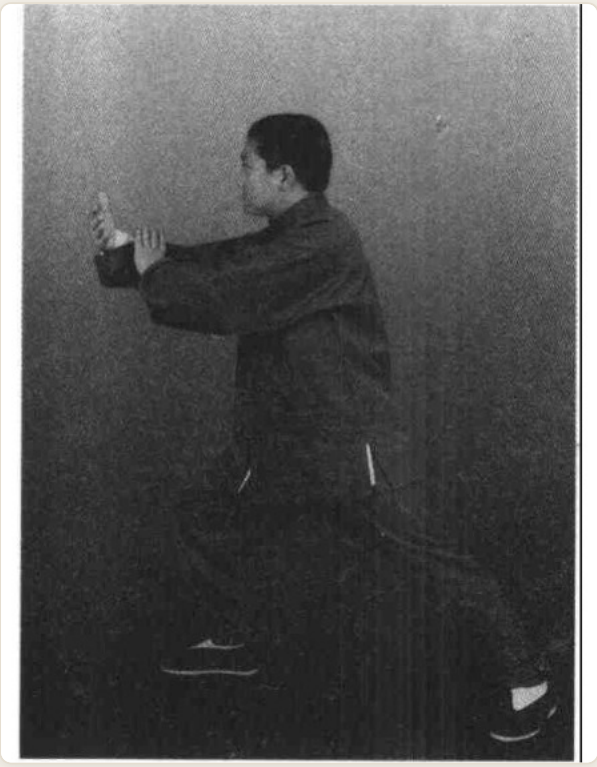
The opening of Step Forward and Grasp the Bird's Tail: the right hand rotates outward and wards upward in front of the right chest, the left hand presses down in front of the left abdomen, and the weight is on the left leg.

图 401



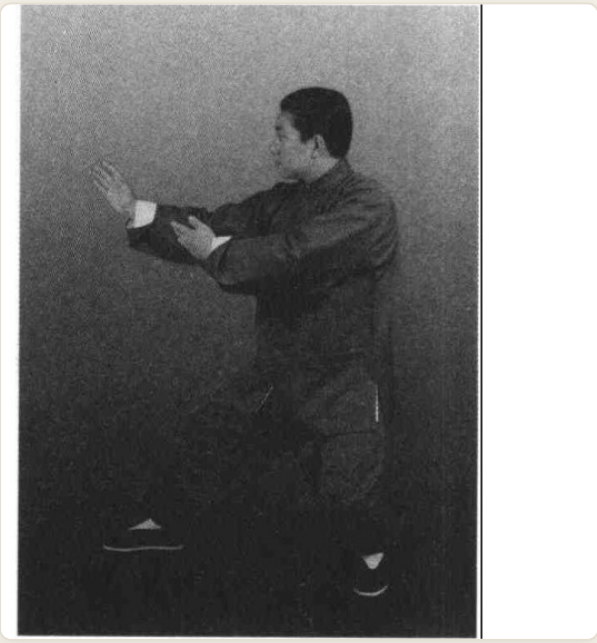
The ward: the left bow stance, the left arm warding forward at shoulder level, and the right palm placed on the inner side of the left wrist.

图 402



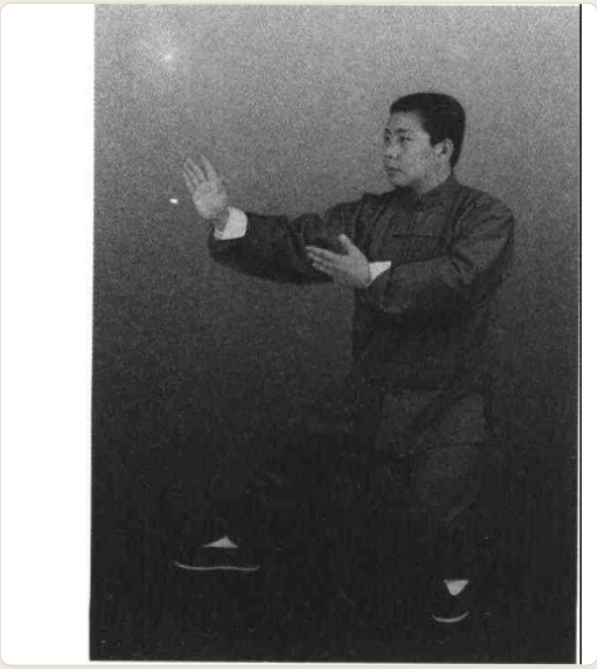
The ward in transition: the weight shifts forward, the left palm wards forward, and the right palm follows.

图 403



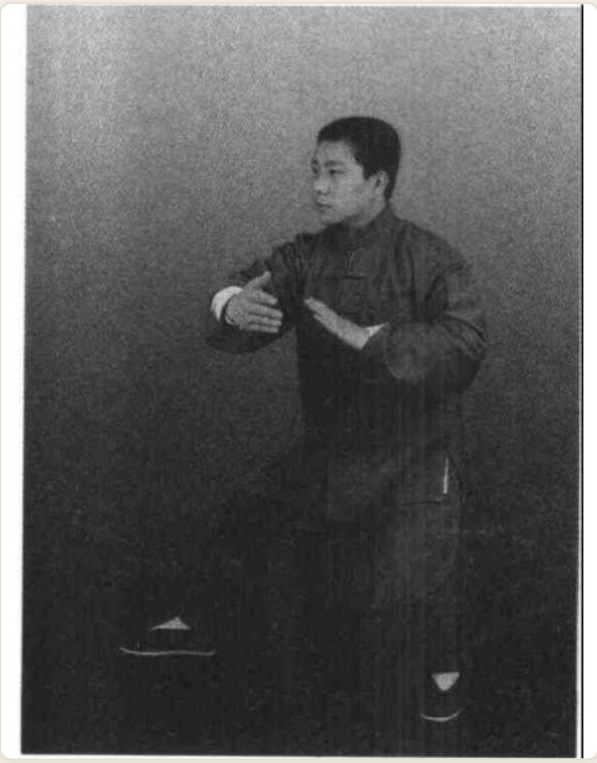
The beginning of the roll-back: both hands rotate inward at the same time, the right palm extending forward and the left palm drawing back.

图 404



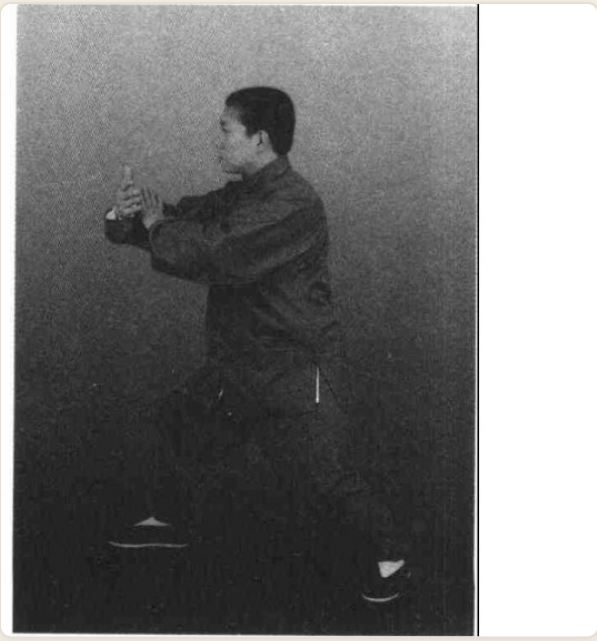
The roll-back: the weight sits back on the right leg, and the two hands roll back to the right rear, to the right side of the body.

图 405



The press: the left palm presses forward, and the right palm follows forward and attaches to the inner side of the left wrist.

图 406



The settled press: the left bow stance unchanged, the two palms joined and pressing forward, the eyes looking straight ahead.

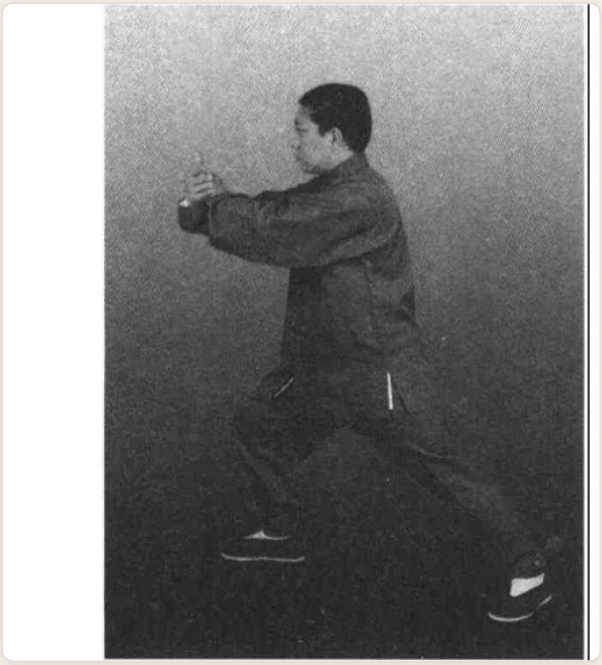
BOOK PAGE 215

Posture Sixty-Nine — the Single Whip

Posture Sixty-Nine — the Single Whip

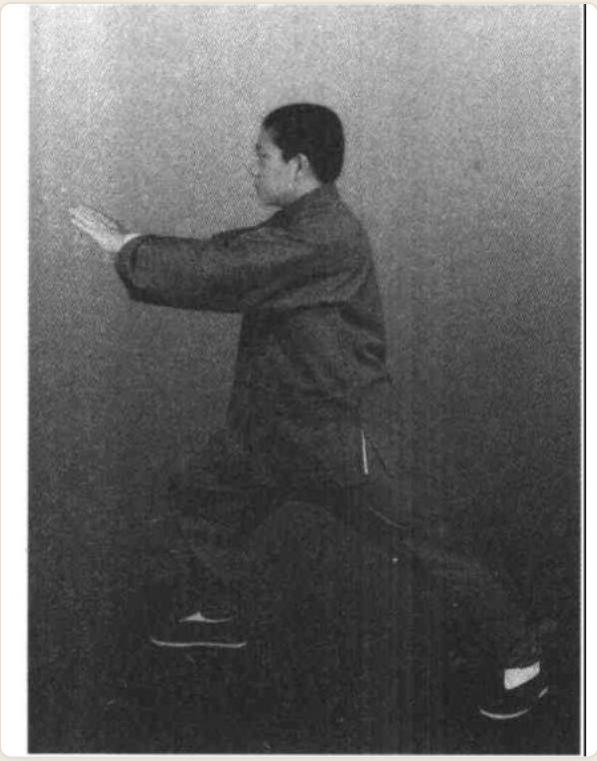
All sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Seven, the Single Whip. See the fifth to the tenth figures on this page (the same as the eighteenth to the twenty-third figures); the sequence continues on the next page.

图 407



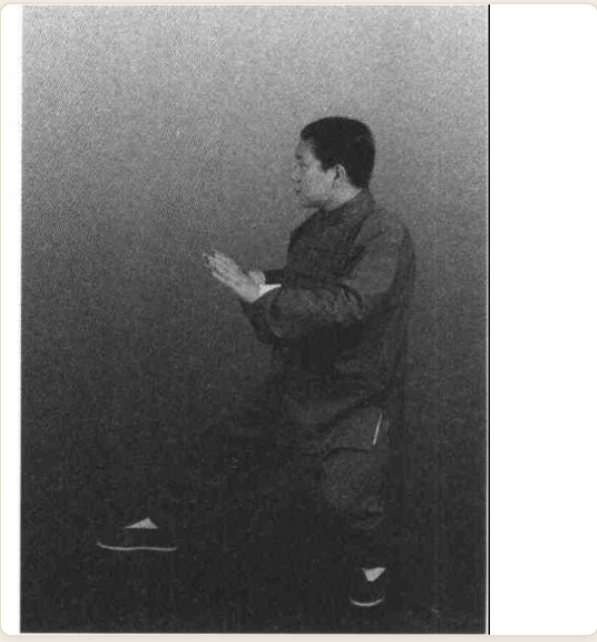
Step Forward and Grasp the Bird's Tail continued: the left bow stance, the transition following the joining of the two palms and the press forward.

图 408



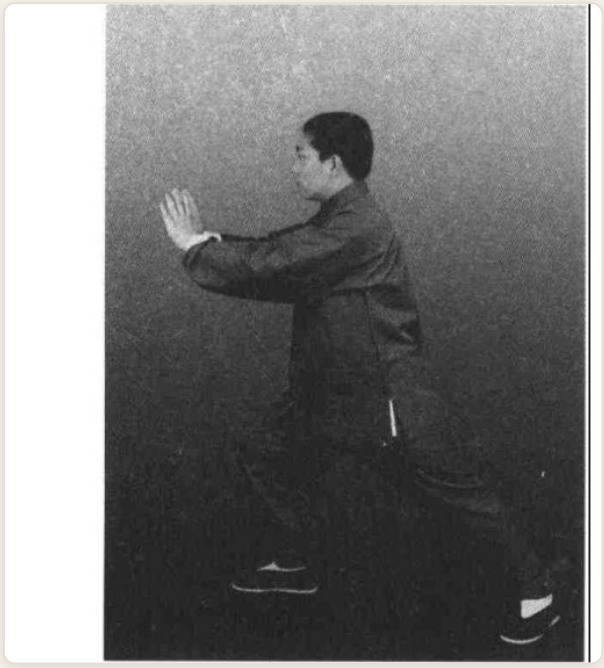
The push: the two palms press down together in front of the abdomen, and the weight shifts forward.

图 409



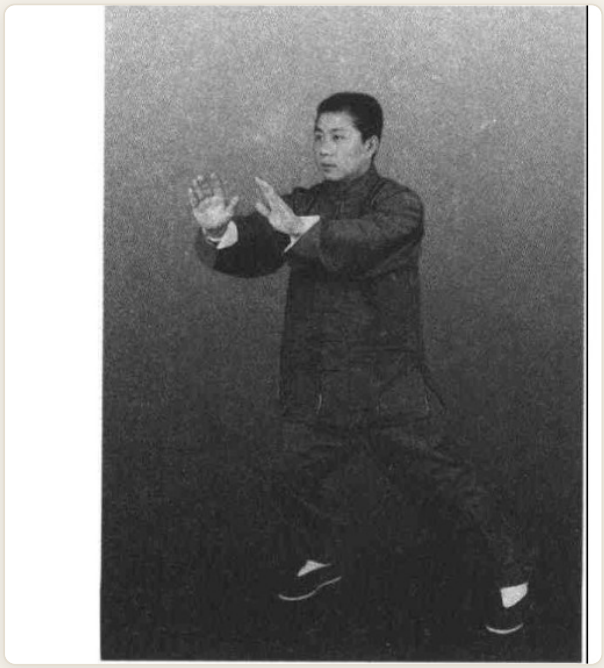
The settled push: the two palms press down, the body sits back, and the stance is the sitting stance.

图 410



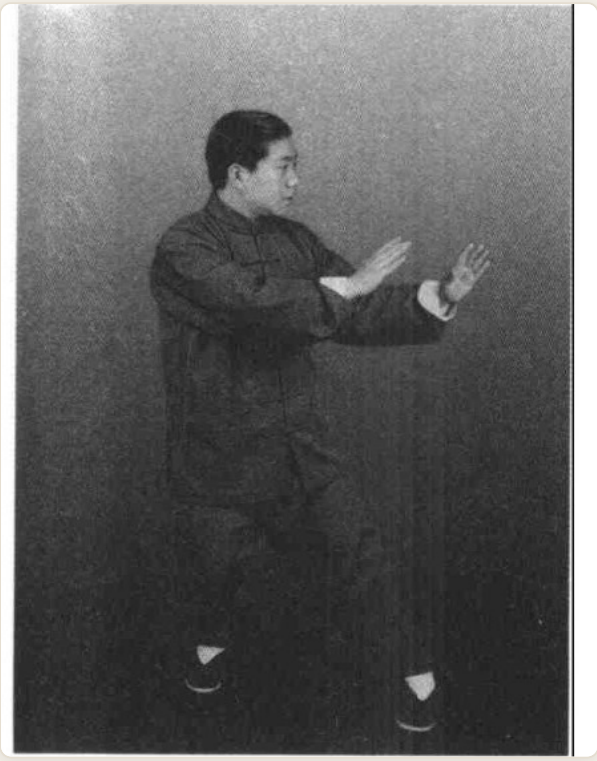
The closing of Grasp the Bird's Tail: the weight sits back on the right leg, the two palms press down in front of the abdomen, and the eyes look straight ahead.

图 411



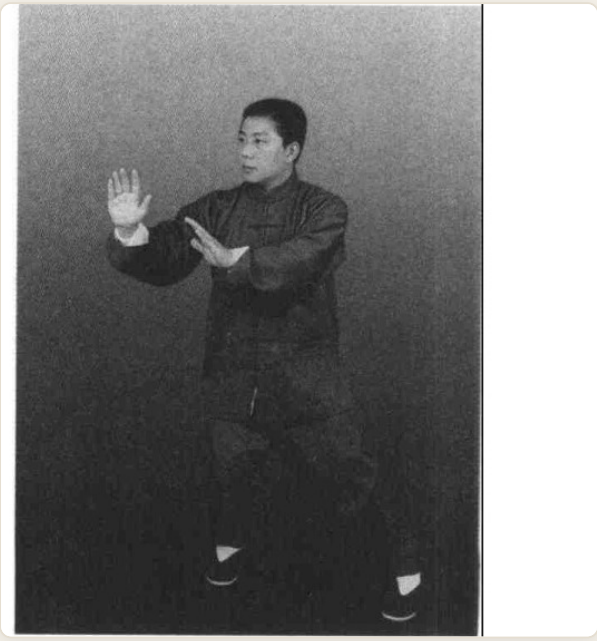
The opening of the Single Whip: the right palm changes into a hook hand and extends back to the right, the left palm is drawn in front of the chest, and the waist turns right.

图 412



The Single Whip in transition: the weight shifts onto the right leg, the left toes turn inward, and the hook hand extends forward.

图 413



The settled Single Whip: the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward, and the right hand hooked behind on the right.

BOOK PAGE 216

Posture Seventy — Wave Hands Like Clouds

Posture Seventy — Wave Hands Like Clouds

All sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Eight, Wave Hands Like Clouds. See the fourth to the eleventh figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-forty-ninth to the hundred-and-fifty-sixth figures), the twelfth to the seventeenth figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-fifty-first to the hundred-and-fifty-sixth figures), and the eighteenth to the twentieth figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-fifty-first to the hundred-and-fifty-third figures).

图 414

The Single Whip continued: the hook hand extends forward, the left palm pushes forward, and the weight shifts forward into the left bow stance.

图 415

The Single Whip from another angle: the settled left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward at shoulder level, and the hook hand spread behind.

图 416

The settled Single Whip from the front: the left palm pushing forward and the right hand hooked behind on the right, the two arms spread apart front and back, the eyes looking toward the left palm.

图 417

The opening of Wave Hands Like Clouds: the right hand changes from the hook hand into a palm and arcs from right to upper left, while the left hand presses down in front of the left abdomen.

图 418

Wave Hands Like Clouds in transition: the right hand rotates inward and presses down in front of the right abdomen, the left hand rotates outward and shifts up in front of the left chest, and the waist turns left.

图 419

Wave Hands Like Clouds (left form): the left hand arcs from left to upper right, and the right hand presses down in front of the right abdomen.

图 420

Wave Hands Like Clouds in transition: the two hands alternate one above the other, the waist turns right, and the weight shifts with the steps.

This page is a full-page sheet of movement plates with no running text. Figures 421 to 429 are the continuous movement sequence of Posture Seventy, Wave Hands Like Clouds, continuing on from the previous page's figures 417 to 420.

图 421

Wave Hands Like Clouds: the right hand shifts up in front of the right brow, the left hand presses down in front of the left abdomen, and the waist turns left.

图 422

Wave Hands Like Clouds in transition: the right hand arcs from right to upper left, the left hand accordingly descends, and the weight shifts onto the left leg.

图 423

Wave Hands Like Clouds (right form): the right hand arcs across to the front of the left shoulder, the left hand presses down in front of the right abdomen, and the waist turns left.

图 424

Wave Hands Like Clouds (left form): the left hand shifts up in front of the left brow, the right hand presses down in front of the right abdomen, and the left foot steps sideways to the left.

图 425

Wave Hands Like Clouds in transition: the left hand arcs from left to upper right, the right hand accordingly descends, and the waist turns right.

图 426

Wave Hands Like Clouds (right form): the left hand arcs across to the front of the right shoulder, the right hand presses down in front of the left abdomen, and the waist turns right.

图 427

The beginning of Wave Hands Like Clouds: the right hand shifts up in front of the right brow, the left hand presses down in front of the left abdomen, and the waist turns left.

图 428

Wave Hands Like Clouds in transition: the right hand arcs from right to upper left, and the left hand accordingly descends.

图 429

Wave Hands Like Clouds (right form): the right hand arcs across to the front of the left shoulder, the left hand presses down in front of the right abdomen, and the stance is the left bow stance.

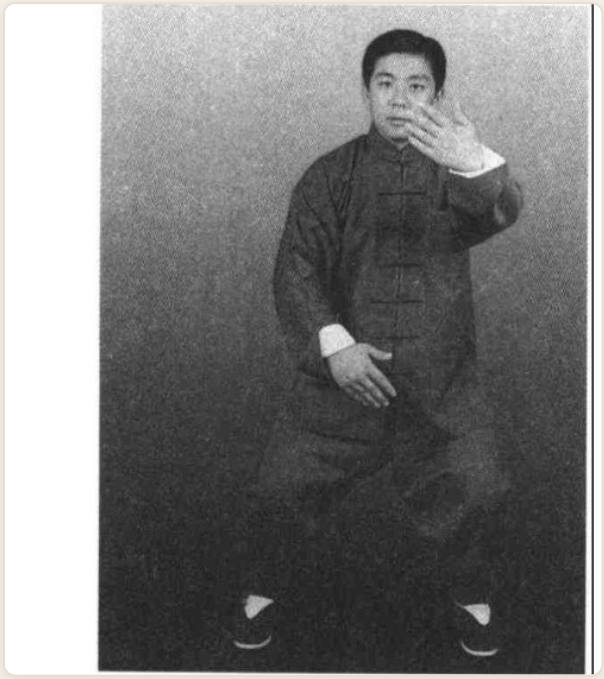
BOOK PAGE 218

Posture Seventy-One — the Single Whip

Posture Seventy-One — the Single Whip

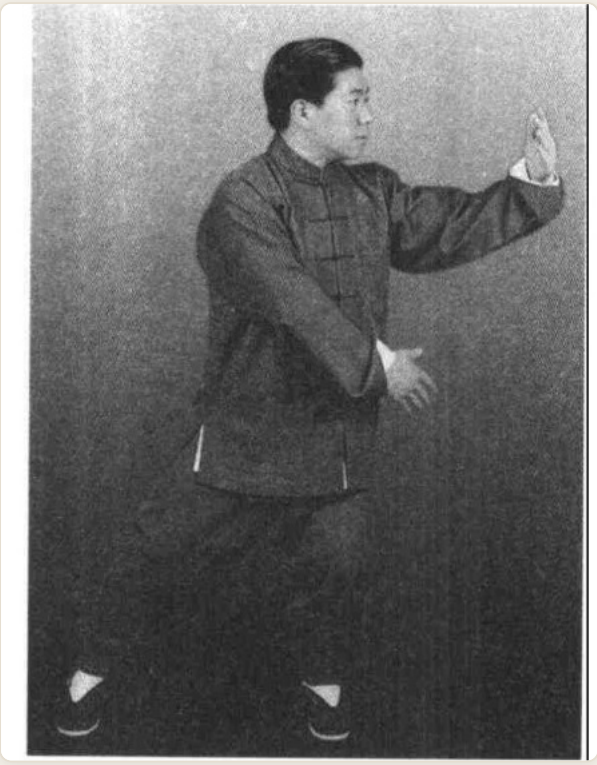
All sections are the same as Posture Twenty-Nine, the Single Whip. See the fifth figure on this page (the same as the hundred-and-sixty-sixth figure) and the sixth to the eighth figures on this page (the same as the twenty-first to the twenty-third figures).

图 430



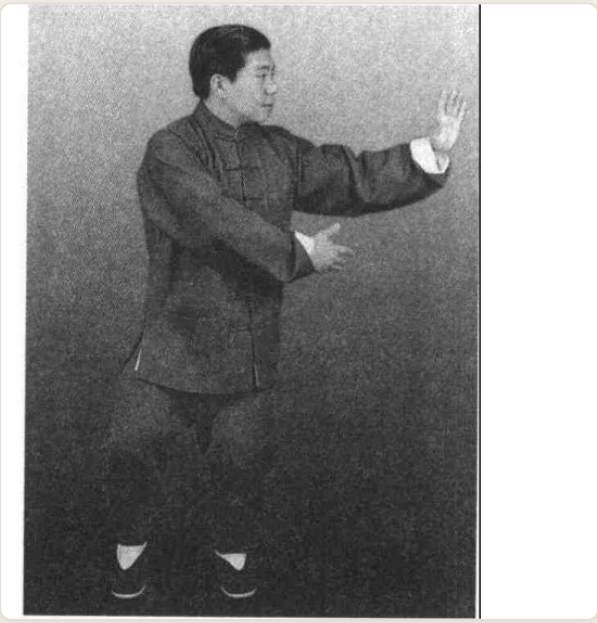
The closing of Wave Hands Like Clouds: the right hand shifts up in front of the right brow, the left hand presses down in front of the left abdomen, and the waist turns left.

图 431



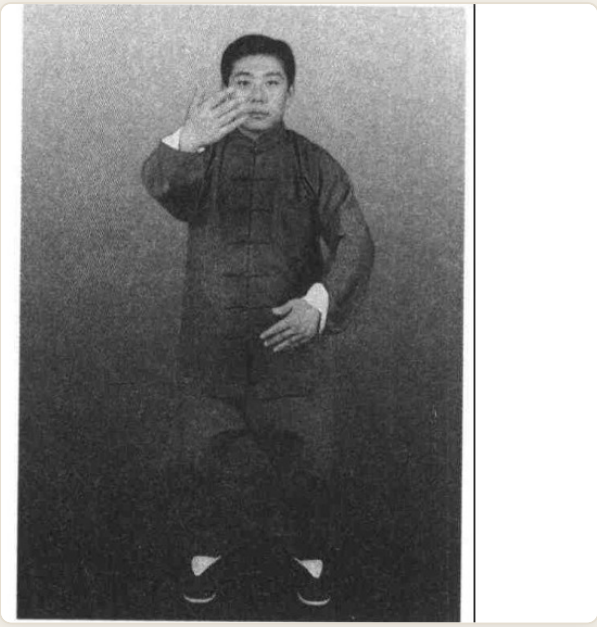
Wave Hands Like Clouds in transition: the right hand arcs from right to upper left, the left hand accordingly descends, and the weight shifts onto the left leg.

图 432



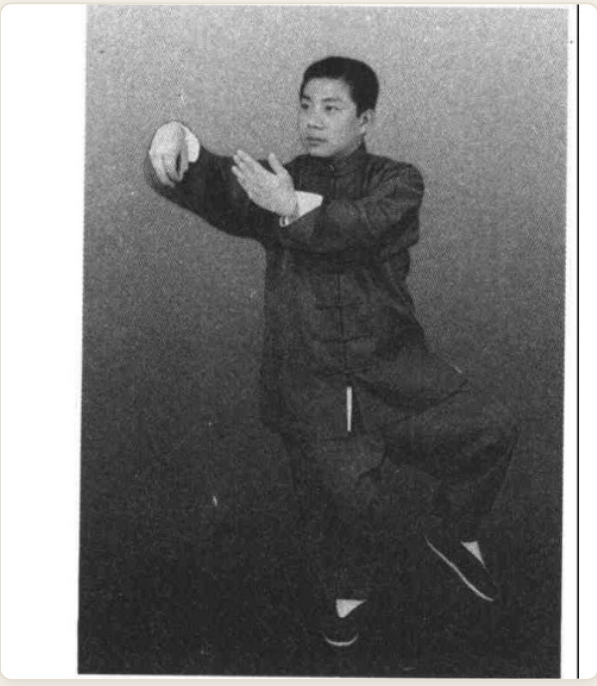
Wave Hands Like Clouds (right form): the right hand arcs across to the front of the left shoulder, the left hand presses down in front of the right abdomen, and the waist turns left.

图 433



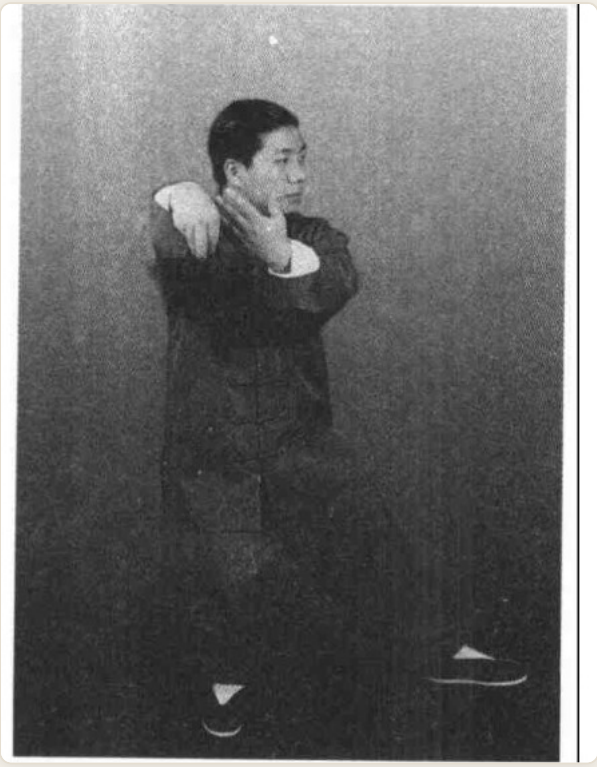
The closing of Wave Hands Like Clouds: after the two hands have alternated one above the other they are drawn in at the sides, and the left foot closes up to the right foot.

图 434



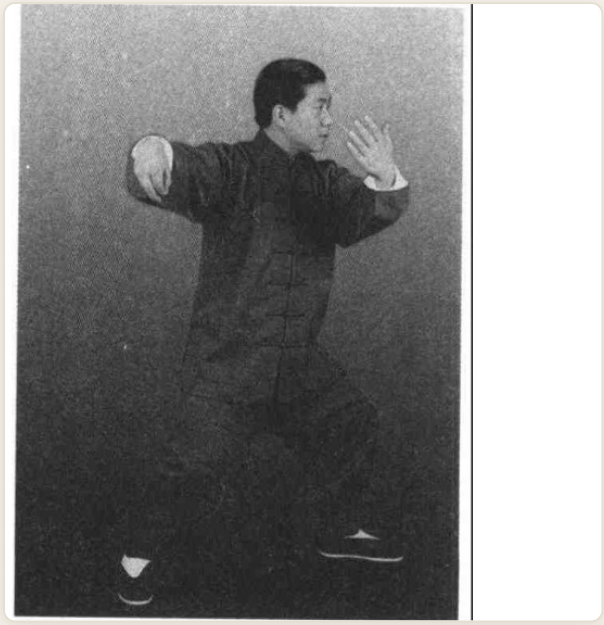
The opening of the Single Whip: the right palm changes into a hook hand and extends back to the right, the left palm is drawn in front of the chest, and the waist turns right.

图 435



The Single Whip in transition: the weight shifts onto the right leg, the left toes turn inward, and the hook hand extends forward.

图 436



The settled Single Whip: the left bow stance, the left palm pushing forward at shoulder level, and the right hand hooked behind on the right.

BOOK PAGE 219

Posture Seventy-Two — High Pat on the Horse with Threading Palm

Posture Seventy-Two — High Pat on the Horse with Threading Palm

I. Application The application of the first part is the same as High Pat on the Horse. In the second part, while my extended right hand is being held by the opponent's left hand, I immediately draw the right hand back with the centre of the palm facing down, and the left hand, raised slightly, threads through with the palm and thrusts at the opponent's throat, while the right hand remains hidden below the left elbow, ready to meet any change.

II. Sequence of movement (a) The movement of High Pat on the Horse is the same as Posture Thirty, High Pat on the Horse. See the second to the fourth figures on this page (the same as the hundred-and-seventieth to the hundred-and-seventy-second figures).

(b) Threading Palm, Left 1. The right leg gradually crouches, and the left leg is lifted and drawn back. At the same time the right arm gradually bends at the elbow and lies across, the arm curved, and is drawn in with a downward-left arc; as it is drawn in the arm rotates outward so

that the centre of the palm turns to face upward; the left palm gradually turns palm-upward and threads up above the right palm. The eyes look level ahead (see the fifth figure on this page).

2. The left foot steps forward one pace, the heel touching first; as the weight gradually shifts onto the left leg the whole of the sole presses down firmly, the left leg bends and the right leg presses out to form the left bow stance. At the same time the left hand continues to thread forward and upward; as the left forearm passes above the right palm, the right arm immediately rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns to face down, and the right palm comes to rest below the upper left arm, while the left palm threads out above the right palm, its centre still facing up, at the height of the chin. The gaze attends to the right palm as it is drawn in, and then to the left palm as it threads forward (see the sixth figure on this page).

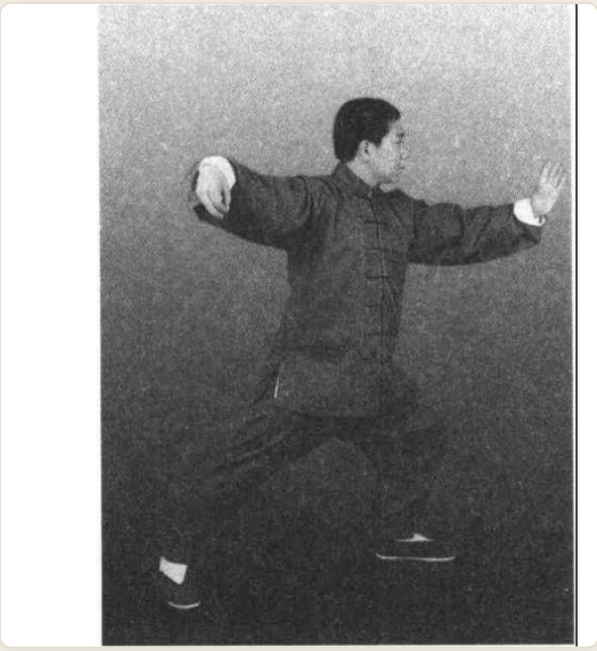
III. Key points 1. When the left leg steps forward the right leg must crouch, so that the left leg takes a somewhat larger step. This both achieves the martial effect and increases the amount of exercise.

2. As the left palm threads through and the bow stance is about to form, the body turns slightly right in coordination.

3. When stepping, the upper body must be centred and upright, not leaning forward. The body method of taijiquan must be nimble, relaxed and calm, but it is not permitted to drop the head forward or to bend the trunk forward.

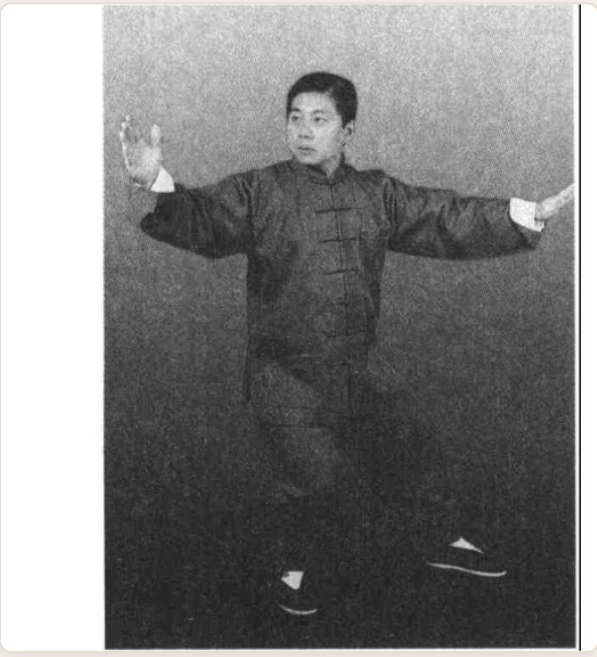
4. The step must be set down nimbly; strive to "step as a cat walks". Therefore, as the left leg steps forward, the right leg must "sink" and "send" the left leg forward; otherwise the step will easily become tense.

图 437



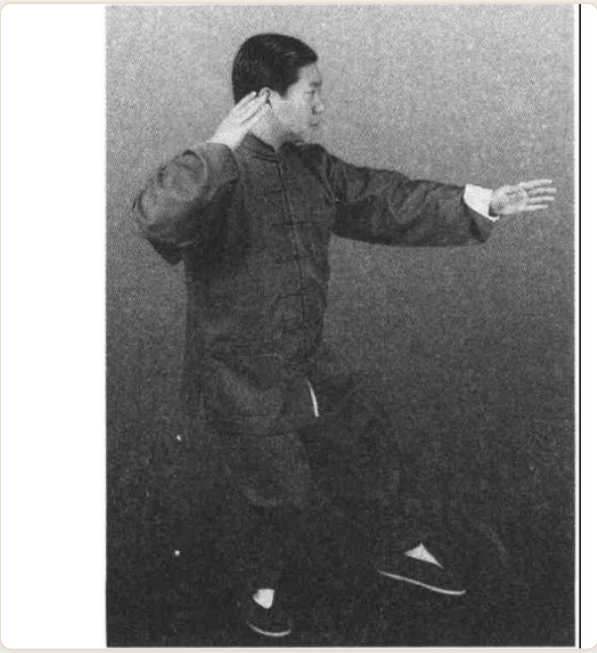
The opening of High Pat on the Horse with Threading Palm: the two hands spread apart front and back, the right hand extends forward and the left hand is drawn in beside the left waist, and the weight sits back.

图 438



The High Pat on the Horse movement: the right hand extends forward to the front of the chest, the left hand is drawn in beside the left waist, and the body is centred and upright.

图 439



The settled High Pat on the Horse: the right palm reaches forward at shoulder level, the left palm is drawn in beside the left waist, and the left leg is forward in the empty stance.

...forward; otherwise the step will easily become tense.

5. When the left palm threads out, the right arm must be curved and a space must be kept at the right armpit; it must not be clamped shut. Otherwise, on the one hand the posture will look awkward and fail to meet the requirement of roundness everywhere; on the other hand, the right hand under the armpit is there to meet changes, and if it is clamped shut it will lose its roundness and liveliness and its usefulness in meeting change will be reduced.

IV. Requirements 1. Although the lower limbs are changing step, "the hundred meetings and the central pole, one breath running through" must still be achieved; do not lean forward or backward.

2. The movements must be continuous without pause. When High Pat on the Horse has reached its position, immediately perform the threading palm; the two movements must not be separated but must be "unbroken as a thread".

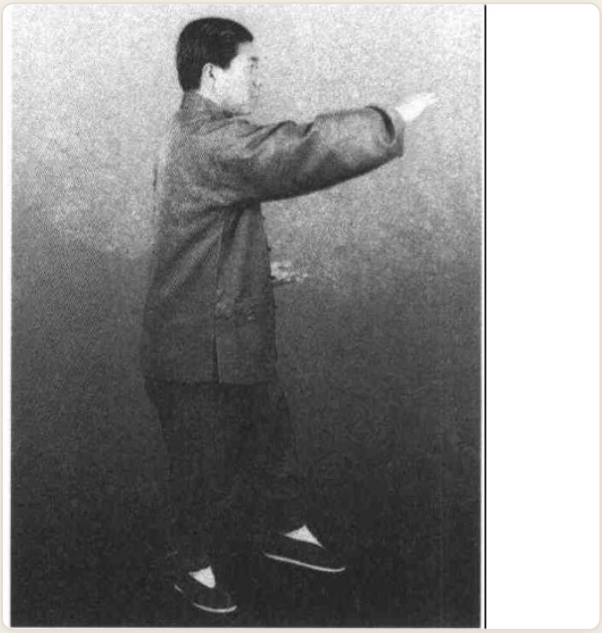
V. Common errors, their causes, and how to correct them 1. Error: the threading arm is fully straightened. Straightening tenses the muscles, which makes the force excessive and the movement sluggish. The main cause is generally that the hand is thrust out with too much force, or that one subjectively wants the hand to reach farther, supposing that a thrust must strike home. The Boxing Treatises say that the principle is originally "give up yourself and follow others", but many mistakenly "give up the near and seek the far". The so-called difference of a hair's breadth leads to an error of a thousand miles. Therefore over-extending is harmful.

Correction: leave a margin when the hand goes out, and keep the arm slightly curved when threading the palm.

2. Error: when the left foot steps, the right leg does not crouch, or crouches very little, and only the body's centre of gravity moves forward so that the left leg steps forward. The main cause is that the application is not deeply understood. Because the right hand I have extended is being held and gripped, a crouch gives the withdrawing right arm a sinking strength which can draw the opponent along, and I then thread the left palm straight through to the opponent's throat. Moreover, in form practice High Pat on the Horse is one of the few movements that bring the body to standing. For this reason, when threading the palm one should return to practising the form in the half-crouched state, so as to train and strengthen the legs. Correction: from the very start of the threading palm the right leg must crouch.

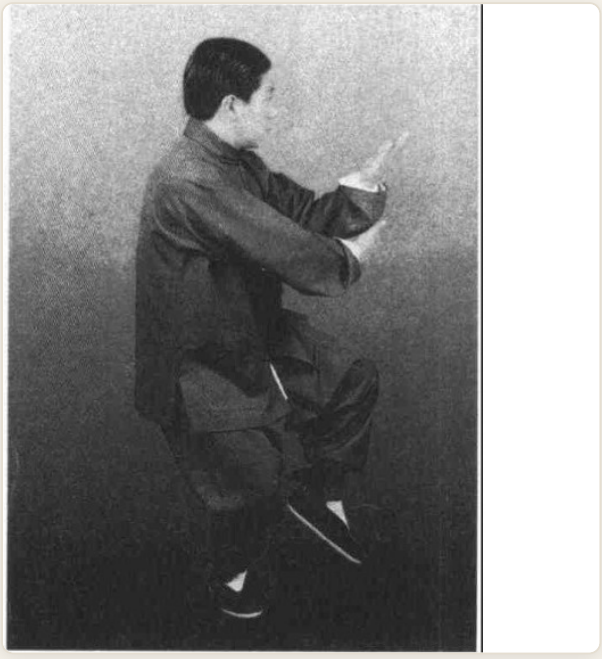
3. Error: upper and lower are disconnected, so that when threading the palm either the hand arrives first or the foot arrives first. The main cause is that the application is not deeply understood. For the issuing of strength there must be a root: the strength starts from the heel, is governed by the waist, is issued from the legs, and takes form in the fingers. If hand and foot are disconnected, from where will the strength start, and how will it reach? Correction: the thrust of the hand necessarily requires the supporting coordination of waist and legs; in practice strive to have the hand arrive when the foot arrives, and take particular care that the bowing leg does not move too fast.

图 440



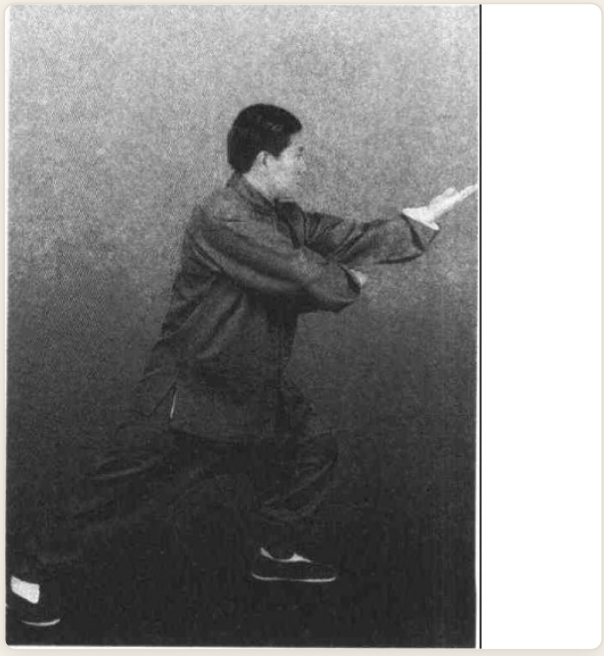
The threading palm in transition: the right arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns to face upward, and the left palm turns palm-upward and threads up above the right palm.

图 441



The left foot steps forward, the left palm continues to thread forward, and the right palm comes to rest below the upper left arm.

图 442A



The settled threading palm: the left bow stance, the left palm threaded forward at the height of the chin, and the right palm resting below the upper left arm, the eyes looking straight ahead.

...coordination of waist and legs; in practice strive to have the hand arrive when the foot arrives, and take particular care that the bowing leg does not move too fast.

4. Error: threading and striking are not clearly distinguished, so that the left hand first goes up and then down. The main cause is a failure to understand the application. The threading palm thrusts at the opponent's throat; striking downward can only hit the chest. Correction: the palm must thread up along a downward-slanting line; it must not arc downward to strike.

VI. Teaching and practice methods 1. Mnemonic: at High Pat on the Horse the hand is held; bend the right leg and draw the right palm back; step the left leg nimbly forward; the left threading palm goes straight to the throat.

2. Constantly sharpen the distinction of empty and full. In the first half, when the Single Whip joins High Pat on the Horse, as the left foot is drawn back the right leg must be settled firm and the left leg lifted lightly; take care that the centre of gravity moves back, that the upper body does not lean forward, and that the left foot is not drawn back scraping the ground. When threading the palm, take care to settle the right leg firm so that the left leg steps forward nimbly. In teaching, observe and correct repeatedly so that the weight moves onto the supporting point and empty and full are clearly distinguished.

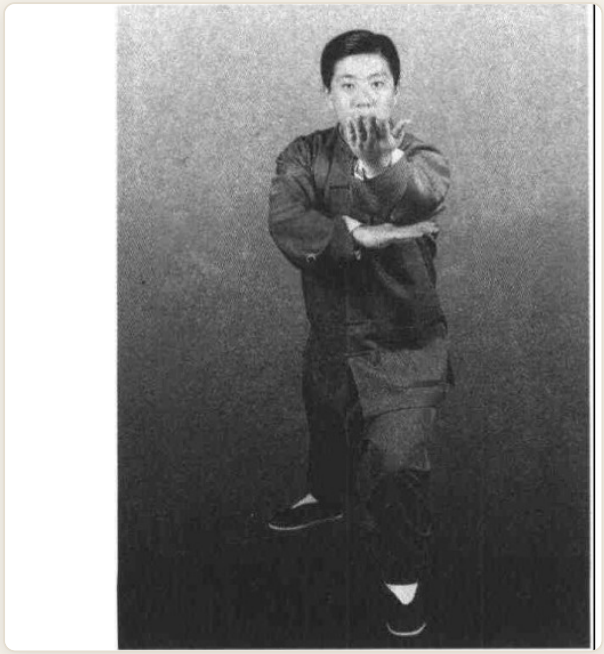
3. The learner should frequently and repeatedly practise the half-crouch position of the right leg, and the stepping forward and drawing back of the left leg, and may also alternate the legs, in order to feel empty and full and strengthen the legs.

4. Paired practice using the application: A — assumes the settled High Pat on the Horse; B — holds A's right hand with the left hand; A — crouches the right leg, draws the right hand back, steps the left leg forward and threads out the left palm; B — retreats slightly. In practice the teacher should explain the meaning and requirements of each detail of the movement, so that the learning becomes vivid.

5. So that beginners may simplify the movements while learning, they may learn with the hand still and the foot moving, or with the foot still and the hand moving, so that it is easier to watch and to imitate; but having once made clear the separate parts of hand and foot, they must immediately practise the hand and foot moving together. In this way they learn quickly and yet do not fall into disconnection and ruin of the movements.

VII. Technical analysis In High Pat on the Horse with Threading Palm, attention must be paid to nimbleness; if the body is sluggish one cannot advance or retreat at ease. Therefore the body must be nimble: no sooner has the opponent's force touched my skin than my intention has already entered his very bones.

图 442B



The settled threading palm from another angle: the left bow stance, the left palm threaded forward and the right palm resting below the upper left arm, the body centred and upright, the eyes looking straight ahead.

BOOK PAGE 222

Posture Seventy-Three — the Cross-Shaped Leg

Posture Seventy-Three — the Cross-Shaped Leg

I. Application Continuing from the previous posture. If an opponent strikes across at me with his right hand from behind on my right, I quickly turn my body toward the right rear as I roll and turn, and at the same time the left arm turns up and bends back; as it embraces the right arm one above the other, I quickly separate the two hands forward and back to bar the opponent's hand. At the same time I quickly lift the right leg and thrust the heel at the opponent's right ribs; the opponent will then certainly fall back with the kick.

Note: In Master Yang Chengfu's book *The Complete Book of Taijiquan: Substance and Application*, Part One (1933 edition), only one plate of the settled Cross-Shaped Leg posture is given here; no sequence plates are listed, and the original way of practising it was the single swing-lotus leg. The method in this book is the form as finally revised and settled by Yang Chengfu, which has long been in wide circulation, and it is therefore taken as the final settled form of the present time. So that readers may understand something of the original way of practising it, it is described as follows:

After the left threading palm, the left toes turn inward and press down firmly, the body gradually turns right, and the weight gradually shifts entirely onto the left leg. At the same time the left palm, with the elbow bent, moves in an arc to the right past the face with the turn of the body, while the right palm remains below the upper left arm. The body continues to turn right, and the right foot is lifted and swings outward in an arc from left to upper right, the knee naturally slightly bent, the foot no higher than the shoulder, the instep turned somewhat to face right. At the same time the left palm strikes from above rightward and then leftward to meet the right foot.

Another method (a counter):

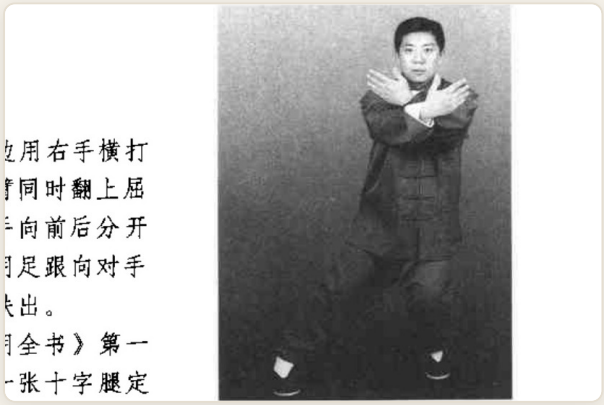
1. To counter the Cross-Shaped Leg, one may first brush the knee and then attack by other means.

2. To counter the Cross-Shaped Leg, one may also ward upward with the left hand, step the right foot forward, and use the right planting punch to counter it.

II. Sequence of movement 1. The body gradually turns right, the left toes turn inward and press down firmly, the weight gradually shifts entirely onto the left leg, and the right foot is lifted (the heel leaving the ground first). At the same time the left arm bends at the elbow and moves right, the centre of the palm facing inward, and the right palm, passing along the outside of the left arm, joins with the turn of the body to the right; as it joins, the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm turns to face inward, so that the two palms cross in front of the chest. The eyes follow the turn of the body and look level to the right, and the gaze must attend to the two palms embracing (see the first and second figures on this page).

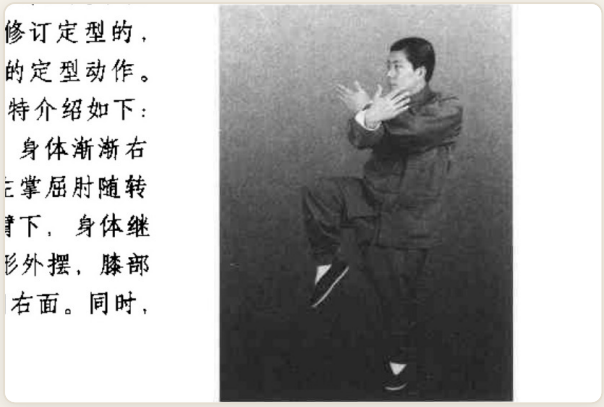
2. The two palms separate to left and right. At the same time the right foot slowly...

图 443



The opening of the Cross-Shaped Leg: the body turns right, the two palms cross in front of the chest, and the right foot is lifted with the heel leaving the ground first.

图 444



The Cross-Shaped Leg in transition: the two palms separate to left and right, and the right foot is lifted and swings outward in an arc from left to upper right.

图 445A

The Cross-Shaped Leg thrust out: the right leg thrusts out to the right front with the heel, the two palms spread to left and right, the body is centred and upright, and the eyes look to the right.

...slowly outward to the right, the toes pointing up; as the right leg thrusts out the left leg gradually straightens, though at the settled posture the knee is still slightly bent. The gaze attends to the right palm as it separates out, and looking level to the right past the right palm (see the first figure on this page, and compare the rear view in figure 210).

III. Key points 1. The waist and hips turn right and the left heel closes in, but the upper body must not lean forward or backward. The coccyx must be held centred, the central axis must not bend, and the turning must not sway, so that the inner strength can reach the nimble, lively use that supports all eight directions.

2. The left hand, following the right turn of waist and hips, moves from left to right in coordination, while the right hand arcs upward from below; the two hands cross and embrace in

front of the chest, and must be full, neither loose and scattered nor shrunk.

3. To thrust out the right leg one must first lift the leg and concentrate the strength at the knee joint, stretching the ligaments of the hips (the lifted knee should generally be no lower than hip level); thus the leg can thrust to the ribs and meet the requirement of the application.

4. After the thrust, when the body is supported on the single leg, the body must be upright, with the upper and lower essentially in one line. Chen Xin says, "When the body method is correct the body's pillar is upright, leaning nowhere, containing emptiness and spirit within." Therefore at that moment, from the crown of the head to the perineum, there must always be a vertical line; leaning forward or backward, tilting left or right, all fail the requirement of the body method. This requires the whole body to relax so that the movement and the shifting of waist and legs become harmonious and coordinated.

IV. Requirements 1. The direction must be true. From High Pat on the Horse with Threading Palm facing east, turn the waist and hips and thrust out with the right leg. The direction of the thrust is due west, and the face is also toward the west.

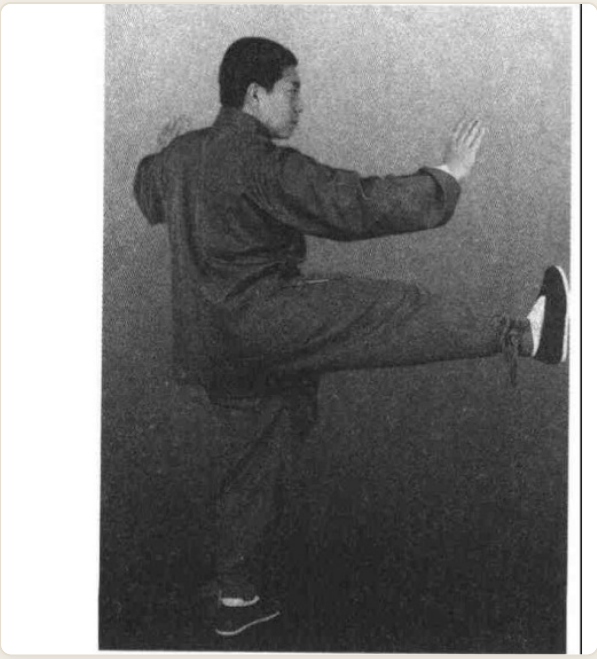
2. The stance must be steady; when thrusting the leg one must not pull the body about and set it askew.

3. The foot must arrive and the hand must arrive.

4. Empty and full must be clear. From the moment the left toes turn inward, the weight shifts onto the left leg, so that the right leg may lift its knee nimbly.

V. Common errors, their causes, and how to correct them 1. Error: when the left foot turns inward, the weight shifts to the right. The main cause is that the application is not deeply understood. The opponent strikes across at me from behind my right; if I shift my weight right as I turn, my body leans right, and I thus deliver myself to be struck. At the same time this hinders a rapid turning of the body, and so increases...

图 445B



The settled single-leg support in profile: after the right leg thrusts out the body is supported on one leg, upper and lower in one line, the two palms spread to left and right, and the waist and hips turned right.

...increases the difficulty of observing the opponent's movements, which is unfavourable for meeting the attack quickly. Moreover, with the weight shifted right the two feet are double-weighted, which is unfavourable for both attack and defence, and because the load on the legs is reduced the benefit of the training is also reduced. Correction: the left foot turns inward, the weight remains on the left foot, the waist and hips turn, and the upper body turns toward the south-west; this then creates favourable conditions for the kick that follows.

2. Error: the two hands cross in front of the chest too tightly and too flat. The main causes are, first, that one attends only to the arcing movement of the left hand and neglects the movement of the right hand, and second, that the application is not sufficiently understood. Tightness and flatness both narrow the protective range of the two hands, making one easy to attack. Correction: attend to fullness, and the right hand must go outward and upward.

3. Error: the direction of the kick is not true. The main cause is generally that the left foot does not turn in enough, so that the direction of the kick leans toward the south-west; secondarily, a failure to understand the application. The opponent attacks from behind my right, so the main direction of my kick should be to the rear, that is, due west. Correction: the key is that the left foot must turn inward by more than 90 degrees; then the right foot's thrust will not only find the true direction easily but will not be awkward.

4. Error: the movement is uneven, sometimes fast and sometimes slow. The main cause is insufficient strength in the legs: the foot turns in quickly, the knee lifts slowly, the kick goes out

quickly. Taijiquan is one of the internal martial arts, and it requires "from within to without" and "drawing the within out by the without" in order to raise the benefit of the training; under the guidance of intent it requires that the movements be light and unhurried, neither slow nor hurried. Therefore one must "let the form follow the movement of intent", striving to make inner and outer join, intent and breath link, and to leave no place of interruption or of fast and slow. Correction: the foot must turn in with the turning of the waist, the left foot settling firm, then lift the leg lightly and slowly, and as the left leg gradually rises slowly thrust out the right foot.

VI. Teaching and practice methods 1. The teacher observes the degree of the left foot's inward turn from the south, and the direction of the kick from the west.

2. The emphasis in teaching should be placed on the kicking leg: practise much and repeatedly supporting on the left foot alone and lifting the right leg to kick, in order to strengthen the legs and attain the requirements of steadiness and nimbleness.

VII. Technical analysis 1. In the Cross-Shaped Leg, what defends is the hand and what attacks is the leg; the hand merely bars, and the application lies chiefly in the leg.

2. If the kicking leg is not practised well it is easy to hold the breath. The breathing of Yang-style taijiquan is required to be entirely natural: one should adopt the natural method of breathing — long, even, fine, slow, neither hurried nor sluggish.

BOOK PAGE 225

Posture Seventy-Four — Step Forward and Point at the Groin with the Fist

Posture Seventy-Four — Step Forward and Point at the Groin with the Fist

I. Application Continuing from the previous posture. If the opponent withdraws his hand, I immediately set the right foot down while the left foot advances and the knee bends and settles firm. At this moment, if the opponent again kicks up from below with his right foot, I quickly use my left hand to deflect the opponent's right foot outward past my left knee, and the right hand immediately closes into a fist and strikes (points) at the opponent's groin, the body leaning very slightly forward.

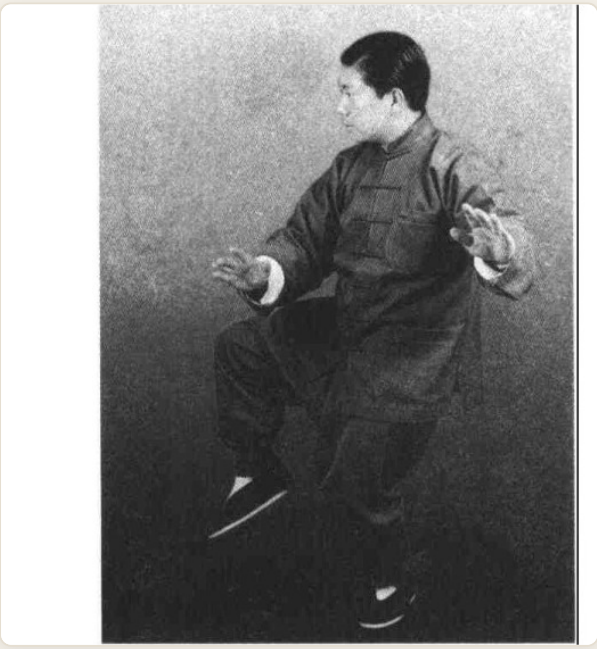
II. Sequence of movement 1. The left leg gradually crouches, the right foot is set down and held suspended, and the body gradually turns right. At the same time the right palm arcs from the right downward, passes in front of the upper abdomen and circles to the left; as it circles the arm rotates inward so that the centre of the palm turns downward; the left palm, too, sinks as the left leg crouches and the body turns right, and arcs forward and upward to the right (see the first figure on this page).

2. The body continues to turn right, and the right foot steps forward and to the right (west by north), the heel touching first; then the right toes swing outward 45 degrees, and as the weight gradually shifts onto the right leg the whole foot presses down firmly. With the turn of the body the right palm moves from the left upward and past the chest to the right; as it moves the arm rotates outward so that the centre of the palm gradually turns downward. The left palm arcs across to the front of the left chest (see the second figure on this page).

3. The weight gradually shifts entirely onto the right leg, and the left foot steps forward from the inner side of the right ankle, the heel touching first, while the body continues to turn slightly right. At the same time the right palm, following the turn, continues right, back and forward in an arc and is drawn in beside the right waist and closed into a fist, while the left palm brushes downward in an arc from front to right and then left. The eyes look level ahead, and the gaze must attend to the left palm (see the third and fourth figures on this page).

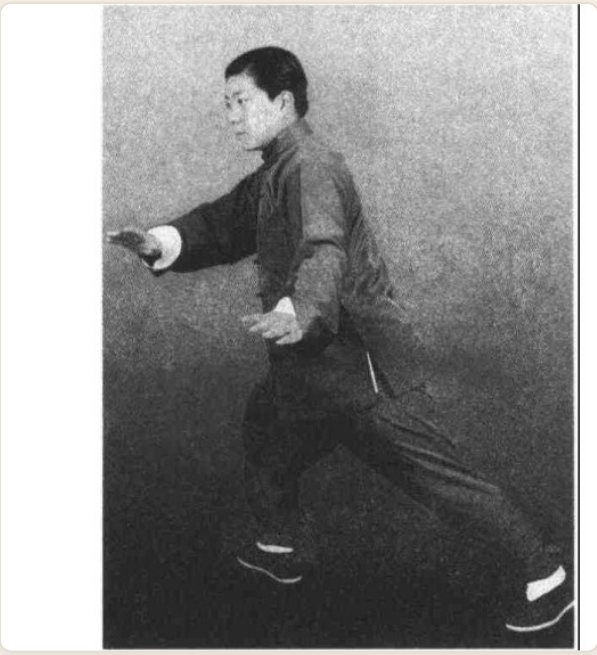
4. The body continues to turn gradually left, and the weight gradually shifts onto the left leg until the whole foot presses down firmly, the left leg bending and the right leg pressing out to form the left bow stance. At the same time the left palm brushes in an arc to the front of the left knee and comes to the side of the left knee, while the right fist is driven forward and down at the height of the abdomen, the body folding slightly at the waist. The eyes look level ahead, and the gaze must attend...

图 446



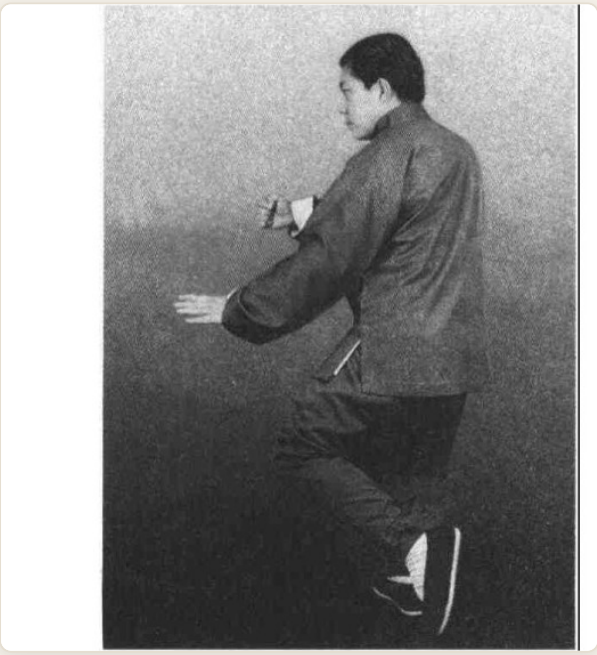
The opening of Step Forward and Point at the Groin with the Fist: the body turns right, the right palm arcs from the right downward, passes in front of the upper abdomen and circles left, and the left palm accordingly arcs forward.

图 447



The right foot steps forward and to the right; the right palm passes the chest and moves right with its centre turning downward, and the left palm arcs across to the front of the left chest.

图 448



The left foot steps forward from the inner side of the right ankle; the right palm arcs and is drawn in beside the right waist and closed into a fist, and the left palm brushes downward in an arc.

...and the left palm's brushing to the left and the right fist's striking out (see the fifth figure on this page).

III. Key points 1. As the right foot descends there must be a downward "sending" by the left leg (bending the left leg), and attention must be paid to keeping the upper body upright.

2. As the left foot advances, when the waist and hips turn left the left hand's brushing of the knee and the right fist's forward strike must be performed at the same time, with upper and lower, left and right mutually drawing and linking one another, so that the movement is not scattered. If the turn of the body is too great, it will overshoot.

3. The right fist's forward strike must be coordinated with the left leg's bending, the right leg's pressing out and the body's slight forward lean, so that body arrives, hand arrives and step arrives.

IV. Requirements 1. Empty and full must be clear: as the right foot descends the left leg must sink and settle firm.

2. The line of the fist's travel must be correct: it should be slightly curved, driven from the waist forward and slightly downward.

3. While brushing, the weight is on the right leg.

V. Common errors, their causes, and how to correct them 1. Error: the fist is closed too early. The main cause is that the application is not sufficiently understood. Correction: the strike follows immediately upon the brushing movement, so the fist should be closed at the moment when the left hand has finished brushing and the right hand has arced to the region of the waist; before that the fist should not be closed.

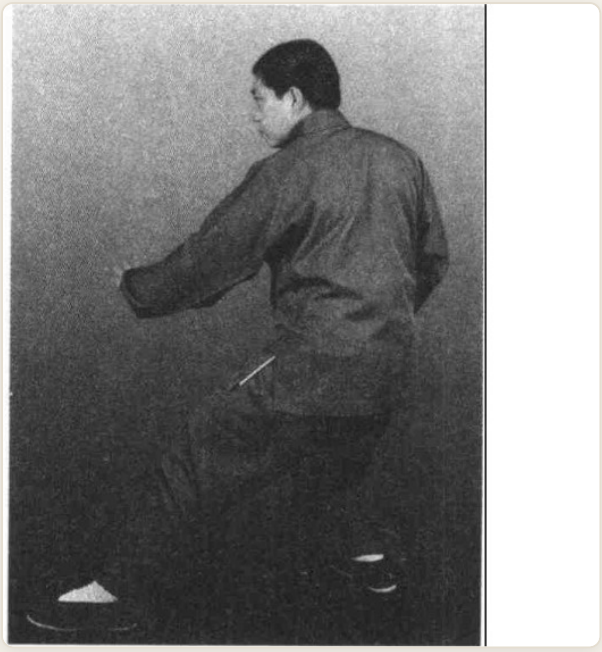
2. Error: the upper body does not lean slightly forward but instead drops the head and bends forward at the waist. The main cause is inattention to keeping the coccyx centred; this is a defect of the body method. Correction: although the body leans slightly forward, "the hundred meetings and the central pole, one breath running through" is required, forming a straight line from the crown of the head to the perineum.

3. Error: the two hands' movement pauses, especially as the right foot descends. The main cause is that the left leg has not sunk and settled firm; in order to keep the body balanced the hand movement is therefore stopped, causing upper and lower to be disconnected. Correction: settle the left leg firm, and let the two hands move in an arc with the turning of the waist.

VI. Teaching and practice methods 1. In this movement the linking movement must first be done well: repeatedly coach the sinking and slight bending of the left leg as the right leg descends, to lay a good foundation for the movements that follow.

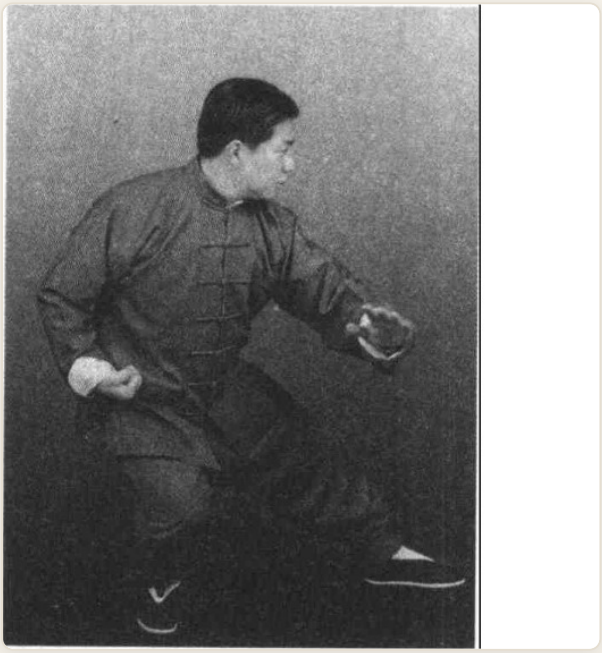
2. Explain clearly that the upper body stays upright, and that as the right fist...

图 449A



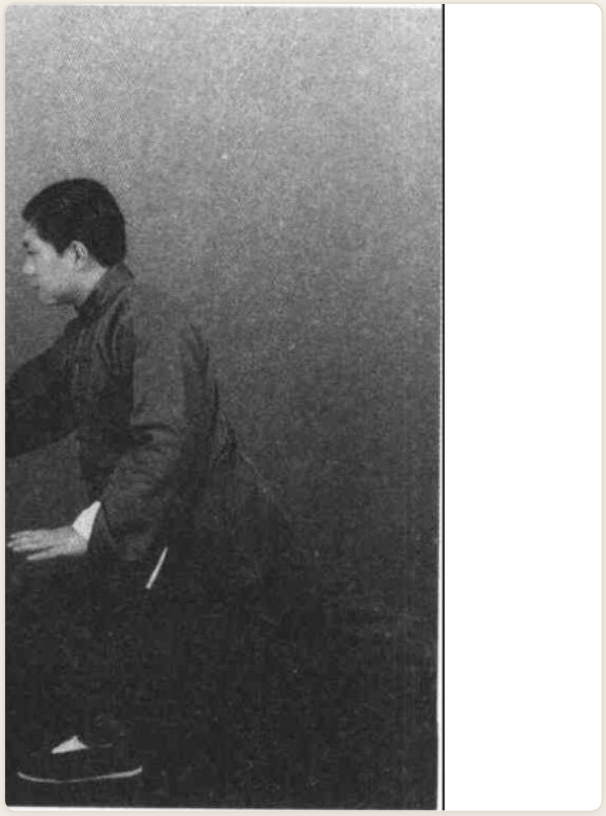
Step Forward and Point at the Groin with the Fist in transition: the right palm arcs right, back and forward and is drawn in beside the right waist and closed into a fist, while the left palm brushes downward in an arc from front to right and then left.

图 449B



The left palm brushes to the side of the left knee, and the right fist is driven forward and down from beside the waist, the body folding slightly at the waist.

图 450



The settled Point at the Groin: the left bow stance, the left palm brushed to the side of the left knee, and the right fist driven forward and down at the height of the abdomen, the eyes looking straight ahead.

Striking forward, when the body turns into a slight forward lean, the head must not drop and the waist must not be curved — let the practitioner understand that a curved waist blocks the flow of qi and blood; explain and demonstrate this repeatedly.

3. The teacher must constantly correct the lateral distance of the stepping and the direction the foot points during practice, so that the hip-root and the limbs relate well to one another and the stance is consequently solid.

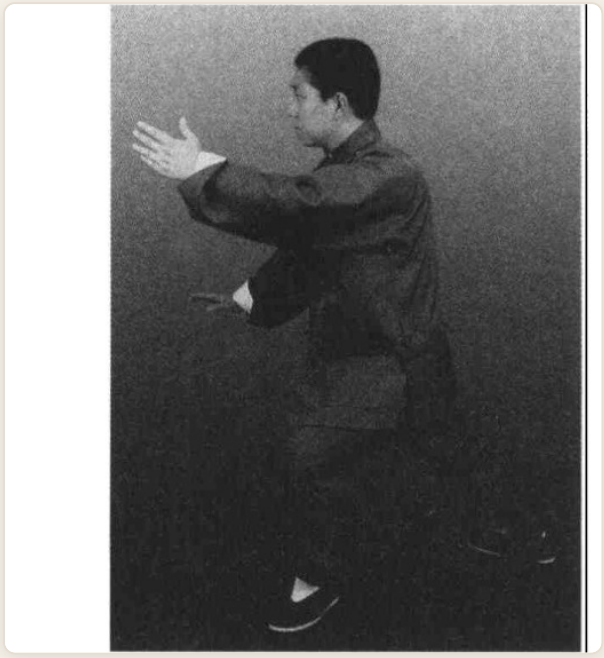
VII. Technical Analysis Advance Step and Strike Toward the Crotch has two movements: first, the parry of the left hand; second, the forward strike of the right hand — and two steps must be taken. This requires the movements to be continuous, upper and lower following one another. One must in particular train well the "calm mind and applied intent": before moving, dismiss all distracting thoughts, as if the ears heard nothing and the eyes saw nothing, so as to be in a state free of thought and worry. Once moving, concentrate the whole spirit on using intent to guide the performance of every movement. Therefore, in practising the form, mind comes first and body second, and one should use intent and not force, so that inner and outer become one.

Posture Seventy-Five — Step Up and Grasp the Bird's Tail

Posture Seventy-Five — Step Up and Grasp the Bird's Tail

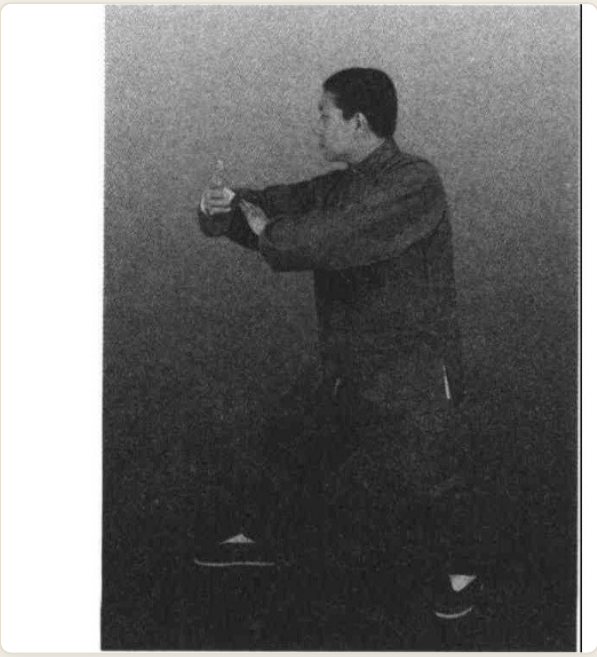
I. Application Same as Posture Three, Grasp the Bird's Tail: see the first figure on this page (the same as figure 131), and the next three figures (the same as figures 8 to 17); the sequence continues on the next page.

图 451



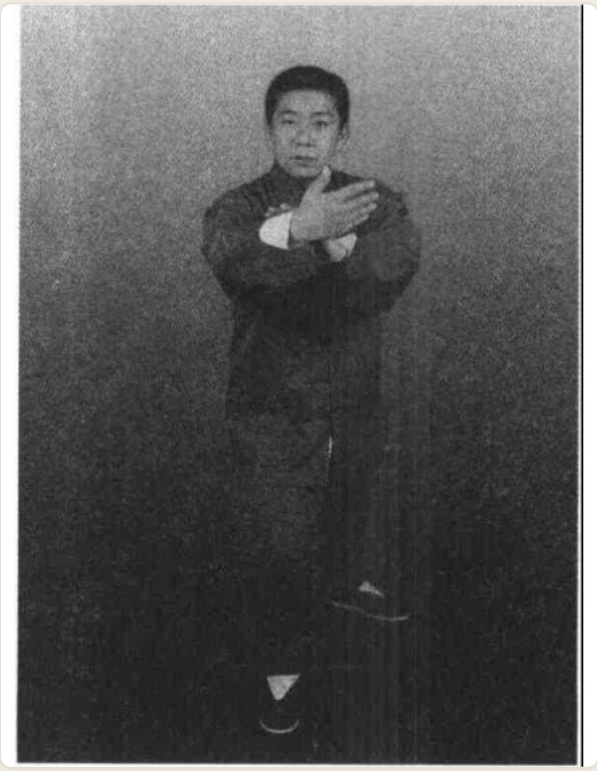
Step Up and Grasp the Bird's Tail, opening: the body straightens and turns left, the left toe swings outward and presses down firmly, both palms close slightly to the right with the turn.

图 452



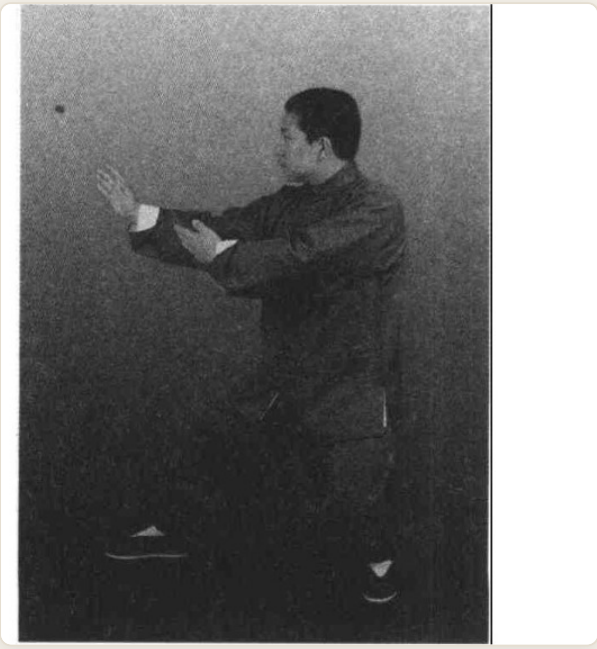
The weight shifts onto the left leg, the right foot lifts and steps forward, both hands ward off to the left with the turn.

图 453



The right foot steps and presses down firmly, both hands join before the chest.

图 454

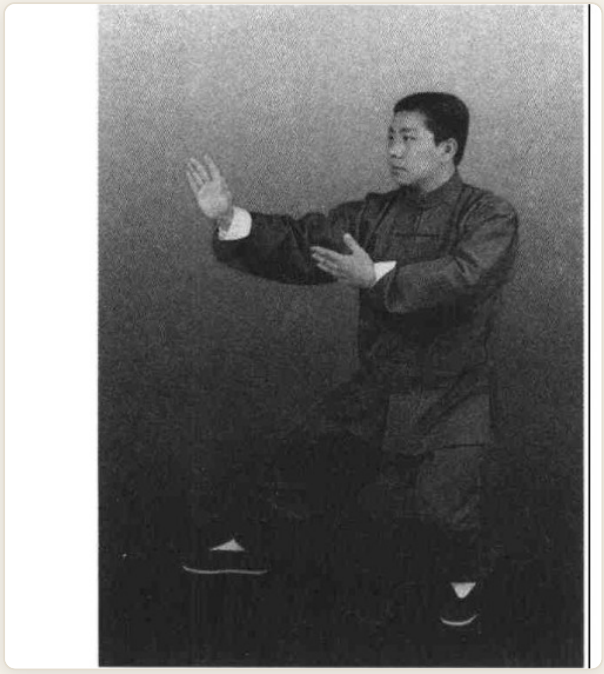


Both hands ward off to the left with the waist, forming the left ward-off.

II. Course of Movement The body straightens and turns left, the left toe swings outward 45° and presses down firmly; the weight Gradually shift the whole weight onto the left leg and lift the right leg forward. At the same time, the left palm bends at the elbow and moves in an arc from the left upward to before the left chest, palm facing to the right; the right fist becomes a palm and scoops in an arc from the front toward the left to below the left forearm, and as it scoops, the arm turns outward so that the palm turns to face obliquely up-left and joins the left palm, both arms forming an arc. The eyes glance at the right palm, then turn to the left palm and look level to the front — see the first figure on the previous page (the same as figure 131).

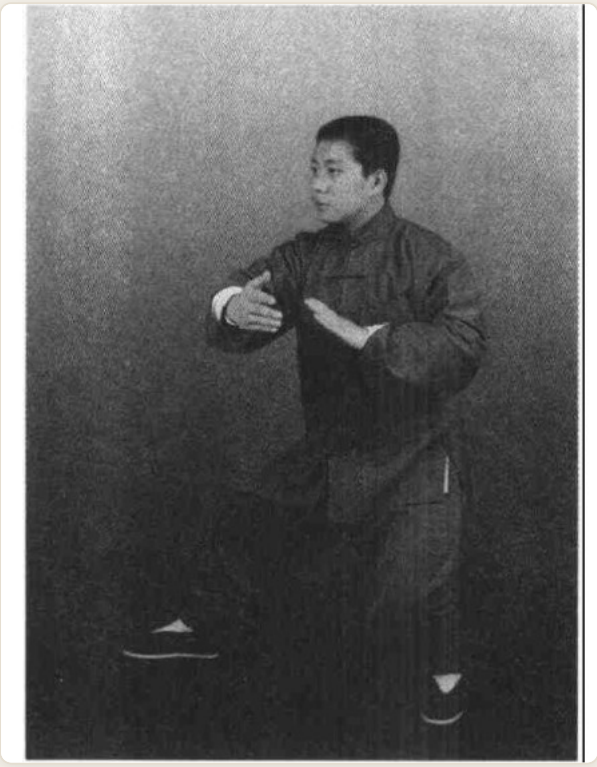
All the other sections are the same as Posture Three, Grasp the Bird's Tail.

图 455



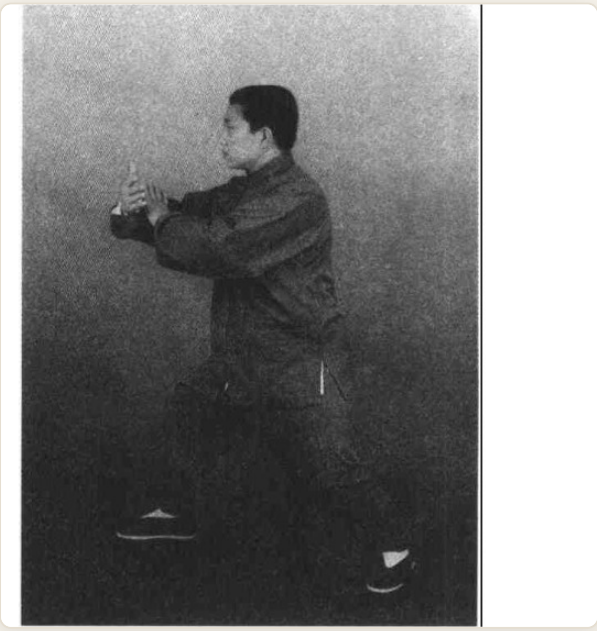
Step Up and Grasp the Bird's Tail: the weight gradually shifts onto the left leg, the right leg lifts, the left palm bends at the elbow and moves up before the left chest, the right palm scoops left to below the left forearm.

图 456



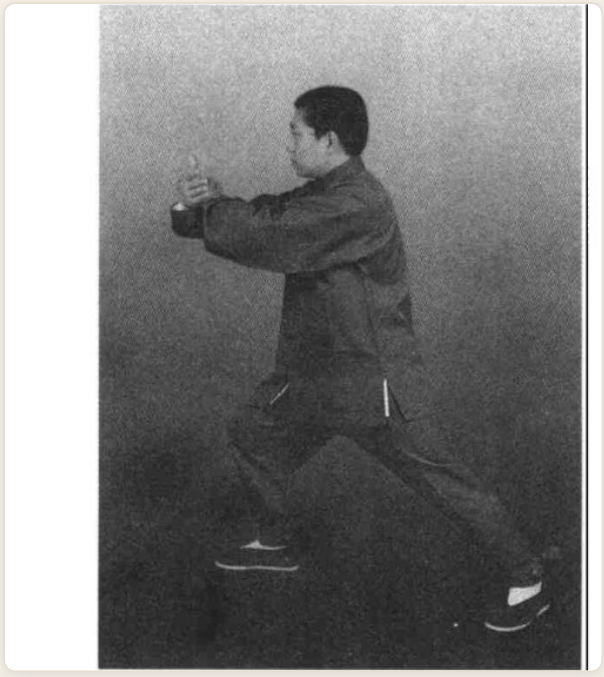
The right palm scoops to below the left forearm, the two palms join, both arms form an arc.

图 457



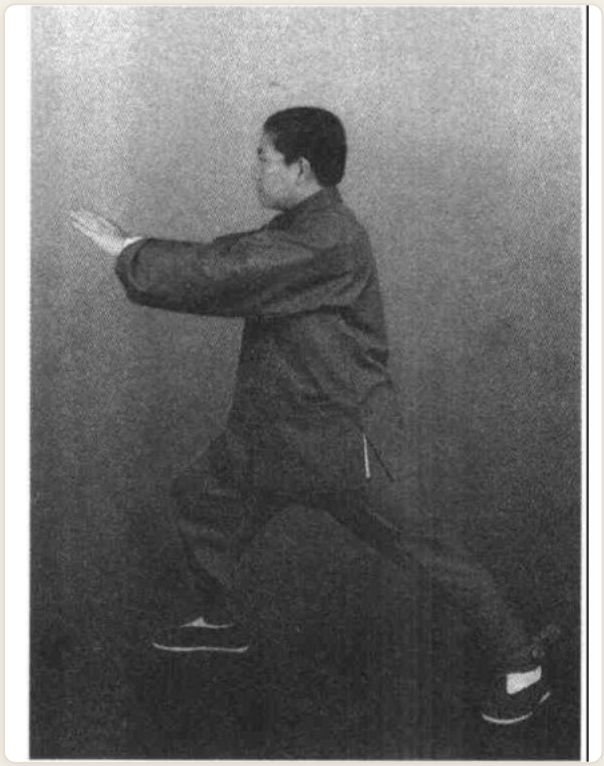
Both palms turn over as the arms rotate outward, the left palm leading, the right palm attached to the inner side of the left wrist.

图 458



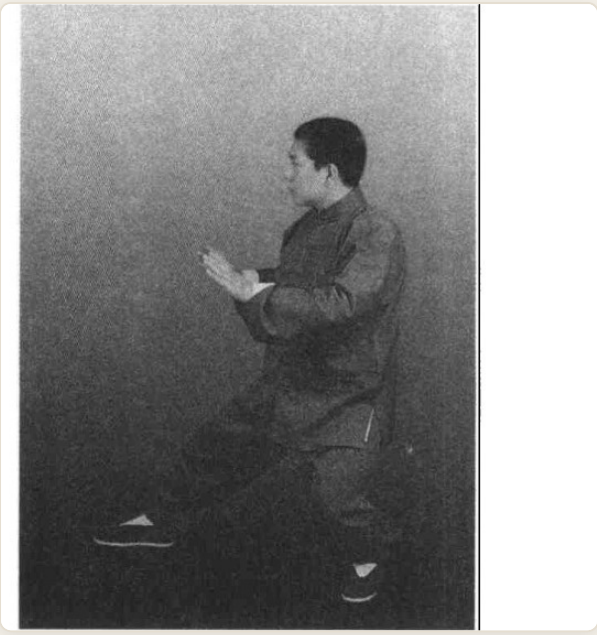
The waist turns left, both palms ward off forward with it, forming the left ward-off.

图 459



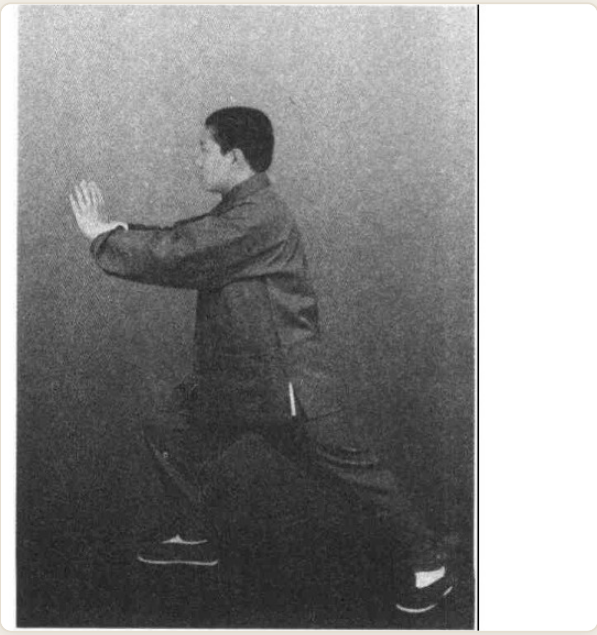
The weight moves forward, both palms ward off to the front-left, wrists seated and palms extended.

图 460



Both hands roll back: the palms turn right with the waist, the left hand extends forward, the right hand draws back.

图 461



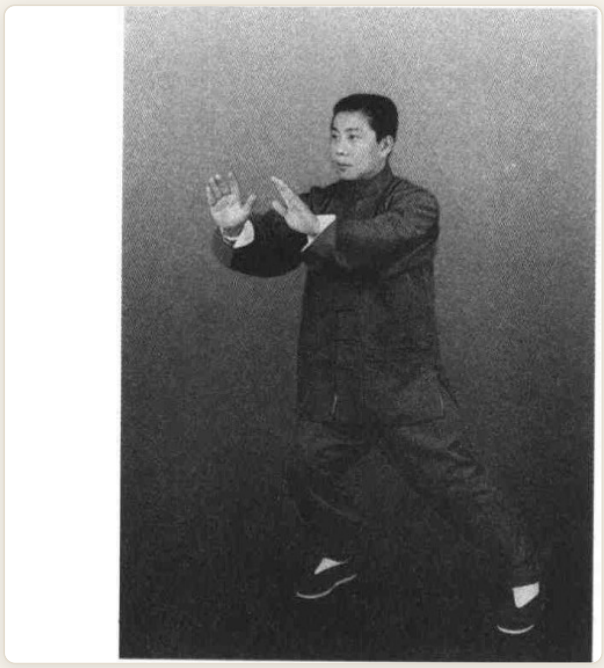
Grasp the Bird's Tail, final position: a left bow stance, both palms press forward, the eyes look to the front.

Posture Seventy-Six — Single Whip

Posture Seventy-Six — Single Whip

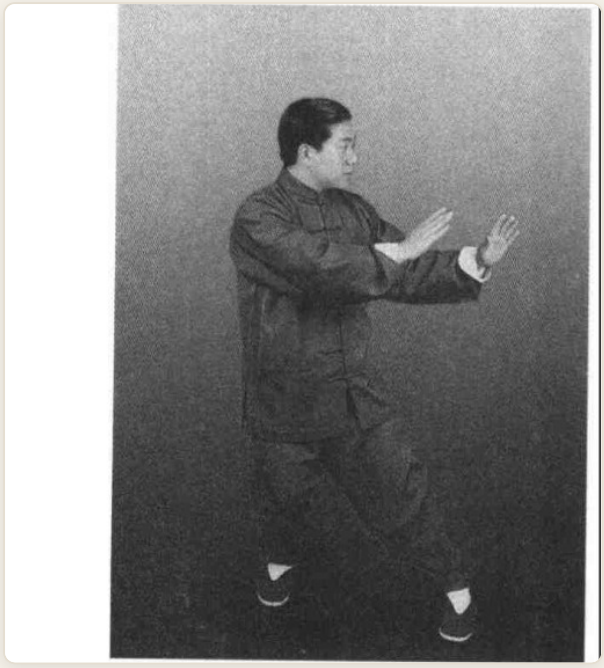
The application, the course of movement and all the other sections are the same as Posture Four, Single Whip: see the first to the seventh figures on this page (the same as figures 18 to 23).

图 462



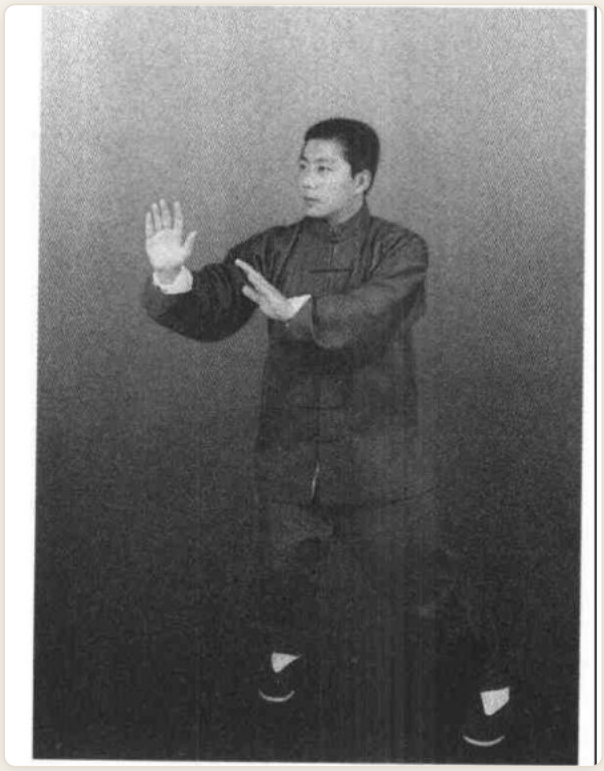
Single Whip, opening: taken over from the final position of Grasp the Bird's Tail, both hands join before the chest.

图 463



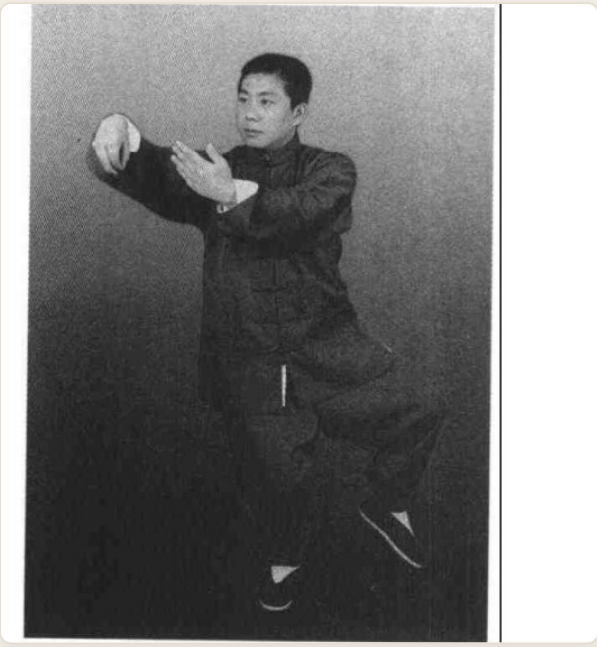
Both hands turn right with the waist, the right palm becomes a hook hand and extends to the front-right.

图 464



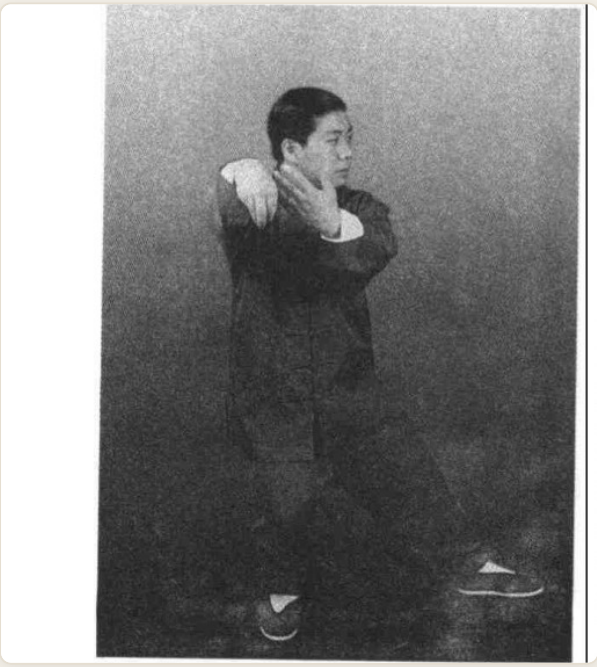
The left foot steps out to the front-left, the left palm pushes out to the front-left with the turn.

图 465



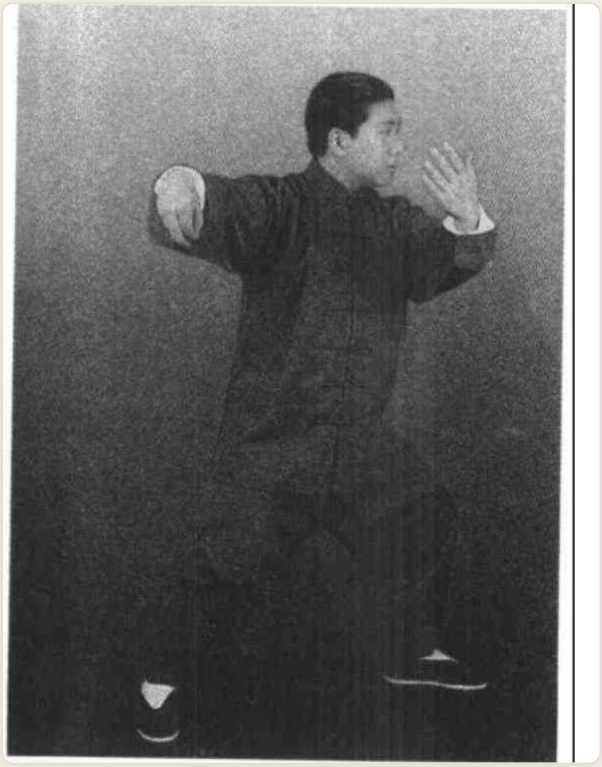
The left palm pushes out to the front-left, the right hook hand is to the right-rear, the eyes look at the left palm.

图 466A



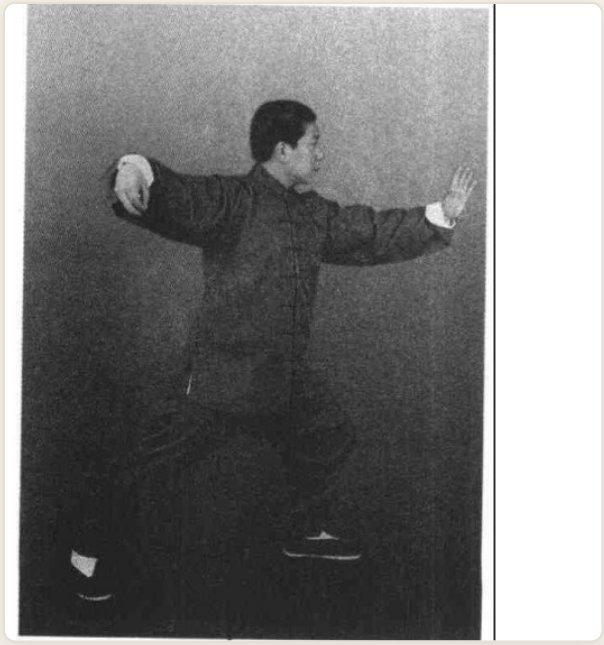
Single Whip, transition: the right hook hand braces behind, the left palm pushes forward, the two arms pull against each other front and back.

图 466B



The left palm pushes out with the wrist seated, palm facing forward, the right hook hand to the right-rear and slightly higher.

图 467



Single Whip, final position: a left bow stance, the left palm pushes forward, the right hook hand braces behind, the eyes look past the left palm.

BOOK PAGE 230

Posture Seventy-Seven — Push Down

Posture Seventy-Seven — Push Down

The application, the course of movement and all the other sections are the same as Posture Fifty-Seven, Push Down: see the first figure on this page (the same as figure 349) and the second figure on this page (the same as figure 350).

Posture Seventy-Eight — Step Up to Seven Stars

I. Application Continuing from the previous posture. If the opponent chops downward with the right hand from above, I immediately rise, turn the body slightly left, step forward and advance, both hands become fists and at once gather and cross to form the character "seven," the eye of the fists facing obliquely inward to ward off. Striking straight at the opponent's chest with the fist is also permissible.

Another application is this:

The opponent strikes up and down with the right hand; I perform Step Up to Seven Stars and block with both hands. The opponent then drives straight at my chest and abdomen with the left

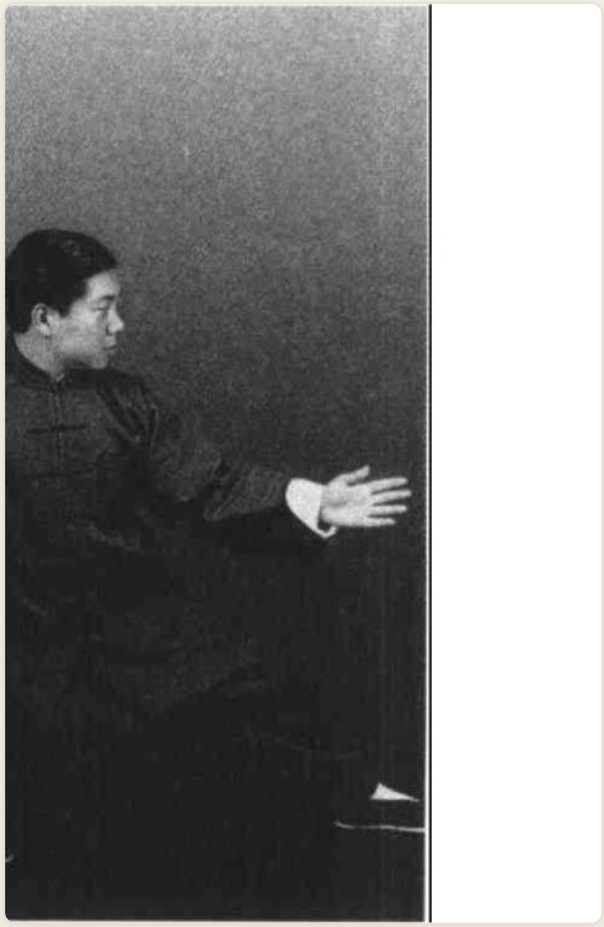
fist; I at once change step, separate both hands (left hand up, right hand down) and immediately strike straight out with the press.

II. Course of Movement 1. The waist and hips gradually turn left, the weight moves forward, the body gradually rises forward and turns left, the left toe swings outward, the left leg bends at the knee and bows forward, the right leg presses; the weight gradually shifts forward onto the left leg. The left palm, warding with the fingers, gradually scoops upward, and the right hand drops slightly (see the third figure on this page).

2. The weight continues to move forward, the left leg bends at the knee and the whole body weight is supported by the left leg; the upper body continues to turn gradually left, the right heel leaves the ground first, the foot lifts forward past the inner side of the left ankle, and at the same time the left palm scoops up to before the chest while the right hand follows the right leg lifting forward and moves from back to front to before the waist (see the fourth figure on this page).

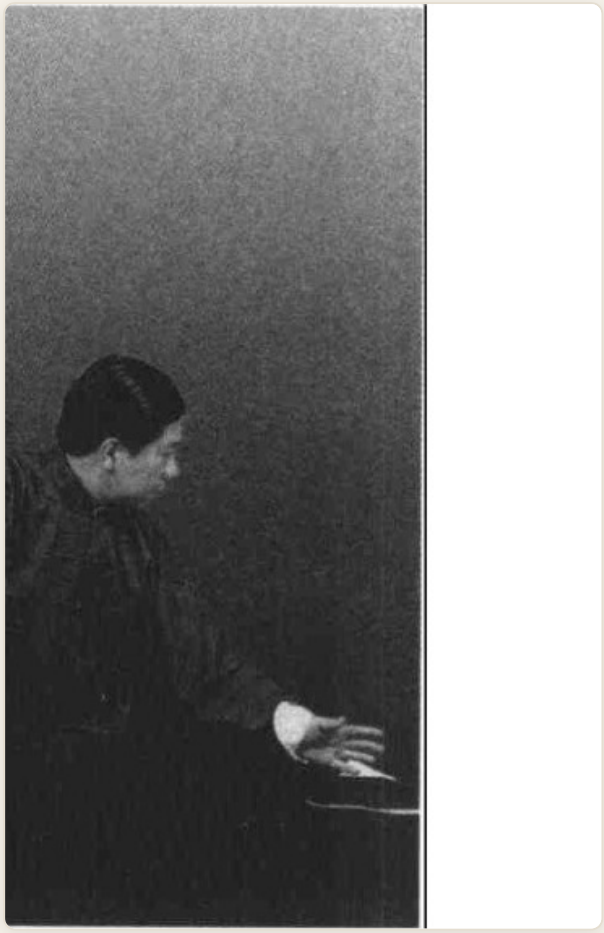
3. The right leg steps forward half a step and touches the ground with the ball of the foot, forming a right empty stance; at the same time the left palm continues to move forward, and as the two fists are about to meet they close. The right fist crosses forward below the left fist, and both ward off forward and up together. The two fists form the character "seven," level with the forehead, the eyes of the fists facing obliquely up. The eyes look level to the front, the gaze attending to the forward ward-off of the crossed fists (see the fifth figure on this page).

图 468



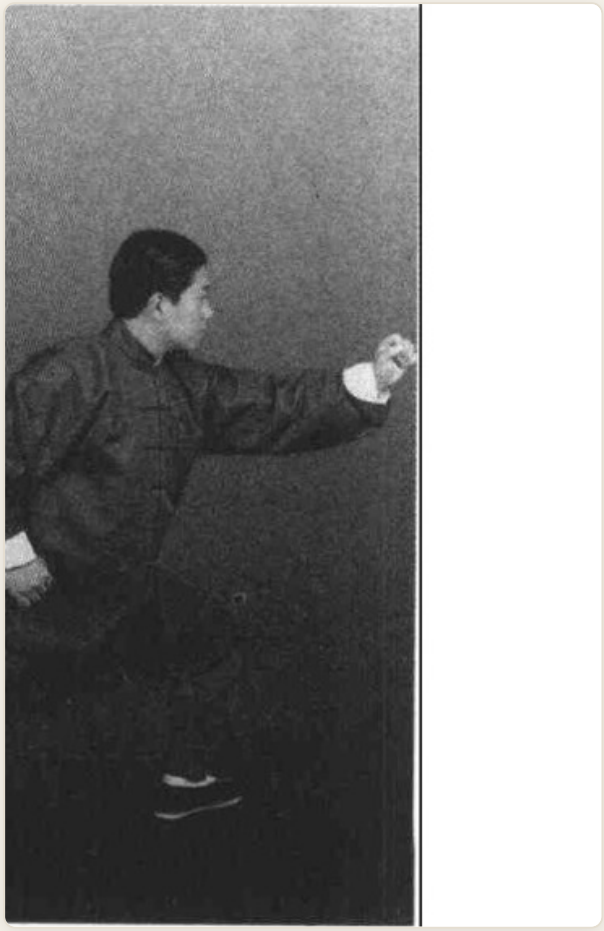
Push Down: from the final position of Single Whip the body sinks, the right leg bends at the knee and sinks, the left leg straightens into a drop stance, the left palm extends forward and presses down.

图 469



Push Down, transition: the weight descends, the left palm extends along the inner side of the left leg and threads out, the eyes look at the forward hand.

图 470



Step Up to Seven Stars, opening: the weight gradually shifts onto the left leg, the left palm, warding with the fingers, scoops upward, the right hand drops slightly.

III. Key Points 1. In rising from the left drop stance, the movement must be led by the waist and hips: the left toe swings outward, the left leg gradually bends, the right leg gradually presses, the waist and hips relax, and the upper body moves level, forming a bow stance — do not rise by straightening both legs.

2. In passing from Push Down into the right empty stance, the body must not sway or lean forward; the upper body must stay upright and the waist and hips must be relaxed — do not stiffen the waist in order to keep balance.

3. When the two fists ward off forward and up, take care not to make it a forward flicking-up movement. The back of the fist follows the forearm; the whole back of the hand does not face outward.

4. When the two fists ward off forward, the shoulders must not rise or lock because the fists have crossed. The two arms must form an arc, attaining stored curvature and fullness.

5. One must be still altogether when still and move altogether when moving, and must change the inner force under the requirement of containing closure within opening and separation within closing; only thus can one train to the point of "touched, it turns freely, and never lacks power." The famous masters of Taijiquan in former times reached the technical state of "wherever it is leaned upon, there strike."

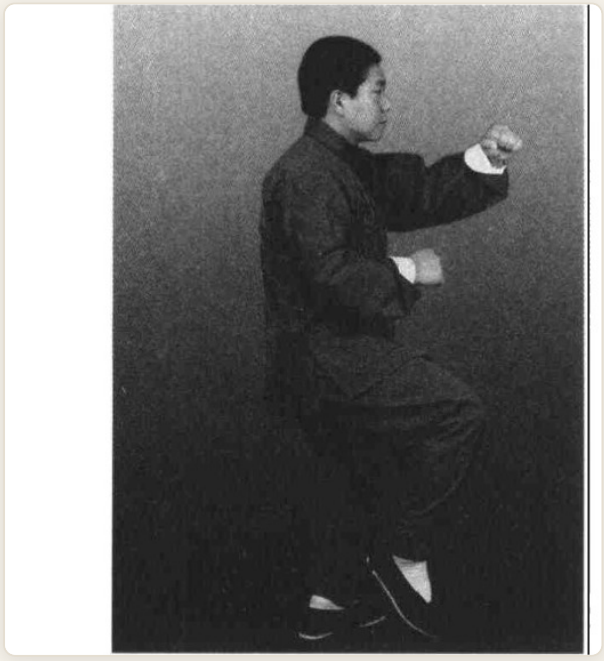
IV. Requirements 1. In passing from Push Down into this posture's right empty stance, each posture must carry through from the one before. When Push Down connects to Step Up to Seven Stars, the Push Down must not come to a dead stop — there must be "force broken but intent unbroken," "broken and then rejoined"; that is, the Push Down appears to pause, but in fact the intent is still focused and the inner force is still turning. Hence the requirement that the link and the transfer be nimble.

2. Rising from Push Down into the right empty stance of Step Up to Seven Stars, empty and full must be clearly distinguished, the step must not drag, and the body must not sway.

3. In the right empty stance, the waist and crotch must sink and be full — round and yet empty; the crotch must not be pinched into a pointed "inverted V."

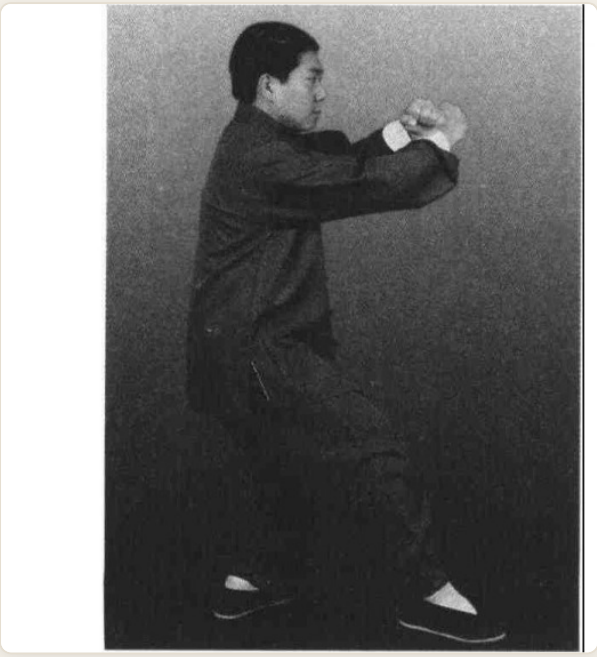
4. In changing both hands into fists, the fists must close as they change.

图 471



Step Up to Seven Stars, transition: the weight shifts onto the left leg, the right foot lifts past the inner side of the left ankle, the left palm scoops up to before the chest, the right hand moves forward.

图 472



Step Up to Seven Stars, final position: a right empty stance, the two fists crossed to form the character "seven," level with the forehead, the eyes look to the front.

V. Errors, Causes, Corrections 1. Error: the crossed fists are too close to the chest, too far, too high or too low. The main cause is insufficient clarity about the application. One must know that the opponent chops down from above with the right hand: if I close the fists too close, the head is easily attacked. Since the opponent's attacking hand has already reached my head, if the fists are too far the arms straighten and the force is insufficient. If too high, my chest and abdomen are too "empty" and exposed to the opponent and easily attacked. Correction: repeatedly check and practise, and the fists are slightly higher than the shoulders and the two arms form an arc.

2. Error: in the right empty stance the right foot presses down firmly, producing double weighting. The main cause is that both legs are weak and the right foot shares the body weight in the hope of lightening the load on the left foot. A further cause is failure to understand the martial meaning. If both feet stand firm, then in advancing or retreating two movements are needed — first shift the weight, and only then can the right foot advance or retreat — and thus the moment is lost and one is beaten while passive. Correction: let the left leg bear the whole body weight, and repeatedly move the right leg forward and back, to strengthen the leg and experience empty and full.

3. Error: the upper body leans forward on rising. The main cause is that the left leg is weak, so one wants to use the forward lean of the upper body to lift the rear right leg. Correction: on rising, bow the left leg forward so that the weight shifts forward onto the left leg. But the fundamental method still lies in training the muscular strength of the legs: practise more the rising movement that connects Push Down to Step Up to Seven Stars. If elderly or weak, one

may take a higher frame — that is, a larger angle of bend in the left leg — which lowers the difficulty and makes the movement easy to complete.

4. Error: when the two fists gather and cross into the character "seven," the position of the fists is wrong — some have the eye of the fist facing inward, some facing up. The main cause is shallow experience of the application. The opponent chops down from above with the right hand; I ward off forward and up with the two fists, and so the backs of the fists must follow the forearms and the eyes of the fists must face slightly obliquely up. If the eyes of the fists face up or the centres of the fists face inward, the former has no ward-off force and the latter causes the elbows to lift, so that one cannot relax the shoulders and drop the elbows. Correction: the eyes of the fists should face slightly obliquely up.

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods 1. The teacher observes from different angles the lateral distance between the legs, and the position and direction of the two fists, at the final position.

2. The emphasis should be placed on the rising from Push Down into Step Up to Seven Stars, because at this point the leg muscles bear the heaviest load. Above all one must train shifting the weight forward.

3. Teach so that the movement is even. Sudden speeding up is especially easy on rising. The forward movement of the two arms is also apt to speed up; one must be neither slow nor hurried, and within a single movement the hands and feet must move evenly, and throughout the whole Taijiquan set every posture must be even.

4. Paired practice combining the application: A — takes the final position of Push Down. B — stands directly in front and chops down from above with the right hand. A — bows the left leg, makes the right empty stance, both hands change to fists forward and up, gathering and crossing to ward off outward in the character "seven." The two then exchange and repeat.

VII. Technical Analysis 1. In the complete Yang-style Taijiquan set there are two "Push Down" postures: one follows "Golden Rooster Stands on One Leg," the other precedes this movement, "Step Up to Seven Stars." When the weight moves forward, "the tailbone centred and upright" is required, which means the two hip joints must be set straight and upright, advancing and retreating together, or exchanging evenly, striving to be neither leaning nor tilted, aligned above with the two shoulder joints and moving in the same direction — conforming to the requirement that "shoulders and hips unite."

2. In passing from Push Down into Step Up to Seven Stars, as the weight moves forward and one bows the left knee and lifts the right leg to rise, the body's centre of gravity moves far from the support point; if the frame is low, the amount of exercise grows even greater. Beginners may therefore take a higher frame, bringing the centre of gravity nearer, which also lightens the load on the legs and makes rising easier.

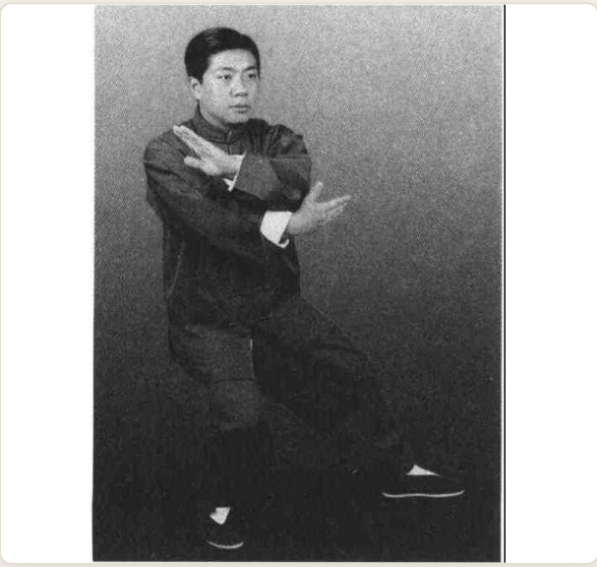
Posture Seventy-Nine — Retreat a Step and Ride the Tiger

Posture Seventy-Nine — Retreat a Step and Ride the Tiger

I. Application Continuing from the previous posture. If the opponent presses in with both hands, I at once stick my two wrists to the inner sides of the opponent's two wrists; the left hand spreads open toward the lower left, the right hand sticks and rises past the upper right, and both my palms turn outward with it. The right foot then withdraws a step backward, comes down and sits firmly, the waist sinks and the force goes down, and the left foot lifts with it, the toe touching the ground, forming the ride-the-tiger shape, so that the whole strength of the opponent falls into emptiness. At this moment, fierce as a tiger though the opponent be, at the slightest turn he comes under my control.

II. Course of Movement 1. The waist turns right about 70° or more, the right foot withdraws a step to the right-rear, the weight gradually shifts onto the right leg; at the same time the two fists become palms and separate, both palms descending together, the right palm following the turn in an arc slightly downward and then, as the back of the hand turns outward, moving slightly upward to before the right chest, while the left palm follows the turn in an arc to a point near the crook of the right elbow (see the first figure on this page).

图 473



Retreat a Step and Ride the Tiger, opening: the waist turns right, the right foot withdraws a step to the right-rear, the two fists become palms and separate, the right palm arcs up to before the right chest, the left palm moves to the crook of the right elbow.

2. The waist turns back to the left, the body still faces forward (east); the left foot lifts slightly and comes down essentially in the same place, touching the ground with the toe, forming a left

empty stance. At the same time both hands continue to separate left and right: the right palm, as the body turns right, goes from front to down, then as the body turns back to face forward rises and opens up to the upper right; as it lifts, the right arm rotates inward so that the palm faces front-right, the fingers obliquely up, slightly higher than the head, moving to the upper right of the body, while the left palm falls in an arc to the lower left beside the left hip, palm facing down, fingers pointing forward. The gaze first attends to the right palm and looks to the front-right past the right elbow, then, after attending to both palms lifting and tearing down, looks forward (see the second and third figures on this page).

III. Key Points 1. Turning the body and withdrawing the step, and separating the two hands, must be done at the same time. This is a process of neutralizing: the opponent presses in, I turn the waist and withdraw the step, so that the pressing force that came straight in falls into emptiness. The waist and crotch are the key to regulating the amount of movement and to strengthening the explosive force; hence the rotation of the waist is required to be relaxed and sinking, straight and upright, without swaying or swinging — otherwise the sticking and the tearing will lack force.

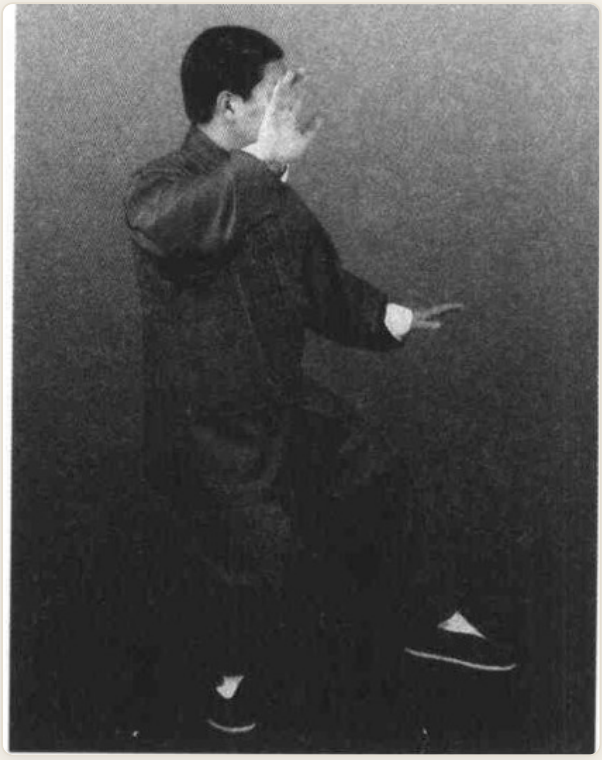
2. Do not separate the two hands too fast; at the start the separation is of small extent. While turning the waist and withdrawing the step, the left hand is still at the crook of the right elbow, and only when the opponent's pressing force begins to waver do I separate the two hands further — the left hand tearing down, the right hand sticking and lifting (the right upper arm essentially level with the shoulder, the right forearm slanting). Note that as the right hand pulls up, the waist must lower.

3. When withdrawing the step backward, note where the right foot lands — do not place it on the same line. The foot is the root of the stance and the stepping; if the root is unsteady, then at the slightest deviation the stance and the stepping must fall into disorder. Victory lies in advancing to seize position; freedom from defeat lies in retreating a step to avoid the point — so the correct placement of the foot when withdrawing is very important.

4. When the right foot retreats and sits firmly, the waist and hips must sink, for only thus can one seize the moment and the position and keep the lower body stable. On the basis of relaxation, attend to straightness and sinking — do not press down stiffly or pull up stiffly, which would impair the flexibility of the waist's rotation. Used properly, the power of the waist can concentrate the strength of the whole body at one point.

IV. Requirements 1. There must be "one movement and nothing unmoving": turning the waist, withdrawing the step and separating the hands move together, upper and lower following one another, neither first nor last.

图 474A



Retreat a Step and Ride the Tiger, transition: the waist turns back left, the left foot comes down in place into a left empty stance, the two hands separate left and right, the right hand lifts to the upper right, palm facing forward.

图 474B

Retreat a Step and Ride the Tiger, final position: a left empty stance, the right palm lifts slightly higher than the head, palm facing front-right, the left palm tears down and presses beside the left hip, the eyes look to the front.

2. The chest must not be thrust out; one must contain the chest and raise the back. Thrusting the chest causes qi to crowd the chest, making the upper heavy and the lower light, so that the heels float up easily.

3. In withdrawing the step and forming the left empty stance, the weight must not fluctuate up and down.

4. The forward left empty leg and the right side of the chest have a tendency to attract and connect, so that the empty leg does not float off to one side and the upper and lower, left and right, are symmetrical and coordinated.

V. Errors, Causes, Corrections 1. Error: on retreating the step, empty and full are unclear and the weight is unsteady. The main cause is tension in the waist and hips, and the left leg not sitting firmly. Correction: the step should change with the body. The conversion of empty and full in the stepping must, along with the conversion of the body method, make the waist alternately draw and exchange left and right waist-gaps during the movement so as to divide empty and full; there must be "the two legs following one another below." Therefore, when the right leg descends to the right-rear with the turning of the waist, the right waist-gap must be empty and

relaxed, and as the waist and hips relax and sink slightly, the stability of the weight is helped; moreover the right leg may retreat only slowly, and only after the left leg has sat firmly.

2. Error: after retreating, the two feet stand on the same line, causing the body to sway and be unsteady. The main cause is that the right leg wrongly goes back and to the left, so that the two feet stand on one line; with a small base the body will sway. This is unreasonable in terms of application: the opponent presses, the force coming in is straight forward; only if I step out to the right-rear and turn the waist can I use the neutralizing method and change the direction of the opponent's force. If I retreat straight back, that forms a clash; not only is the stance unsteady, but I cannot change the opponent's straight-forward pressing force, and I put myself at a passive disadvantage. Correction: the right foot, retreating, should go slightly to the right-rear.

3. Error: the two hands separate too early. The main cause is shallow understanding of the application. If the opponent's straight-forward pressing force is met by my two hands forcibly separating up and down, there is difficulty. One should first turn the waist and retreat the step, and only after his force has shifted and dispersed do I tear down and stick and lift, so as to make the whole strength of the opponent fall into emptiness. Correction: on retreating, first bring the left hand near the crook of the right arm so that the two wrists stick to the inner sides of the opponent's two wrists, and only then separate.

4. Error: the path of the two hands' movement is wrong — just one big circle drawn up and down. The main cause is insufficient understanding of the application, producing "scattering." Correction: in the mind, use my two wrists stick to the opponent's two wrists, and as I turn the waist right and retreat the step backward, my two hands first sink slightly, then move right with the turning waist; then the left palm, palm facing down, tears to the lower left, while the back of the right hand faces outward and sticks and lifts to the upper right. In this way there is both a vertical circle and a horizontal circle — it is not an unconscious random drawing of circles.

5. Error: the two hands stay rather close to the body, at essentially the same distance as in White Crane Spreads Its Wings. The main cause is shallow understanding of the application. The opponent is using the press; if my two hands are a small distance apart vertically and close to the body, not only can I not make the opponent's whole strength fall into emptiness, but it is very easy for him to take advantage of my position to attack at will.

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods 1. Broken-down practice: (1) the movement of the hands — first right, then separate up and down. (2) the movement of the feet — sit firmly on the left leg, the right leg retreats to the right-rear. (3) the complete movement.

2. Paired practice combining the application: A — presses with both hands on B. B — retreats the step and turns the waist, both hands sticking to the inner sides of A's two wrists, drawing back and to the right (neutralizing), then separates the two hands up and down, tearing left and lifting right, so that A's two-handed press falls into emptiness. In the paired practice the two exchange and repeat, and must experience the meaning of turning the body and retreating the step.

Posture Eighty — Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus

Posture Eighty — Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus

I. Application Continuing from the previous posture. If there is an opponent in front, and another opponent strikes from behind me with the right hand, then in this emergency where both front and rear must be guarded, I at once spin the right foot in place, the left foot hangs up behind and revolves with the body, and at the same time I use both hands and the left foot in the manner of a whirlwind, sweeping hands and foot together at the opponent's upper and lower parts. After revolving one full circle I return to the original position, and immediately stick to the right elbow and wrist of the opponent in front; then, going around to the opponent's inner wrist-gate, I ward, carry and tear back to the left, and at the same time swiftly kick with the back of the right foot at the opponent's chest and ribs using crosswise force. Where the foot passes it is like a fierce wind swaying lotus leaves — the so-called supple waist folding a hundred times as if boneless, and sweeping away, the whole body is hands. The subtlety of this skill is not something a beginner can grasp at once. **II. Course of Movement** 1. The movement begins: the right leg sinks slightly, the waist turns slightly right, the right palm comes down in an arc slightly to the right from above and pushes out past the chest, the palm slanting forward, the fingers slanting; at the same time the waist turns slightly left to face the front, the left palm rises in an arc slightly to the left from beside the left hip and guards up to before the left forehead, the fingers passing slightly above the head, the palm facing forward, the fingers slanting up. The eyes attend to the movement of the two hands, then look level to the front (see the first figure on this page).

2. Pivoting on the ball of the right foot, begin to revolve to the right-rear; the body must first sink down, the waist and hips relax, the right leg sinks, and then the waist and hips turn right-rear, the left foot with it rising slightly by pressing the ground, the left leg opening out and swinging to the right-rear with the turn. During the turn both palms face down and the two arms form an arc, the left hand high and the right low; as the turn proceeds the right palm rises level with the nose and the left palm level with the chest, the left palm slightly lower than the right elbow, the left palm still facing down and the right palm slanting forward. Because the "sweep" is done with both hands and the left foot at the same time, hands and foot swing around together with the turning of the body (see the second figure on this page).

3. Turning the waist and swinging the leg, the left foot swings toward the rear-left (northwest) obliquely; the toe turns in and touches the ground, the left toe pointing east-northeast, the left toe a little behind the right heel, the right toe pointing east-southeast. The waist and hips sink down, the weight gradually shifts onto the left foot until the whole foot is firm, and the left leg sits firmly with the knee bent. The right foot then slowly lifts, the body continues to turn right, and both palms shift rightward with the turn, the face toward the east, the hands toward the southeast corner diagonally; the right palm moves to the front-right diagonal of the body, and the

left palm moves to the left of the right elbow, slightly lower than the right elbow. The gaze shifts with the direction of the hands (see the third and fourth figures on this page).

4. The waist turns slightly left, the left leg rises a little, the right foot lifts and goes left, and then the waist turns; the right leg swings outward in an arc from left to right and upward, the knee naturally slightly bent, the foot need not rise above the shoulder (because the instep kicks crosswise at the opponent's chest and ribs), the instep facing slightly to the right. At the same time hand and foot respond to one another — hand welcoming foot, foot welcoming hand — and both palms strike from right to left against the face of the right foot, the left hand slightly first and the right slightly after. The body continues to turn right and both hands swing with the momentum to the front-left diagonal, facing north-by-west. The gaze attends to the meeting of the two palms and the instep, then looks level forward (see the fifth and sixth figures on this page).

III. Key Points 1. The left hand guarding the forehead is oblique, not horizontal, otherwise would form a carried shoulder and a raised elbow. The right hand pushing forward must also be slightly oblique — it must not be horizontal or straight — and the fingers on the body's centreline, so that the fingers of the upper and lower hands cross slightly.

2. The revolving movement of Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus is comparatively difficult: one must "stand like the beam of a steelyard, move like a wheel." In revolving, the waist must be set straight and upright like a great banner and vertical, steady and roundly turning like the steelyard weight — not swaying, not collapsing. The turning must pivot on the ball of the right foot, the left foot pressing the ground slightly; first turn the waist and hips, and then the left leg swings to the right-rear with the momentum; only thus can the turn be round and lively. Hence the centre of gravity in the revolution must always be on the ball of the right foot, and must not deviate. The waist must not be stiffly held up, nor must it "fall apart."

3. After revolving, the left toe turns in and comes down, and the right foot at once becomes empty and lifts — only thus can empty and full be clearly distinguished.

4. After revolving, when the two hands move to the southeast they should not pause, but should continuously coordinate with the movement of the right foot and shift gradually to the left.

5. "Body shape and waist support — how could they be absent?" Therefore when the left foot comes down one must gradually squat, and then, as the waist turns from left to right and the right foot lifts and swings from left to right and up, the body must not only avoid leaning forward or back but must also have the intent of pressing up and stretching out.

6. After revolving, the right foot shifts left and then swings out to the right in a kick. This circle should not be too large; if it is large the movement "scatters," and the speed of movement slows and the time lengthens, so that the chance of kicking the opponent is reduced and the requirement of the application is not met.

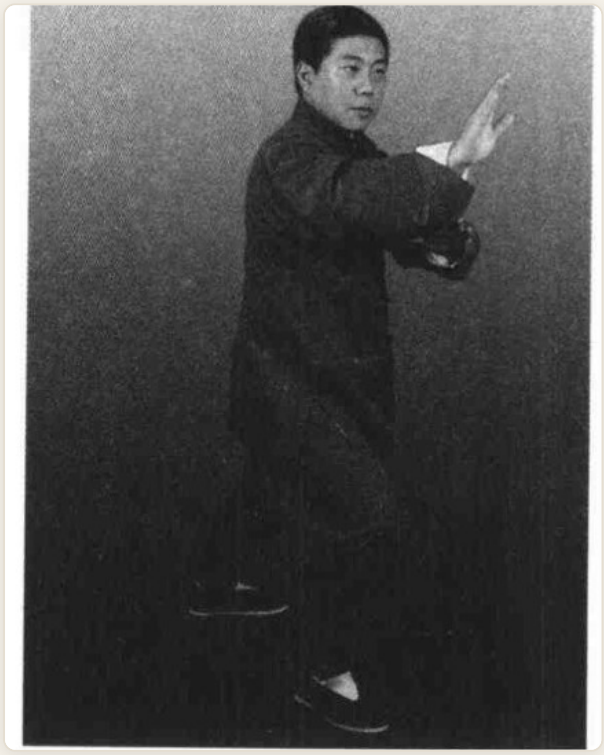
7. Hand and foot meeting in the strike should pat lightly — the sound need not be loud. One must be relaxed, quiet and natural, because the substance of the movement is the two hands tearing

to the lower left and the right leg swinging crosswise from left to right; the pat is only a form, and if the pat is heavy it actually interrupts the movement.

8. The right leg's swing is crosswise force: the turning of the waist must lead the swing of the right leg, and at the same time the hands and the foot move in opposite directions yet echo one another, which makes the movement of the leg more powerful.

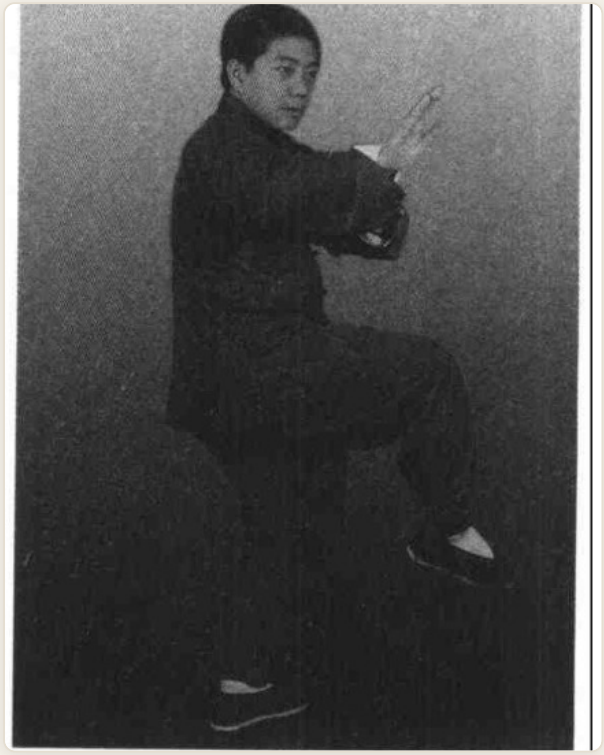
9. In revolving, the two hands are before the chest and the left foot opens out and swings with the waist's revolution; at this moment hands and foot sweep at the opponent's upper and lower parts, so there must be the manner of a whirlwind, and it must be fast. The right foot kicks out with crosswise force, and where the foot passes is like a fierce wind swaying lotus leaves — this too must be fast. The boxing treatise says: "When the movement is urgent, respond urgently;

图 478



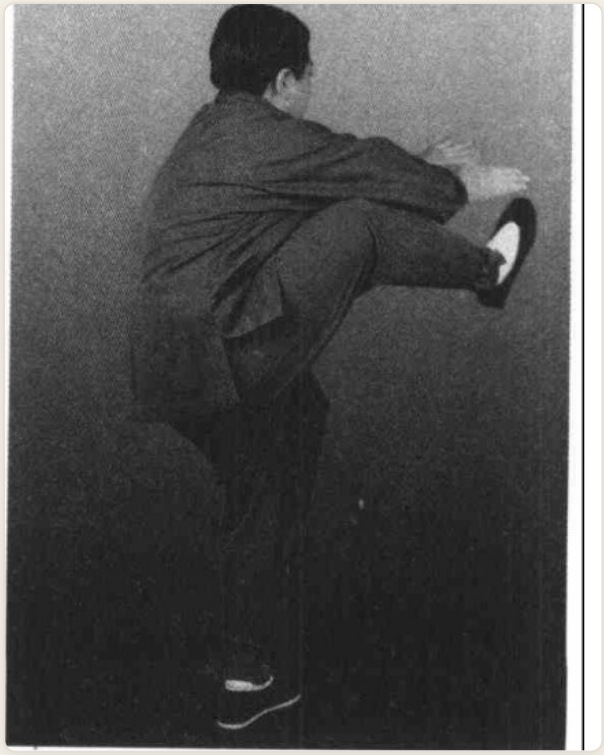
Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus: the waist turns slightly left, the left leg rises a little, the right foot lifts and goes left, both palms strike from right to left.

图 479



Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus: the right leg swings outward in an arc from left to right and upward, the instep facing slightly to the right.

图 480



Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus, final position: both palms strike from right to left against the face of the right foot, the left hand slightly first and the right slightly after, the eyes look to the front.

when the movement is slow, follow slowly"; "use stillness to master motion, strike later but arrive first." It can be seen that the application of Taijiquan is not simply a requirement of slowness — it requires the ability both to be slow and to be fast. Chen Xin said: "In slowness, be slow enough that others cannot keep up with me; in speed, be fast enough that others cannot keep up with me." So Taijiquan trains lightness and agility precisely in order to attain a later heaviness and speed, and in order that "in movement nothing, however small, is not reached." Relaxation and quietness must be stressed; therefore in practising Taijiquan, apart from a few individual movements, one should not be fast — one should be slow, light, agile and even, especially as a beginner.

IV. Requirements 1. Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus: first the turning of the body, second the swinging kick. The turn must be turned steadily, the body not swaying; the kick must be kicked roundly, with turning power and force.

2. The turning of the body should be led by the waist, and the swinging kick should also be led by the waist; one must not move only the leg without moving the waist — the principle "the master is in the waist" must be embodied.

3. After the right leg has swung and kicked, the left foot must still stand steady; the two hands swing left, and the right leg hangs rather than quickly coming to the ground — it hangs light,

agile, steady and firm.

4. The positions of the two feet must be stood accurately.

V. Errors, Causes, Corrections 1. Error: at the start of the movement one attends only to the movement of the hands (left hand raising to the frame, right hand pushing forward) without attending to turning the waist and sinking, and after the body revolves one does not attend to sinking when the left foot lands, nor to the turning of the waist and hips. The main cause is neglect of "upper and lower following one another." Grandmaster Yang Chengfu's orally transmitted *Ten Essentials of Taijiquan* says: "When the hand moves, the waist moves, the foot moves, the eyes move with them — only thus can it be called upper and lower following one another. If one thing does not move, it is scattered." In terms of training the body, when hands, waist and feet all move the qi and blood of the whole body circulate and more muscular and other bodily tissues take part in the activity; this is a method of practice that stresses wholeness. As for the sinking of the body: in terms of application, a lowered centre of gravity makes the revolution steadier and gives the tearing and other hand movements a firm root. Correction: the waist should be the key to the turning of the upper and lower limbs, and one should use sinking to bring out the force of the crotch and hips, so that issuing force does not become floating and powerless and the movements remain agile.

2. Error: when the body revolves, the two hands suddenly change height, causing interruption. The main cause is that attention is focused on a part — if on the hands, then only the hands move; if on the foot, then only the foot moves. This is the error beginners most easily commit, one of the errors beginners most easily commit. If during the revolution the two hands do not move and only the revolution is done, then when the revolution is finished the height of the hands is suddenly corrected. Correction: from the very start of the revolution the two hands change height, going from left hand high and right hand low gradually to right hand high and left hand low. In this way there is no sudden change but a gradual one, which also conforms to the principle "one movement and nothing unmoving."

3. Error: after the revolution the direction of the body is incorrect. The left foot swings around too far and lands beyond northeast, so that the direction of the swinging kick goes beyond southeast. In terms of application, when the left foot has landed it is already close to the opponent, and the right leg's swinging kick has lost its effect. In some cases the revolution is insufficient and the left foot lands at the southeast, so that the direction of the right leg's swing is northeast, and then the right leg's swing cannot possibly reach the opponent. The main cause lies in not understanding the application. In Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus the enemy is front and rear — one opponent in front, one behind — and after the revolution one must still face the front (east) to deal with the attacking enemy. Correction: there must be control in the revolution; the left foot lands in a northwesterly direction, the right foot in front and the left foot behind.

4. Error: the revolution is poor and the swaying unsteady. The main cause is that the method has not been mastered. Correction: begin the revolution with the weight on the right foot, the left toe

helping to keep balance, until the waist has turned so that the face is about to turn westward — only then lightly tap the left toe, lift the left leg, and swing it with the waist's revolution. Then, with one more slight turn of the waist, the left leg can swing around and come down with the momentum; the time spent on one leg is not long, and the body will not topple east and west. Moreover, in terms of application, the line along which the swinging force acts must be long, and then the sweeping power is greater.

5. Error: there is a pause in the middle of the movement — for example at the start, when the left hand raises to the frame and the right hand pushes forward; when preparing to revolve; and when the left foot lands after the revolution. All of these cause brief pauses. The main cause is shallow experience of unbroken continuity. Taijiquan masters most avoid having beginnings and endings, breaks and continuations, because when the old force is exhausted and the new force has not yet been born, this is the moment when one is most easily taken advantage of. Correction: Taijiquan uses intent and not force, unbroken from beginning to end, cycling round and beginning again, endless. Every posture must attend to rising, bearing, turning and closing, and must also attend to continuity in every movement; in the transitions of direction, the spirit must be gathered together, and only then can the opportunity and momentum for the next posture arise. There must absolutely be no pause anywhere in the movement. One must also attend to inner and outer, upper and lower, left and right, front and rear being coordinated and unified, and achieve "inner and outer united," "one qi running through," "done in one breath." For example: the moment the left foot lands, the right foot must lift with the waist's turn to the left — only thus can there be no pause.

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods 1. Explain the application, the direction of movement, the key points and so on.

2. Whole and sectional demonstration (left frame and forward push, revolution, swinging kick).

3. Mnemonic: left frame, right push, the body sinks slightly; the right foot is the axis, the waist turns right; the two hands and the left foot sweep behind the body; sweeping away, the whole body is hands. Left falls and right rises, the two hands oblique; stick the wrist, carry and tear, draw back; the crosswise force swings and kicks, moving the waist's force; it goes like a fierce wind swaying lotus leaves.

4. The difficulty lies in the revolution; the teaching method for the revolution lies in maintaining the centre of gravity, obtaining the motive force of the turn, and controlling direction: (1) To train well the maintenance of the centre of gravity, first let the practitioner attempt a revolution supported on one leg, watching one another. Most people, after the left leg has swung out, shift the weight forward, so that the left leg comes down (This page also carries one unnumbered push-hands demonstration photograph.) to the ground and cannot complete a full revolution. Therefore one uses the method of gradually increasing the angle of revolution, so that the learner can master it. Begin with a 90° revolution, after which the left foot swings from east to south; the second step increases it to turn from east to west; and after that it is increased to swing from east to north (the face still toward the east), completing the whole movement. (2) As

for the motive force of the revolution: turning the waist and hips, together with the left foot pressing the ground and swinging, naturally carries the left leg swiftly swinging backward. If one relied only on the leg's swing, not only would the body be unsteady but the swing would be powerless, and could not meet the requirement of the martial art. (3) Directional control also requires repeated practice to raise the functional stability of the position sense receptors, gradually strengthening one's sense of the body's position and posture in space and the movement of each part of the body.

5. Progressive method: (1) left frame and right push. (2) As above, plus the revolution. (3) As above, plus the left foot descending, the right foot lifting to the left, the two hands going right. (4) As above, plus hand and foot meeting in the strike. (5) The complete movement.

Learn one part of the movement, then learn a new part, then add it to the old part, increasing gradually — consolidate one section, add one section, until the whole movement is learned.

6. Paired practice combining the application: A — (the principal practitioner) takes the final position of Retreat a Step and Ride the Tiger. B — (the partner) stands in front of A and strikes with the left fist. C — (the partner) stands behind A and strikes A with the right hand. A — immediately revolves, sweeping with both hands and the left foot at C behind him; then immediately carries and tears B's left wrist with both hands toward his own lower left, and at the same time kicks at B's chest and ribs with the instep of the right foot.

The main point is to experience the application and understand the meaning of the movement; one must on no account actually kick or strike, and must guard against injuring others. The three may take turns practising.

VII. Technical Analysis 1. The application is characterized by enemies front and rear. The movement is characterized in that the whole movement comprises the combination of two detailed movements.

2. During the revolution the point of support is the right foot; after the revolution it is the left foot; the transfer must be light and agile.

3. The right foot's kick with crosswise force must be controlled, otherwise the body's revolution will be out of control. To maintain the balance of the left-foot support, the two hands should shift to the left.

4. After the revolution the left leg sits firmly, so that one stands steady. The two hands moving to the front-right diagonal is the preparation for the swinging tear.

5. As for hand and foot meeting in the strike: if the hand pats the foot and the foot waits to be patted, that shows the hand to be the master, and it loses the meaning of the lotus-swinging foot. If the foot strikes the hand and the hand waits to be struck, that shows the foot to be the master, and it loses the meaning of the two hands' swinging tear. Therefore it should be the foot striking the hand and the hand patting the foot, but with the foot as master.

6. In practising this movement one easily exposes hardness of force: the revolution sways unsteadily, the foot lands heavily, and the right foot kicks stiffly with a loud patting sound. The movements of Taijiquan must be both light and agile and yet steady and settled; from relaxation one enters suppleness, and then one trains steadiness and settledness. The Yang-style Taijiquan elder Chen Xin said: "When the work of movement has lasted long, then hardness is transformed into suppleness, and suppleness is trained into hardness; when hard and soft attain the mean, then yin and yang appear. Hence this boxing cannot be named by hardness, nor can it be named by softness; it is simply named by the nameless name, the Supreme Ultimate." "The Supreme Ultimate means the perfect attainment of both hardness and softness, blended so as to leave no trace. Its work is much, and therefore its accomplishment is difficult." Grandmaster Yang Chengfu said: "Taijiquan is the art of containing hardness within suppleness, of hiding a needle in cotton." Many people have put in a great deal of effort, yet still find success difficult. If the qi shows outwardly and the movements are fierce, that leans toward hardness; if the outward appearance is excessively soft and gentle, that leans toward softness. One should attain "where yin and yang abide, no trace can be sought."

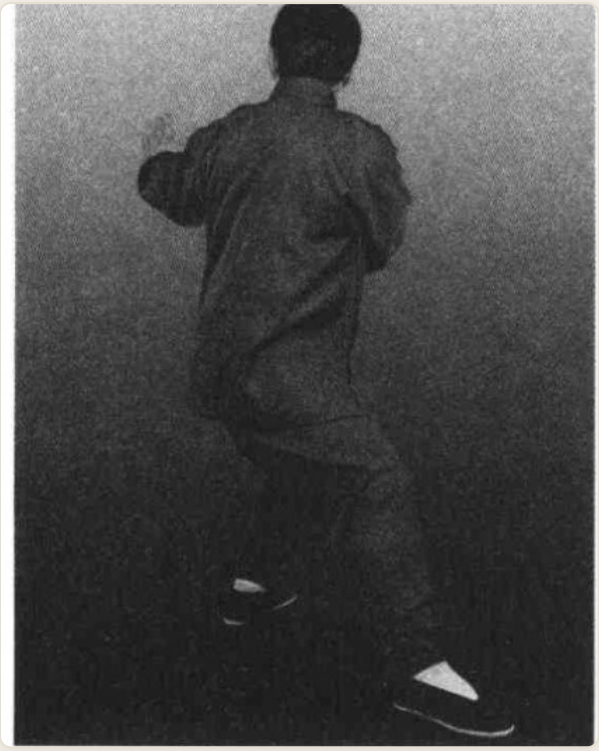
BOOK PAGE 243

Posture Eighty-One — Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger

Posture Eighty-One — Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger

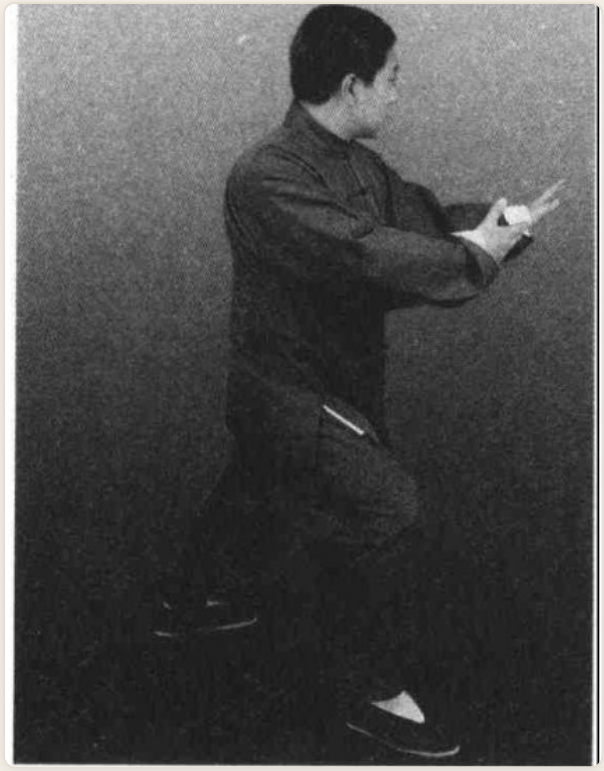
I. Application Continuing from the previous posture. If the opponent withdraws his body, I at once follow my left and right hands sticking to the opponent's hands, and going around the opponent's wrists revolve to the right; both hands close into fists and strike from the left corner. The left hand at the same time sinks at the opponent's right elbow and strikes forward again, and the right hand draws back and strikes again at the opponent's chest; at the same time the right leg comes down to the right-front and sits firmly, all storing its momentum, the waist having sinking force, rather like a riding-horse crotch, the left foot becoming empty, as if forming the shape of a bended bow shooting a tiger.

图 481A



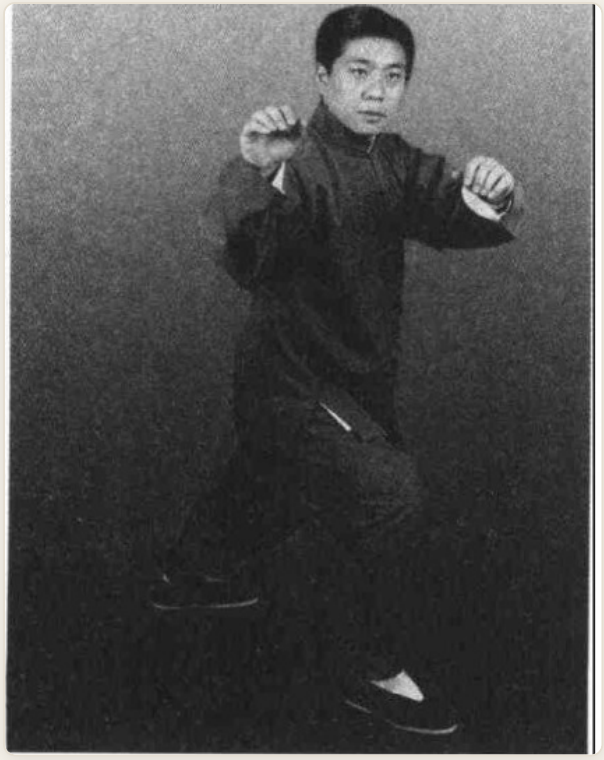
Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus, adjustment: the left leg sits firmly and stands steady, the two hands move to the front-right diagonal, prepared for the swinging tear.

图 481B



Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus: the foot strikes the hand and the hand pats the foot, with the foot as master, both palms meeting the face of the right foot.

图 482



Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger, opening: the body turns slightly left, the left leg gradually squats and sits firmly, the right foot comes down in place, the toe pointing obliquely southeast.

II. Course of Movement 1. The body turns slightly left with the swinging momentum, the left leg gradually squats and sits firmly, the right foot comes down in place, the toe pointing obliquely southeast, first with the heel touching the ground, and as the weight gradually shifts onto the right leg until the whole foot is firm; at the same time the upper body turns slightly right, the two palms shift right in an arc with the turn, the right palm rotating outward so that the palm turns to face up (the left palm still facing down). The gaze attends to the two palms shifting right (see the third figure on the previous page).

2. The body continues to turn right (facing south-southeast), bowing the right leg and pressing the left leg, forming a right bow stance. The two palms, with the turning of the body, go from left to down and, passing before the abdomen, arc up to the right; the left palm arcs from before the chest to the upper right, the right palm arcs up from the right shoulder, and as it goes the arm rotates inward so that the right palm slants downward. The body turns left to face northeast; the right fist passes the right side of the head, the left fist passes before the right chest, and both fists strike out together toward the front-left diagonal (northeast), the right fist placed beside the right forehead with the right arm forming an arc, the left fist level with the chest. The gaze first attends to the two hands arcing up to the right, and when the body turns left and the two fists are

about to strike out toward the front-left diagonal, it turns to the front-left diagonal and looks level, attending to the left fist's strike (see the fourth and fifth figures on the previous page).

III. Key Points 1. The linking movements must be done well. Each posture has its own rising, bearing, turning and closing. The beginning of "Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger" must not pause after the end of "Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus" (the foot pat), but must be continuously unbroken, sinking and turning the waist, immediately performing "Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger."

2. The two hands must turn with the waist: "palm, wrist, elbow and shoulder, back, waist, crotch, knee and foot — nine joints above and below, joint by joint issued from the waist." Therefore the changes of the hands must rely on the waist: the waist turns right, the two hands go from up to down and, passing before the abdomen, to the right and up; when the right palm has moved to the right side of the head (becoming a fist) and the left palm has moved to before the right chest, the body turns left, and the two fists strike out toward the front-left diagonal with the waist's force.

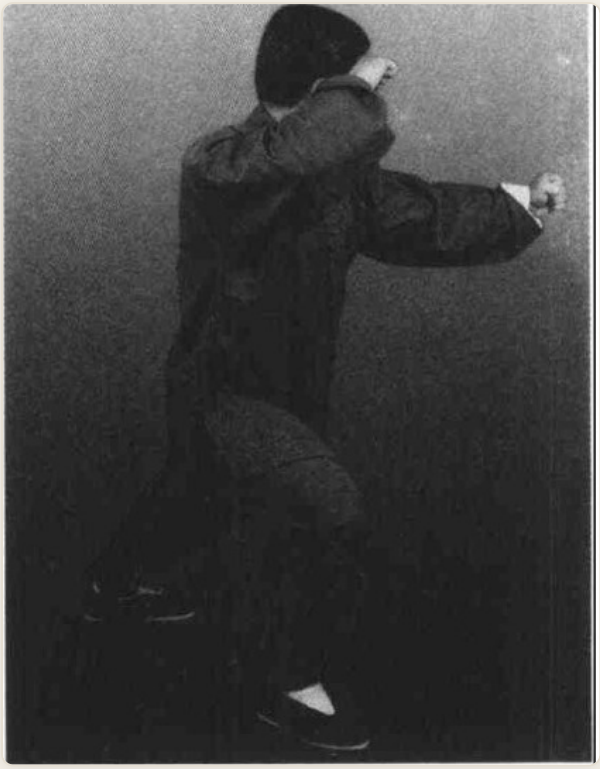
3. The movement of the two hands must conform to the requirements of the application: when shifting right, the upper right hand must not be too far from the body so as to cause "scattering"; the left hand should be before the chest; and on the strike, the right fist need not rise above the head, nor the left fist above the shoulder.

4. At the instant of forming the final position, guard against the right elbow lifting, the shoulders rising, and the body leaning forward.

5. The front and rear feet are not on one line; the right foot is slightly forward.

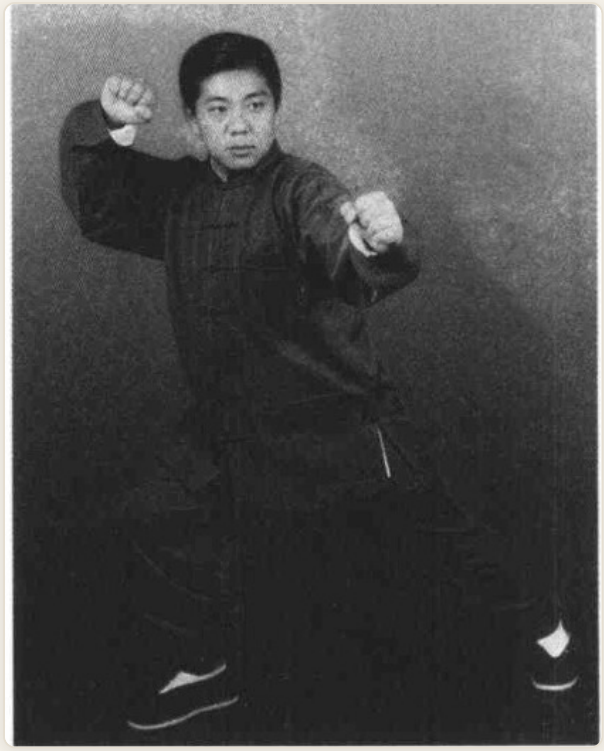
6. The gaze must change with the fists, from southwest to northeast.

图 483A



Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger, transition: the body turns right into a right bow stance, the two palms go from left to down and arc up to the right past the abdomen, the right palm closes into a fist and moves to the right side of the head.

图 483B



Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger, final position: both fists strike out toward the front-left diagonal (northeast), the right fist beside the right forehead, the left fist level with the chest, the eyes look at the left fist.

IV. Requirements 1. Both the upper and lower limbs must carry force through: "the source supports the waist and spine, the force runs through to the four tips." The upper limbs carry force through by intent, filling the whole arm; there must be both steadiness and settledness and relaxed quietness, and the arm movements are also required to be agile and unimpeded.

2. It is required that intent arrive, the eyes arrive, the body arrive, the hands arrive and the step arrive: when moving, all move together; when arriving, all arrive together. Therefore when the two fists strike out together at the end, the right knee must bow in and the two fists must arrive.

3. The direction of movement must be accurate: the waist turns right and faces southwest, the waist turns left and faces northeast.

4. In practising Taijiquan one must always be "relaxed and quiet," the attention concentrated, and the movements guided by intent. The movements must be relaxed and supple, and one must not use clumsy force. Training intent together with training the body enables inner and outer to become one; therefore practising Taijiquan can prevent and treat chronic illness and can strengthen the constitution.

V. Errors, Causes, Corrections 1. Error: the direction is wrong — the right leg steps not in front of the body (southeast) but to the right side. The main cause is failure to understand the

application. Because after "Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus," the opponent withdraws his body and I at once follow the enemy's hands with my left and right hands sticking to them; if I step to the right, then (This page also carries one unnumbered push-hands demonstration photograph.) one cannot speak of "following." If I step forward to the right, advancing can meet the requirement of following, and retreating allows a left carry; if I then step forward once more I can close the fists and strike from the right corner — the left hand striking his right elbow, the right hand striking his chest. Correction: on the basis of understanding the application, attend to where the right foot is placed after the lotus swing — it should be placed to the right-front.

2. Error: the shoulder is carried when the fist strikes out. The main cause is failure to attend to sinking the shoulder and dropping the elbow, whence the elbow rises, and from the raised elbow the shoulder is carried. A carried shoulder brings a whole series of problems, such as impairing "containing the chest and raising the back" and hindering "sinking the qi to the elixir field." Correction: begin from the word "relax," and through experiencing the conversion of empty and full, achieve the sinking of the shoulder.

3. Error: instead of turning the waist and hips one merely sways the body left and right, violating the principle "the master is in the waist." The main cause is that the waist and hips are not relaxed. The waist is the key to the turning of the upper and lower; only if the central axis is unbent and uns waying can it be agile; only by using the waist's power in the movement can the force reach the four limbs. Correction: the waist must be relaxed, sinking and straight, so that its rotation is agile, so that one uses the waist's power and concentrates the strength of the whole body at one point — only then can the fist strike with force.

4. Error: the body leans forward after the fist strikes out. The *Boxing Treatise* says: "Stand like the beam of a steelyard, move like a wheel." If my body leans forward, the centre of gravity must shift forward, and at a slight push from another I must fall. Moreover, though one advances, one cannot retreat; hence "seeking the far by giving up the near" is wrong. The main cause is that one does not use the waist's power to strike, but uses the erroneous method of bending the waist and leaning forward. Correction: stress that when the fist strikes out the force is led from the spine to set the four limbs in motion; therefore there can only be rotation of the waist, and no leaning forward of the body.

5. Error: the right foot comes down too fast, reducing the amount of exercise. The main cause is that the left leg is weak: at a slight squat one feels the single leg cannot support, and so one can only bring the right foot down a little faster. Another cause is that during the lotus swing the right leg's rightward swing goes out of control, causing the body to turn and dragging the left foot, which is the root, so that the body sways and the right foot comes down too fast. Correction: (1) strengthen the legs and do more single-leg-support squatting practice, the squat going gradually from shallow to deep. (2) Hand and foot meeting in the strike must be controlled and must not favour one side; in particular attend to the swing amplitude of the right leg; with a stable centre of gravity, the left leg can squat slowly, "sending" the right leg down and out lightly.

6. Error: the method of holding the fist is poor — some hold the fist too tightly, some have the direction wrong. The main cause of the former is failure to understand the form of the closed fist. Taijiquan must contain hardness within suppleness, but one must enter by way of relaxation and suppleness; therefore the fist should not be held too tightly, but must have the intent of gathering its qi together, so that it cannot be opened when separated nor scattered when struck. One should also note Chen Xin's saying: "When going out, the hand is open; on meeting a person, it becomes a fist." The latter is that the direction of the fist is wrong: some have both fists' eye facing up, some have both fists' centre facing down — neither is right. The cause lies in failure to understand the application. The left fist strikes straight forward, using the upright fist, so its eye faces up (slightly oblique); the right hand is before the head, and it is correct for its eye to face obliquely down — this is called the "reverse fist." Correction: the fist must be held with appropriate tightness; the left fist in front and the right fist behind, the left low and the right high, the eyes of the two fists facing each other at a distance.

VI. Teaching and Practice Methods 1. Mnemonic: squat lightly and set the right leg down; stick and turn, revolving to the right; the waist sinks with force and the right foot is firm; the eyes of the fists face one another as they go out obliquely.

2. The difficulty lies in the linking: after the lotus swing one must do well the squatting of the left leg and the "sending" of the right foot out obliquely, which is generally not easy to do with ease and roundness, so it should be attacked as a difficulty, with much practice and much thought. First train control to make the centre of gravity stable, and then let the left leg squat.

3. Clarify the direction: (1) the right foot is placed at the southeast corner. (2) The face first turns to the northwest, then to the southwest, and finally to the northeast.

4. Progressive method: (1) the left leg squats, the right leg hangs. (2) As above, extend the right leg toward the southeast. (3) As above, both hands shift right in an arc. (4) As above, both hands continue to shift right, bow the right leg. (5) As above, both fists strike out.

Practise one detail, then add another detail, and gradually learn the whole movement.

5. Yang-style Taijiquan, as a means of preventing and treating illness, uses natural breathing. In teaching, no requirement is placed on the breathing; the practitioner need not fuss over the breathing, and simply lets it be natural, gradually training to "abdomen relaxed, qi gathered; mind quiet, spirit at ease."

VII. Technical Analysis 1. When I am smooth and the other is contrary, that is called sticking. Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger sticks first and strikes after: sticking to the other with oneself, one must know the other, and only thus can one be neither after nor before. Therefore the first half of the movement must stress sticking — sticking so that the two fists each strike where they should — and only then stress striking. Sticking makes it easy to listen to force.

2. When the left leg squats after the lotus swing, normal breathing is often affected; hence the abdomen is required to be relaxed and quiet — "with the abdomen relaxed and quiet, the qi rises of itself" — which also makes the lower body steady.

3. Two movements, four corners: Turn the Body and Swing the Lotus goes first to the southeast corner and then to the northwest corner; Bend the Bow and Shoot the Tiger goes first to the southwest corner and then to the northeast corner.

4. In practising Taijiquan one must "seek quiet within movement," "use quiet to govern movement, so that though moving one is as if still." Hence "the slower the form is practised the better; being slow, the breathing becomes deep and long, the qi sinks to the elixir field, and naturally there is no fault of the blood vessels swelling." Therefore in practising Taijiquan one's thoughts must be concentrated, the mind and spirit single, the breathing natural, the intent stored in the elixir field, distracting thoughts dismissed — hearing and yet not hearing, seeing and yet not seeing — being in a state free of thought and worry. In practising the form one concentrates wholly on using intent to guide each movement, "using intent to move the qi, using the qi to move the body." Naturally, a beginner remembers this movement and forgets that one, attends to the movement of the hands and forgets the movement of the feet, and is in a flurry, unable to be in that high state free of thought and worry. But after long practice, once the set is familiar, one can gradually train to "intent moves, form follows," and can even train to "in quiet there is movement, yet though moving one is still." In this way it can certainly play a good role in improving health, preventing and treating illness, and prolonging life.

BOOK PAGE 248

Posture Eighty-Two — Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch

Posture Eighty-Two — Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch

I. Application Same as Posture Twelve above, Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch.

II. Course of Movement 1. The body gradually shifts left, the weight gradually shifts onto the left leg; at the same time the left fist becomes a palm, which moves down in an arc to the rear-left with the turning of the body, the palm facing obliquely up, and the right fist, as before, arcs down and comes to rest at the front-upper right of the left palm, rotating outward as it descends so that the centre of the fist faces obliquely down (the right fist level with the shoulder)

图 484

Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch, opening: the body gradually shifts left, the left fist becomes a palm and moves down in an arc to the rear-left, the right fist arcs down and comes to rest at the front-upper right of the left palm.

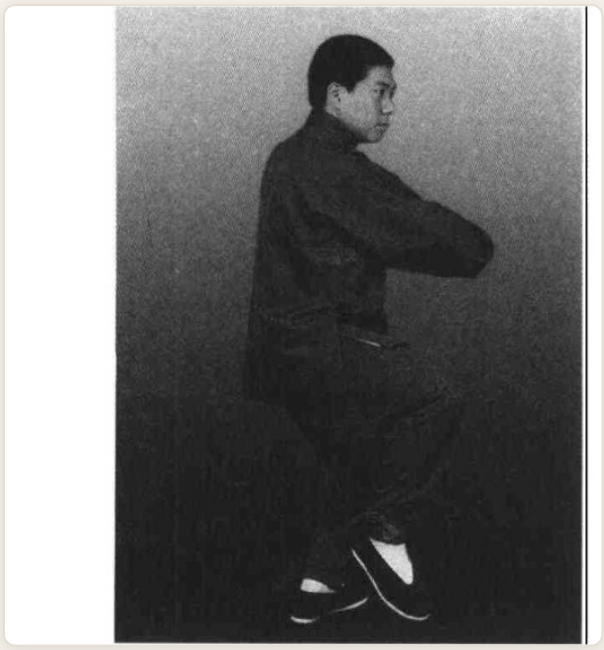
(see the third figure on the previous page).

2. The weight continues to shift left, the left hand moves up and the right hand descends (see the first figure on this page).

3. The whole weight shifts onto the left leg, the right foot is drawn back; at the same time the right fist goes down and circles left past the front of the abdomen, the centre of the fist turning to face down; the left palm moves left and up (not rising above the ear) in an arc, and as it moves the arm rotates inward so that the palm turns to face the lower right. The gaze attends to the circling of the two hands, then gradually turns to look level forward (the second figure on this page, the same as figure 55; the third and fourth figures on this page, the same as figure 56; the fifth figure on this page, the same as figure 57; the sixth figure on this page, the same as figure 58; the seventh figure on this page, the same as figure 59).

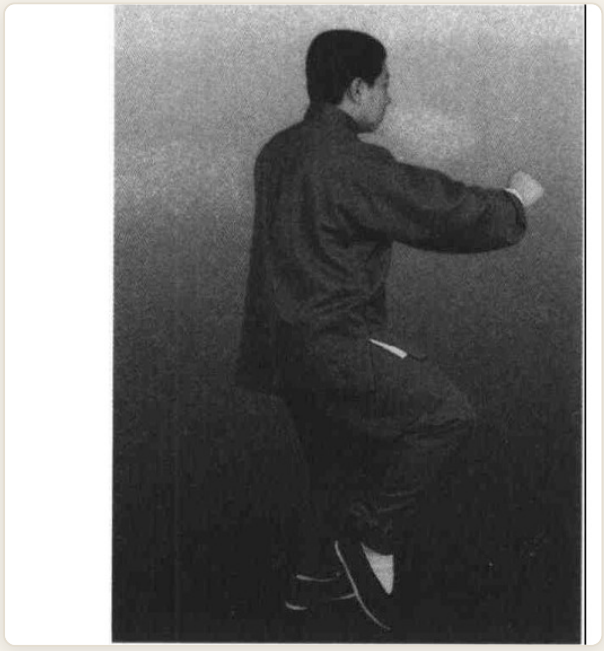
All the other sections are the same as Posture Twelve, Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch.

图 485



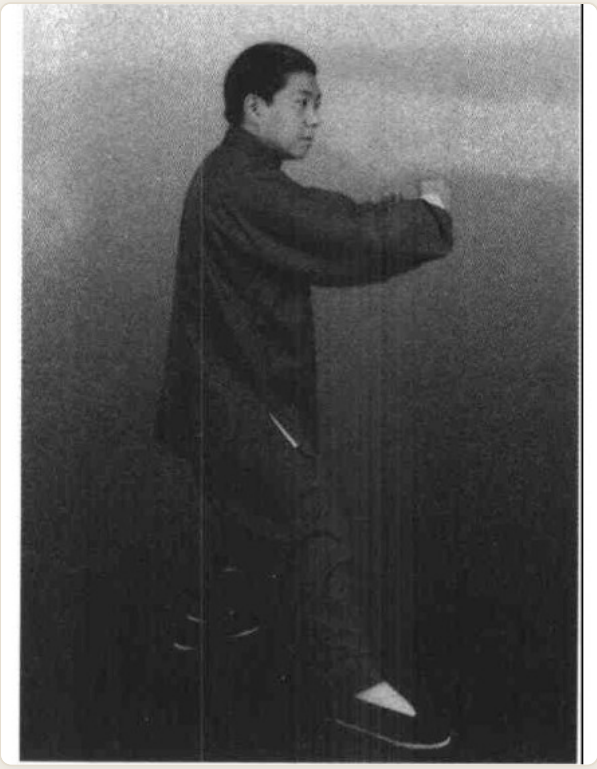
Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the weight continues to shift left, the left hand moves up, the right hand descends.

图 486



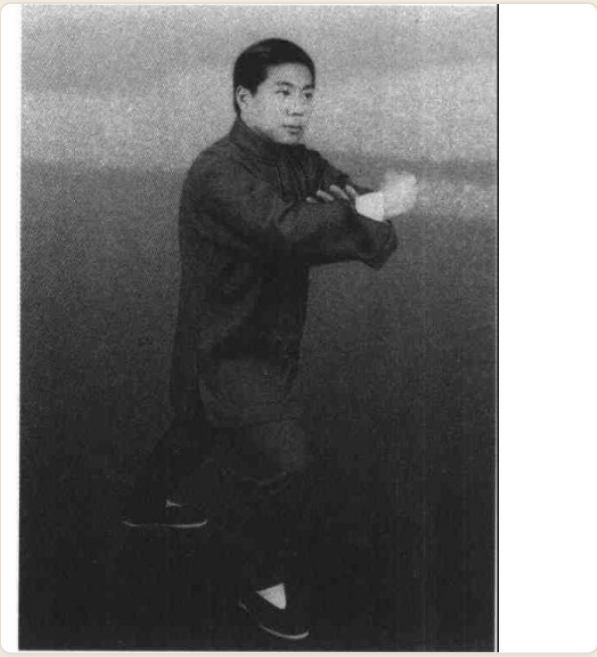
Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the right fist circles left past the front of the abdomen, the centre of the fist turns to face down, the left palm arcs upward (the same as figure 55).

图 487A



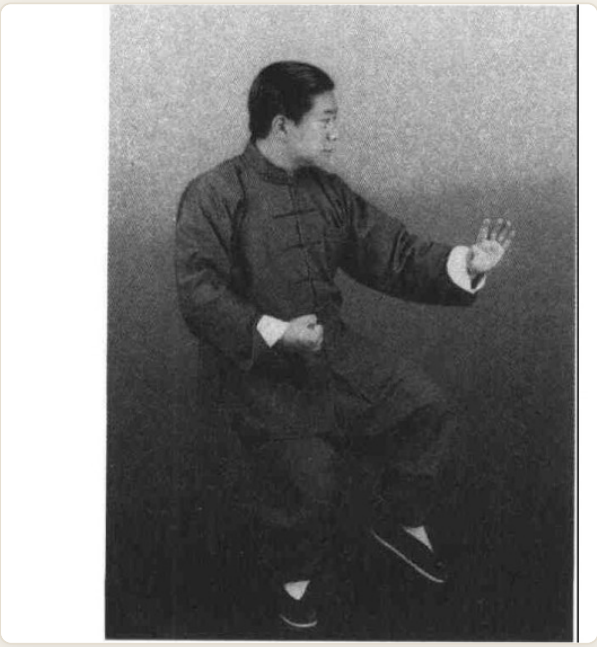
Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the right fist circles left to below the left wrist, the left palm rotates inward and turns over (the same as figure 56).

图 487B



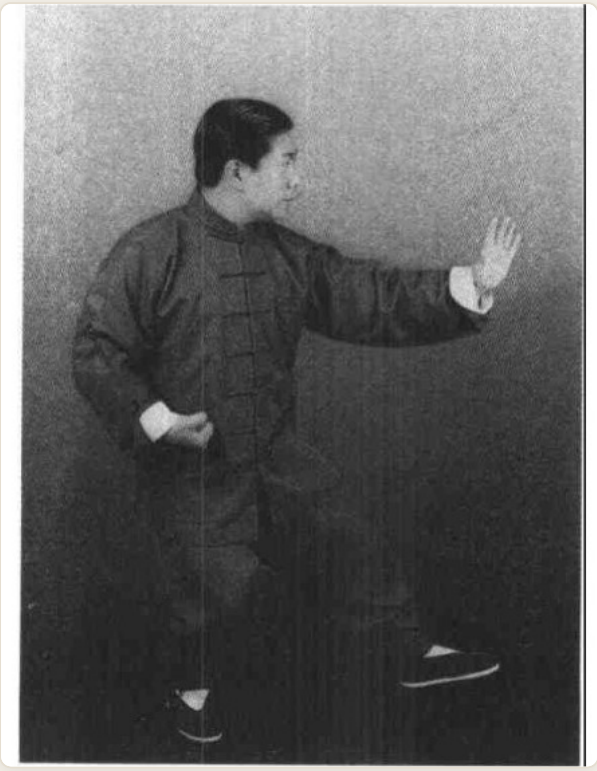
Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the right hand lifts, the left hand presses down, the two hands cross up and down (the same as figure 56).

图 488



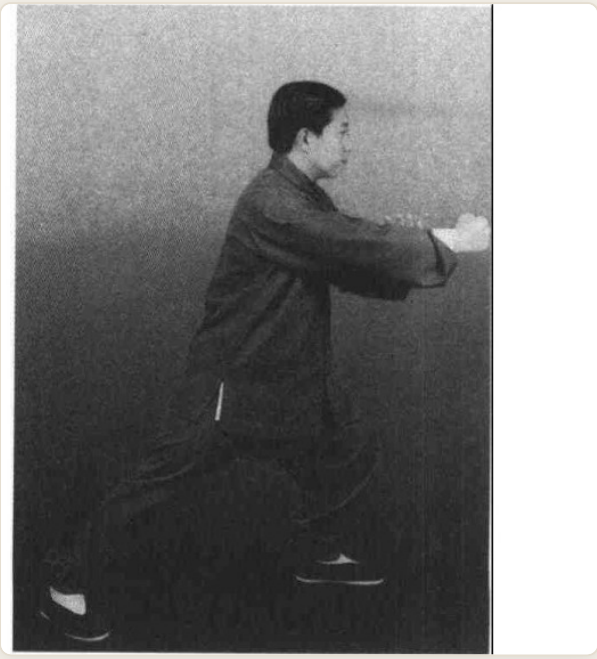
Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the right foot is drawn back, the two hands circle, the eyes look to the front (the same as figure 57).

图 489



Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the right fist circles down to below the left wrist, the left palm turns over to face the lower right (the same as figure 58).

图 490



Advance, Deflect, Parry and Punch: the right foot steps forward, the right fist deflects out, the left palm parries forward (the same as figure 59).

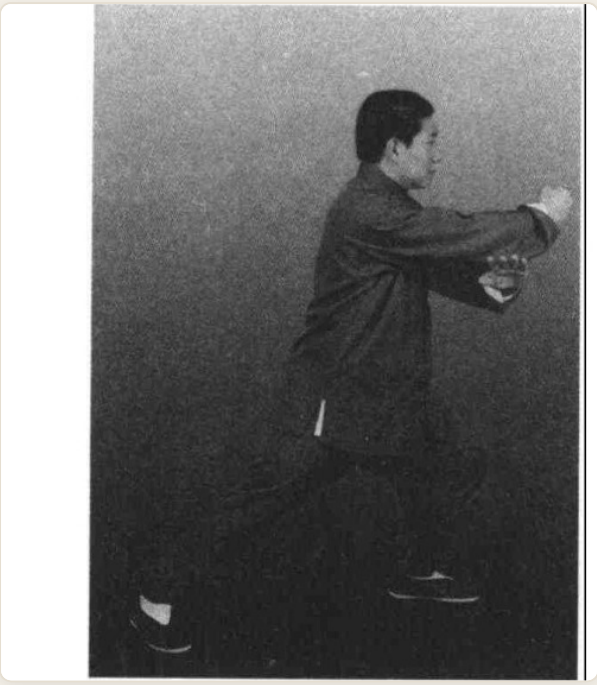
BOOK PAGE 250

Posture Eighty-Three — Apparent Close-Up

Posture Eighty-Three — Apparent Close-Up

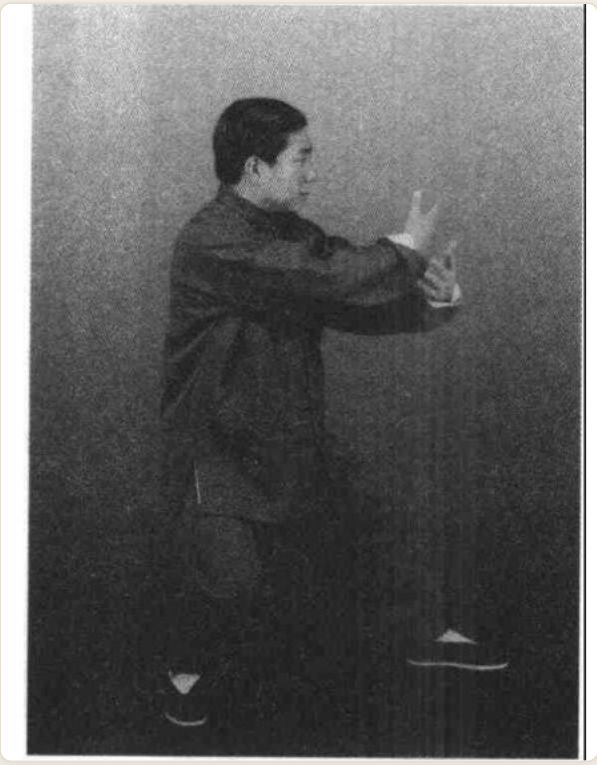
All the sections are the same as Posture Thirteen, Apparent Close-Up: see the first to the sixth figures on this page (the same as figures 60 to 63).

图 491



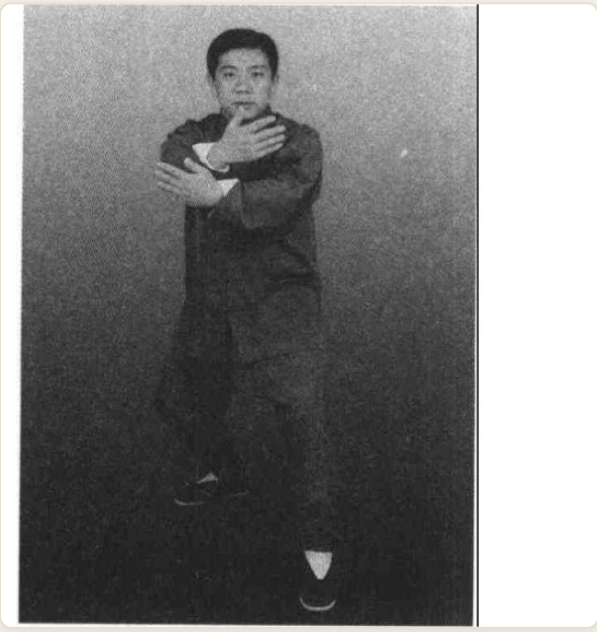
Apparent Close-Up, opening: both palms cross before the chest, the right palm outside and the left palm inside.

图 492A



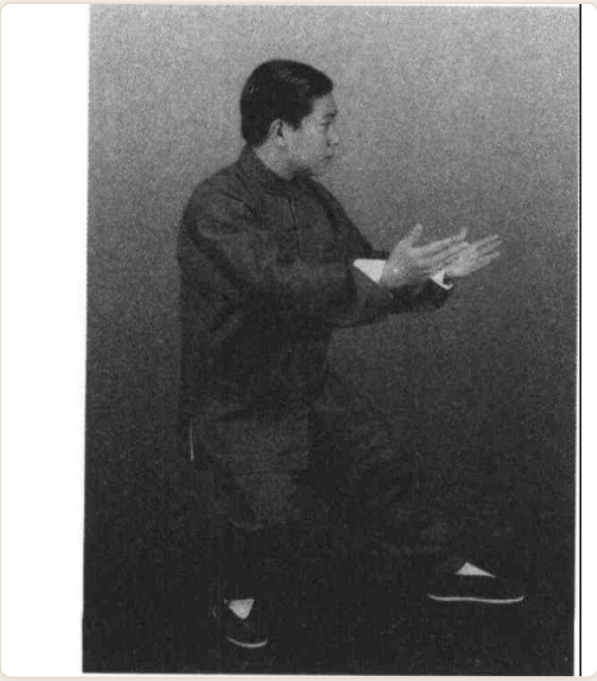
Apparent Close-Up: the two palms separate with the turn, the right palm rotating outward and turning over.

图 492B



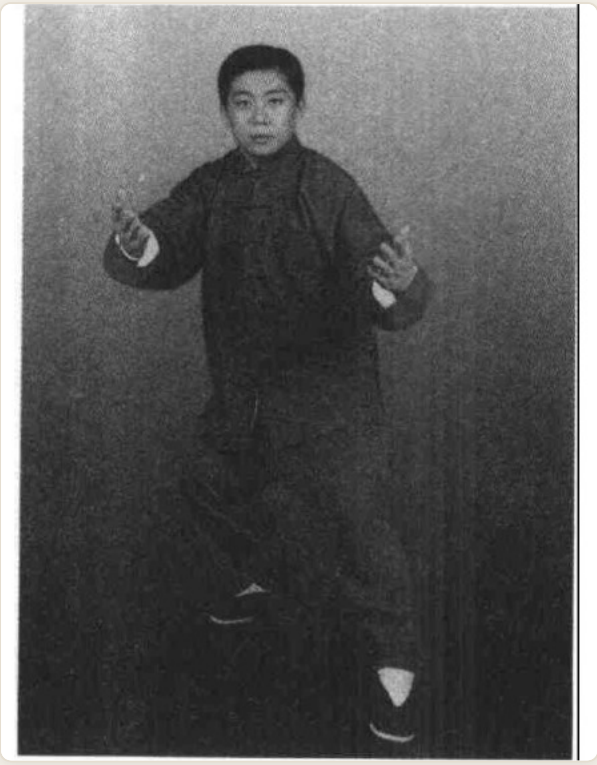
Apparent Close-Up: the two palms separate to before the two shoulders, palms facing forward.

图 493A



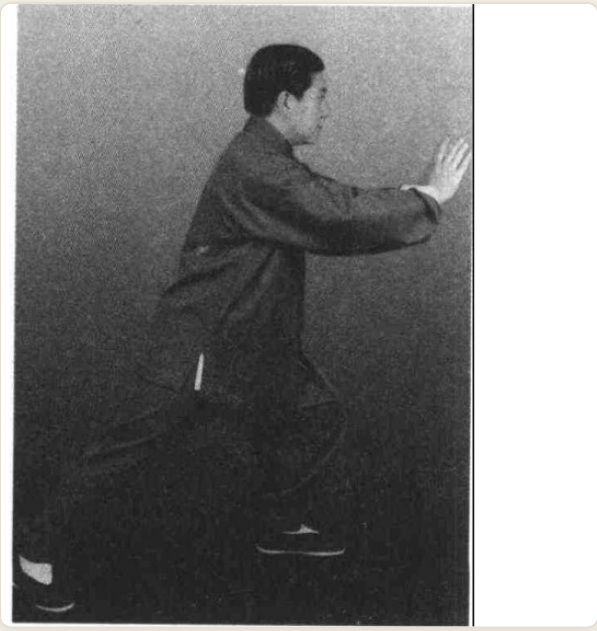
Apparent Close-Up: the two hands draw back with the waist as the body sits back, palms slanting up.

图 493B



Apparent Close-Up: the weight sits back, the two palms draw back to before the chest, then turn over and press forward.

图 494



Apparent Close-Up, final position: a right bow stance, both palms press forward, the eyes look to the front.

BOOK PAGE 251

Posture Eighty-Four — Cross Hands

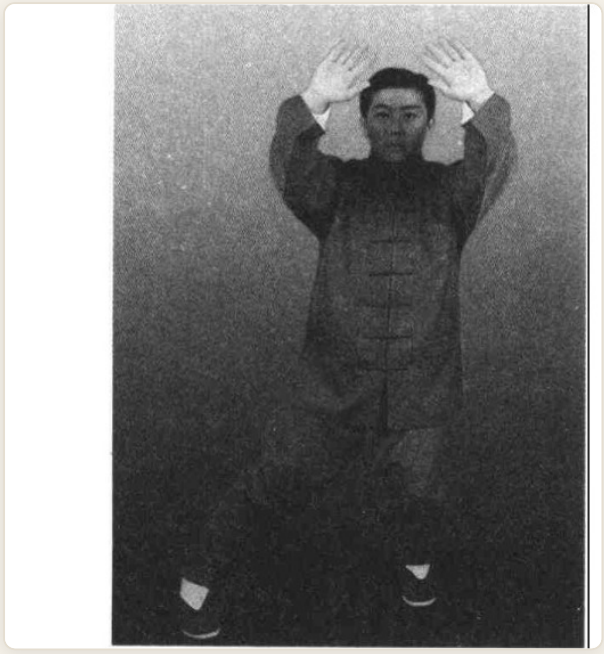
Posture Eighty-Four — Cross Hands

All the sections are the same as Posture Fourteen, Cross Hands: see the first to the fourth figures on this page (the same as figures 64 to 67).

Posture Eighty-Five — Closing

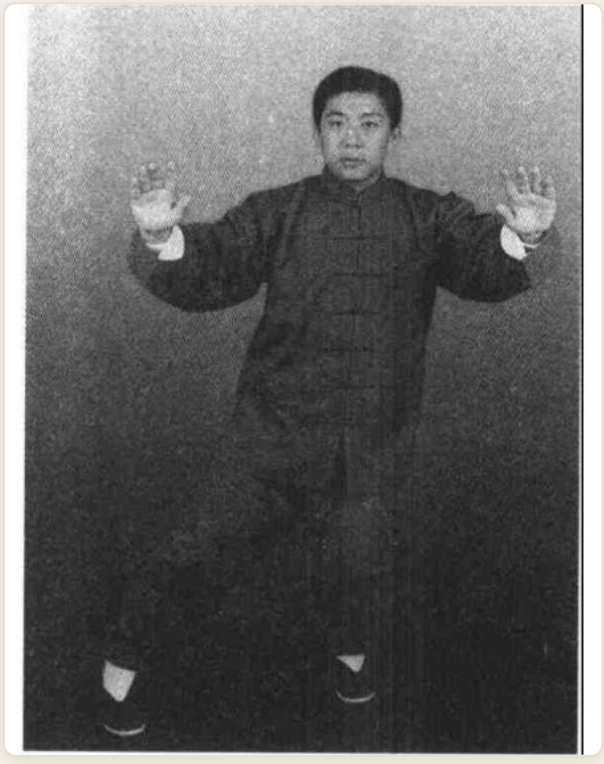
I. Course of Movement 1. The two arms extend forward, and as they extend both arms rotate inward so that the two palms turn to face down, forming a rough cross with the right hand below and the left hand above — see the fifth figure on this page.

图 495



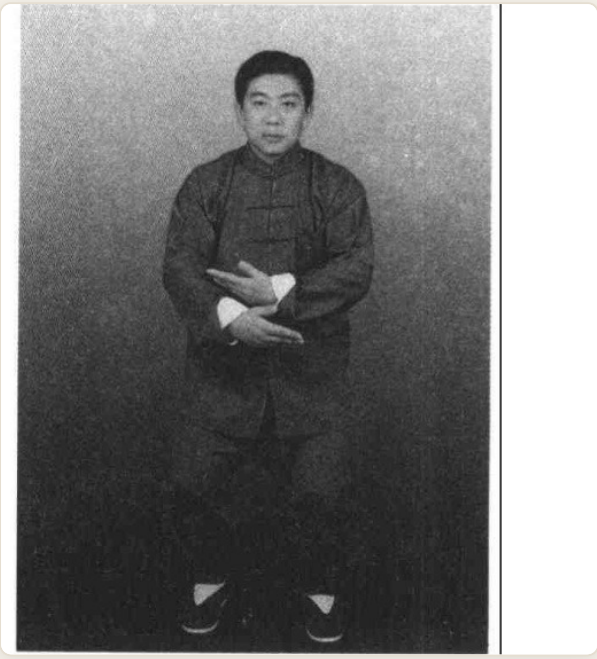
Cross Hands: both hands raise above the head, the two arms separate, the palms facing forward.

图 496



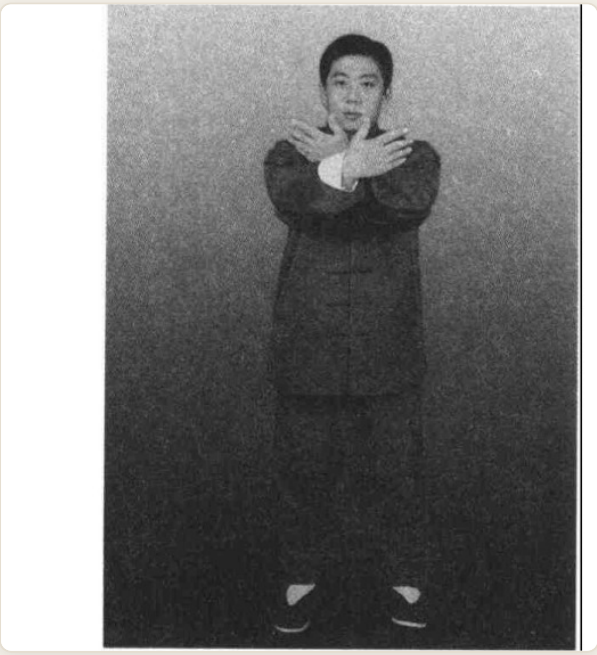
Cross Hands: both palms come down to left and right, palms facing outward, the fingertips slanting up.

图 497



Cross Hands: the two hands cross before the chest, the right hand outside and the left inside, forming Cross Hands.

图 498



Cross Hands, final position: the two hands cross and embrace before the chest, both legs bend slightly at the knee, the eyes look to the front (the same as figures 64 to 67).

2. The two arms continue to separate until the distance between the two hands is the same as the shoulder width. Then the two elbows sink, naturally carrying the two palms gradually downward to press to beside the hips, the fingers pointing forward, the palms still facing down. The eyes look level forward — see the sixth figure on this page to the sixth figure on this page (the same as figures 2 to 4, and figure 1).

3. Finally the fingers of both hands hang naturally.

II. Technical Analysis The Closing is also called "closing Taijiquan." This is the ending posture of a whole set and the practitioner must not neglect it. Closing Taijiquan — closing the two modes, the four images, the eight trigrams and the sixty-four hexagrams — yet still returning to the Supreme Ultimate. That is to say, one gathers in one's mind and breath, brings them wholly back to the elixir field, concentrates the spirit, quiets the breath, knows where to stop and is settled, and must not let them disperse or finish carelessly.

When a set of the form is finished, at the Closing one must still return to the original place (that is, wherever the opening posture was at the start, there the Closing must still be at the end); the direction must be correct and the standing position must be right.

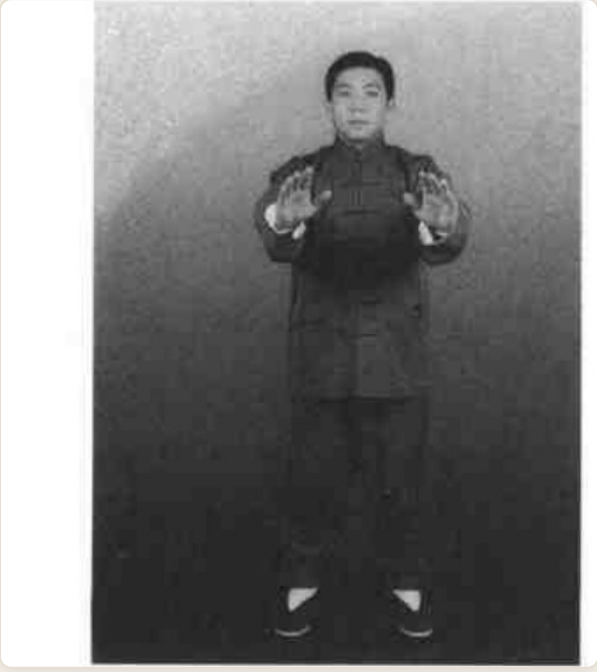
图 499

Closing: the two arms extend forward, the arms rotate inward so that the palms turn to face down, the right hand below and the left above, roughly forming a cross.

图 500

Closing: the two arms separate to shoulder width, the two elbows sink and carry the two palms gradually down to press beside the hips.

图 501



Closing: the two palms press to beside the hips, the fingers hang naturally, the palms facing down.

图 502

Closing, final position: the two hands hang at the sides of the body, the body stands erect, the eyes look to the front.

图 503

Closing, gathering the work: the whole set is finished, returning to the original place of the opening, the direction correct, the standing position accurate.

BOOK PAGE 253

Route Map of the Yang-Style Taijiquan Sequence of Movements

Route Map of the Yang-Style Taijiquan Sequence of Movements

(The whole page is the route map; there is no running text. The diagram marks the positions and facings of Postures One through Eighty-Five in boxes, with a compass at the lower right: north above, south below, west to the left and east to the right. As this diagram belongs to the section as a stand-alone schematic and is not a numbered text illustration, it carries no figure number.)

Chapter Three — Push Hands Yang-style Taijiquan push hands has three traditional pushing methods; a brief introduction to them is given here in passing (with the five-form push hands added).

BOOK PAGE 254

Section One — Fixed-Step Push Hands

Section One — Fixed-Step Push Hands

Fixed-hand push hands, also called the four cardinal push hands, is performed by two people in place using the four techniques of ward-off, roll-back, press and push against one another. Its movements are as follows:

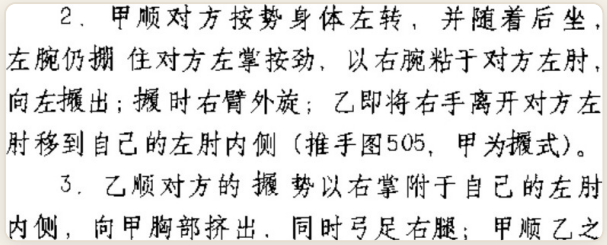
1. A and B face one another and each steps out the right foot (for convenience of explanation the right foot is assumed for both; in practice the left and right feet may alternate in front). They each raise the left hand and join it (backs of the hands facing each other, wrists crossing), each holding ward-off force; then each raises the right hand and places it at the other's left elbow, becoming the double joining of hands with the left wrists crossed. B bends the right leg and bows forward, A bends the left leg and sits back; at the same time they turn left and press toward A with both hands; A receives the other's pressing with the left arm's ward-off, and at the same time A's upper body, following the momentum, begins to turn left (push-hands figure 504: the one in black is A, the one in white is B; A is warding off, B is pressing).

2. A, following the other's pressing momentum, turns the body left and, as he sits back, the left wrist still wards off the other's left-palm pressing force, while the right wrist sticks to the other's left elbow and wards out to the left; on warding off, the right arm rotates outward. B at once takes the right hand off the other's left elbow and moves it to the inner side of his own left elbow (push-hands figure 505: A in the ward-off form).

图 504

Four cardinal push hands: B presses toward A with both hands, A receives it with the left arm's ward-off, and the two right wrists cross.

图 505



Four cardinal push hands: A turns left and sits back, the left wrist wards off B's pressing force, and wards out to the right.

3. B, following the other's ward-off momentum, places the right palm on the inner side of his own left elbow and presses out toward A's chest, at the same time bowing the right leg; A, following B's pressing momentum, the waist turns right and both arms rotate inward (push-hands figure 506: B in the press form).

4. A, following the other's pressing momentum, continues to turn the waist right, turning the body until it squarely faces B; at the same time both arms continue to rotate inward, and the right hand presses down on B's right hand while the left hand sinks down to the other's forearm near the elbow; both hands press forward together, and the right leg bends and bows forward; B at once receives the other's pressing with the right arm's ward-off (push-hands figure 507: A presses, B wards off).

Then B turns the upper body right and sticks the left hand to A's right elbow to ward off to the right; A then places the left hand on the inner side of his own right elbow and presses forward; B at once changes to the pressing and A again receives it with the left arm's ward-off — and so they push against one another in this cycle. If the upper limbs revolve in the opposite direction (pushing against one another), the movement is as before, only the left and right directions are reversed.

Fixed-step push hands requires that when each has pressed fully it is exactly the moment the step has bowed fully, and when each has warded off fully it is exactly the moment of sitting back to the point (if one sits back when pressing and bows forward when warding off, both are wrong). Ward-off and press lie between the bow and the sit.

Beginners at push hands must on no account let the movements become rough, to prevent accidents and injury; at the same time the breathing must be free and the movements relaxed and open.

Section Two — Moving-Step Push Hands

Section Two — Moving-Step Push Hands

Moving-step push hands is a circular practice performed by two people using the four techniques of ward-off, roll-back, press and push, coordinated with the stepping of advancing and retreating. There are two kinds of stepping: joined stepping and interlocking stepping.

1. Joined stepping: assume that A and B both have the left foot forward and begin with the double joining of hands (moving-step push hands figure 508, A's starting point).

图 506

Four cardinal push hands: A turns the waist right, both arms rotate inward, the right arm presses forward; B in the press form.

图 507

Four cardinal push hands: A presses forward with both hands and bends the right leg to bow; B receives A's pressing with the right arm's ward-off.

Suppose A retreats and B advances. A slightly lifts the right foot forward and then still sets it back in the same place, and B at the same time slightly lifts the left foot back and then still sets it down in the same place. Then A retreats the left foot, B advances the right foot; A retreats the right foot again, B advances the left foot (stepping figure 508, A). It looks as though A retreats three steps and B advances three steps, but in fact the first step is only a slight lift and then a setting down in the same place.

Then it changes to B retreating and A advancing (stepping figure 508, B's starting point — that is, the final footfall of both A and B in figure 508, A). When A has retreated three steps he lifts the left foot back and sets it forward in the same place (turning to advance), and B, having advanced three steps, lifts the right foot forward and sets it back in the same place (turning to retreat). Then A advances and B retreats two steps each (stepping figure 508, B).

Then it changes back to A retreating and B advancing, and so on in a cycle of one advancing and one retreating.

2. Interlocking stepping: A and B stand facing one another one step apart (stepping figure 509, A's starting point).

Suppose A retreats and B advances. B steps the left foot forward and inserts it on the inner side of A's right foot, while A retreats the left foot one step; then B steps the right foot forward and sets it on the outer side of A's left foot, while A retreats the right foot one step; then B steps the left foot again and still inserts it on the inner side of A's right foot, while A retreats the left foot one step (stepping figure 509, A).

Then it changes to B retreating and A advancing (stepping figure 509, B's starting point — that is, the final footfall of both A and B in figure 509, A). When A has retreated three steps, the right foot then passes from the outer side of B's left foot to the inner side (turning to advance); B at the same time slightly lifts the right foot forward and sets it back in the same place (turning to retreat). Then A advances and B retreats two steps each (stepping figure 509, B).

Then it changes back to A retreating and B advancing, and so on in a cycle of one advancing and one retreating.

In moving-step push hands, whether joined stepping or interlocking stepping, the upper limbs still use the four techniques of ward-off, roll-back, press and push; but when the stepping begins, the one retreating is necessarily rolling back and the one advancing necessarily pressing. Then the one retreating, as he retreats, changes to ward-off, and when the ward-off has reached its end the step has exactly retreated three steps; the one advancing, as he advances, changes to press, and when the press is full it is exactly the moment when the forward step is complete. Then when the one retreating changes to advancing, his upper limbs also change from ward-off to press; and when the one advancing changes to retreating, his upper limbs also change from press to ward-off.

In this way they perform the circular practice in coordination with the stepping.

BOOK PAGE 257

Diagram of the Stepping of Moving-Step Push Hands

Diagram of the Stepping of Moving-Step Push Hands

(The whole page is the stepping diagram; there is no running text. The diagram is in four groups — figure 508A, 508B, 509A and 509B — with black footprints representing A and white footprints representing B; the mark "0" on a footprint denotes the starting point and "1, 2, 3" the order of the advance and retreat steps; the arrow denotes the rise of that foot forward and its setting down in the same place. As this diagram belongs to the section as a stand-alone schematic and is not a numbered text illustration, it carries no figure number.)

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Section Three — Five-Form Push Hands

Section Three — Five-Form Push Hands

1. Push hands with moving steps in place A and B stand and join hands in the manner of fixed-step push hands, and the movements of the hands likewise follow the four forms of ward-off,

roll-back, press and push, cycling round without interruption. The only difference is that when A wards off B, the rear leg rises slightly and then at once comes down in the same place. Conversely, when B wards off A, B also moves the rear leg, and when A presses B he also first moves the front leg. In short, when A and B change techniques, they must follow the momentum and lift the empty step, echoing one another. They may also change hands and change steps in pushing. But when changing steps they must first bring the feet together — without bringing the feet together one cannot achieve the left-right alternating push.

2. Push hands with alternating left and right steps The upper-limb movements are as in the previous form. The only difference is that when A first steps up the right foot (leg), the rear leg (the left foot) rises slightly and comes down in the same place, and then the right step is at once withdrawn to stand together with the left foot; then he changes to stepping up the left foot (leg), and at this time A's right leg (that is, the rear leg) also rises slightly and comes down in the same place, and then the left step is withdrawn to stand together with the right foot, after which he steps up the right foot again — and so they push in alternation, repeatedly. B cooperates with A as in the first form: when A steps up the right foot, B retreats the right foot; when A withdraws the right step to stand together with the left foot, B draws back the right foot to stand together with the left foot. If A steps up the left foot, B retreats the left foot; if A withdraws the left step, B also draws back the left step to stand together with the right foot. In short, A and B must cooperate closely; when stepping up and changing steps they need only refer to the previous form. What differs is that the previous forms add a bringing-together of the feet so that the left and right steps can alternate with one another in a cycle. Note further: when stepping up, the stepping foot must be inserted into the opponent's crotch. For example, when A steps up the right foot, A's right foot is inserted into B's crotch and must stand together with B's right foot. When stepping up the left foot, A's left step must stand together with B's left foot.

3. Push hands with one step forward and one step back The upper-limb movements are the same. The lower-limb movements refer to the first form: on stepping up the right foot, the left foot is lifted and at once comes down in the same place, and then the right step is drawn back one step in retreat; after pressing down firmly the left foot is lifted, the left foot is raised and comes down in the same place, and then the right foot steps forward again — and so it continues, with only one step forward and one step back. Note only that when A steps up the right foot, B must retreat the left step, and when A retreats the right step, B must step up the left foot. If a bringing-together of the feet is added, then one may change hands and change feet (steps) in pushing. If in this way the left and right limbs can obtain balanced exercise.

4. Push hands with a step up and crotch insertion The movements refer to the previous; the difference is that when A steps up the right foot, B must retreat the right foot, and then A withdraws the right step and B must step up the right foot. At the same time, when B steps up, the foot must be inserted into the opponent's crotch, as in the second form, and they push in this way continuously. A bringing-together may also be added to change hands and change steps in pushing.

5. Push hands with left and right leaning The stepping is as in the second form. The only difference is that when A steps up the right foot and inserts into the crotch, the right side of his body leans toward B's chest, the left palm pressed into the hollow of the right elbow, and B retreats the right step and presses it full. After A withdraws the right step, he instead inserts the left step into B's crotch and leans the left side of his body toward B's chest, the right palm pressed into the hollow of the left elbow, and B retreats the left step and presses it full. Pushing continuously in this way feels very lively and spirited. A and B may also exchange in practice, provided only that they bring the feet together and change hands.

BOOK PAGE 259

Section Four — Great Roll-Back

Section Four — Great Roll-Back

Because the great roll-back is coordinated with stepping, the extent of the roll-back is greater than the roll-back in fixed-step push hands, and so it is called the great roll-back. And because the direction of the great roll-back's stepping is toward the four oblique corners (see the overall tendency of the schematic of the directions of the great roll-back stepping), it is also called the four-corner push-hands method. And because its main movements are roll-back and lean, and in each cycle the two together perform four roll-backs and four leans, it is also called four roll-backs and four leans. Because the changes of direction are many and the movements are of large extent, it is very much liked by students of the form.

1. The two stand facing north and south: suppose A faces south and B faces north, and the two form the double joining of hands with the right wrists crossed; suppose further that A rolls back and B leans, A retreating and B advancing. B changes to pressing A's right forearm with both hands, and A wards it with the right forearm (great roll-back figure 510; in the movement description this is the right form, in the diagram it is the left form). A retreats the right foot toward the northwest obliquely, the body turning right; at the same time he turns over the right hand and plucks (loosely grips) B's right wrist, and uses the left forearm (the ulnar side near the wrist) to stick to B's right upper arm (near the elbow joint) and roll back to the right. While A retreats, B strides the left foot across to the west (slightly north), follows A's plucking and rolling momentum, and steps the right foot forward to insert it into A's crotch; at the same time the left palm moves to rest on the inner side of the right elbow and he leans shoulder-first toward A's chest. (For the stepping see the schematic of the directions of the great roll-back stepping, 510A; for the posture see great roll-back figure 513. In the diagram Yang Chengfu is B.) There are five reference diagrams of the great roll-back postures, all traced from original photographs of Grandmaster Yang Chengfu; because there are no diagrams of the transitional movements they are hard to link up, but the postures of rolling back and leaning on both sides are all present, and so they are appended for reference.

2. A sinks the left forearm with the waist to dissolve B's leaning force, and flashes the right hand at B's face. (Great roll-back figure 512; Yang is A here. In this diagram B's posture has not leaned fully; the stance should be the same as Yang Chengfu's in great roll-back figure 513.)

3. B then receives A's right wrist with his own right wrist, and at the same time moves the left hand to stick above A's right elbow, and the two of them again return to the original double joining of hands with the right wrists crossed. While receiving A's right wrist, B steps up the left foot and, pivoting on the sole of the left foot, turns the body to the right and retreats the right foot, standing parallel with the left foot, turning to face east. A at the same time slightly lifts the left foot back, turns the toe in toward the south and sets the foot down, turns the body right, brings the right foot alongside, and turns to face west. (Great roll-back stepping figure 510B.)

Each cycle of the great roll-back requires walking four oblique corners. In the above — A retreating and B advancing, A rolling back and B leaning — they have walked one oblique corner and completed the first leaning movement. Then the second roll-back and lean is B retreating and A advancing, B rolling back and A leaning (the movement is as above, only A and B exchange; B's retreating direction is southwest — great roll-back stepping figure 511A); B turns to face south and A faces north (great roll-back stepping figure 511B). The third is again A retreating and B advancing, A rolling back and B leaning, then turning to face east (the movement as in the first, only the direction differs — great roll-back stepping figure 512A and B). The fourth is again B retreating and A advancing, B rolling back and A leaning, returning again to A facing south and B facing north (the movement as in the second — great roll-back stepping figure 513A and B). And so they practise in repeated cycles.

The above movements begin from the double joining of hands with the right wrists crossed; therefore, whether A or B, the roll-back and the lean walked are all right roll-back and right lean. If one wishes to walk left roll-back and left lean, one may change to beginning from the double joining of hands with the left wrists crossed, and follow the movements described above with left and right reversed (great roll-back figures 511 and 514). In practice the left and right may alternate.

图 510

Great Roll-Back: A retreats the step and turns the body aside, B steps up and inserts into the crotch, and leans shoulder-first toward A's chest.

图 511

Great Roll-Back: the second roll-back and lean — B retreats and A advances, B rolls back and A leans, the direction turning to the southwest.

图 512

Great Roll-Back: A sinks the left forearm with the waist to dissolve B's leaning force, and flashes the right hand at B's face (Yang is A here).

The techniques of the great roll-back are four: pluck, roll-back, elbow and lean. In practice the movements of pluck (together with roll-back) and of lean are very clearly displayed, while roll-back and elbow are not displayed, being used only in the variations.

The roll-back method — In Grandmaster Yang Chengfu's *Complete Book of Taijiquan for Body and Use*, in the explanation of the four-corner push hands of the great roll-back, "roll-back" is explained thus: "...taking hold of B's left wrist is plucking. If the right hand does not move, that is cutting off. As soon as it changes it becomes roll-back. Rolling back means sweeping aside B's left elbow, and striking obliquely at B's collar with the palm." This is explained in terms of A rolling back on the left and B leaning on the left. A plucks B's left wrist with the left hand, and at the same time uses the right forearm (the ulnar side near the wrist) to stick to B's left upper arm (slightly above the elbow joint) and roll back to the left; if "the right hand does not move," then the ulnar side "cuts off" B's left elbow joint; if "as soon as it changes it becomes roll-back," then the right hand "sweeps aside B's left elbow" and strikes obliquely at B's collar with the back of the hand on the thumb side. Hence the roll-back movement is not displayed in practice, and there is a roll-back movement only in the intent or in the variation. Thus the oblique strike with the back of the hand is taken as "roll-back." Besides this there are two other explanations: one takes the flash as the roll-back palm; the other takes it that, immediately after the left roll-back, the right elbow sinks and the right hand draws and dissolves B's leaning force — this being taken as the roll-back.

The elbow method — this too is an elbow movement in the intent or in the variation: when A rolls back on the left and cuts off B's left elbow with the right forearm, B then folds and stacks his left

elbow onto the upper side of A's right forearm and drives the tip of the elbow toward the top of A's chest — this being the elbow movement. From the sentence in *Complete Book of Taijiquan for Body and Use*, "The plucking posture. A plucks on the left and changes to the flash. The right is still the cut-off. B blocks with the left elbow" (People's Sports Publishing House, first edition July 1957, p. 42), it appears that it is also the one being rolled back who uses the elbow method by bringing the elbow to bear. But there is another view that it is the one rolling back who uses the elbow method — namely, when A rolls back on the left and B leans on the left, A uses the right elbow sinking to dissolve B's leaning force, this movement being taken as the elbow movement. Although the great roll-back is said to have the four techniques of pluck, roll-back, elbow and lean, it actually also includes the techniques of ward-off, press and push. For ward-off, roll-back and push, see in detail the movement descriptions of the great roll-back above. The press, before the one being rolled back uses the lean, contains the intent of pressing. In the variations, moreover, the one pressing also uses the press method: after A's left roll-back he still sticks the right forearm to B's left upper arm, releases the left hand from the lower pluck and moves it to rest at the right wrist, and this becomes the press form.

图 513

Great Roll-Back: A rolls back on the left, and B folds and stacks the left elbow onto the upper side of A's right forearm and drives the tip of the elbow toward A's chest.

图 514

Great Roll-Back: the posture of left roll-back and left lean (as shown in the original photograph of Yang Chengfu).

BOOK PAGE 262

Diagram of the Directions of the Great Roll-Back Stepping

Diagram of the Directions of the Great Roll-Back Stepping

(The whole page is the diagram of the stepping directions; there is no running text. The diagram is in eight panels, all using black and white footprints to show the direction of the footfalls, with a compass in the middle: north above, south below, west to the left and east to the right. The panels run down the left column as 510A, 511A, 512A and 513A, and down the right column as 510B, 511B, 512B and 513B. As this diagram belongs to the section as a stand-alone schematic and is not a numbered text illustration, it carries no figure number.)

BOOK PAGE 263

Photographs of Push Hands and the Great Roll-Back

Photographs of Push Hands and the Great Roll-Back

Demonstrators: Fu Zhongwen, Fu Shengyuan **Single push hands** (photos 1 to 3)

Four cardinal push hands (photos 4 to 7)

(This page is a plate of photographs; there is no running text. The photographs are numbered in the book's own photo series, not in the figure series used for the numbered text illustrations, and so no separate figure note is made.)

BOOK PAGE 264

Great Roll-Back

Great Roll-Back

(photos 8 to 16)

(This page is a plate of photographs; there is no running text. The photographs are numbered in the book's own photo series, not in the figure series used for the numbered text illustrations, and so no separate figure note is made.) (Photos 17 to 20, continuing the great roll-back photographs from the previous page. Besides the four photographs, this page also carries one decorative taiji yin-yang graphic; it is not a numbered text illustration and carries no figure number.)

(This page is a plate of photographs; there is no running text. With this, Chapter Three, Push Hands, is entirely concluded.)

Chapter Four — Important Writings of Famous Taijiquan Masters

BOOK PAGE 266

I. A Talk on the Practice of Taijiquan

I. A Talk on the Practice of Taijiquan

Orally related by Yang Chengfu Recorded by Zhang Hongkui Among the martial arts of China, though the schools are many and varied, one should know that all of them are techniques embodying philosophical principle. Throughout the ages there have been men of old who exhausted the energies of a whole lifetime and still could not exhaust the profundities — such cases are everywhere. If a student spends a single day's effort, he gains a single day's result; by daily accumulation and monthly increase, when the water arrives the channel is formed.

Taijiquan is the art of containing hardness within suppleness, of hiding a needle in cotton; in technique, in physiology and in mechanics it holds a considerable philosophical principle. Therefore one who studies this way must pass through a definite procedure and a considerable time. Though the guidance of a good teacher and the mutual sharpening of good friends are certainly indispensable, the most essential thing is daily training of oneself. Otherwise, though

one talks all day and yearns for years, on the day one joins hands there is emptiness and nothing there, and one remains an outsider — for there is nothing but daily work. This is what the ancients meant by "vain thought all day is not as good as study." If one can be unremitting morning and evening, unmoved by cold and heat, and the moment a thought arises take up the form and train, then whether old or young, male or female, the success is one and the same.

Recently, students of Taijiquan have spread from north to south, and like-minded people increase day by day; one cannot but rejoice for the future of the martial art. Yet among these people, though there is certainly no lack of those who train hard with single-minded devotion and sincerely seek learning, whose future is immeasurable, the ordinary run cannot avoid falling into one of two paths. The first: a man is naturally gifted, of strong years and strength, who from one instance infers three, whose intelligence stands out from the crowd — but alas, at a slight success he is content, and at once stops halfway, unable to receive the greater. The second: he is hasty in seeking quick results, and attains his form by neglect; before a year is out he has already learned boxing, sword, broadsword and spear — yet though he copies the gourd's shape, in reality he has not got the secret flavour of it. Once one examines his directions and movements, upper and lower, inner and outer, none of them accord with measure; if he wishes to correct them, then every form must be revised, and what is corrected in the morning is already forgotten by evening. Hence one often hears it said: "Learning the form is easy; correcting the form is hard." This saying arises entirely from hastening to completion. Such people, passing error on as error, come to mislead themselves and mislead others, and are the greatest cause for anxiety about the future of the art.

In beginning Taijiquan, one first practises the form frame. What is called the form frame is this: following the names of the forms in the boxing manual, form by form is taught by the teacher, and the student, with whole heart and quiet spirit, silently memorises and studies it, and performs it accordingly — this is called practising the frame. At this time the student should attend to inner and outer, upper and lower. What belongs to the inner is the so-called "use intent and not force": below, the qi sinks to the elixir field; above, the crown is suspended from the top. What belongs to the

BOOK PAGE 267

A Talk on the Practice of Taijiquan (continued)

A Talk on the Practice of Taijiquan (continued)

As for what shows outwardly: the whole body is light and nimble, and every joint is threaded through — from the feet to the legs, to the waist, letting the shoulders sink and the elbows bend. When first learning, take these few phrases and ponder them morning and evening, and taste them for yourself; for each posture and each hand, always examine carefully and probe. In moving and practising, strive above all for correctness. Once the practice has become pure, then

take up the second posture, and in this way gradually work through to the end of the form; if you do so, there will be nothing to go back and correct, and in time you will no longer need to be reminded of the key points.

In practising and moving, all the joints of the whole body must be relaxed and natural. First, the mouth and abdomen must not hold the breath; second, the four limbs, waist and legs must not put forth stiff force. These two sentences — students of the internal martial arts can all recite them; yet the moment they make one movement, turn one body, or kick a leg and swing the waist, their breath gasps and their body sways, and the fault lies precisely in holding the breath and putting forth stiff force.

1. In practising, the head must not tilt to the side nor tip forward or back; this is what is meant by "suspending the crown of the head" — as though something were held up on top of the head. Above all, beware of stiffening it straight; this is the meaning of the word "suspend." Though the eyes look level ahead, at times they must follow the movement of the body, and though the line of sight is empty, it is nonetheless a movement of key importance within the changes, supplementing what the body method and the hand method lack. The mouth is as if open, yet not open; as if closed, yet not closed; breathe out through the mouth and in through the nose, letting it be natural. If moisture forms beneath the tongue, swallow it with the body and do not spit it away.

2. The trunk should be centred and upright, not leaning; the spine and the coccyx should be vertical and not off-centre. But when meeting with the changes of opening and closing, there is the activity of "hollowing the chest and rounding the back," "sinking the shoulders and turning the waist"; at the time of first learning one must take note of this, otherwise in time it will be difficult to change, and one will surely fall into rigidity and stagnation, so that however deep one's skill, it will be hard to gain benefit and put it to use.

3. All the joints of the two arms must be relaxed and open. The shoulders should hang down, the elbows should bend downward, the palms should stretch slightly, and the fingertips should curve slightly. Move the arms with intent and thread the fingers with qi; as days and months accumulate, the internal power becomes penetrating and numinous, and its marvel quietly arises of itself.

4. The two legs should distinguish substantial and insubstantial, rising and falling like the walk of a cat. When the weight shifts to the left, the left is substantial and the right leg is called insubstantial; when it shifts to the right, the right is substantial and the left is called insubstantial. What is called insubstantial is not empty — its momentum is still unbroken, and it retains a reserve of intent for lengthening, shortening and changing. What is called substantial is simply solid, and does not mean that excessive force or violent strength is used. Thus the leg is bent to vertical as the standard; beyond this it is called overreaching in force, the body plunges forward, and the centred and upright posture is lost.

5. The sole of the foot should distinguish two forms — the kick (the left and right separate-foot or left and right raise-foot in the form) and the heel-push. In the kick, attend to the toe; in the heel-

push, attend to the whole sole. When the intent arrives, the qi arrives; when the qi arrives, the power arrives of itself. But the joints of the leg must all be relaxed and steady as it goes out. At this moment one most easily puts forth stiff force, the body lurches this way and that, and the leg is issued without power.

As for the sequence of Taijiquan: first practise the form (which belongs to the bare-hand work), such as the Taijiquan and the Taiji Long Fist; next, single-hand push, in-place push-hands, moving-step push-hands, the Great Roll-back, and free-hand sparring; after that come the weapons, such as the Taiji Sword, the Taiji Sabre, the Taiji Spear (the Thirteen-Spear), and so on.

As for practice times: twice each day after rising; if there is no time in the morning, then twice before sleeping. Within a single day one should practise seven or eight times, and at the very least once at dawn and once at dusk. But after drunkenness and after a full meal, both should be avoided.

As for the place of practice: a courtyard and a hall that can let air through and that has plenty of light are suitable. Avoid places with harsh wind blowing directly upon one and places with damp, mouldy air; for once the body is set in motion the breathing is sure to become deep and long, and so if harsh wind and mouldy air penetrate deep into the abdomen they harm the organs and easily bring on illness. As for the clothing for practice, a wide cut of Chinese short jacket and broad-toed cloth shoes are suitable. When practising over a long stretch, if you come to sweat, on no account wipe yourself with cold water, otherwise there is none who will not fall ill.

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II. Ten Essentials of Taijiquan

II. Ten Essentials of Taijiquan

Orally related by Yang Chengfu Recorded by Chen Weiming 1. **Suspend the crown and lift the energy to the top** — "Lifting the energy to the top" means the head is held upright, with the spirit threaded to the crown of the head. One must not use force; if force is used the neck becomes stiff and the blood and qi cannot flow. There must be the sense of an empty, numinous naturalness. Without suspending the crown and lifting the energy to the top, the spirit cannot be raised.

2. **Hollow the chest and round the back** — "Hollowing the chest" means the chest is slightly drawn in, so that the qi sinks to the cinnabar field. The chest must not be thrust out; if thrust out, the qi crowds at the chest, the upper is heavy and the lower light, and the heels easily float up. "Rounding the back" means the qi clings to the back. If one can hollow the chest one can naturally round the back; if one can round the back, the power can issue from the spine, and there is nothing one faces that one cannot overcome.

3. **Relax the waist** — The waist is the sovereign of the whole body. Only if the waist can relax will the two feet have strength and the lower base be steady; all the changes of substantial and insubstantial come from the turning of the waist. Hence it is said: "The source of life and intent lies in the hollow of the waist." Whenever one cannot get power, one must seek it from the waist and legs.

4. **Distinguish substantial and insubstantial** — Taijiquan takes the distinguishing of substantial and insubstantial as its first essential meaning. If the whole body sits on the right leg, then the right leg is substantial and the left leg is insubstantial; if the whole body sits on the left leg, then the left leg is substantial and the right leg is insubstantial. If substantial and insubstantial can be distinguished, then turning is light and nimble, with no effort at all; if they cannot be distinguished, then stepping is heavy and sluggish, one stands unstably, and one is easily pulled about by another.

5. **Sink the shoulders and drop the elbows** — "Sinking the shoulders" means the shoulders loosen and hang down. If they cannot loosen and hang, the two shoulders rise up, and the qi follows them up with it, so that the whole body loses its power. "Dropping the elbows" means the sense of the elbows loosening and dropping downward; if the elbows are held suspended, the shoulders cannot sink, one cannot send a person far, and one comes near to the broken power of the external schools.

6. **Use intent and not force** — The *Taijiquan Treatise* says: this is entirely a matter of using intent and not force. In practising Taijiquan the whole body loosens and opens; not the slightest clumsy force is allowed to linger between the sinews, bones and blood vessels so as to bind oneself — only then can one be light, nimble and changing, turning round and freely as one wishes. Some may doubt: if one does not use force, how can force grow? Now, the body has its channels and collaterals as the earth has its ditches and channels: if the ditches and channels are not blocked the water flows, and if the channels and collaterals are not closed the qi passes through. If the whole body is full of stiff force throughout the channels and collaterals, then the blood and qi stagnate, turning is not nimble, and pulling one hair moves the whole body. But if one does not use force and uses intent instead, then where the intent arrives the qi arrives with it; and so the blood and qi flow and pour in, day by day infusing, circulating through the whole body with no moment of stagnation. Practise long and long, and one gains the true internal power — which is what the *Taijiquan Treatise* calls "supremely soft, and then supremely firm and hard." For one whose Taijiquan skill has ripened, the arm is like cotton wrapped around iron, and its weight is exceedingly heavy; whereas one who practises an external-school boxing shows force when he uses force, and when he does not use force he is very light and buoyant — from which one can see that his force is the outward, surface force of external power. To use force and not intent is what most easily stirs one into motion, and is not to be prized.

7. **Upper and lower follow one another** — This is what the *Taijiquan Treatise* says: "Its root is in the feet, it issues from the legs, it is governed by the waist, and it takes shape in the fingers; from the feet to the legs to the waist, there must always be one complete qi." The hand moves,

the foot moves, the leg moves, and the gaze follows and moves with them; only thus can it be called upper and lower following one another. If one thing does not move, then it is scattered and disordered.

8. **Inner and outer unite** — What Taijiquan practises lies in the spirit; hence it is said: "The spirit is the commander-in-chief, the body is the one driven." If the spirit can be raised, then naturally the movement is light and nimble. The frame is nothing other than the opening and closing of substantial and insubstantial. What is called opening is not only the hands and feet opening — the mind and intent open along with them; what is called closing is not only the hands and feet closing — the mind and intent close along with them. If one can unite inner and outer into one qi, then all is one seamless whole.

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II. Ten Essentials of Taijiquan (continued)

II. Ten Essentials of Taijiquan (continued)

9. **Linked without interruption** — In the external schools of boxing, the power is the acquired, clumsy power, and so it has a beginning and an ending, times of continuation and times of break: the old power is spent and the new power not yet born, and at such a moment one is most easily taken advantage of. Taijiquan uses intent and not force; from first to last it is unbroken and continuous, going round and beginning again, cycling without end. The original treatise's words "like the great Yangtze and the sea, rolling on without cease," and again "in movement like drawing silk," both speak of its being threaded through as one qi.

10. **Seek stillness within movement** — In the external schools of boxing, leaping and bounding are taken as the skill, and all one's strength is used up, so that after practice there is none who is not out of breath. Taijiquan governs movement with a still mind; though it moves, it is as if still — hence the slower one practises the frame, the better. When slow, the breathing is deep and long, the qi sinks to the cinnabar field, and there is naturally none of the fault of blood and pulse swelling. Students who taste this with care may perhaps grasp its meaning.

III. A Treatise on Taijiquan

Wang Zongyue Taijiquan is born of the Ultimateless, and is the mother of yin and yang. In movement they separate, in stillness they join; without excess and without shortfall, following the bend and yielding to the stretch. When the other is hard and I am soft, this is called "yielding"; when I am in accord and the other is contrary, this is called "sticking." If the other moves urgently I respond urgently; if the other moves slowly I follow slowly. Though the changes are of ten thousand kinds, the principle runs through as one. From familiarity with the postures one gradually awakens to understanding power; from understanding power one ascends step by step

to the numinous. Yet without long practice of the work, one cannot break through with sudden insight. Suspend the crown and lift the energy to the top, sink the qi to the cinnabar field; do not lean and do not tilt; now hidden, now revealed. Where the left is heavy, then the left is insubstantial; where the right is heavy, then the right vanishes. Raise it and it grows higher; press it down and it grows deeper; advance it and it grows longer; retreat it and it grows more urgent. A single feather cannot be added; a fly or an insect cannot alight. The other does not know me, while I alone know the other — that the hero finds nothing he faces that he cannot overcome follows from this. This art has many side doors. Though the postures differ, they come to no more than the strong bullying the weak, the slow giving way to the fast, the powerless struck by the powerful, and the slow hand yielding to the fast hand. These are all innate natural capacities, not a matter of acquired learning and deliberate effort. Observe the phrase "four ounces deflect a thousand catties" — plainly it is not victory by force. See the form in which a man of eighty or ninety can hold off a crowd — what use is speed there? Stand like a balance scale, move like a wheel; if one side is heavy it follows, if it is double-heavy it stagnates. One constantly sees those of several years of pure practice who cannot transform, and are invariably taken in hand by others: they have not awakened to the fault of double-heaviness. To avoid this fault one must know yin and yang. Sticking is yielding, and yielding is sticking. Yang does not leave yin, yin does not leave yang. Only when yin and yang aid one another is there understanding of power. After understanding power, the more one practises the finer one becomes. Silently and wordlessly pondering, one gradually arrives at doing as one's heart desires. This is at root "giving up oneself and following the other"; many go wrong by giving up the near and seeking the far. As it is said, "a hair's breadth of difference, and the error is a thousand miles." Students must not fail to distinguish this most carefully — this is the treatise.

As for the Long Fist: it is like the great Yangtze and the sea, rolling on without cease. Ward-off, roll-back, press and push, pluck, split, elbow and shoulder — these are the eight trigrams. Advancing step, retreating step, looking left, gazing right, and central equilibrium — these are the five elements. Ward-off, roll-back, press and push are the four cardinal directions, Qian, Kun, Kan and Li. Pluck, split, elbow and shoulder are Xun, Zhen, Dui and Gen, the four diagonal corners. Advance, retreat, look, gaze and equilibrium are metal, wood, water, fire and earth. Joined together they make the thirteen postures.

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IV. Song of the Thirteen Postures

IV. Song of the Thirteen Postures

(Author unknown)

The thirteen overall postures are not to be made light of; the source of life and intent lies in the hollow of the waist; in changing and turning, substantial and insubstantial, one must take care,

and the qi must spread through the body without the least stagnation. Struck within stillness, moving yet still; showing the marvellous according to the enemy's changes. Posture by posture keep it in mind and weigh its intent; what you gain, you will not feel to have cost you effort. Moment by moment keep your mind on the waist; within the belly, loose and still, the qi rises. The coccyx is centred and the spirit threads to the crown; the whole body is light and agile, the crown of the head suspended. Carefully keep your mind on pushing and seeking; in bending and stretching, opening and closing, let it be free. To enter the gate and be led on the way, one must be taught by word of mouth; the work never ceases, and the method one cultivates oneself. If you ask what is the standard for substance and function — intent and qi are the ruler, bone and flesh the minister; think: what after all is the aim of this intent? To lengthen life and prolong the years, an unaging spring. Sing it, sing it — the hundred and forty; every word is true and its meaning loses nothing. If you do not push and seek in this direction, you waste your effort and are left with sighs.

V. Heart of the Practice of the Thirteen Postures

Wu Yuxiang Use the mind to move the qi, and be sure to make it calm and settled. Only then can it gather and enter the bones, and use the qi to move the body. Be sure to make it smooth and compliant; only then can it be easy and follow the mind. If the spirit can be raised, there is no fear of sluggishness and heaviness — this is what is meant by "suspending the crown of the head." Intent and qi must be changed with agility; only then is there the delight of roundness and liveliness — this is what is meant by "changing and turning, substantial and insubstantial." In issuing power one must be calm, loose and clean, concentrating on one direction. In standing the body one must be centred, upright, at ease and comfortable, bracing in eight directions. Moving the qi is like a pearl of nine turnings, going everywhere without obstruction (this means the qi spreads through the body). Moving is like steel tempered a hundred times, crushing everything hard. In form like a falcon striking a rabbit, in spirit like a cat catching a mouse. Still as a mountain peak, moving as rivers and streams. Storing power like drawing a bow, issuing power like loosing an arrow. Seek the straight within the curved, store and then issue. Power issues from the spine, the step changes with the body. Gathering is issuing, broken and again joined. In going and returning there must be folding; in advancing and retreating there must be turning and exchange. Supremely soft, and then supremely firm and hard. Able to breathe, and then able to be nimble. The qi is nourished by straightness and takes no harm; the power is stored by curving and has surplus. The mind is the command, the qi is the banner; the waist is the great standard. First seek expansion, then seek compactness — only then can one attain to fine exactness.

It is also said: if the other does not move, I do not move; if the other moves slightly, I move first. The power is as if loose yet not loose, about to extend yet not extended. The power breaks but the intent does not break. It is also said: the mind comes first, the body after. The belly is loose, the qi gathers into the bones; the spirit is at ease, the body is still. Moment by moment keep it in mind. Remember firmly: if one thing moves, nothing does not move; if one thing is still, nothing is not still. Drawing and sending to and fro, the qi clings to the back and gathers into the spine.

Within, solidify the spirit; without, show ease and calm. Step like the walk of a cat, move the power like drawing silk. The whole body's intent is in the spirit, not in the qi — if it is in the qi, then it stagnates. One who has qi has no power; one who has no qi is purely firm. The qi is like a cartwheel, the waist like the axle.

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VI. A Treatise on Taijiquan

VI. A Treatise on Taijiquan

Wu Yuxiang In every movement the whole body must be light and nimble, and above all threaded through. The qi should be roused and stirred, the spirit should be gathered within. Let there be no place of deficiency, no place of concavity or convexity, no place of break or interruption. Its root is in the feet and it issues from the legs; it is governed by the waist and takes shape in the fingers. From the feet to the legs to the waist, there must always be one complete qi. Only then, advancing and retreating, can one gain the moment and gain the position. Where one fails to gain the moment and the position, the body becomes scattered and disordered, and the fault must be sought in the waist and legs — this holds for above and below, front and back, left and right. All of this is intent, and is not on the outside. Where there is above there is below; where there is front there is back; where there is left there is right. If the intent wants to go up, it lodges a downward intent. If you lift a thing up and add to it the force of a check, then its root breaks of itself — there is no doubt that this destroys it quickly. Substantial and insubstantial should be clearly distinguished: every place has its own substantial and insubstantial. Everywhere it is always this one substantial and insubstantial, and the whole body is threaded through joint by joint. Do not let there be the least interruption.

VII. Song of Striking Hands

Revised by Wang Zongyue Ward-off, roll-back, press and push must be done in earnest; upper and lower following one another, the opponent finds it hard to enter. Let him come at me with giant force — drawing him out, four ounces deflect a thousand catties. Lure him in, let him fall into emptiness, join and issue; stick, connect, adhere and follow, neither letting go nor resisting.

VIII. A Brief Talk on Practising Taijiquan

Fu Zhongwen In recent years Taijiquan has become a sport loved by the broad masses of the people. And the theory of Taijiquan has developed from a purely technical standpoint into an exploration grounded in science. This is something to be glad about.

I loved Taijiquan from the time I was a boy. Under the enlightenment and teaching of my teacher Yang Chengfu, I would not presume to say how much I have understood — only that in seventy

years I have never once broken off. Precisely because I have persevered without slackening and practised Taijiquan earnestly, my constitution has been strengthened.

Taijiquan possesses a high degree of artistry and scientific content: it is subtle and fine, and its theory is profound. If one can, in accordance with the theory

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VIII. A Brief Talk on Practising Taijiquan (continued)

VIII. A Brief Talk on Practising Taijiquan (continued)

...to train, then once one has real skill one can better grasp the inner delight of Taijiquan. To practise Taijiquan well, besides following the theoretical guidance of the sages of old and the pointers to the essentials, I hold that one must attend to several aspects.

First, one must grasp the meaning of "power" (*jin*). When one has practised Taijiquan earnestly to the appropriate stage, one will develop power. This power is a kind of "undifferentiated power," and it is the foundation of entry into Taijiquan. Hence it is said, "after understanding power, the more one practises the finer one becomes." By my own experience, this power is like a whole stretch of autumn reeds by a lake, blown down by a great wind and rising again — tough and not broken, supple yet with resilience. It is also like the rolling waves of the ocean: the substance of the water is soft, yet it holds a very deep and mighty force. Once the undifferentiated power has been developed, one goes on further, to develop from that undifferentiated power a "light and nimble power." The undifferentiated power is a deep, rich strength hidden and not displayed, so that one attains "firmness within softness." The light and nimble power means both possessing the feeling of lightness and nimbleness and being able to turn round and move with liveliness. Only by binding these two powers tightly together so that they serve one another can one reconcile firm and soft, and wrap a needle in cotton; and only when one can further transform and break them down into ward-off, roll-back, press and push, and can apply these powers with agility, can one reach the goal of thorough comprehension and doing as one's hands and heart desire, and so enter a realm of high artistry.

If one would develop power in Taijiquan, it cannot be done by mere brute courage and crude practice, without tasting its meaning and studying its frame. Beyond bitter practice of one's own, one must practise so that everything accords with the principles and requirements and squares with reality. This calls for attending to the following four points in daily practice.

One: the gaze is level, and must be concentrated and lively; when each posture changes, the line of sight must follow the movement of the body. Above all, avoid a wooden stare or looking wildly about.

Two: the waist is the sovereign of the whole body, and in practising one must "raise the waist." A mnemonic verse has it: "How can body shape and raised waist ever be absent?" In postures

such as Cloud Hands, Brush Knee and Twist Step, the Diagonal Flying Posture, Needle at the Bottom of the Sea, and High Pat on Horse, the waist must be lifted and upright, like a pivot turning, and in the turning it never leaves the axis. It is also like a compass needle: the needle moves but the needle's axis does not leave its original position. What the martial artists call "holding the central earth" means precisely that the central earth does not leave its original position. To cite mechanics, this is the action of the centre of gravity. Therefore in practising one must study "the coccyx centred." The spirit threads to the crown; only when the coccyx is centred can one maintain the centre of gravity, without the faults of a tilted posture or a frame that overreaches or falls short. If, in practising, one lowers the head and hunches the shoulders, and the waist is not lifted, then the centre of gravity is lost — that is what is called a "sunken waist." As the saying goes, "head lowered, waist sunken, the skill is not high." For when the waist sinks the breathing is not free, the qi cannot sink, the crown cannot be empty and void, substantial and insubstantial are indistinct, and upper and lower cannot be threaded through as one qi — in the end one never practises to a high and luminous degree.

Three: the four limbs. On the movement of the four limbs in Taijiquan there is a saying: "arms like *ruyi*, legs like a winnowing basket rim." That is, both the arms and the legs must have a slight sense of bending and holding in reserve, and must not be stretched out too straight. "Power has surplus by holding in reserve" refers precisely to this. In postures such as Single Whip and Part the Wild Horse's Mane, the rear leg is slightly bent and rounded outward. Only so can one achieve the front bow and rear push, with the force issuing from the heel, like a tree rooted in the earth so that the whole body is steady — and not, instead, thrusting too straight backward. In general, the four limbs must be round and smooth, nimble and alive, steady and solid; above all, avoid stiff straightness.

Let me now set out the several joints one by one:

(1) One should sit the wrist and stand the palm upright, but the centre of the palm should be slightly concave and must not be flat — this is essential.

(2) The fingers should not be too straight, and the gaps between the fingers should not be closed tight; they should be as if open yet not open, and after long practice the power arises of itself.

(3) The shoulders must be loose, lively and sunken; one must not use stiff strength or have the sense of raising them up.

VIII. A Brief Talk on Practising Taijiquan (continued)

VIII. A Brief Talk on Practising Taijiquan (continued)

(4) The elbows must hang down. In a posture such as White Crane Spreads Its Wings, though the arms are lifted upward, the tip of the elbow must have a downward intent.

(5) The shoulder should lead the elbow, and the elbow should lead the wrist; and again, the fingers should lead the palm, and the palm should carry the arm while the elbow sinks and the shoulder relaxes. One should also use the intent of the waist and legs to match the hand, elbow and shoulder, so that upper and lower are linked through. Though there may be a slight order of before and after, the movement must be coordinated and threaded through joint by joint. One must not overreach in power; overreaching in power makes one stiff.

(6) In stepping, the heel must touch ground first, and then one settles it firmly, little by little — this is what is meant by "stepping like the walk of a cat." The image of a cat's walk is a marvellous one: the step is both light and nimble and steady and solid, while the body is lively. At the same time the knee follows forward, but in the bow stance one must not overreach in power (meaning that the knee should not pass beyond the toes), so that advancing and retreating can be nimble. The rear foot should hold a ward-off power, and must on no account be tilted over.

(7) The lifting and setting of the feet, as in the Cloud Hands posture: in the crossing step one must first lift the heel, and then lift the toes. After the crossing step, when the foot comes down, the toes must touch ground first, and then one settles it firmly, little by little. If one can do this, then left and right, substantial and insubstantial, are naturally clearly distinguished.

(8) One must hollow the chest. Hollowing the chest is not the same as a sunken waist or a caved-in chest; rather, all the joints of the two arms must be relaxed and open, the elbows hanging down, and the breathing natural.

(9) Open the crotch. Opening the crotch does not mean a wide step; it really means relaxing the hips — when the hips are relaxed, the crotch opens of itself.

(10) The crotch must be level, and when the crotch is level the lower base is steady. At the same time, on the basis of a level crotch the intent must also lift upward: lift the crotch and thread it to the crown. This must be done naturally, and then the head is naturally centred and upright, the breathing free and easy, the bearing calm and comfortable; and thereby one can have upper and lower following one another, every posture even, and can grasp for oneself the delight of a whole body light, nimble, round and lively.

IV. State of Mind

(1) The mind must be still while the spirit must be roused; avoid lowering the brows and downcast eyes, listless and dispirited, lacking vitality. But one must also avoid glaring with

knitted brows and a thrust-out chest and bared teeth. The whole body must be threaded through joint by joint; do not let there be the least interruption.

(2) Value the experience accumulated by those who came before, and train earnestly in accordance with the classic frames. But one must practise so as to be natural, loose and clean, so that every movement makes the whole body light and nimble. One must "follow the rules, become familiar with the rules, transform the rules — yet never leave the rules." With this resolute spirit, only then can one practise to gaining the moment and gaining the position.

In sum, every frame in Taijiquan has its own essential meaning, and one must ponder it with all one's heart and grasp it with care. In raising the hand and setting the foot, one must not be too clumsy; if too clumsy, then the waist and legs do not follow and the whole body easily becomes stiff. The step must change with the body, and in advancing and retreating there must be folding. In posture one must first seek expansion, and afterwards seek compactness. Pay attention at all times, work on every posture, keep every posture clear and not vague; it must be linked through, completed in one breath. As days and months accumulate, when the work is complete it comes of itself.

IX. Theoretical Research in Taijiquan Is an Important Subject

Fu Zhongwen Our country's martial arts have a very early origin; examine the history and truly their source is distant and their stream long. From the relevant materials, masters of deep martial skill and transcendent art are also many, too many to enumerate. To speak of Yang-style Taijiquan alone,

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IX. Theoretical Research in Taijiquan Is an Important Subject (continued)

IX. Theoretical Research in Taijiquan Is an Important Subject (continued)

The details cannot all be told at once; let me speak of what I know, and of my own experience.

I was born in my home town on South Street inside the city of Yongnian, a place that loved Taijiquan. From childhood I had my ears and eyes steeped in it, and quite naturally I came to love this boxing art as well.

Our founding master, Yang Lukchan, was a man of the South Gate of Yongnian. Because Taijiquan was then current in our county, many people studied the art under Lukchan, and students revered him as the founding master of Yang-style Taijiquan.

Yang-style Taijiquan, seen from its outward form, is soft and yielding as one practises the frame, and so in the north it is also called "cotton boxing." In fact the power within it is out of the ordinary: one must move as if drawing silk, continuous and unbroken, and yet must attain the requirement of "a needle wrapped in cotton"; and when one issues power, it is truly majestic and mighty indeed.

I hold that to practise this art of Taijiquan well one must put in bitter effort, for skill is produced by solid, honest practice. One must learn earnestly and practise assiduously. The masters of the older generations all produced their skill through long years and a tenacious, peerless will. When the skill is deep and the attainment high, reaching a certain realm, it is sublimated into theory; and so the sages of old summed up much precious experience. Works such as Wang Zongyue's *Treatise on Taijiquan* and Master Yang Chengfu's *A Talk on Practising Taijiquan* and others are all famous documents that set a model for later generations, so that those who come after have something to follow and take fewer crooked roads.

In the past there were also many relevant works on Taijiquan. Some authors wrote with great plausibility, but when you follow their talk round and round, most of it is copied back and forth from other writings, with little real skill behind it — truly a case of idle boasting. I myself have not practised hard enough either, so I can only speak of my own experience.

I hold that the skill of Taijiquan did not begin with theory; rather, the men of old practised over the long term, and through much time many masters gradually accumulated experience, and then deepened their understanding, put it into practice, and gradually produced a rich body of writing. This is the sublimation of skill, and also the guide to skill. Take calligraphy: at first people simply practised writing characters, and there was very little written exposition of method. Later, masters such as Wang Xizhi summed up the way to hold the brush and the requirements of writing, and thereafter many famous calligraphers appeared, and at the same time the content of the art of calligraphy was enriched. Practising Taijiquan is like the art of calligraphy: the frame must be practised until it is light, nimble and round, free and natural, yet upright and generous; the spirit must be full yet held within, and the bearing must be upright and lifted, avoiding listlessness. In the joining of one frame to the next, in the course of the movement, one must be like the calligrapher's "hiding the head and guarding the tail," turning round and smooth yet with reserve — and yet posture must be clear and not vague. Though there are fixed postures, one must not be wooden and stagnant; every posture must be linked through, moved with lightness and nimbleness. One must combine expansion with compactness, guarding against scattering and against stiffness. Know that "light and nimble" is not flightiness, and that calmness is not woodenness; one must make the practising of a whole set of frames turn round freely, every posture complete, finished in one breath. For the one practising, there is the sense of "the heart apprehending, the spirit understanding"; for the one watching, there is a feeling of peace and ease and comfort. Thus Taijiquan is indeed a method of exercise that can bring a person health and long life.

At present, judging by the momentum of Taijiquan's development, its prospects are indeed bright. But in order to carry forward and magnify this martial art, we must dig out the experience of the older generations, and take the profound and essential meanings within it, its true substance, and through practice and more practice advance our technique, so that the art of "a needle wrapped in cotton" may bloom in more brilliant flowers and bear more abundant fruit. And so, how to take the theory of those who came before and again put it in the service of those who come after — to study its essential spirit...

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IX. Theoretical Research in Taijiquan Is an Important Subject (continued)

IX. Theoretical Research in Taijiquan Is an Important Subject (continued)

...its essential spirit, to advance the skill of Taijiquan and raise its artistic level — this is in truth a subject of the greatest importance.

X. The Essentials of Practising Taijiquan and What to Avoid

Fu Zhongwen Taijiquan is a precious martial-arts heritage of our country. Because it has a tremendous effect in promoting people's health and in casting off illness and prolonging life, it is deeply loved by the people.

I loved Taijiquan from childhood, and at the age of nine I became a student of Yang Chengfu of the Yang family gate of Taijiquan. Over seventy years I have kept up my practice without a single break; and though I have now reached a great age, I am still strong of body, clear of ear and eye, and whole in tooth. How should one practise to attain the best result, and what problems should one watch out for? Let me now speak of my own experience to my friends in the martial world.

Taijiquan divides into substantial and insubstantial (that is, yin and yang). In practising Taijiquan there is the insubstantial and the substantial, and firm and soft aid one another; hence the method of practising Taijiquan is required to accord with dialectics. In practising, one must first be still of mind — that is, concentrate one's thought and clear away distracting notions. Taijiquan requires stillness within movement: the mind must be still while the spirit must be roused; one must above all avoid lowering the brows and downcast eyes, listless and dispirited, lacking vitality. But one must also avoid glaring angrily with wide eyes and a thrust-out chest and bared teeth.

Second, the key to practising lies in correct posture, and it is required that every posture be even. Whether one's practice is correct can be seen from the practitioner's waist and body, because the waist is the sovereign of the whole body. In practising one must raise the waist — in

postures such as Cloud Hands, Brush Knee and Twist Step, the Diagonal Flying Posture, Needle at the Bottom of the Sea, and High Pat on Horse, the waist must be lifted and upright, like a pivot turning, and in turning it never leaves the axis. It is also like a compass needle: the needle moves but the needle's axis does not leave its original position. If in practising the waist is not lifted and the centre of gravity is lost, that is what is called a "sunken waist." As the saying goes, "head lowered, waist sunken, the skill is not high." For when the waist sinks the breathing is not free, the qi cannot sink, the crown cannot be empty and void, substantial and insubstantial are indistinct, and upper and lower cannot be threaded through as one qi — in the end one cannot reach a high and luminous level. Many beginners are prone to the disease of impatience, hoping to finish learning the whole set of postures in a short time. In fact, "haste does not bring success." If at the start one does not demand correct posture, then later it will be hard to correct the frame. Incorrect posture will affect the efficacy of one's practice. In sum, one must "follow the rules, transform the rules, yet never leave the rules."

Again, in practising the gaze must be level, and must be concentrated and lively. As each posture of Taiji changes, the line of sight must follow the movement of the body; above all, avoid a wooden stare. In practising there are definite requirements for the movement of the four limbs. There is a saying: "arms like *ruyi*, legs like a winnowing basket rim." That is, the arms and legs must be slightly bent and must not be stretched too straight; both overreaching and falling short are improper. "Power has surplus by bending and storing" refers precisely to this. In postures such as Single Whip and Part the Wild Horse's Mane, with the right leg slightly bent and turned outward, one can achieve the front bow and the right push, with the force issuing from the heel. In general, the four limbs must be round and smooth, nimble and alive, steady and solid; above all, avoid stiff straightness.

In addition, in practising the shoulders must be loose, lively and sunken; one must not use stiff strength or have the intent of raising the shoulders, and the elbows must hang down. As in the White Crane...

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X. The Essentials of Practising Taijiquan and What to Avoid (continued)

X. The Essentials of Practising Taijiquan and What to Avoid (continued)

...Spread Its Wings, though the arms are lifted upward, the tip of the elbow must have a downward intent. At the same time attend to hollowing the chest; all the joints of the two arms must be opened apart, and the breathing natural.

One who practises must also give attention to the way of nourishing life, and should achieve "diligence, constancy, courtesy and sincerity." Diligence means industriousness and frugality: in

material life one should be tranquil and indifferent to fame or gain, and on no account give oneself up to pleasure. Constancy means a steady heart: practising the martial art and the boxing is not the work of a single day; it requires persistence — above all avoid one day of exposure and ten days of cold, and avoid stopping as soon as one has had a taste. Courtesy means politeness: in dealing with people and handling things one should be open and generous, tolerant and forbearing, and not haggle over small matters. Sincerity means being genuine: whether in practising the boxing or in conducting oneself, one must be open-hearted and aboveboard, whole-hearted and true, modest and prudent. As the saying goes, "when the heart is sincere, it works." Sincerity of heart is the foundation of success in every undertaking.

XI. On the Medical Efficacy of Taijiquan

Fu Zhongwen For the elderly to exercise the body there are many and various forms of movement — taking a walk, kicking the legs, bending the waist and so on — but the comparatively correct and comparatively systematic form of exercise is still the sport of Taijiquan.

I have taught Yang-style Taijiquan at Tongji University for more than ten years. Many comrades of weak health have, through practising Yang-style Taijiquan, gradually recovered their health. There was one teacher who had suffered from stomach trouble for many years, with more than ten major haemorrhages over three years, so that he could not even eat rice gruel. After a year of practising the boxing his condition improved, and he led students out to do fieldwork. Comrade Li Guohao, honorary president of Tongji University and chairman of the municipal Political Consultative Conference, also kept up his daily practice, and many times led the staff Taijiquan team to take part in the university's athletics meet, where they even won the team championship.

According to many years of scientific measurement at Tongji University, the sport of Taijiquan effectively improves the function of the cardiovascular system. It can lower cholesterol, triglycerides and free fatty acids, strengthen the activity of the anticoagulant system in the blood, and lower the level of uric acid in the blood, and thereby help resist platelet aggregation and prevent the formation of blood clots. This is of great benefit in preventing and treating cardiovascular disease in the elderly. The physiological functions of the elderly gradually decline with age; the cardiac output falls as age increases, and in addition the arteries readily harden, so that the blood supply to the internal organs is insufficient, and the heart, brain, kidneys and other important organs are especially liable to disease. But if one persists in practising Taijiquan, it can increase the blood circulation of the heart and raise the blood and oxygen supply to the organs of the whole body. It has been measured that after practising, both the systolic and diastolic blood pressure of the human body can fall by about ten millimetres of mercury. In addition it has good effects on the respiratory system, the bones, the joints, the muscles, and the metabolism of substances within the body.

After Liberation, the sport of Taijiquan was spread abroad, and in hospitals and sanatoria it has been listed as an important part of comprehensive therapy. That Taijiquan prevents illness, treats

illness and prolongs life is already acknowledged by all.

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XII. On the Method of Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan

XII. On the Method of Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan

Fu Shengyuan The movements of Taijiquan are movements of the whole body, not of a part; they are gentle movements, not violent movements. And its movement of the whole body and its gentle movement are precisely the Taiji movement that is continuous and unbroken, with firm and soft aiding one another: it is a spontaneous tendency, not something mysterious; it takes the natural movement of the body, with no forcing or contrivance anywhere in it. As for what Taiji means — using the principle of Taijiquan's movements to explain the meaning of the name "Taijiquan," without the least far-fetched attachment to mysterious talk, and without resorting to the fashionable jargon or mnemonic formulas of the boxing world for vague and impressionistic talk.

Consider the two characters "Tai Ji," which appear in the *Xici* commentary of the *Zhouyi*. The *Xici* says: "In the *Yi* there is the Supreme Ultimate, which gives birth to the two modes; the two modes give birth to the four images; the four images give birth to the eight trigrams." Let us explain this sentence in plain words: the two modes, the four images and the eight trigrams are all born of the Supreme Ultimate. The Supreme Ultimate is the primordial motive force of everything. The movement of the two modes, four images and eight trigrams is entirely the movement of the Supreme Ultimate. The cosmos is one Supreme Ultimate, and the human body is also one Supreme Ultimate. The belly of the human body (that is, the cinnabar field) is the Supreme Ultimate; the two flanks are the two modes; the two hands and two feet are the four images; and the two hands and two feet, each having two joints, make the eight trigrams.

The primordial motive force of the cosmos lies in the Supreme Ultimate; the primordial motive force of the human body also lies in the Supreme Ultimate. The movements of Taijiquan take the belly as their master. The belly is the most central place of the human body; when this place moves, there is nothing in the whole body that does not move. In the sport of Taijiquan, if one does not move, then nothing moves; but when one moves, the whole body moves. Hence a movement in which the whole body does not move is not Taiji. The belly is the most central place of the whole body; when the belly moves, the two flanks, the two hands and the two feet move swiftly without haste. The movements of Taijiquan take their origin from the belly (that is, the cinnabar field) as their master; without using violent force, there is no movement of the whole body that is not reached — outwardly exceedingly soft and gentle, inwardly a force continuous and unbroken, growing breath by breath.

In learning Taijiquan one must understand the importance of the three characters "loose," "solid" and "gathered." What is "loose"? The body must be loose. What is "solid"? The qi must be solid.

What is "gathered"? The spirit must be gathered. Body loose, qi solid, spirit gathered — and one can gradually reach the realm of Taiji! But the reason why this is so can only be grasped by oneself once the student has practised to a certain degree.

(One) The body must be loose. The plain explanation of the character "loose" is simply not using force (not using stiff force), for as soon as one uses force, the movement cannot be natural. In the part where one deliberately applies force, the other parts are sure to be out of balance. Without using stiff force the movement is natural, spreading through the whole body, reaching everywhere without exception, and even and uniform throughout — and looseness is not the same as emptiness. To force the use of strength is hard: that is what is called clumsy force; and though clumsy force is great, it is the force of a part and does not hit the mark. Not using force is soft: that is what is called sinking power; and though sinking power is light and small, it is the force of the whole and can hit the mark.

(Two) The qi must be solid. The plain explanation of the character "solid" is simply not scattering, the body loose while the qi is solid. Though the body does not use force, the qi is nevertheless not scattered; if the qi is not scattered, then the movements can begin to be not scattered; if the movements are not scattered, then the whole body can begin to be one. How can one make the qi solid? Simply sink the qi into the belly and do not let it float on top. But this differs from deliberately deepening the breath and expanding the lungs to the utmost and pressing the diaphragm downward. In practising, the shoulders must hang, the elbows must drop, the waist must be settled down, and after a long time the qi naturally sinks — this is what is called the heart empty and the belly solid. When the belly is solid then the qi is solid, and the body has a centre of gravity; however the hands and feet move, the centre of gravity is always in the belly. Gaining that centre of gravity, the movements are as one wishes — hence it is said: when the qi is solid the body is steady of itself.

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XII. On the Method of Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan (continued)

XII. On the Method of Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan (continued)

(Three) The spirit must be gathered. The plain explanation of the character "gathered" is simply that inner and outer unite, and so one can be gathered and settled. Though the body is loose and the qi solid, if inner and outer do not unite, one can in no way reach with the body wherever the mind goes. Only when inner and outer unite are body and mind one qi. Shoulder unites with hip, elbow unites with knee, hand unites with foot — this is called the outer three unities. Mind unites with intent, intent unites with qi, qi unites with power — this is called the inner three unities.

These six unities are what is meant by inner and outer uniting; with the six unities the body is centred and upright, and when the body is centred and upright the spirit can be raised.

XIII. Key Points in Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan

Fu Shengyuan Nowadays there are many people practising Taijiquan, and not a few practising Yang-style Taijiquan; but what is regrettable is that many people, for various reasons, let their postures go out of shape in practice.

Some say that letting the postures go out of shape may even be a kind of innovation. I hold that this question is already stated most clearly in the prefatory notes to *The Complete Book of Taijiquan: Substance and Function* written by the Grand Master of Yang-style Taijiquan, my maternal great-grandfather Mr. Yang Chengfu. He said: "Taijiquan has only one school and no second method; one must not dazzle oneself with cleverness and recklessly add or subtract. As for the established methods of the former worthies, if there were anywhere to be altered — from the Yuan and Ming down to the present it is several hundred years, and if there were anything that could be changed, men of old would already have done it before us; why should they wait for our generation? May the students who come after not scramble only after the outward, but seek only the inward; if you would advance to purity and richness, the day may be awaited. In short, in the fine details of the boxing postures, do not seize upon outward form; one must seek the union of intent. I fear only that private notions will recklessly alter them, and error be passed on as error, so that the true transmission of substance and function is easily lost, and the original meaning of the former worthies buried." Therefore I hold that if one has not yet reached the point of practising Taijiquan without distortion, and has no deep attainment in the work, one had better not set about innovating the postures. And even if one wishes to innovate, one should not call it Yang-style Taijiquan, but should call it some other style of Taijiquan, so as to avoid misleading students and confusing people's eyes and ears.

Furthermore, I hold that in both learning and practising one must not be impatient; if one is in a hurry, I fear that haste defeats the purpose, and learning in front and forgetting behind is of no use. Taking Yang-style Taijiquan as the case: each set takes about twenty minutes to practise, and one should practise at least three sets a day, and further must practise according to the requirements. The frame one has learned must be corrected from time to time to raise one's own level; the longer one learns the higher the requirements, and the more one practises the more one feels it is not easy — only thus can there be progress.

In practising, one must gather one's spirit, and must not let one's thoughts wander; one must think about the movements, and imagine that an enemy is right beside one. Only thus can one use the postures freely, without appearing affected — this is what is called using intent and not force.

At the same time, in practising Taijiquan every lift of a hand and set of a foot must have spirit; Taijiquan is loose and not empty, and one must not practise it limp and yielding, going from looseness to emptiness.

Yang-style Taijiquan sets store by "sitting the wrist": the hand must sit the wrist, the wrist must have power, just as when tap water flows out of a rubber hose — with a little pressure the water's driving force is stronger and it shoots farther. But the fingers, the shoulder and elbow, and the arm must all be loose, and must not be stiff.

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XIII. Key Points in Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan (continued)

XIII. Key Points in Practising Yang-Style Taijiquan (continued)

As for the breathing, it must certainly be natural; I hold that a person's breathing should be like a refrigerator, able to adjust itself automatically.

People often ask: "Why does the frame of Yang-style Taijiquan always turn about the root on the substantial foot?" I think this is a good question, because Yang-style Taijiquan's turning on the substantial foot is for the sake of the training, and is extremely rich in martial application. In the past this point was not made clear, and so in general, when practising, people used the insubstantial foot to turn the heel and shift the centre; this reduced the practice of Taijiquan to a mere general exercise and lowered its martial effectiveness. If one wants to restore the martial effectiveness of Taijiquan, then in practising one must take particular care to use the substantial foot to turn the root and shift the centre. For a frame that uses the insubstantial foot to change the centre of gravity has the foot only just set down when the centre is already shifting, and the foot is released the moment it takes the weight — so the training effect will not be as good as turning the root on the substantial foot. And the distinguishing feature of turning the root on the substantial foot is that the power is unbroken, and the power can keep on being carried forward unceasingly.

Some also worry whether turning the root on the substantial foot will break the power. I hold that so long as substantial and insubstantial are clearly distinguished, the root is not easily broken, because the substantial foot turning its root is a living pillar, and not a dead one.

In addition, one must also attend to this: turning the root must be coordinated with relaxing the hip, and in turning the toes must be slightly lifted, using the heel to turn. And in practising, from the Beginning Posture to the Closing Posture, the whole body must sink and must not float; only when loose can one sink, and the root must turn downward like turning a screw.

Of course, using the substantial foot to turn the root comes down from the old teaching method and is a little more difficult; the whole set of postures is one link clasping another. The number of repetitions should be set according to one's own physical strength; those in good health should train beyond their normal capacity — only then can they develop real skill.

I myself have followed my father Fu Zhongwen in practising from the age of nine. What I have said above is only some of my own experience over many years, and is not necessarily correct. I offer a brick to draw forth jade, and hope that the broad community of fellow practitioners will not stint their instruction.

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Postscript One

Postscript One

Over more than twenty years I have read through in detail the works on Yang-style Taijiquan published at home and abroad, and have found that the fixed-posture photographs of the various schools are much alike, while the course of the movements differs considerably. During my travels away from home (to Chengdu, Harbin, Shenzhen and elsewhere), I saw that the Yang-style Taijiquan practised in different places was not quite the same either; and at international Taijiquan gatherings, the Yang-style Taijiquan demonstrated by the various well-known masters and by the delegates of different regions was again not entirely uniform. So then, what frame should one take as the standard? And which method of practice is the fitting one?

To be sure, the Yang-style Taijiquan most widely current today was given its definitive form by the Grand Master Yang Chengfu, the representative figure of the third generation of transmission. But we should further recognize that Master Yang's Taijiquan can be divided into two periods, earlier and later (conveniently taking about 1928 as the dividing line). This can be known from the two books Master Yang published in succession: namely *The Art of Taijiquan*, written in 1925 by Master Yang's disciple Mr. Chen Weiming, and *The Complete Book of Taijiquan: Substance and Function*, written in 1934 by Mr. Zheng Manqing. In them, Master Yang's photographs from before and after differ somewhat.

Furthermore, analysing a little the many books, periodicals, video recordings and demonstrations of Yang-style Taijiquan, one can also find this situation: the methods of Master Yang's earlier disciples, or of their disciples, are for the most part similar to one another, while the methods of his later disciples are again basically the same among themselves. Though the methods before and after differ, they were all transmitted directly or indirectly by Master Yang, and are all Yang-style Taijiquan; one cannot and should not say who is right and who is wrong. This is because Master Yang's Taijiquan was continually being improved (for example, in the earlier period the fixed posture of the left ward-off faced due south, while in the later period it was changed to face due west, and so on). Master Yang's Taijiquan differed before and after, so what a learner acquired was naturally different; add to this that each person's temperament differs and their comprehension differs, and one arrives at the present situation of divergent methods.

Then should we, in practising Yang-style Taijiquan, take the earlier or the later period as our standard? A study of Master Yang's photographs from the two periods shows that in the later

period the body shape and the step shapes and so on are more regular and more reasonable than in the earlier. As Master Yang indeed points out in *The Complete Book of Taijiquan: Substance and Function*: "Reviewing the frames of my work of a dozen years past, they again do not come up to those of recent days." For a boxer, continually raising his art and improving his technique is an entirely normal phenomenon, and one that accords with the laws of the development of things. Therefore Yang-style Taijiquan should take Master Yang's frame of his later years as its standard.

That the fixed postures of the various forms of traditional Yang-style Taijiquan should take Master Yang Chengfu's photographs of his later years as their standard admits of no dispute. Yet as to the course of the movements, which method of practice is the fitting one?

Only by comparison can one discriminate. Surveying the photographs of the various schools of Yang-style Taijiquan that have been published, one does not find it hard to see that the photographs most resembling Master Yang's later ones are those of the late Master Fu Zhongwen. As the famous Taiji master, my uncle Master Chen Weiming, said, "Fu

Postscript One (continued)

Postscript One (continued)

Zhongwen was a junior relative of the Grand Master Yang Chengfu of Yongnian. He received the master's transmission, and in the rule and the plumb-line he was not off by a hair; hence people called him the orthodox line of Taijiquan." And again, the senior Yang Zhenji, a direct fourth-generation transmitter of Yang-style Taijiquan, said: "Fu Zhongwen loved the martial arts from childhood, and studied boxing with my father and elder brother. Under their meticulous teaching, through many years of hammering and whetting, he at last grasped the essence and profound purport of Yang-style Taijiquan, and became a Yang-style Taijiquan expert of weight at home and abroad." "'In the book *Yang-Style Taijiquan*, compiled and written by Mr. Fu Zhongwen, every posture in the book is compiled according to the frame the old gentleman taught in the past, and the fixed posture of each form has not been altered.'" Indeed, Teacher Fu studied boxing with Master Yang from childhood; and when Master Yang went south from Beijing in 1928 to teach boxing (in Shanghai, Nanjing, Wuhu, Guangzhou and elsewhere), up until Master Yang's death from illness in Shanghai in 1936 (at the age of fifty-three), Teacher Fu stayed at his side throughout, together morning and evening, receiving Master Yang's strict and devoted guidance, and practising hard himself. Teacher Fu was thoroughly versed in Master Yang's frames of his later years, and was much valued; he often spoke on the spot in Master Yang's place, taught and demonstrated the boxing, and went out to compete, and thus deeply received Master Yang's true transmission. As Teacher Fu himself said with modesty: "Though my skill has not reached the point where the fire is purest blue, yet when it comes to the Yang family's Taijiquan, I dare assert

that within the country there is no second person who understands it as clearly as I do." "Every one of my postures I learned from Master Yang, and I have not altered the least bit." And analysed again from the principles of boxing, Teacher Fu's manner of practice is comparatively scientific and reasonable — for example his emphasis on turning the body on the substantial foot, on sitting the leg and turning the waist, and on sitting the wrist; for this can not only raise the effect on health, but also make the lower base steady, the power unbroken, the body method nimble, rich in martial effectiveness, and conducive to developing real skill.

In sum, I hold that the frames (fixed postures) of traditional Yang-style Taijiquan must take as their standard the photographs of the Grand Master Yang Chengfu in his later period (published in 1934), while the course of its movements should follow the practice method of the late Master Fu Zhongwen.

This short piece is respectfully offered in place of a postscript.

Respectfully written as a postscript at Shanghai by Xi Guizhong

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Postscript Two

Postscript Two

The book *Yang-Style Taijiquan: Method of Teaching and Method of Practice*, compiled and written by the great Teacher Fu Zhongwen and the Master Fu Shengyuan, had scarcely been published by Tongji University Press at the end of 1989 when it became so sought-after that paper grew dear in Luoyang and the printing was snapped up clean. Of all lovers of Taijiquan there was none who did not revere that book as a model.

The one small blemish on the book was that, owing to the paper and the printing, Teacher Fu Zhongwen's photographs in it were not clear, and the pictures were very small, so that there was no lover of Taijiquan who did not consider it a matter for regret. Everyone wished to strive to glimpse the splendour of Master Fu's boxing photographs, and to take them as the standard of the orthodox line.

Now *The Directly Transmitted Yang-Style Taijiquan Coaching Method*, after careful revision, is to be published anew — a matter of real significance. The boxing photographs have been replaced with photographs of Master Fu Zhongwen's beloved grandson, my senior fellow-disciple Fu Qingquan. Senior Fu Qingquan once won the championship of Taijiquan and Taiji Sword within China, and over the long term received the instruction of his grandfather and his father, deeply awakening to the essence of Yang-style Taijiquan.

The three generations — the great Teacher Fu Zhongwen, the Master Fu Shengyuan and senior Fu Qingquan — have all their lives done their utmost for the promotion of Yang-style Taijiquan,

and have won the admiration and respect of the world.

In 1987 I had the good fortune, together with other senior and junior fellow-disciples, to study in Singapore the traditional eighty-five-form Yang-style Taijiquan under the Master Fu Shengyuan, and with my fellow-disciples I founded the Yongnian Taijiquan Society at Johor Bahru in Malaysia, to promote this eighty-five-form Yang-style Taijiquan given its definitive form by the famous Taijiquan master Yang Chengfu.

The founding master Yang Lukchan, who enjoyed the name "Yang the Invincible," had a martial art beyond compare, and the anecdotes handed down about him are exceedingly many, filling us with amazement and admiration; but regrettably, in those years the camera had not yet been invented, and we have no way to glimpse the frame and the spirit with which he practised.

The late Master Yang Chengfu is acclaimed as the one who gave Yang-style Taijiquan its definitive form. He fixed the positions of Yang-style Taijiquan, and left his later photographs as a model: settled and expansive, easy and generous, of great bearing and fine appearance, as a model for later generations.

The late great Teacher Fu Zhongwen, who stayed at the side of the late Master Yang Chengfu, fully inherited the frame given its definitive form in the late Master Yang Chengfu's later years; year in and year out, without the least carelessness, he trained, and in 1944 he founded the Yongnian Taijiquan Society in Shanghai. At that time the Grand Master Chen Weiming praised the great Teacher Fu's frame as the orthodox line of Taijiquan. This "orthodox line" refers to the frame given its definitive form by the late Master Yang Chengfu. The great Teacher Fu Zhongwen was the husband of the granddaughter of the sister of the late Taiji Master Yang Chengfu, and was one of the representative figures of contemporary Chinese Yang-style Taijiquan. From early childhood he followed at the side of the late Master Yang Chengfu, deeply probing and bitterly practising Taijiquan. At that time, if someone, admiring Master Yang's fame, offered to compare skills, Master Yang would always have the great Teacher Fu take the field, and there was none whom he did not bring to submission. Hence the great Teacher Fu enjoyed a lofty reputation in the martial world, of high virtue and great prestige.

Postscript Two (continued)

Postscript Two (continued)

The Master Fu Shengyuan practised the martial art with his father from childhood, was deeply influenced by his father, and, carrying on the family teaching, travelled north and south within China and overseas, invited to every part of the world to carry forward this traditional set of the orthodox Yang-style Taijiquan. He is humble as a valley, does not care for fame or gain, and teaches earnestly. Before retiring he taught at the Shanghai Mechanical and Electrical Workers'

University and concurrently taught at Tongji University, the Shanghai Institute of Chemical Technology and the Shanghai Institute of Finance and Economics. In 1986 he carried his art south, and successively taught Taijiquan in Australia, Singapore, Malaysia, Thailand and elsewhere. In recent years he has many times visited more than twenty countries in Europe and America to teach and to exchange, and is deeply welcomed by lovers of Taijiquan; he may be called the first to spread the orthodox Yang-style Taijiquan in the countries of Southeast Asia.

In Taijiquan, between one lift of the hand and one set of the foot there is substance and spirit; when one thing moves nothing does not move, when one thing is still nothing is not still; the whole set must have upper and lower following one another, continuous and unbroken — all of which embodies a serious pursuit of the frame. At the same time each stage has its different levels of requirement, and the most important of all is the training method of changing on the substantial foot, which fully carries through the spirit of the late Master Yang Chengfu's Ten Essentials of Taijiquan. In this book there are also special examples pointing out the errors easily committed in every posture and every form, the causes that produce them, and the methods of correcting them — to fellow students who love the sport of Taijiquan this is undoubtedly a reference book of great value.

We are deeply convinced that with the publication of this *Directly Transmitted Yang-Style Taijiquan Coaching Method* it will surely make its contribution in spreading and raising the art of Taijiquan, and in the sport of Taijiquan, where the schools are in confusion, it will clear the source and rectify the root for Yang-style Taijiquan.

What made me, a student, feel overwhelmed by the honour is that the Master Fu Shengyuan asked his student to write a short piece for this work, so that I, as his student, feel deeply the honour.

Finally, it is worth mentioning that in 1987, when the Master Fu Shengyuan came south to Singapore to teach boxing, he carried with him the draft manuscript of the *Yang-Style Taijiquan: Method of Teaching and Method of Practice*, which he had taken such pains to compile, and solemnly entrusted us to find a way to publish it in Malaysia. In the end, in 1993, after many twists and turns, we succeeded in publishing this book of his in Malaysia, under the title *Yongnian Yang-Style Taijiquan*. The boxing photographs in the book are of the Master Fu Shengyuan's own frame, and the photographs are clearly and beautifully printed.

I believe that with the publication of *The Directly Transmitted Yang-Style Taijiquan Coaching Method*, lovers of Taijiquan will have the chance to glimpse the frame style transmitted in a single line through three generations of the Fu family. This is a matter of great significance, for it keeps those who come after from straying into byways, enables them to distinguish what is the orthodox road of Yang-style Taijiquan, saves them from walking crooked roads, and lets them take directly the true marrow of Master Yang's Yang-style Taijiquan.

This is offered as a postscript.

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